

COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



Bishops at Work (Part 1)

So far I have not dealt with same coloured bishop endings in Endgame Corner, so it is high time to do it. Important concepts in same coloured bishops endings are:

1) **The principle of one diagonal**, i.e. if the bishop can fulfill all its tasks on one diagonal, then it is very strong as it can be diverted and can't fall in zugzwang.

2) **Capablanca's rule**: Put all your pawns on the opposite colour of your bishop, so that they can't be attacked by the opponent's bishop and complement your bishop by protecting squares of the other colour to compensate the bishop's greatest weakness: its monochromacity (it can only visit 32 of the 64 squares of the board).

3) **Put protected pawns on the colour of your opponents bishop to restrict it** (and ideally close it out of your position altogether). This is contradictory to Capablanca's rule (see 2), but chess is no easy game. It depends on the given situation, which rule should be used. Both strategies are of course also applicable in the middlegame.

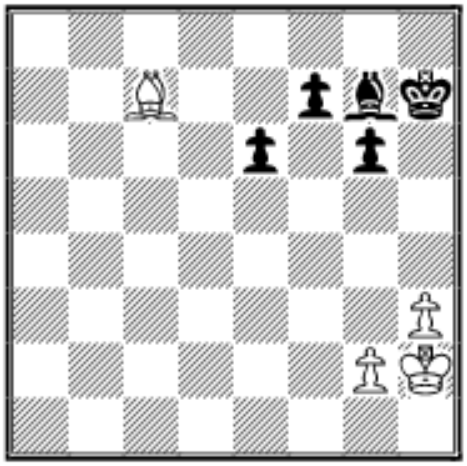
4) **It is difficult to dislodge a king from squares of the other colour**, if there is no check with a pawn and no zugzwang available.

I can't deal with all of these principles in detail, but I hope that my analysis of the following recent games shed some light on the problems:

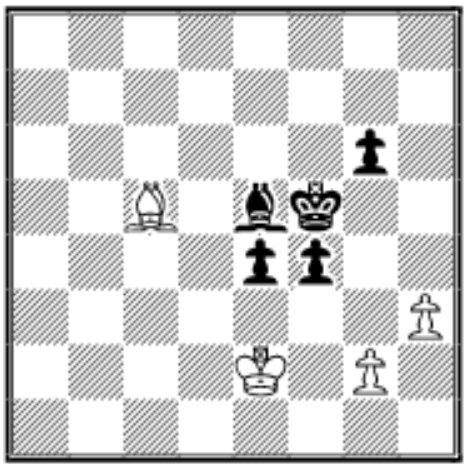
A) A king defends his fortress

The following game is an instructive example of the strength of a defending king, which can't be disloged:

19.01 *P.Blatny* (2458) - *K.Bischoff* (2541) Austrian Staatsliga 31.10.2001



44...f5 45.Kg3 e5 46.Kf3 Kg8 47.Ke2 Kf7 48.Ba5 Ke6 49.Bd2 e4 50.Bc1 Be5 51.Bd2 f4 52.Bb4 Kf5 53.Bc5



White's king on e2 is holding the position together: **53...Bf6**

53...Kg5 54.Kf2 Kh4 55.Be7+ g5

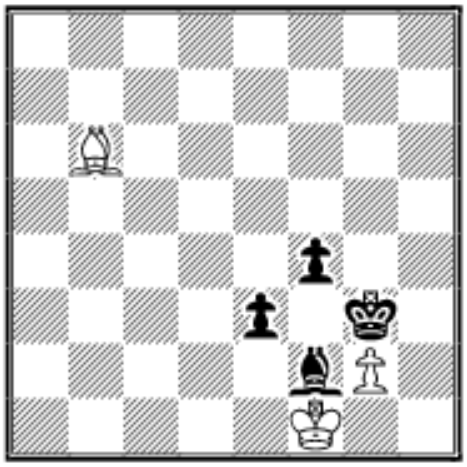
A) 56.Bd8? Bd4+

A1) 57.Kf1 Be3 58.Bf6 (58.Ba5 Kg3 59.Be1+ Kh2 60.h4 g4 61.h5 g3 62.h6 f3–+) 58...f3 59.Be5 Bf4 60.Bc3 Kg3 61.Be1+ Kh2 62.gxf3 exf3 63.Kf2 Bg3+–+

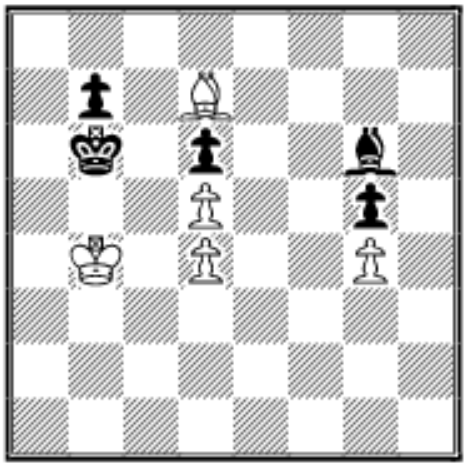
A2) 57.Ke2 Be3 58.Bc7 Kg3 59.Kf1 Bd2 60.Be5 (60.Bb6 f3 61.gxf3 Kxf3–+) 60...e3 61.Bd4 e2+ 62.Kxe2 Be3 63.Bc3 Kxg2 64.Be1 Bb6 65.h4 f3+ 66.Kd3 gxh4 67.Bxh4 Bc7–+

B) 56.Bc5! the king has to stay on f2 for the time being

54.Bf2 Bc3 55.Bc5 Ba5 56.Ba7 Bb4 57.Bb6 Ke6 58.Bc7 Bd6 59.Bb6 Kd5 60.Ba7 Bc5 61.Bb8 g5 62.Bc7 Ke6 63.Bd8 Kf5 64.Ba5 Kg6 65.Bc3 Kh5 66.Ba5 Bg1 67.Bb4 Bh2 68.Ba5 Kh4 69.Be1+! Bg3 70.Bd2 Kh5 71.Bb4 Kg6 72.Bc5 Kf5 73.Bb6 g4 74.hxg4+ Kxg4 75.Bc5 Bh4 76.Bb6 Bf6 (76...Kg3 77.Bf2+ Kxg2 78.Bxh4 e3 79.Be1=) **77.Kf2 Bb2 78.Ba7 Bc1 79.Bb6 Ba3 80.Ba7 Be7 81.Bb6 Bh4+ 82.Ke2 Bg5 83.Kf2 e3+ 84.Kf1 Bh4 85.Ke2 Bf2 86.Kf1 Kg3**



87.Bc7! the only move as 87.Ba5? e2+ 88.Kxe2 Kxg2–+ loses **87...Kg4 88.Bb6 Bh4 89.Ke2** and after a few more moves a draw was agreed.



19.02 *T.Souche* (2139) - *M.Santo Roman* (2426) Paris-ch op 2001

White's king on b4 keeps the enemy at bay. Butt he has to defend very carefully due to his weak pawns: **52.Bb5?** loses precious ground. White can hold the position with 52.Be6

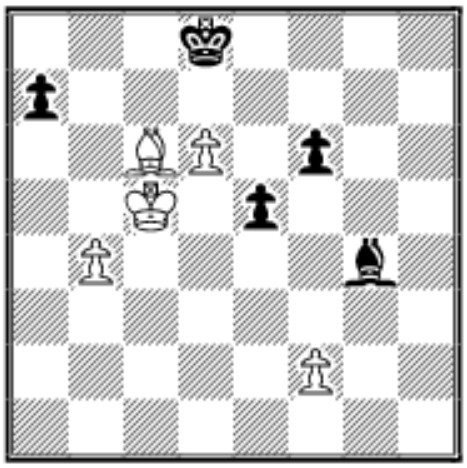
A) 52...Kc7 53.Ka5 Bd3 (53...Be8 54.Bf5 Bd7 55.Bxd7 Kxd7 56.Kb6 Kc8 57.Kb5 Kc7 58.Ka5 Kb8 59.Kb6= as 59...Ka8?? loses to 60.Kc7 b5 61.Kxd6+-) 54.Bf7 b6+ 55.Kb4 Be2 56.Be6 Ba6 57.Bf5 Bc8 58.Be6! (58.Bxc8? Kxc8 59.Kb5 Kb7 60.Ka4 Ka6 61.Kb4 b5 62.Kb3 Ka5–+)

58...Ba6= (58...Bxe6? 59.dxe6 d5 60.Kb5 Kd6 61.Kxb6 Kxe6 62.Kc6+-; 58...Bd7? 59.Bxd7 Kxd7 60.Kb5 Kc7 61.Ka6+-)

B) 52...Be4 53.Bg8 Bf3 54.Be6 Ka6 55.Ka4 b5+ 56.Kb4 Kb6 57.Bd7 Bxd5 58.Bxb5=

52...Be4! 53.Kc4 (53.Bc4 Bf3–+) **53...Bd3+!** a nice shot. White probably hoped for 53...Bxd5+?? 54.Kxd5 Kxb5 55.Kxd6+- **54.Kxd3 Kxb5 55.Ke4 Kc4 56.Kf5 b5 57.Ke6 b4 58.Kxd6 b3 59.Kc7** (59.Kc6 b2 60.d6 b1Q 61.d7 Qb8–+) **59...Kxd5 0–1**

19.03 *Xu Jun* (2668) - *P.Nielsen* (2578) Istanbul ol (Men) 2000



The goalkeeper on d8 would have drawn this position as well: **48.b5 f5?**

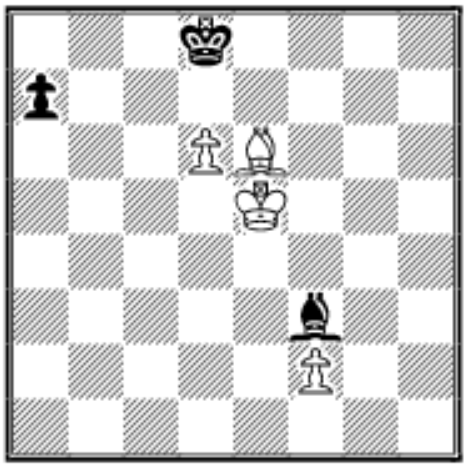
Christopher Lutz showed the method to hold the draw (see his analysis in the MEGABASE 2001): 48...Be6! 49.Kb4 Bc8 50.Ka5 f5 51.Kb4 Be6 52.Kc5 f4 e.g.

A) 53.Bf3 Bc8 54.Kc6 Bd7+ 55.Kd5 Bxb5 56.Kxe5 a5 57.Kxf4 a4 58.Bd1 (58.Bd5 Bd3 59.Ke5 Bb1 60.f4 a3 61.f5 a2=) 58...a3 59.Bb3 Bc6 60.Ke5 Bf3=

B) 53.f3 Bb3 54.Bd5 (54.Kb4 Be6 55.Ka5 Bc8 56.Be4 Ke8 57.b6 axb6+ 58.Kxb6 Kd8=) 54...Bc2 55.Kc6 e4 56.fxe4 f3 57.e5 f2 58.e6 (58.Bc4 Be4+ 59.Kc5 Bg2=) 58...f1Q 59.e7+ Ke8 60.Kc7 Qxb5 61.Bc6+ Qxc6+ 62.Kxc6 Bf5=

49.Kd5 e4 (49...Bf3+ 50.Kxe5 Bxc6 51.bxc6 a5 52.Ke6+-)

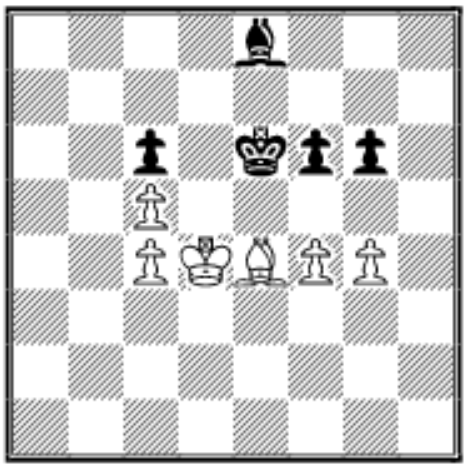
50.Ke5 Bh3 51.Bd5 Bg4 52.Be6 Be2 53.Kxf5 Bxb5 (53...e3 54.fxe3 Bxb5 55.e4 Bd3 [55...a5 56.e5 a4 57.Ke4 a3 58.Kd4+-] 56.Kf4 a5 57.Ke3 Bc2 58.e5 a4 59.Kd4 Bb1 60.Bg4+-) **54.Kxe4 Bc6+** (54...a5 55.f4 a4 56.f5 a3 57.f6 Ke8 58.Kd4 Ba4 59.f7+ Kf8 60.Kc5 Kg7 61.Kb4 Bd7 62.Ba2+-) **55.Ke5 Bf3**



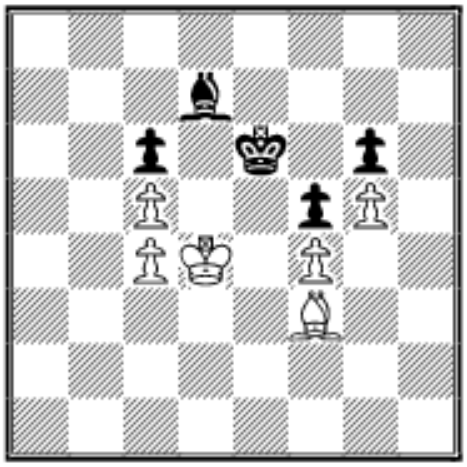
White wins the race now: **56.Bd5 Bg4** (56...Bxd5 57.Kxd5 a5 58.f4 a4 59.f5 a3 60.f6 Ke8 61.Ke6 a2 62.f7+ Kf8 63.d7+-) **57.f4 a5 58.f5 a4 59.f6 Ke8 60.f7+ Kf8 61.Be6 a3 62.d7 1–0**

19.04 *A.Miles* (2584) - *L.Comas Fabrego* (2516) Mondariz zt 1.1 2000

In the next example Black tried the restriction method, but it is nevertheless very complicated as Tony Miles tried very hard to break through:



It looks like White's king and bishop have no inroad into Black's camp, but Miles finds an amazing way to create trouble: **69.g5 f5!** Normally the defender tries to exchange pawns to reduce the remaining winning potential, but in this position he has to restrict White's bishop with f5. 69...fxg5? 70.fxg5 Kf7 71.Ke5 Ke7 72.Bg2 Bd7 73.Bf3 Be8 74.Be4+- **70.Bf3 Bd7**



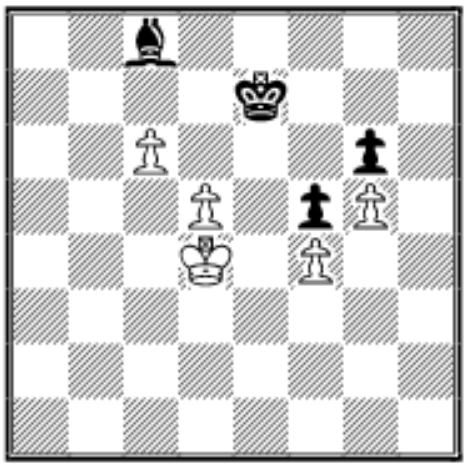
71.Bd5+!! A fantastic shot! Tony Miles really had good technique and fighting spirit! **71...cxd5?**

71...Ke7! was correct as Tsesarsky showed in CBM 79: 72.Ke5 cxd5 73.cxd5

A) 73...Bb5 works as well: 74.c6 Bc4 (74...Ba4? 75.d6++-) 75.d6+ Kf7 76.Kd4 Be6 77.Kc5 Ke8=

B) 73...Ba4 74.c6 Bb5 75.d6+ Kd8 76.c7+ (76.Kd5 Kc8 77.Kc5 Bd3=) 76...Kd7 77.Kf6 Ba6 78.Kxg6 Kxd6 79.Kxf5 Kxc7 80.Kf6 Kd7 81.f5 Bd3! firing at the f-pawn is essential (81...Ke8? 82.Kg7+-) 82.g6 Ke8 83.g7 Bc4 84.Kg6 Bd5 85.Kh7 Ke7=

72.cxd5+ Ke7 73.c6 Bc8 (73...Be8 74.Ke5 Bf7 75.d6+ Kd8 76.Kf6+-)



A critical position. White has to make the right choice. **74.Kc5?**

74.Ke5! was called for: 74...Ba6 75.d6+ Kf7 76.Kd5 Ke8 77.Ke6 Bc4+ 78.Kf6 Bb5 79.c7 Kd7 80.Kxg6 Ba6 81.Kxf5 Kxd6 82.g6 Kxc7 83.Ke6 Kd8 84.Kf7 Bc4+ 85.Kf8 Kd7 86.f5+- (Tsesarsky)

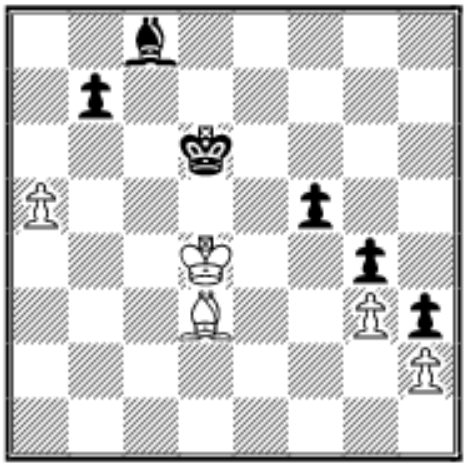
74...Ke8! After 74...Kd8? 75.Kb6+- Black is in a fatal zugzwang. **75.d6** (75.Kb6 Kd8 76.d6 Be6 77.Kb7 Bd5=) **75...Be6 76.Kd4** (76.d7+ Ke7 [76...Bxd7? 77.cxd7+ Kxd7

78.Kd5 Ke7 79.Ke5 Kf7 80.Kd6+-] 77.Kb6 Bxd7 78.cxd7 Kxd7 79.Kb7 Kd6 80.Kc8 Kd5 81.Kd7 Ke4=) **76...Kf7 77.Kc5** (77.Ke5 Bb3 78.d7 Ke7 79.d8Q+ Kxd8 80.Kf6 Kc7 81.Kxg6 Kxc6 82.Kxf5 Kd7 83.Kf6 Ke8 84.g6 Kf8=) **77...Ke8 78.Kd4 Kf7 79.d7 Ke7 80.Kc5 Kd8 81.Kd4 Ke7 82.Kc5 Kd8 83.Kd6 Bxd7 84.cxd7** stalemate ½–½

Sources:

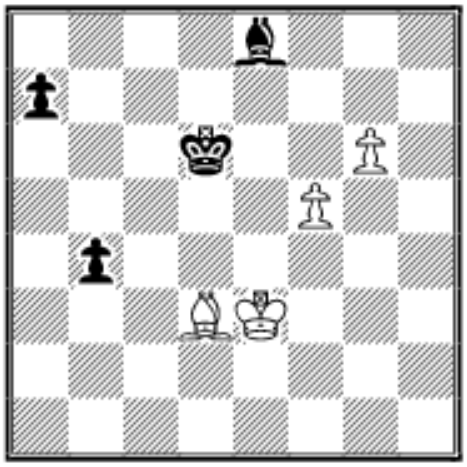
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
ChessBase Magazine 79
The Week in Chess
Secrets of Chess Intuition, Beliavsky and Mikhalchishin, Gambit 2002

Exercises (Solutions next month)



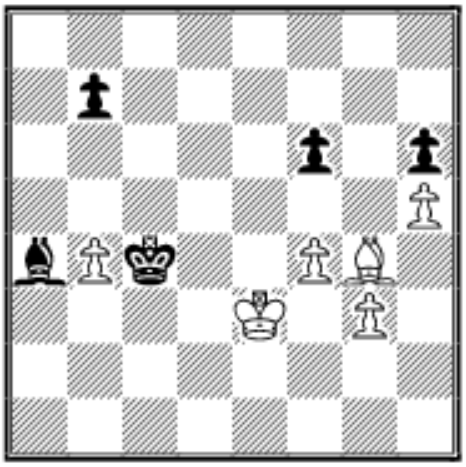
E19.01 *T,Thiel* (2335) - *K.Müller* (2505) German Bundesliga 1997

Can White to move save his skin?



E19.02 *B.Raphael* - *H.Kennicott* USA–01.New York 1857

How to asses this position with White to move?



E19.03 *E.van Haastert* (2417) - *M.Hoffmann* (2428) Dutch Team Playoffs Enschede 2002

Who is better? (White to move.)



E19.04 *Rogulj* - *Groszpeter* Gleisdorf 1996

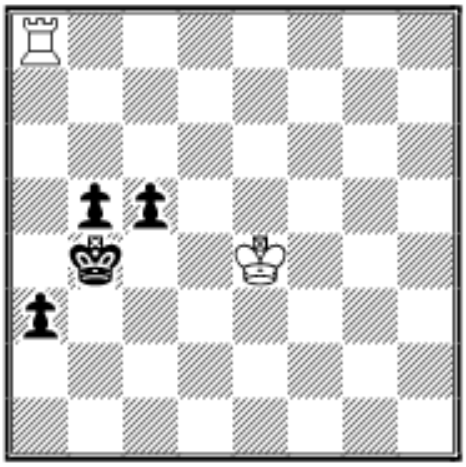
Find Black's most convincing move.



E19.05 *Z.Ivanovic* (2232) - *M.Savic* (2184) Croatian Cup Pula 2002

While playing through some bishop endings I found this very fascinating pawn ending. How to evaluate this position with White to move?

Solutions to last month exercises



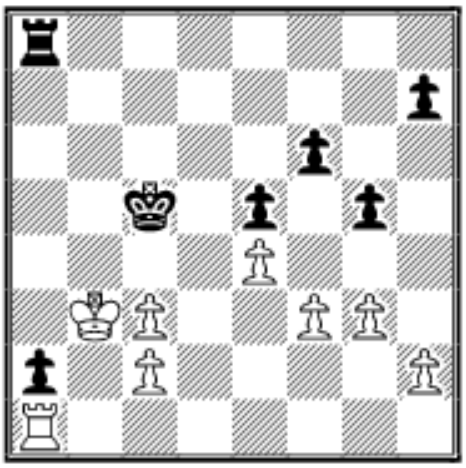
E18.01 *J.Loifenfeld* (2400) - *A.Illner* (2309) German 2.Bundesliga West 2000

White has to act very precisely: **65.Kd3?** now the advance c4 follows with check!

65.Ke3! Kb3 66.Ra5 b4 (66...c4 67.Rxb5+ Kc2 68.Ra5=; 66...a2? 67.Kd2+-) 67.Rxc5 a2 (67...Kb2 68.Ra5 b3 69.Kd3=) 68.Ra5 Kb2 69.Kd3 (69.Kd2? b3 70.Kd3 a1Q–+) 69...b3 70.Kc4=

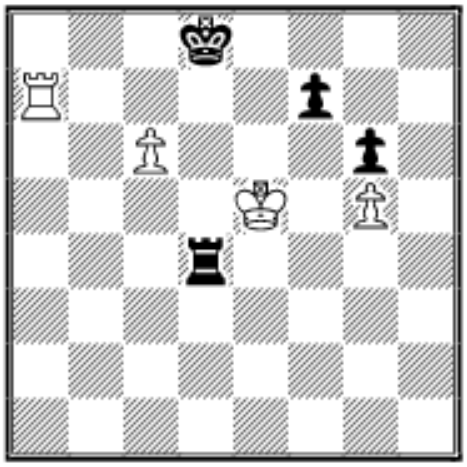
65.Ra7? is wrong as well: 65...c4 66.Kd4 Kb3 67.Rh7 c3 68.Kd3 a2 69.Rh1 b4 70.Rf1 c2 71.Rc1 Ka3! 72.Kxc2 b3+ 73.Kd3 b2–+

65...Kb3 66.Kd2 (66.Ra5 c4+ 67.Kd2 b4 68.Kc1 Ka2–+) **66...Kb2 67.Ra5 b4 68.Kd3 a2 0–1**



E18.02 *H.Hebbinghaus* - *T.Heinemann* NDBMM Potsdam 2002

1.Rxa2?? was a very unfortunate choice: **1...Rb8+ 2.Ka3 Kc4 3.Ra1 Kxc3 4.Ka2 Kxc2 0–1**



E18.03 *R.Polzin* (2469) - *E.Brestian* (2428) Austrian Staatsliga 2002

The position is astonishingly difficult: **57...Rc4?**

57...Rg4! was the right move: 58.Kf6 (58.Rxf7 Rxg5+ 59.Kd6 Rf5=) 58...Rf4+ 59.Ke5 Rf1=

58.Kf6?

58.Rxf7 leads to a won endgame with the g-pawn: 58...Rxc6 59.Rf6 Rc1 (59...Rc5+ 60.Kd6 Rf5 61.Rxg6 Ke8 62.Ke6 Rf8 63.Rh6 Rg8 64.g6 Kf8 65.Kf6+-) 60.Rxg6 Ke7 61.Rf6 Rc5+ 62.Kf4 Ra5 63.Kg4 Ra1 64.Kf5 Ra8 65.Kg6 Rg8+ 66.Kh6+-

58.c7+ wins surprisingly as well:

A) 58...Kd7 59.c8Q+ Kxc8 60.Rxf7 Rc6 61.Re7 (61.Rf6? Rc5+ 62.Kf4 Rc4+ 63.Kg3 Kd7 64.Rxg6 Ke7 65.Rf6 Ra4=) 61...Kd8 62.Re6 Rc8 63.Kf6 Kd7 64.Re7+ Kd6 65.Re1 Rg8 66.Kf7+-

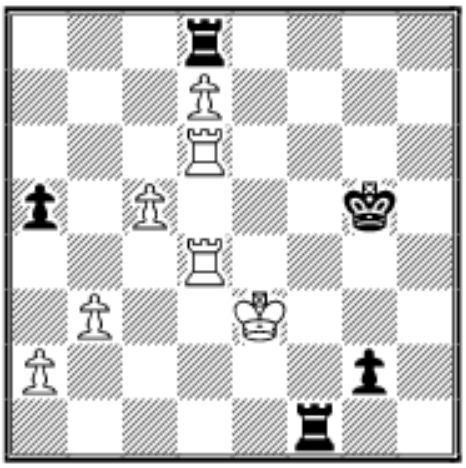
B) 58...Kc8 59.Kf6 Rf4+ (59...Rc5 60.Ra8+ Kxc7 61.Ra7+ Kd8 62.Rxf7 Ke8 63.Rh7 Rc6+ 64.Kg7 Ra6 65.Rh6+-) 60.Ke7

B1) 60...Rf1 61.Ra8+ Kxc7 62.Rf8 f5 (62...Rg1 63.Rxf7 Rxg5 64.Kf6++-) 63.gxf6 g5 64.Rg8 Re1+ 65.Kf8 Re5 66.f7+-

B2) 60...Rg4 61.Ra5 Rf4 62.Ra8+ Kxc7 63.Rf8+-

58...Rf4+! (58...Rxc6+? 59.Kxf7 Rb6 60.Ra8+ Kd7

61.Rg8+-) **59.Ke5 Rf1 60.Rd7+ Kc8 61.Kd6 f6 62.Rc7+** (62.Rf7 Rd1+ 63.Kc5 fxg5=) **62...Kd8 63.Rd7+ ½–½**



E18.04 *V.Anand* (2794) - *A.Shirov* (2722) Leon Man+Comp

Anand played **56.R4d5+** and Shirov resigned due to **56...Kh4** (56...Rf5 57.Rxf5+ Kxf5 58.Kf2+-) **57.Rh6+ Kg4** (57...Kg3 58.Rg5#) **58.Rg6+ Kh4 59.Rxg2+- 1–0**

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COLUMNISTS

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Karsten Müller

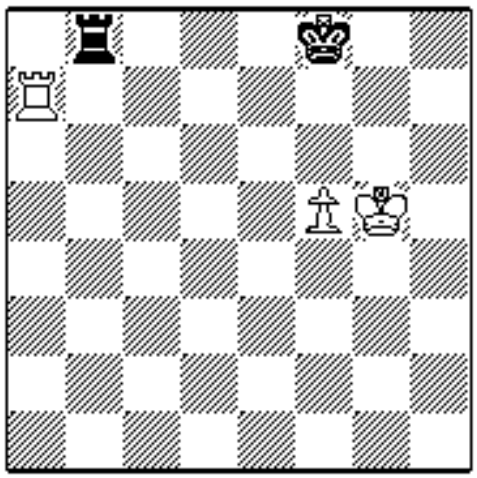
The Chess Cafe is pleased to welcome German grandmaster Karsten Müller as one of its regular columnists. Müller was born in Hamburg in 1970 and has played for the Hamburger SK team in the German Bundesliga since 1988, with an overall score for the 12 years of 86½/159, achieving a GM norm in the 1997-98 season. His third place finish in the 1997 German Championship together with his second place finish in the 1998 Hamburg Championship earned the grandmaster title. He has been a regular contributor to *ChessBase Magazine* since 1997 and is the co-author, with IM Frank Lamprecht, of the outstanding book *Secrets of Pawn Endings* (Everyman 2000). Away from the chessboard he is a mathematician and currently working at Hamburg University undertaking research towards his doctorate.



We hope you enjoy Karsten's new **Chess Cafe** column, ***Endgame Corner***...

All Rook Endings Are Drawn

You are certainly aware of the old aphorism by Dr.Siegbert Tarrasch. It certainly contains a lot of truth, but matters are of course not that easy and sometimes it only seems to apply when you are one or two pawns up. Nevertheless, a drawish tendency is inherent in many rook endings and in my first **Chess Cafe** column I want to look at Rook and h- and f-pawn vs Rook. The general result is a draw, which has baffled me ever since I got to know it. Before we dive into the jungle, I want to give three positions with Rook+f-pawn vs Rook (*See Diagram*):

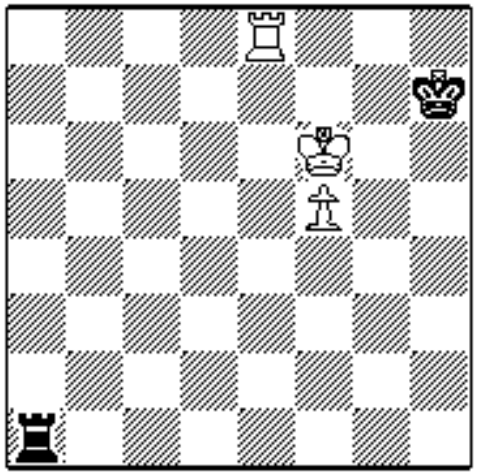


1.01 Philidor Position +/=

The Philidor position is one of the most important of endgame theory and the defensive method is certainly worth knowing as it applies also to the other pawns on the 5th rank: 1...Rb6! and White can't make any progress as his King has no shelter after 2.f6 Rb1 3.Kg6 Rg1 +=

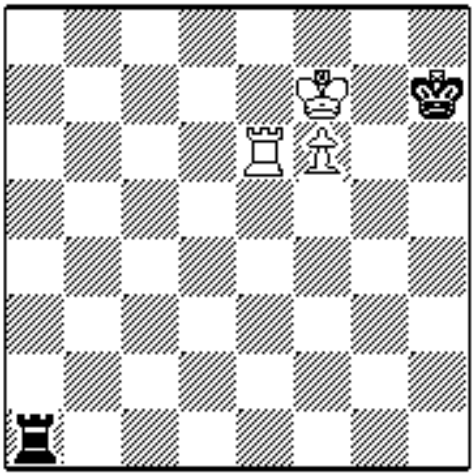
White to move wins as follows: **1.Kg6! Kg8** (1...Rb1 2.Ra8+ Ke7 3.f6+ Ke6 4.Re8+ Kd7 5.f7 +-) **2.f6 Rd8 3.Rg7+ Kf8 4.Rh7 Kg8 5.f7+ Kf8 6.Rh8+** +-

If Black to move misses Philidor's set up, active defense with **1...Rb1?!** is possible as well, but passively waiting on the eighth rank is fatal, as White wins with 2.Kg6! similar to the White to play case of the first diagram. **So the general principle that active play is crucially important in rook endings is valid here as well.** After **2.Kg6 Rf1!** the Rook moves behind the pawn to make his advance more difficult. After **3.Kf6**, another important moment arises. To which side shall Black's King go? To the long or the short side of the pawn? **3...Kg8!** (3...Ke8? loses as the checking distance of Black's Rook is much too short. White can gradually force the advance of his pawn: 4.Ra8+ Kd7 5.Rf8! Rh1 6.Kg7 Rg1+ 7.Kf7 Rh1 8.f6 Rh7+ 9.Kg8 Rh1 10.Ra8 Rg1+ 11.Kf8 Rf1 12.f7 Rg1 and White has reached a **Lucena-type position** and wins by building a bridge: 13.Ra4 Rg2 14.Rd4+ Kc7 15.Ke7 Re2+ 16.Kf6 Rf2+ 17.Ke6 Re2+ 18.Kf5 Rf2+ 19.Rf4 +-) **4.Ra8+ Kh7 5.Rf8 Ra1!** and the reason for going to the short side is revealed: **the checking distance of the Rook is great enough now**. After **6.Re8** we have reached the next position (*See Diagram*):



1.02 After Kling and Horwitz 1851 =/=

Black can still draw comfortably by the following method: **1...Rf1! 2.Rf8 Ra1 3.Re8 Rf1 4.Ke6 Kg7** and White can't make progress. If Black plays less accurately with **1...Ra6+?!**, the position remains drawn, but great care is required: **2.Kf7 Ra7+ 3.Re7 Ra8 4.f6 Ra1** (4...Kh6!? draws as well.) **5.Re6!** and we have reached Chéron's position (1.03), which is of crucial importance for the ending Rook+ h- and f-pawn vs Rook (*See Diagram*):

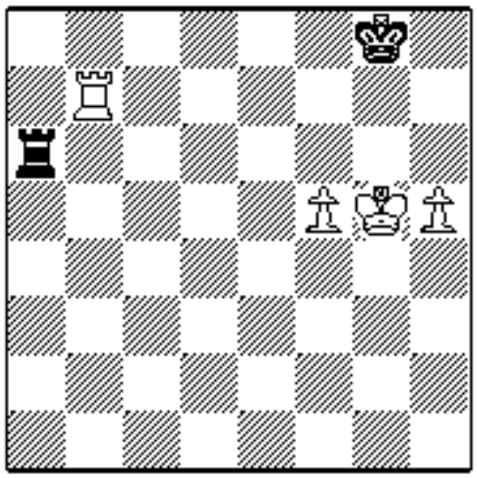


1.03 Chéron 1926 +/=

1...Ra8! only establishing a last rank defense secures the draw **2.Re8** (2.Ke7 Kg6 3.f7+ Kg7! 4.Ra6 Rb8 =) **2...Ra7+** (2...Ra6 is playable as well. All other moves lose.) **3.Re7 Ra8 4.Re6 Kh6 5.Re1 Ra7+! 6.Re7** (6.Kf8 Kg6! 7.Rf1 Rf7 +=) **6...Ra8 7.Re6 Kh7** =

White to move wins, but he has to act very precisely: **1.Kf8! Kg6** (1...Ra8+ 2.Re8! Ra6 [2...Ra7 3.Re7+ +-] 3.f7 Ra7 4.Rd8 Kg6 5.Rd6+! Kh7 6.Ke8+-; 1...Ra2 2.f7 Ra8+ 3.Re8!+- [3.Ke7? Kg7! =]) **2.f7+! Kh7 3.Rf6 Re1 4.Rf2 Re3 5.Rh2+ Kg6 6.Kg8** +-

With h- and f-pawn, a third rank defense like Philidor's in the first diagram is not enough to reach a draw (*See Diagram*):



1.04 Maizelis, *Shakhmaty*, September 1939 +/-

White to move wins relatively easily: **1.f6 Ra1 2.Rg7+ Kh8** (2...Kf8 3.h6 and the h-pawn runs through.) **3.Kg6 Rg1+ 4.Kf7 Ra1 5.Rg8+ Kh7 6.Re8 Ra7+ 7.Kf8** followed by f7 and White wins the Lucena-type position.

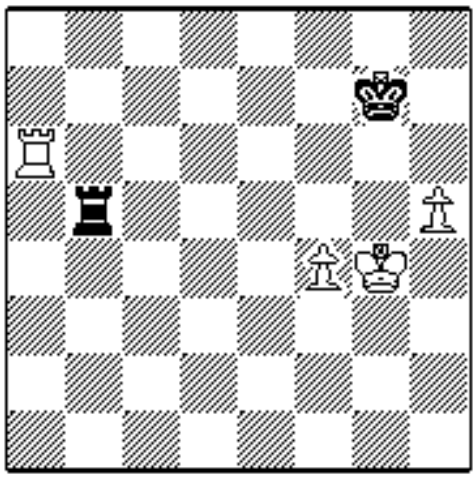
With Black to move, much more care is required: **1...Ra1!? 2.h6 Rg1+** (2...Ra6 3.f6 Ra1 4.Rb8+ Kh7 5.f7 Rf1 6.Rb7! [6.f8Q? Rxf8 7.Rxf8 stalemate.] 6...Kh8 7.Kg6 Rg1+ 8.Kf6 Rf1+ 9.Ke7 Re1+ 10.Kd8 Rf1 11.Ke8 Rf5 12.Rb5 +-) **3.Kf6 Ra1**

There are two major alternatives:
(A) 3...Rh1 4.Rg7+ Kf8 (4...Kh8 5.Re7 Rxh6+ 6.Kf7! Ra6 7.f6! Kh7 8.Kf8+! Kg6 9.f7! Ra8+ 10.Re8 Ra7 11.Re6+!+-) 5.Kg6 Rg1+ 6.Kh7 Rf1 7.Ra7 Rg1 (7...Rxf5 8.Kg6!+-) 8.f6 Rg2 9.Rg7 Rf2 10.Kg6 Rf1 11.h7 Rg1+ 12.Kf5 Rh1 13.Ke5+- (after 13.Rg8+ Kf7 14.h8Q?? is a fatal error: Rxh8 15.Rg7+ [15.Rxh8 stalemate] 15...Kf8! 16.Kg6 Rh1 =, but 14.Ra8 still wins.);

(B) 3...Rf1 4.Rg7+ Kh8 (4...Kf8 5.Rg5 Rh1 6.Kg6 Kg8 7.f6 Rh2 8.f7+ Kf8 9.h7 +-) 5.Re7 Kg8 6.Re8+ Kh7 7.Ke6 Ra1 (7...Kxh6 8.f6! Re1+ 9.Kf7 Ra1 10.Rh8+ Kg5 11.Kg7! +-) 8.f6 Ra6+ 9.Kf5 Ra5+ 10.Re5 +-

4.Re7 Ra2 (4...Rh1 5.Ke6 Rxh6+ 6.f6! +-) **5.Ke5 Re2+ 6.Kd6 Rd2+** (6...Rf2 7.Re8+ Kh7 8.Ke6 +-) **7.Ke6 Re2+ 8.Kd7 Rd2+** (8...Rf2 9.Re8+ Kh7 [9...Kf7 10.h7 +-] 10.Ke6 +-) **9.Ke8 Rf2 10.Re5 Kh7** (10...Rf1 11.Ke7 +-) **11.Kf7** (11.Ke7? Kxh6! 12.Kf7 Ra2 13.f6 Ra8 14.Re6 Kh7 = and we have reached the Black-to-play case of the third diagram) **11...Kxh6 12.Re6+! Kh7 13.f6! Ra2 14.Kf8!** +- (White-to-play case of the third diagram).

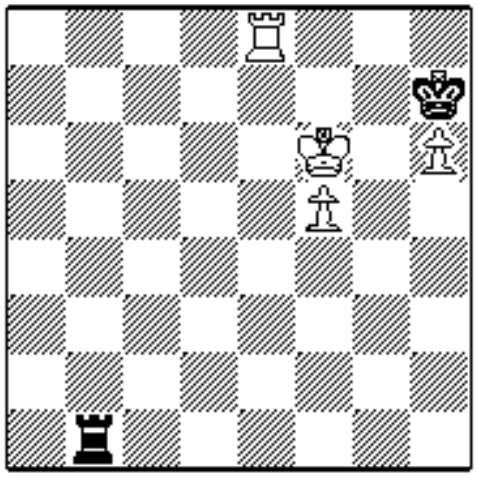
But starting from a normal position, the attacker is usually not able to confine the defending King to the back rank. The following defensive effort by endgame virtuoso Vassily Smyslov is so impressive that Mark Dvoretsky thinks that for a practical player, it is enough to study it to understand the whole ending with h- and f-pawn and Rook vs Rook (*See Diagram*):



1.05 S.Gligoric - V.Smyslov, Moscow 1947 =/=

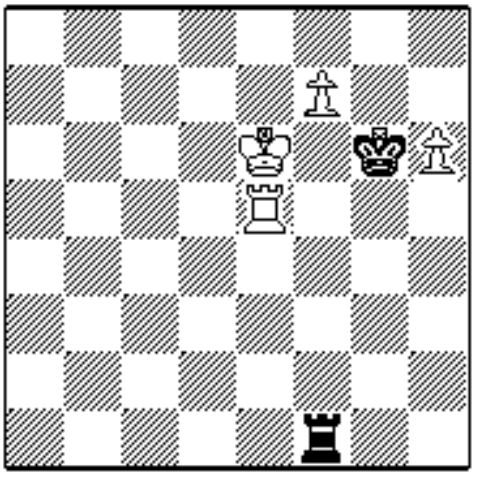
Black's Rook occupies a good position on b5 as it hinders the advance of White's King: **1.Rg6+** (After 1.f5 Black can give checks from behind: 1...Rb1 2.h6+ Kh7 3.Kg5 Rg1+ 4.Kf4 Rf1+ 5.Ke5 Re1+ 6.Kf6 (A) The immediate 6...Kxh6? runs into 7.Kf7+! Kh7 8.Ra2 Rh1 [8...Kh6 9.f6 Rb1 10.Rh2+! Kg5 11.Kg7 +-] 9.f6 +-; (B) 6...Rb1! 7.Re6 Kxh6 =) **1...Kf7! 2.Rg5 Rb1!** the southwest corner is the right place for the Rook. It can give check from the side or behind depending on White's winning attempts. **3.Rc5** (3.h6 Ra1! [3...Rg1+? 4.Kf5 Rh1 5.Rg7+ +-] 4.h7 [4.Rh5 Kg8 5.h7+ Kh8 6.f5 Ra4+ 7.Kg5 Ra6 =] 4...Rg1+ 5.Kf3 Rh1 6.Ra5 Kg6 7.Ra7 Kf5 =) **3...Kf6 4.Rc6+ Kg7!** this decision is of crucial importance. (After 4...Kf7? Black's King is driven to the back rank: 5.Kg5 Rg1+ 6.Kf5 Rh1 7.Rc7+ +- [compare 1.04]) **5.Kg5 Rg1+! 6.Kf5 Ra1 7.Rc7+ Kh6 8.Re7 Rb1 9.Re8 Kg7 10.Re5 Ra1 11.Rd5 Rf1** (11...Rb1 =) **12.Rd4 Ra1 13.Rd6 Ra5+ 14.Kg4 Ra1** (14...Rb5!? 15.Rg6+ and the position after 1.Rg6+ arises again.) **15.Re6 Rg1+ 16.Kf5 Ra1 17.h6+ Kh7!** now Black's King has to go on the h-file to take the h-pawn when the appropriate time arrives. **18.Rd6 Ra2 19.Kg5 Rg2+ 20.Kf6 Kxh6! 21.Ke7+ Kh7** (21...Kg7 22.f5 Re2+ 23.Re6 Rf2! 24.f6+ Kg6! [24...Kg8? 25.Re5 +-] 25.Rd6 [25.f7+ Kg7! =; 25.Re1 Ra2 26.Rg1+ Kh7 27.f7 Ra7+! =] 25...Rf1 =) **22.f5 Re2+ 23.Re6 Ra2 24.f6 Ra8! 25.Kf7 Kh6 26.Re1 Ra7+! 27.Re7 Ra8** (27...Ra1 28.Kf8 Kg6! 29.f7 Kf6! 30.Kg8 Rg1+! =) **28.Rd7 Kh7 29.Rd1 Ra7+! 30.Ke6 Ra6+ 31.Rd6 Ra8 32.Rd4 Kg8 33.Rg4+ Kf8** ½-½

In the next position White has managed to penetrate one step further, but with accurate play it is still drawn (*See Diagram*):



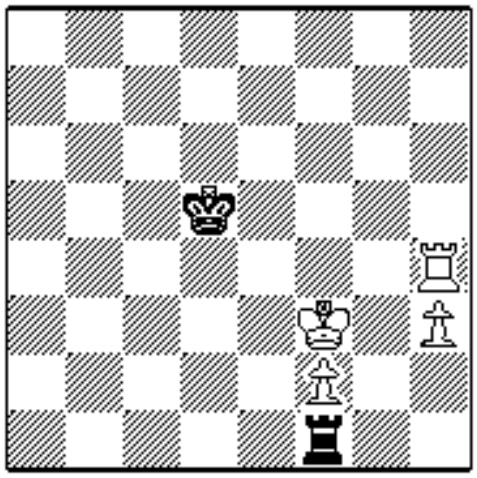
1.06 A.Ivanov (2395) - A.Vitolinsh (2430)
URS-FL Frunze 1979 =/=

72.Ke6!? (72.Kf7 Kxh6 73.Re2 Rb7+ 74.Re7 Rb8 75.f6 Kh7 =) **72...Rb6+?** allows White's King to penetrate to f7 with decisive effect. (72...Kxh6! was called for: 73.f6 Rb6+! 74.Kf7 [74.Ke7 Rb7+ =] 74...Kh7 =; 72...Re1+? is wrong as well: 73.Kf7 Rf1 74.f6 Kxh6 75.Re2 Kg5 76.Kg7 +-) **73.Kf7 Ra6** (73...Kxh6 74.Re6+! +-; 73...Rxh6 74.f6 +-; 73...Rb7+ 74.Kf8 Kxh6 75.Re6+! +-) **74.Re1 Ra8** (74...Ra7+ 75.Kf8! [Maizelis] 75...Kxh6 76.Re6+! Kg5 [76...Kh7 77.Re7+ +-] 77.f6! Kf5 78.Rd6 Ke5 79.Rb6 +-) **75.f6 Ra7+ 76.Re7 Ra8 77.Re8 Ra7+** (77...Ra6 78.Ke7 (A) 78...Kg6 (A1) 79.Rg8+?! Kf5 80.h7 [80.f7? Ra7+ 81.Ke8 Ra8 +=] 80...Ra7+ 81.Kf8 Rxh7 82.Rg7! Rh8+ 83.Ke7! Ra8 84.f7! Ra7+ 85.Kd6! Ra6+ 86.Kc5 Rf6 87.Kd5! Kf4 88.Rg1 Ke3 89.Re1+ Kd2 90.Re7! +-; (A2) 79.h7 Ra7+ 80.Ke6 Ra6+ 81.Kd5 Kxh7 82.f7! +-; (B) 78...Ra7+ 79.Ke6 with transposition into the game after 78.Ke6) **78.Ke6 Ra6+ 79.Kf5 Ra5+ 80.Re5 Ra1 81.f7 Rf1+ 82.Ke6 Kg6** (*See Diagram*):



At first sight it seems that Black can hold on, but the strike **83.Rg5+!!** clarifies the situation: **83...Kxg5 84.h7 Re1+** (84...Rf6+ 85.Ke7 Kg6 86.h8Q Rxf7+ 87.Ke6 +-) **85.Kd7 Rd1+ 86.Ke8 Re1+ 87.Kf8 Rh1 88.Kg7** 1-0

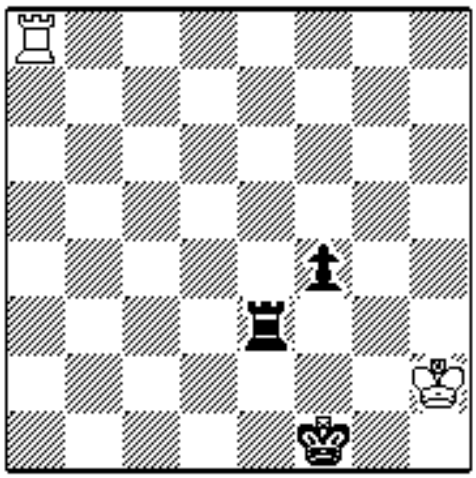
I want to end this article with one recent example and two exercises (*See Diagram*):



1.07 J.Timman (2635) - N.Short (2655), El Escorial cf 1993 =/=

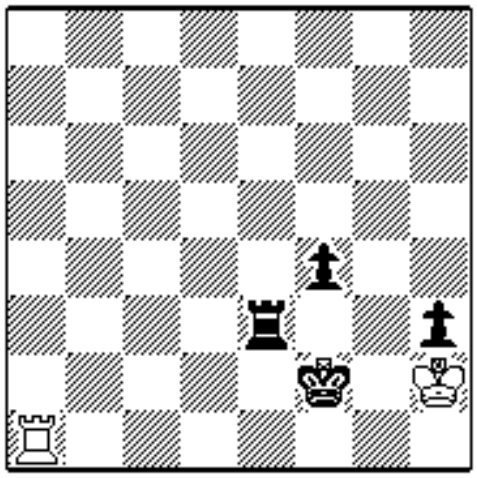
66.Rf4 (66.Re4?! Rxf2+ =) **66...Ke5 67.Kg2 Ra1 68.Rf8 Ke6 69.h4 Ke7 70.Rf4 Ra8 71.Kh3 Rh8 72.Kg4 Rg8+ 73.Kh5 Ke6 74.Kh6** (74.f3!?) **74...Ke5 75.Ra4** (75.Rf3 Rh8+ 76.Kg5 Rg8+ 77.Kh5 Rh8+ and White can't make progress.) **75...Rg2?** (75...Kf6 76.Ra6+ [76.Rf4+ Ke5 77.Rf7 Ke6 78.Rf3 Rh8+ 79.Kg5 Rg8+ 80.Kh5 Rh8+ 81.Kg4 Rg8+ 82.Kh3 Rh8 =] 76...Kf7 [76...Kf5? 77.h5 Rh8+ 78.Kg7 Rxh5 79.Ra5+! Kg4 80.f3+! Kh4 81.Rxh5+! Kxh5 82.Kf6! +-] 77.Ra3 Rg6+! [77...Rb8 78.Kh7+-; 77...Rg2 78.Rf3+ +-; 77...Rh8+ 78.Kg5 Rg8+ 79.Kf5 Rg2 80.Ra7+ Kg8 81.f4 +-; 77...Kf6 78.Rf3+ +-] 78.Kh5 Rf6 79.f3 Rf5+ 80.Kg4 Rb5 = (Ftacnik in MEGABASE 99]) **76.f3 Rg3 77.Re4+ Kf5 78.Re8 Rg6+ 79.Kh7 Rf6 80.Kg7 Rg6+ 81.Kh7 Rf6 82.Re7! Ra6** (82...Kf4 83.Kg7 +-) **83.Rf7+ Ke6 84.Kg7 Ra1 85.Rf6+** 1-0 as White wins with his h-pawn for a change.

Exercises
(Solutions next month)



E1.01 *I.Bondarevsky - I.Kan*, URS-ch11 Leningrad 1939

Can White to move save the postion? What about Black to move? (*See Diagram*):



E1.02 *A.Kotov - S.Flohr*, URS-ch19 Moscow 1951

How to asses the position with Black to move?

Sources:
A.Chéron, *Lehr-und Handbuch der Endspiele*, Band 1, 2.Auflage, Engelhardt Verlag, Berlin 1960.
M.Dvoretsky, A.Yusupov, *Technique for the Tournament Player*, Batsford 1995.
J.Nunn, *Secrets of Rook Endings*, 2nd edition, GAMBIT 1999 (first edition, Batsford 1992).
J.Emms, *The Survival Guide to Rook Endings*, Everyman 1999.
J.Speelman, J.Tisdall and R.Wade, *Batsford Chess Endings*, Batsford 1993.
ChessBase MEGABASE 1999.

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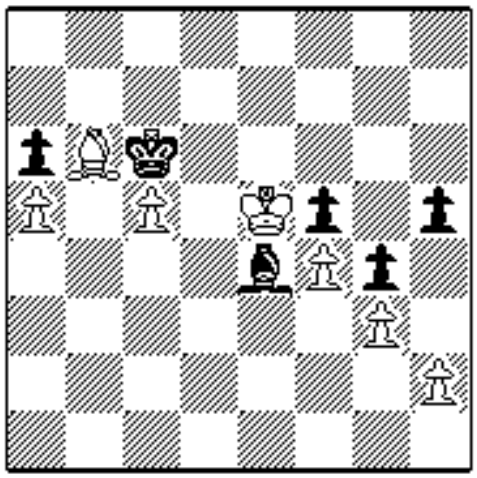
COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller

Bees of Opps

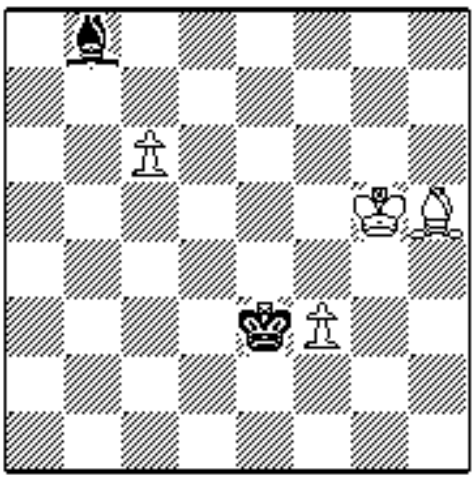
OPPOSITE-COLOURED BISHOP ENDINGS are even more drawish than rook endings as both bishops live in different worlds. If the defender manages to establish a **firm blockade on squares the same colour of his bishop** this is usually the end of the matter (*See Diagram*):



2.01 H.Strobel - K.Müller Hamburg 1983 =/=

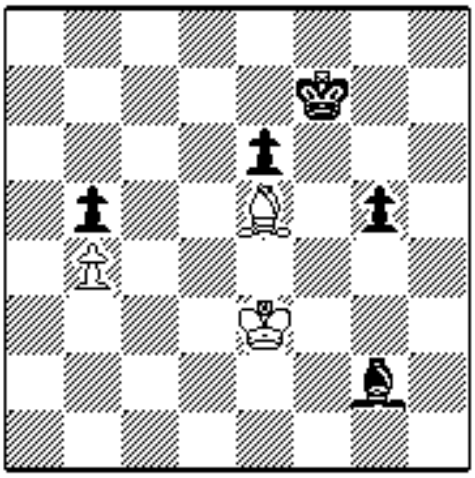
White can win Black's h-pawn, but not the game: **41...Bd3 42.Kf6 Be4 43.Kg5 Bd3 44.Kxh5 Be4** draw agreed as the plan king-march to g1 followed by h2-h4 g4xh3e.p. Kg1-h2 leads to nothing after Bd5(or e4)-f3 with the same ironclad fortress as after **45.Kh4 Bf3** (45...Bg2!?) **46.h3 gxh3 47.Kxh3 Bg4+ 48.Kh4 Kd5 49.Kg5 Kc6 50.Kf6 Kd7 51.Ke5 Bh3 52.Kd5 Bg2+**=

The next two positions represent the second main type of fortress (*See Diagram*):



2.02 Cheron 1957 =/=

Black's king can't get in front of one of the passed pawns, but, assisting his bishop, he nevertheless manages to survive: **1...Bc7!** (After 1...Kd4? 2.f4 the pawns can no longer be stopped on the same diagonal and Black is lost e.g. 2...Kc5 3.Bf3 Kd6 4.f5 Ke7 5.f6+ Kf8 6.Kf5 Ke8 7.Ke6 Bg3 8.f7+ Kf8 9.Bd5 Bf4 10.Kd7+-; 1...Bh2? 2.Kf5 Kd4 3.f4 Ke3 4.c7+-) **2.Kf5 Kd4 3.Ke6 Kc5 4.Kd7 Kb6 5.Be8 Bb8 6.Ke6 Kc5 7.Kf5 Kd4 8.Kg4 Ke3 9.Bh5 Bc7=.**

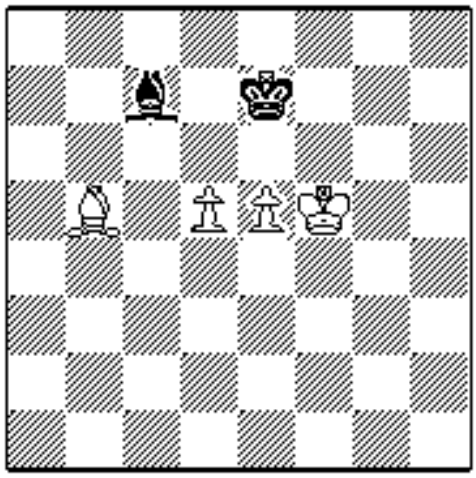


(*See Diagram*):

2.03 V.Kramnik - G.Kasparov Braingames WCh London 2000 =/=

The players agreed to a draw as Kasparov can't make any progress: **1...Kg6 2.Bc7 Kf5 3.Kd4 Kg4 4.Ke3 Kh3 5.Kf2 =**

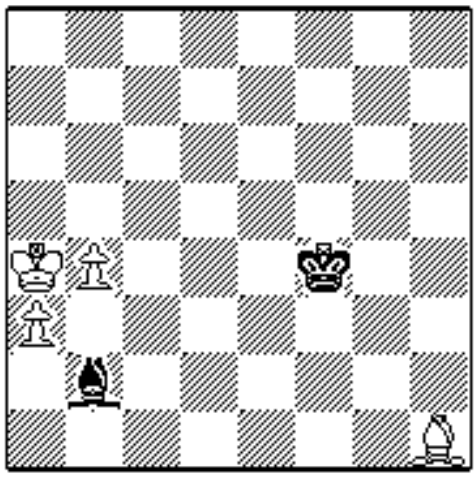
Even two connected passed pawns usually don't win (*See Diagram*):



2.04 =/=

White can't make any meaningful progress as Black's bishop ties White's king to the defense of the e-pawn: **1.Ke4** (1.e6 Bd6=; 1.d6+ Bxd6 2.exd6+ Kxd6=)**1...Bb8! 2.Kd4 Bc7**=. The bishop has two squares on the b8-h2 diagonal so Black doesn't fall into zugzwang.

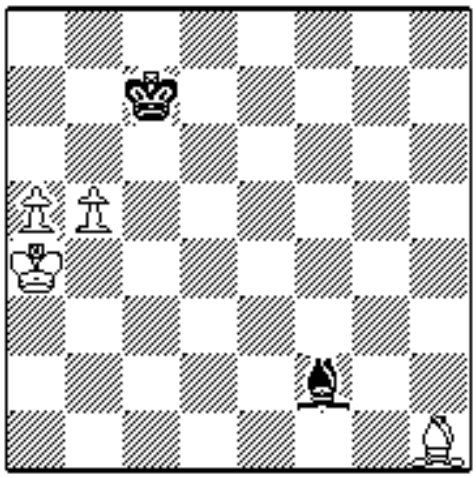
So usually the best strategy to win with connected passed pawns is to keep the king in front of them (*See Diagram*):



2.05 Somlai - Sherzer Zalaegerszeg 1990 +/

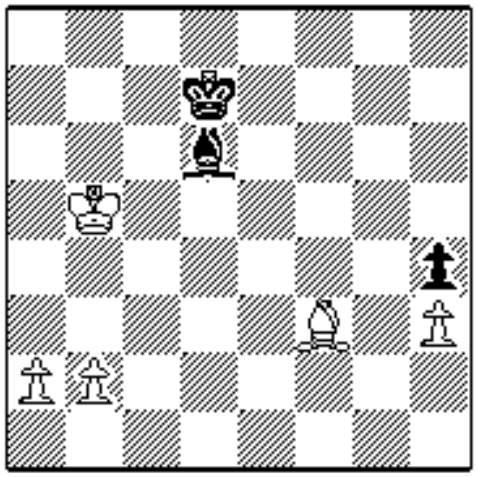
1.Kb3?! a step in the wrong direction. (1.b5 immediately was easier: 1...Ke5 2.b6 Kd6 3.Kb4+- [Soltis in *GM Secrets: Endings*]) **1...Bc1** (1...Bd4 doesn't help either as White's king gets in front of the pawns: 2.Kc4 Ke5 3.a4 Bf2 4.Kb5 Kd6 [4...Be1 5.Kc5 Bf2+ 6.Kc6+-] 5.Ka6+-) **2.a4?** this spoils the win as Black's king is back in time now. (2.b5! was called for: 2...Ke5 3.Kb4 Be3 [3...Kd6 4.b6 Be3 5.Kb5+-] 4.Ka5 Kd4 5.b6 Kc4 6.b7 Ba7 7.a4 Kc5 8.Ka6 Bb8 9.a5 Kb4 10.Bf3

Bc7 11.Be2 Ka4 12.Bd1+ Kb4 13.Bc2 Bf4 14.Kb6 Be3+ 15.Kc6 Ba7 16.a6 Ka5 17.b8Q Bxb8 18.Kb7 Kb5 19.Bd3++-) **2...Ke5 3.Kc4** (3.a5 Kd6 4.b5 Bd2 5.Ka4 Kc5 6.b6 Bg5 7.Bg2 Bd8 8.b7 Bc7=; 3.b5 Kd6 4.b6 Kc5 5.b7 Bf4=) **3...Kd6 4.Kb5 Bd2!** keeping an eye on the b-pawn **5.a5 Kc7 6.Ka4 Be1 7.b5 Bf2!** (*See Diagram*)



Against a- and b-pawns this formation is enough to draw as White's king can't penetrate on the queenside. **8.b6+ Bxb6 9.axb6+ Kxb6 ½-½**

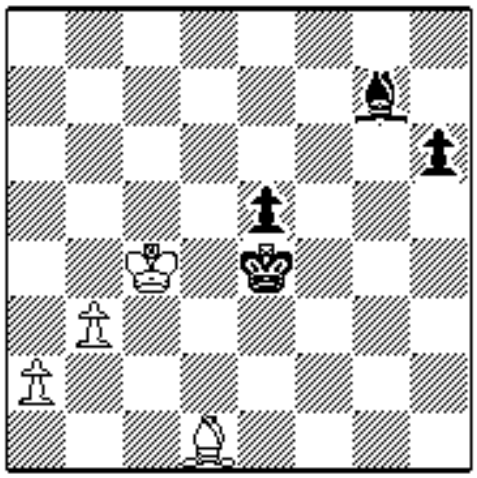
The next position is very similar despite the additional h-pawns due to the "wrong" rook's pawn on h3 (*See Diagram*):



2.06 E.Walther - R.J.Fischer Zürich 1959 +/

54.a4? already a decisive mistake allowing Black's king to get to a7. (54.b4! was necessary as pointed out by Pal Benko in *Chess Endgame Lessons*, p.24: 54...Kc7 55.Ka5 Kb8 56.b5 Ba3 57.b6 Kc8 58.Ka6 Kb8 59.Be4 Bc5 [59...Kc8 60.Ka7 Bc5 61.a4+-] 60.a4 Bd4 61.Kb5+-) **54...Kc7 55.b4 Kb8 56.a5 Ka7 57.Ka4 Bg3 58.b5 Bf2 59.Be2** (After 59.Bd5 Be3 60.b6+ Bxb6 61.axb6+ Kxb6 62.Kb4 Kc7= Black's king is inside Rauser's drawing zone a6-c4-d5-e4-h7 [for further details see Averbakh, example #68, p.41]) **59...Be3 60.Kb3 Bd2 61.b6+ Kb7 62.Ka4 Kc6! 63.Bb5+ Kc5!** draw agreed as White can't make any meaningful progress.

The connected passed pawns surprisingly even win in the following position (*See Diagram*):



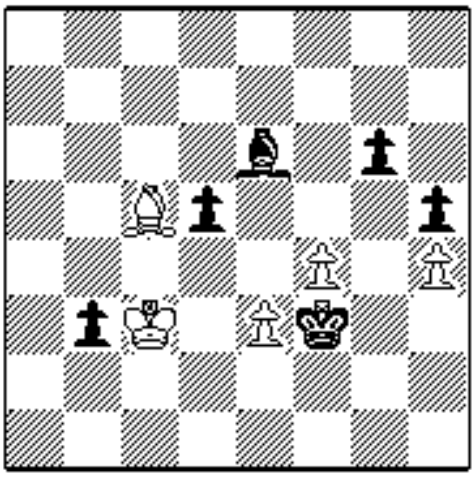
2.07 A.Khalifman (2635) - A.G.Donchenko (2385) Moscow Tal mem 1992 +/-

The analysis is based on work by Solozhenkin and Khalifman on the CD ROM *Ungleichfarbige Läuferendspiele*: **66...Kf5** (66...Ke3 67.a4 e4 68.a5 Be5 69.b4 Kd2 70.Bh5+-; 66...h5!? 67.Bxh5 Kf5 68.a4 [68.b4 Ke6 69.Kb5 wins as well, because Ka6 followed by b5-b6 and a4-a5 can't be prevented in the long run.] 68...Ke6 [68...Bh6 69.a5 Ke6 70.Kc5! Kd7 71.Kb6 Kc8 72.b4+-] and now White has to act very precisely:

A) 69.a5? Kd6 70.Kb5 Bh6 71.Kb6 [71.b4 Bd2=] 71...Be3+ 72.Kb7 Kc5! 73.a6 Kb4 74.Bd1 e4=;

B) 69.Kc5! Bf8+ [69...Kd7 70.Kb6 Kc8 (70...Bf8 71.a5+-) 71.b4+-] 70.Kc6 Bb4 71.Bg4+ Ke7 72.Kb6 Kd6 73.a5 Bc5+ 74.Kb7 Bd4 [74...Kd5 75.a6 Kd4 76.b4+-] 75.a6 Kd5 76.Bf3+ [76.a7? Bxa7 77.Kxa7 Kc5=] 76...e4 77.Bxe4+ Kxe4 78.b4+-) **67.a4 Ke6 68.a5 Kd6 69.b4** Bh6 would save Black now. But unfortunately it is not possible: **69...e4** [69...Bf6 70.Kb5 Kc7 71.Ka6 e4 72.b5 Kb8 73.b6 Bc3 74.Kb5 Bxa5 75.Kxa5 Kb7 76.Kb5 e3 77.Be2+-] **70.b5 h5 71.Bxh5 Kc7 72.b6+ Kb7 73.Kb5 Bd4 74.a6+ Kb8 75.Be8 1-0**

That positional considerations can be more important than material in opposite colored bishop endings is illustrated by the next two very famous examples (*See Diagram*):

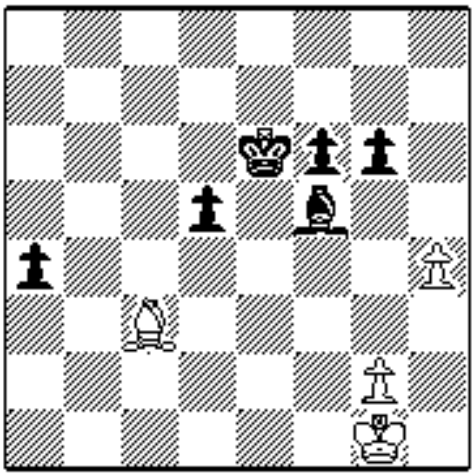


2.08 A.Kotov - M.Botvinnik URS-ch22 Moscow 1955 /+

A first sight it looks as if White has an ironclad fortress. His king safeguards the passed b-pawn and his bishop protects the other pawns. But Botvinnik managed to land a fantastic blow: **59...g5!! 60.fxg5** (60.hxg5 h4 61.Bd6 [61.f5 Bxf5 62.Kxb3 h3 63.Bd6 Kxe3-+] 61...Bf5 62.g6 Bxg6 63.f5 Bxf5 64.Kxb3 h3-+) **60...d4+!** Keeping the valuable b-pawn **61.exd4 Kg3** (61...Kg4? 62.d5 Bxd5 63.Bf2 spoils

it.) **62.Ba3** (62.g6 Kxh4 63.Be7+ Kg4-+ and Black wins as his bishop can protect the b-pawn and stop the white pawns **on one and the same diagonal. This is an important principle in bishop endings !**) **62...Kxh4 63.Kd3 Kxg5 64.Ke4 h4 65.Kf3 Bd5+** and Kotov resigned. A possible finish is **66.Kf2 Kf4 67.Kg1 h3 68.Kh2 Be6 69.d5 Bd7 70.d6 Ke4-+**

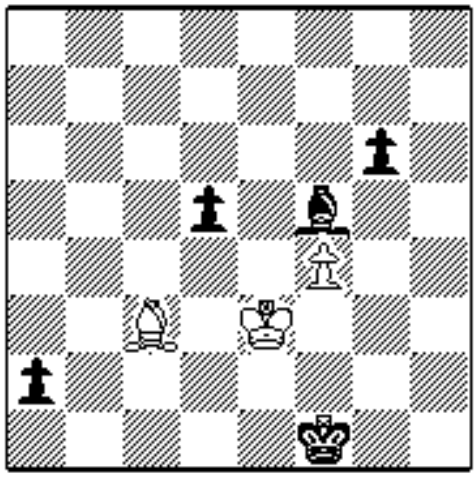
In very extreme cases even the bishop can be sacrificed (*See Diagram*):



2.09 V.Topalov (2740) - A.Shirov (2710) Linares 1998 =/+

Shirov played the unbelievable **47...Bh3!!** which is surprisingly the only move to win, e.g. 47...Be4? 48.g3 Kf5 49.Kf2 a3 50.Ba1 Bh1 51.Ke3 Kg4 and now:

A) 52.Kf2? f5 53.Be5 a2 54.Bb2 f4 55.gxf4 Kxh4! 56.Ke3 Be4 57.Kf2 Kg4 58.Ke3 (58.Be5 Kf5 59.Ke3 g5-+) 58...Kg3 59.Ba1 Kg2 60.Be5 (60.Ke2 Bf5 61.Bd4 Bg4+ 62.Ke3 Kf1 63.Kd2 Be2 64.Kc1 Kg2 65.Kb2 Bc4-+) 60...Kf1 61.Bc3 Bf5 (*See Diagram*)

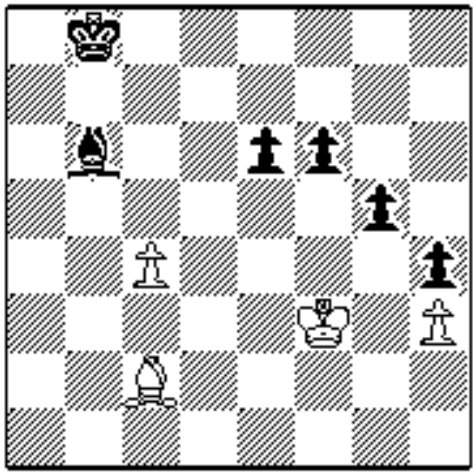


putting White in zugzwang 62.Kd2 62.Kf3 d4 63.Bxd4 Ke1 64.Ke3 Kd1-+) 62...Kf2 63.Bb2 Kf3 64.Be5 Bb1 65.Ke1 Ke3 66.Bb2 Kxf4-+;

B) 52.Bxf6 Kxg3 53.Ke2 a2 (53...d4 54.Bxd4 Kxh4 55.Bf6+ g5 56.Kd2=) 54.Ke3 Kg4 55.Ke2 Kf5 56.Ba1 Ke4 57.Kd2 d4 58.Bb2 Bf3 59.Ba1 d3 60.Bf6 Bg4 61.Ba1 Bf5 62.Bb2 Kf4 63.Bc3 Kg4 64.Bf6 a1Q 65.Bxa1 Kxh4 66.Bf6+ g5 67.Ke3=; 47...Kd6? 48.Kf2 Kc5 49.Ke3= **48.gxh3** (48.Kf2 Kf5 49.Kf3 Bxg2+ 50.Kxg2 Ke4-+ [A.Shirov in Informant 72/415]) **48...Kf5 49.Kf2 Ke4 50.Bxf6** (50.Ke2 f5-+ [A.Shirov]; After 50.Bb4 Black's three passed pawns decide the outcome: 50...Kd3 51.Ba3 d4 52.Bb2 f5 53.Kf3 Kc4 54.Ke2 d3+ 55.Kd2 f4 56.Be5 f3 57.Ke3 f2 58.Kxf2 Kb3-+) **50...d4 51.Be7** (51.Ke2?! a3-+ [Ftacnik in *ChessBase Magazine 64*]; 51.Bg5 Kd3 52.Ke1 Kc2-+) **51...Kd3! 52.Bc5 Kc4! 53.Be7** until this point all Black's move were unique. Now he has a choice: **53...Kb3** (53...Kc3-+) and Topalov resigned due to **54.Bc5 d3**

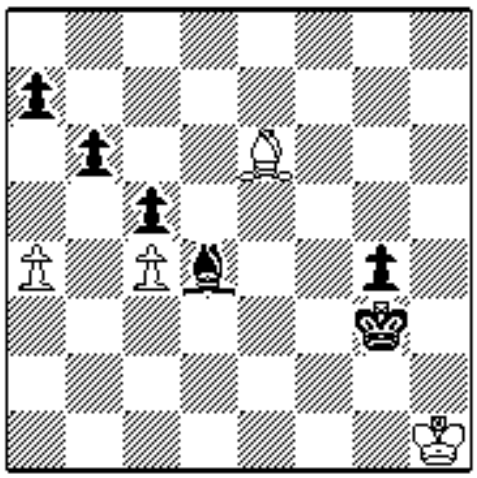
55.Ke3 Kc2 56.Bb4 a3-+ (Ftacnik)

Exercises:



E2.01 M.Dvoretsky

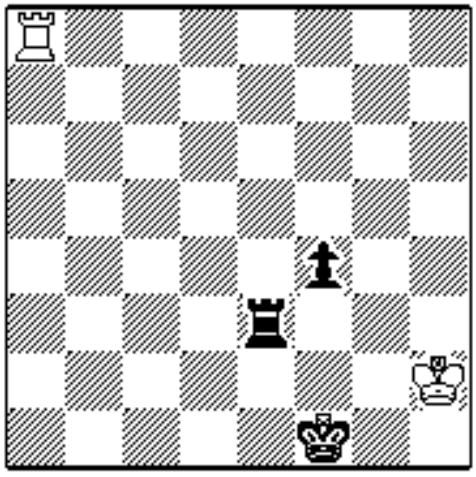
It looks pretty grim for White doesn't it ?



E2.02 K.Müller (2470) - J.Gustafsson Hamburg simul 1994

In a simultaneous display against young talents from Hamburg Jan Gustafsson, who was fourteen years old, reached the following position. Did he manage to win it?

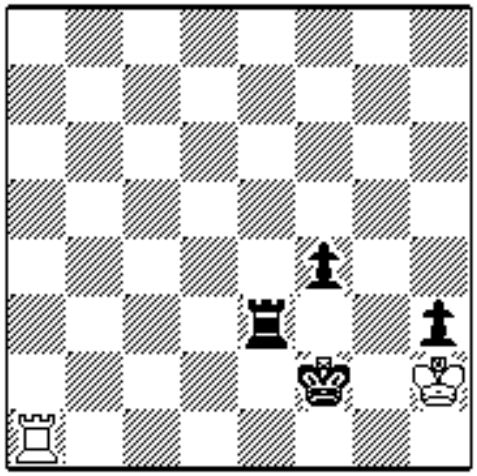
Solutions to last month's exercises:



E1.01 I.Bondarevsky - I.Kan URS-ch11 Leningrad 1939

In the game it was White to play: **127.Ra1+! Re1 128.Ra3!** f3 has to be prevented **128...Re2+ 129.Kh1! Re3 130.Ra1+! Kf2 131.Kh2 Re1 132.Ra4 f3 133.Ra2+ Re2 134.Ra1** White has established a back rank defense **134...Re3 135.Rb1 Re7 136.Rb2+! Re2 137.Rb1 Re1 138.Rb2+ Ke3 139.Rb3+! Kf4 140.Rb4+! Re4 141.Rb8 Re2+ 142.Kg1 ½-½**

Black to move wins as in (1.03): **1...f3!** (1...Re2+ 2.Kh3 Re3+! 3.Kh2 f3!-+) **2.Ra1+** (2.Ra7 f2 3.Ra2 Rf3-+) **2...Re1! 3.Ra3 f2-+**



E1.02 A.Kotov - S.Flohr
URS-ch19 Moscow 1951

Flohr won the game as follows: **107...Re1 108.Ra2+** (108.Ra3 A. 108...f3? 109.Kxh3! Re3 [109...Re8 110.Ra2+! Kf1 111.Kg3!=] 110.Ra1!=; B. 108...Re8 109.Ra2+ Kf1 110.Ra1+ Re1 111.Ra3 Re2+ 112.Kh1 Re3 113.Ra1+ Re1 114.Ra3 f3-+) **108...Kf1 109.Kxh3** (109.Ra3 Re2+ 110.Kh1 Re3 111.Ra1+ Re1 112.Ra3 f3 113.Rxf3+ Ke2+-+) **109...Re3+! 110.Kg4 f3! 111.Kg3 f2+! 112.Kh2 Re8 113.Ra1+ Ke2 114.Ra2+ Kf3 0-1**

Sources:

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COLUMNISTS

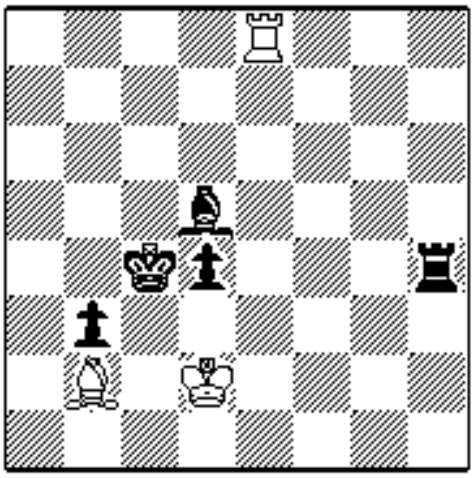
Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller

Chess Cafe Reader E-books Articles

Bees of Opps and Rooks

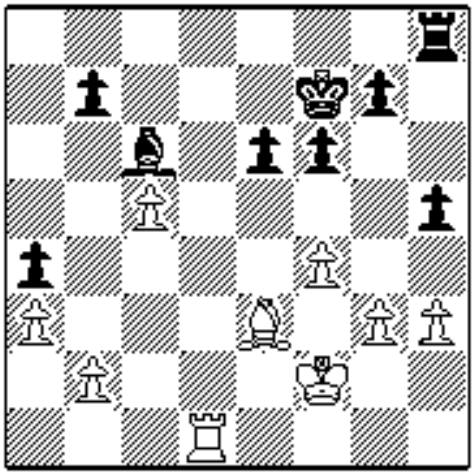
My first column was about rooks my second about opposite coloured bishops, so it is now time to deal with opposite coloured bishop and rook endings. A lot of new motifs like sacrificing the exchange and playing for mate come into play then. Generally speaking, the winning chances of the attacking side are much higher than in opposite coloured bishops endings. The first example demonstrates this (*See Diagram*):



3.01 *Ed.Lasker - J.R.Capablanca*, New York 1931 /+

Without the rooks the position would be dead drawn, but with them Capablanca won convincingly: **65...Rh2+ 66.Re2** (66.Kc1 d3 67.Rc8+ Kb5 68.Rb8+ Ka4 69.Rf8 [69.Rc8?! d2+ 70.Kd1 Bf3#] 69...Rc2+ 70.Kb1 d2 71.Rf1 Bf3-+) **66...Rh3 67.Re8 Bc6 68.Re2** (68.Rc8!? Rh2+ 69.Kc1 Kd3 70.Kb1 Be4 71.Ka1 Ke3 72.Bc1+ Kf3 73.Rf8+ Ke2 74.Re8 Kd1 75.Bb2 Rh1 76.Rc8 Ke2+ 77.Bc1 d3 78.Kb2 Rxc1 79.Rxc1 d2 80.Rg1 Bd5-+) **68...Bf3 69.Rf2 Bg4** threatening Rd3+ followed by Rd1 mate **70.Ke1** (70.Rf1 Rh2+ 71.Kc1 Bh5 72.Kb1 [72.Rf4?! Rh1+ 73.Kd2 Rd1#] 72...d3-+) **70...Re3+ 71.Kf1 Bh3+ 72.Kg1 Re1+ 73.Kh2 Bf1 74.Kg3 Rb1 75.Ba3 Bd3 76.Rf8 Kc3 77.Rf2 Bc2 78.Kf4 Ra1 79.Rf3+ d3 80.Bd6** and Edward Lasker lost on time.

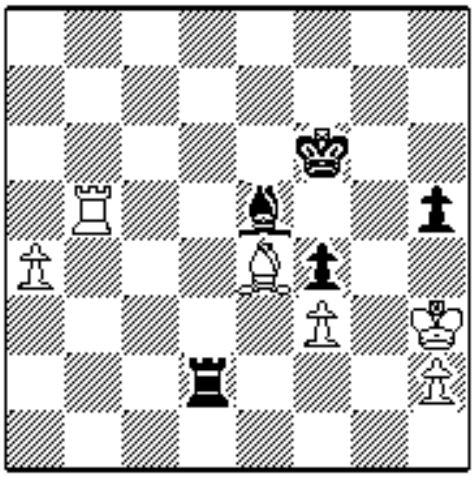
The next example is well known and so I will not give too many details. Just enjoy Nimzowitsch's excellent technique (*See Diagram*):



3.02 ***H.von Gottschall - A.Nimzowitsch*****, Hannover 1926** /+

29...Kg6 30.Rd4 Kf5 31.Bd2 Rf8! the rook occupies the f-file as Nimzowitsch's next aim is to open it **32.Be1?! e5 33.fxe5 fxe5 34.Rh4 g5 35.Rb4** (Of course not 35.Rxh5?? Kg6+-+) **35...Ke6+ 36.Ke2 e4 37.Bf2 Rf3 38.Rb6 Ke5 39.Rb4 Kd5 40.h4 gxh4 41.gxh4 Rh3 42.Rd4+ Ke5 43.Rd8 Bd5 44.Re8+** (44.Rh8?! Bc4+ 45.Kd2 Rd3+ 46.Ke1 e3 47.Bg1 Ke4-+) **44...Be6 45.Rd8 Kf4 46.Rf8+ Bf5 47.Rf7 Rh2 48.Re7 Bg4+ 49.Ke1 Kf3 50.Rf7+ Kg2 51.Kd2?!** (51.Bd4 was more tenacious.) **51...Kf1 52.Ke3 Bf3 53.Bg3 Rxb2 54.Bd6 Rb3+ 55.Kd4 Kf2 56.Rg7 e3 57.Bg3+ Kf1 58.Rf7 e2 59.Re7 Bc6 0-1**

In the recent Braingames World Championship there were two games with rooks and opposite coloured bishops (*See Diagram* - for the other see the exercises):

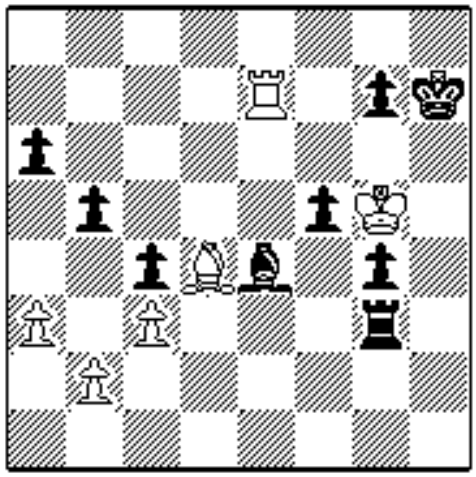


3.03 ***V.Kramnik - G.Kasparov*****, Braingames WCh London 2000** +/

The material is quite reduced and White's king has difficulties entering the play. But due to his strong a-pawn he should win nevertheless: **38.a5** (38.Rb6+!? with the idea 38...Rd6? 39.Rxd6+ Bxd6 40.Kh4+- came strongly into consideration as well.) **38...Ra2 39.Rb6+ Ke7??** in severe time trouble Kasparov blunders making it very easy for Kramnik. 39...Kg7 was called for although White should be winning in the long run e.g. 40.a6 Bd4 41.Rg6+ Kf8 (41...Kf7? 42.Rd6 Ra4 43.Rxd4+-) 42.Bb7 Ra5 43.Rd6 Be3 (43...Bg1 44.Rf6+ Kg7 45.Rxf4 Ra2 46.Rf5 Rxh2+ 47.Kg3 h4+ 48.Kg4 Bf2 49.f4+-) 44.Rd5!? trading rooks is normally not such a good winning strategy. But here it works due to the far advanced a-pawn and Black's weakness on h5: 44...Rxd5 45.Bxd5 Kg7 46.Kg2 Ba7 (46...h4 47.Kh3 Bf2 48.Kg4+-) 47.h4! fixing the weakness h5 on a light square is very important! 47...Kf6 48.Be4 Be3 49.Kf1 Ba7 50.Ke2 Bg1 51.Kd3 Bf2 52.Bh7 Kg7 (52...Ke5 53.Ke2 Ba7 54.Bg6+-) 53.Bf5 Kf6 54.Ke4 Be3 55.Bh3+- **40.Bd5!** and Kasparov resigned as the pawn ending after 40...Rxa5 (40...Re2 41.Re6+ Kd7 42.a6+-) 41.Re6+ Kd7 42.Rxe5 Kd6 43.Rxh5 Rxd5 44.Rxd5+ Kxd5 45.Kg4 is hopeless.

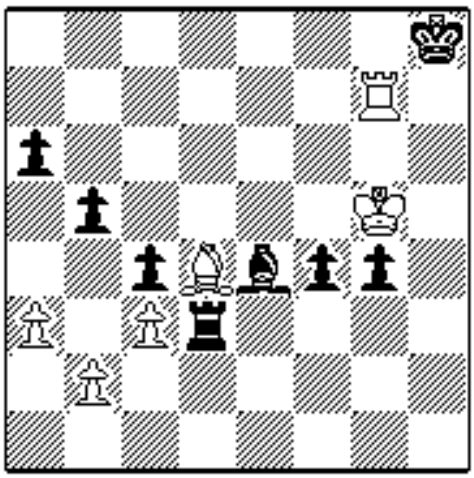
In 1993, I was the Alexei Shirov's second at the Munich tournament and

Alexei's start had not been very good. After two rounds he had only half a point and in the third round his position against Lautier was very bad until in the second time control. Joel was too greedy and had to seal a move in the following position (*See Diagram*):



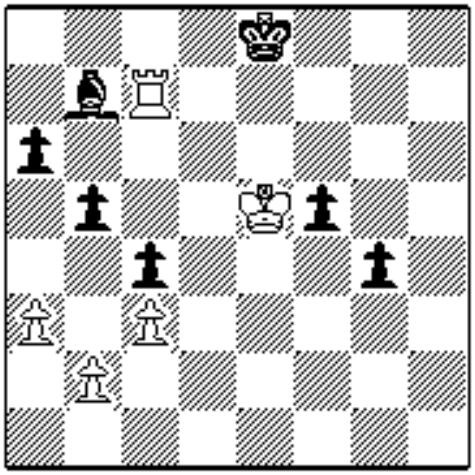
3.04 *A.Shirov* (2670) - *J.Lautier* (2635), Munich 1993 /=

Black is three pawns up at the moment, but he is nevertheless at the brink of disaster because of White's strong attack. After analysing the position myself for a long time I shared my thought's with the German chess trainer and columnist Claus Dieter Meyer and he wrote an article for the German *Schachmagazin 64* (12/1994). Alexei included it in his book *Fire on Board*. So let's see what happened: **61...Kg8?** Lautier had indeed sealed the move we had expected, although in retrospect it seems to be losing a drawn position. But - to be honest - at the time we also thought that it would lead to a draw. Instead, there were two ways to hold on: 61...Rh3 and 61...Rd3. I will only give some details for 61...Rh3: 62.Rxg7+ Kh8 63.Kg6 f4+ 64.Kg5 (64.Kf7? Rh7!) 64...Bf3 (64...Rd3? - *See Diagram* -



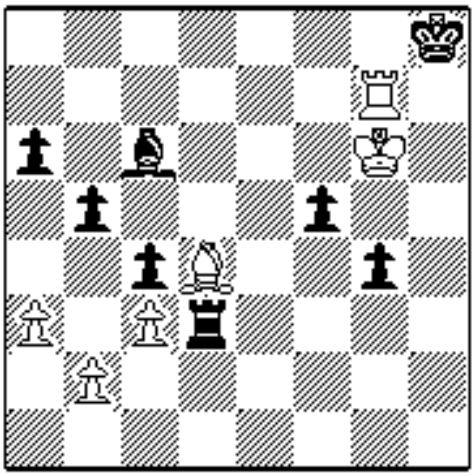
is beautifully refuted by 65.Re7+ Rxd4 66.cxd4 g3 67.Rxe4 g2 68.Re1 f3 69.Kg6 f2 70.Re8#) 65.Kxf4 Bd1 66.Rxg4+ Kh7 67.Rg7+ Kh6 and Black should be able to hold on. **62.Kg6 Bc6 63.Bc5!?** Joel had overlooked this tricky move in his adjournment analysis and did not find the strongest resistance. **63...Rd3?!**

63...Kh8!? should have been played. The main line runs: 64.Bd4! Kg8 and we have reached the position after 62...Bc6 again. Now comes the stronger continuation 65.Rxg7+ Kf8 66.Rc7 Bd5 (66...Bg2!? comes into consideration as well: 67.Kf6 Ke8 68.Ke6 Kd8 69.Rc5 Bb7 70.Bf6+ Ke8 71.Rc7 Re3+ 72.Be5 Rxe5+ 73.Kxe5 (*See Diagram*)



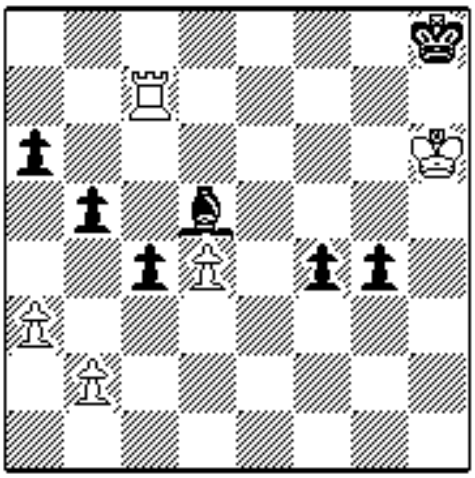
Meyer worked very hard on this position and finally came to the conclusion that White is winning.) 67.Rc5! (better than 67.Kf6 Ke8 68.Rc5 Bb7! 69.Re5+ Kd7 70.Re7+ Kc6 71.Re6+=) my improvement over the post mortem analysis of Shirov and Lautier, which runs 67...Be6 (67...Bb7? 68.Re5! Bc6 69.Bc5+ Kg8 70.Re6 Bd7 71.Re7 Rd3 72.Rg7+ Kh8 73.Bd4+-; 67...Bf7+? 68.Kf6 Ke8 69.Be5 Rg2 70.Rc8+ Kd7 71.Rc7+ Ke8 72.Rxf7 Rxb2 73.Ke6+-) 68.Kf6 Bd7 69.Rc7 Ke8 70.Ra7 with a further branch: (A) 70...Bc6 71.Re7+ Kd8 [71...Kf8 72.Rc7 Be8 73.Rc8+-] 72.Bb6+ Kc8 73.Rc7+ Kb8 74.Rxc6 should be winning for White although it is not trivial; (B) 70...Kd8 71.Bb6+ Kc8 72.Rc7+ Kd8 73.Rc5+ Ke8 74.Re5+ Kf8 75.Bc5+ Kg8 76.Re7 Rd3 77.Rg7+ Kh8 78.Bd4 Bc6 79.Rc7 Rxd4 80.cxd4 Be4 81.Kg6 f4+ 82.Kh6 and we have reached the game after 68.Kh6)

64.Rxg7+ Kh8 65.Bd4 (*See Diagram*)



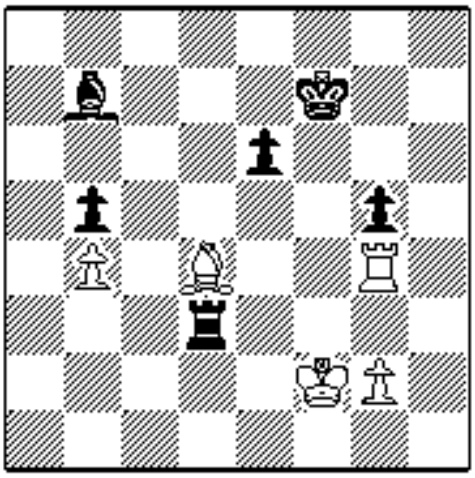
65... Rxd4 (65...Be8+ 66.Kh6 Rh3+ 67.Kg5 Rh5+ 68.Kf4+-) **66.cxd4 f4** (66...g3 67.Rh7+ Kg8 68.Rc7 Be8+ [68...Kf8 69.Rxc6 g2 70.Kf6 Kg8 71.Rc8+ Kh7 72.Rc7+ Kh8 73.Rg7+-] 69.Kf6 f4 70.Rg7+ Kh8 [70...Kf8 71.Rg5 Bc6 72.d5 f3 73.dxc6 f2 74.c7 f1D+ 75.Rf5+-] 71.Rg5 Bc6 72.d5 Bxd5 73.Rxd5 g2 74.Kf7!+- B.Certic in Informant 58.) **67.Rc7 Be4+** (67...Bd5 68.Rc8+ Bg8 69.Rf8 f3 70.d5 g3 71.Rxf3 Bxd5 72.Rxg3+-, Lautier)

68.Kh6 Bd5 (*See Diagram*)



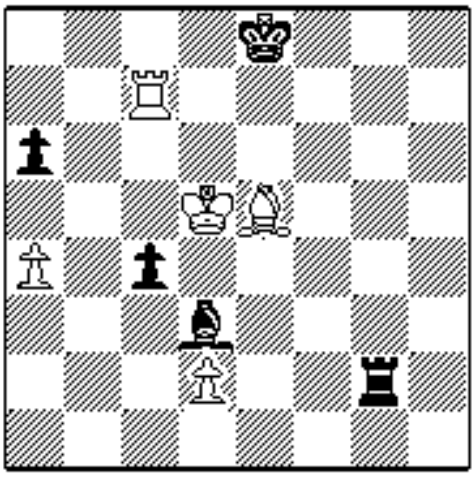
and now Alexei found the bonecrusher **69.Rc5!** leaving Joel Lautier defenceless: **69...Bg8 70.d5 f3 71.d6 Be6** (71...f2 72.Rf5 g3 73.d7 g2 74.d8Q g1Q 75.Qf6+ Qg7+ 76.Qxg7#) **72.Re5 Bd7 73.Re7 f2 74.Rxd7 Kg8 75.Rg7+ Kf8 76.d7 1-0**

Exercises (Solutions next month):



E 3.01 *V.Kramnik - G.Kasparov*, Braingames Wch, London 2000

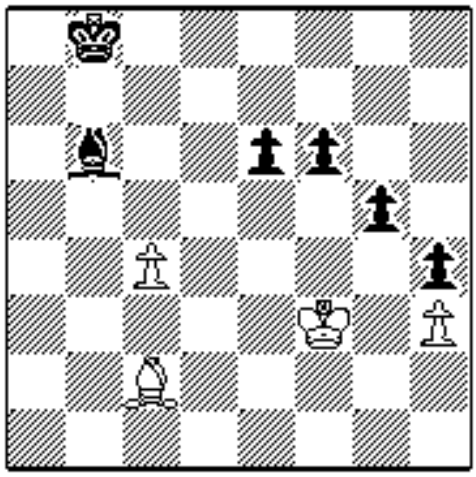
Garry Kasparov chose the natural looking **35...Rd2+** . Was that a good winning try?



E 3.02 *I.Radziewicz* (2379) - *R.Fernandez Blanco* (2096), EU-ch U20 Girls Aviles 2000

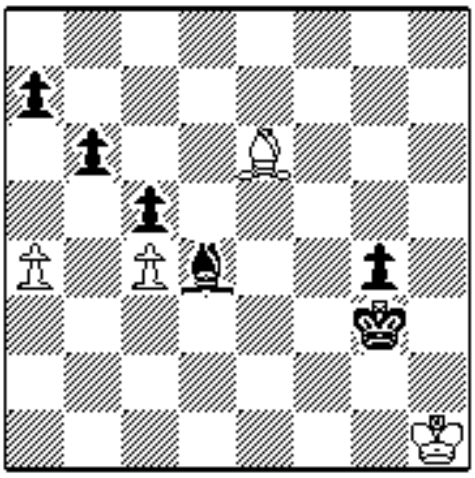
White to move and win

Solutions to last month's exercises:



S2.01 M.Dvoretsky

White creates a fortress with **1.c5! Bxc5 2.Bb3!** forcing Black's e-pawn to a dark square which allows a blockade: **2...e5 3.Be6 Kc7 4.Ke4** and Black can't make any further progress.



S2.02 *K.Müller* (2470) - *J.Gustafsson*, Hamburg simul 1994

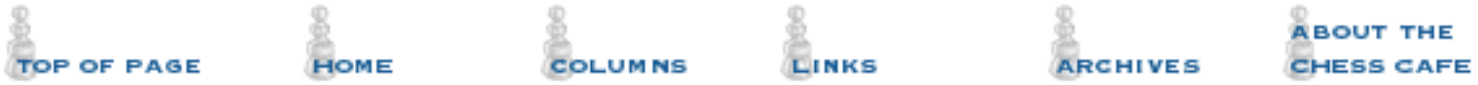
Jan Gustafsson managed to win as follows: **49...Kf3 50.Bd5+ Kf2 51.Be6 g3 52.Bd5 Kf1** (52...a5 53.Bc6 b5 54.cxb5 c4 or 52...a6 53.Bb7 b5 54.axb5 axb5 55.cxb5 c4 would have won faster.) **53.Bc6 Bf2 54.Bg2+ Ke2 55.Bc6 Kd3 56.Bb5 Kc3 57.Kg2 Kb4 58.Kf3 Ka5 59.Bc6 a6 60.Bb7 b5** (60...Kxa4? 61.Bxa6=) **61.axb5 axb5 62.cxb5 Kxb5 63.Ke2 Kb4 64.Kd2 Kb3 65.Bd5+ c4 66.Ke2 Kc3 67.Be6 Kd4 68.Bf7 c3 69.Bg6 Kc4 0-1**

Sources:

A.Shirov, *Fire on Board*, Cadogan 1995
E.Solozhenkin, *Endspiele mit ungleichen Läufern*, ChessBase CD-ROM, Hamburg 2000
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001.

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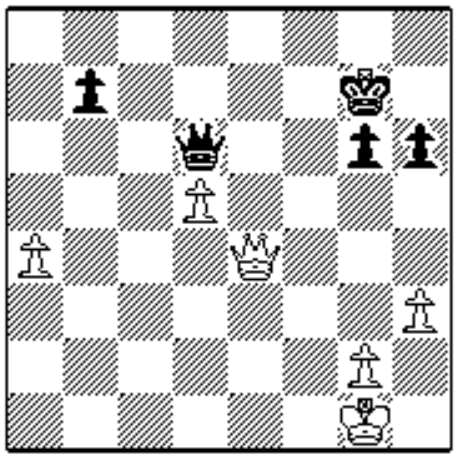
Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller

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Activate the King

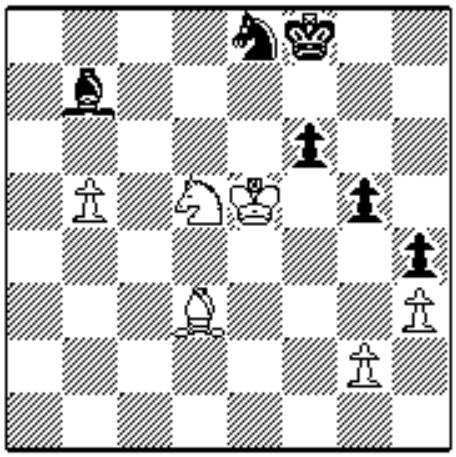
An endgame is different from a middlegame in many respects. One of the most important is the new role of the King. In the middlegame he usually hides after castling behind his pawn shield, but when the firepower on the board diminishes he himself becomes a strong fighting unit:



4.01 *Rashkovsky - Krasenkov*, Capelle la Grande 1990 +/

White's main trump, the far-advanced d-pawn, needs further support, so his majesty comes: **1.Kf2 Qf6+ 2.Ke2 Qb2+ 3.Ke3 Qc3+ 4.Qd3 Qe5+ 5.Kf3 Qf6+ 6.Ke4 Qh4+ 7.g4 Qe1+ 8.Kd4 Qa1+ 9.Kc5 Qxa4 10.Qc3+** (immediately simplifying into a pawn endgame with 10.Qd4+?? backfires as Black gets an **outside passed b-pawn** [an important concept in pawn endings] 10...Qxd4+ 11.Kxd4 Kf6 12.Kc5 Ke7 13.h4 g5–+] **10...Kf7 11.Kd6 Qf4+ 12.Kd7 b5 13.d6 b4 14.Qc7 Qe4** (after 14...b3 15.Kc6+ Kg8 16.Qb8+ White wins the b-pawn leaving Black without counterplay.) **15.Kc8+ Kf6 16.Qc5** and Krasenkov resigned due to **16...b3 17.d7 Qa8+ 18.Kc7 b2 19.d8Q+ Qxd8+ 20.Kxd8 b1Q 21.Qe7#**

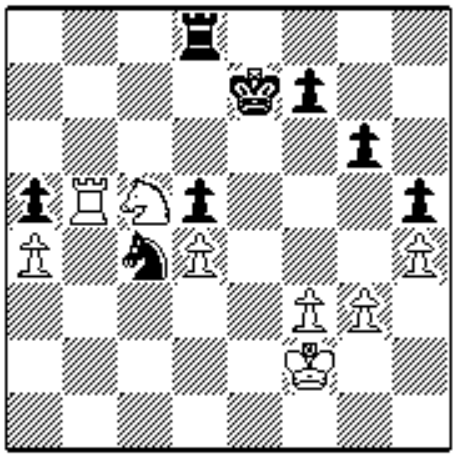
But beware of running into a mating net:



4.02 *N.Short* (2685) - *A.Beliavsky* (2620), Linares 1992

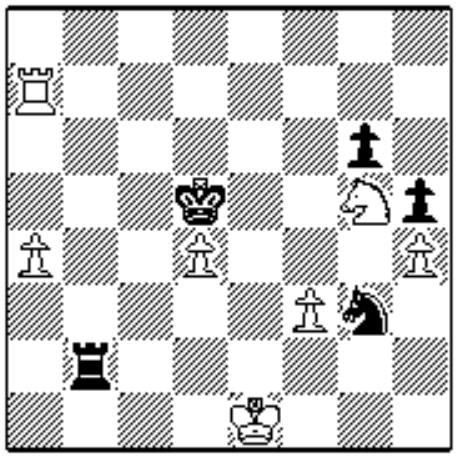
Instead of capturing with the Knight on f6, Nigel Short wanted to improve the position of his King even further with **58.Ke6??** missing the reply **58...Bc8#**

In two of my recent games, this theme played an important role:

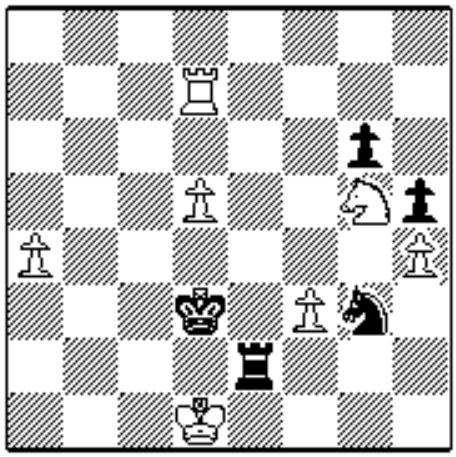


4.03 *J.Emms* (2527) - *K.Müller* (2513), German Bundesliga 2001, Solingen - Hamburg, 6th board

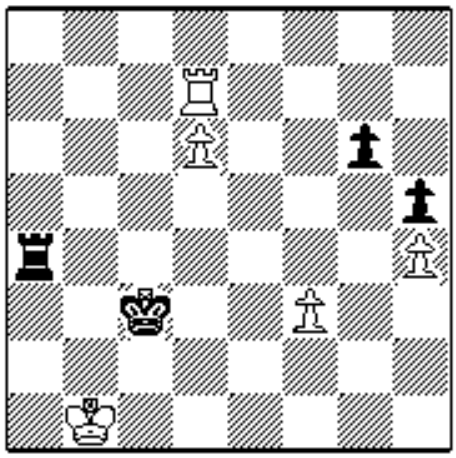
After the time control I took a closer look at the position and found myself in trouble. Finally I decided to activate my Rook at the cost of two pawns to obtain counterplay: **41...Rd6** (After 41...Rc8 I didn't like 42.g4) **42.Nd3 Rb6 43.Rxd5 Rb3 44.Ne5! Rb2+ 45.Ke1 Ne3 46.Rxa5** (I was a worried about 46.Nxg6+ during the game, but in the post mortem we decided, that Black has good chances to draw after 46...fxg6 47.Re5+ Kd6 48.Rxe3 Kd5) **46...Nf5 47.Ra7+?** (47.d5! was John's suggestion. It seems to be very strong e.g. 47...Rg2 48.Nc4 Rxg3 49.Ra7+ Kf6 50.d6 Rxf3 51.d7 Ke7 52.Nb6 Rd3 53.a5+-) **47...Ke6 48.Nxf7** (Of course not 48.Rxf7? Nxd4 49.f4 Re2+ 50.Kf1 Rxe5) **48...Nxg3** [Dorfman's proposal 48...Nxd4 is interesting as well, e.g., 49.Ng5+ Kd5 50.a5 Kc4 51.a6 Ra2 52.Rc7+ Kd3 53.a7 Nc2+ and White's King can't escape from the checks as after 54.Kf1 Ne3+ 55.Kg1 Ra1+ 56.Kh2 Ra2+ 57.Kh3? leads to disaster: 57...Nf1 58.Rd7+ Kc4 59.Rc7+ Kb5 60.Rb7+ Kc5 61.Ne4+ Kc4 62.Rc7+ Kd3 63.Rd7+ Ke3–+] **49.Ng5+ Kd5** (*See Diagram*)



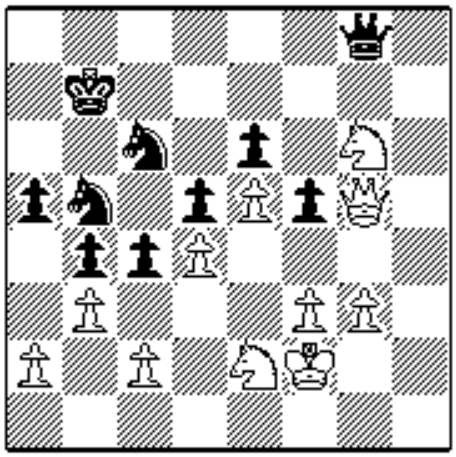
Now Black's King is coming to assist the attack **50.Rd7+ Kc4 51.d5 Re2+?** (As Lubomir Ftacnik pointed out, 51...Kd3! immediately was called for: 52.Rc7 [52.Re7? Nf5 53.Re4 Ne3–+] 52...Nf5! 53.Ne4 [53.Rc1? Ne3–+] 53...Nxh4 54.Rc3+ Kd4 55.d6 Nxf3+ 56.Rxf3 Kxe4 57.Rg3 Rb4=) **52.Kd1 Kd3** (*See Diagram*)



Certainly not an easy position to play as John had to win - the Hamburg team was leading 3½:2½ - and was already running short of time **53.Kc1** (53.Rc7!? was interesting as well: (A) 53...Ra2? 54.d6 Ra1+ 55.Rc1 Ra2 56.Ne4! Nxe4 57.fxe4 Rxa4 58.d7 Rd4 59.Ke1+-; (B) 53...Rh2? 54.Kc1 Rxh4 55.Kb2 [55.Ne6!?] 55...Rxa4 56.d6 Rb4+ 57.Ka3 Rb8 58.Nf7 h4 59.d7 h3 60.Rc8 Rxc8 61.dxc8Q h2 62.Ne5+ Kd4 63.Kb4 Kxe5 64.Qh8++-; (C) 53...Rd2+! 54.Kc1 Ne2+ 55.Kb1 Ke3 and Black is still fighting.[55...Nc3+? 56.Rxc3+ Kxc3 57.Ne4++- is the main point behind 53.Rc7.]) **53...Ra2 54.Kb1 Rxa4 55.d6 Ne2?** (55...Rb4+ 56.Ka2 Nf5 was better.) **56.Ne4?** (56.Rb7! seems to win, e.g., 56...Nc3+ [56...Rd4 57.d7 Nc3+ 58.Kc1 Ne2+ 59.Kb2 Nf4 60.Nf7 Ne6 61.Rb8 Kd2 62.Ne5 Rd5 63.f4 Ke3 64.Re8+-] 57.Kb2 Ra2+ 58.Kb3 Ra1 59.d7 Rb1+ 60.Ka3 Rxb7 61.d8Q+ Kc2 62.Qg8+-) **56...Nc3+ 57.Nxc3 Kxc3** (*See Diagram*)

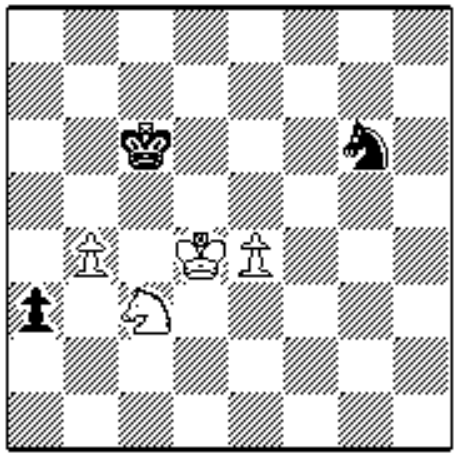


I had read John's excellent book *The Survival Guide to Rook Endings* and therefore managed to survive: **58.Rc7+** (58.Rd8 Rd4 59.d7 Kd3 60.Kb2 Rd6 61.Kb3 Kd4=) **58...Kb3 59.Rb7+** (59.Re7 Kc3 [59...Rd4? 60.Re3+ Kc4 61.Re4+-] 60.d7 Rd4=) **59...Kc3 60.Rc7+ Kb3 61.d7 Rd4 62.Kc1 Rd6 63.f4 Rd5 64.Rb7+ Kc3 65.Rc7+ Kb3 66.Rc6 Rxd7 67.Rxg6 Rf7 68.Rg5 Rxf4 69.Rxh5 Kc3 70.Rc5+** (After 70.Kd1 Kd3 71.Rd5+ Rd4 72.Rxd4+ Kxd4= the subject of my book (together with IM Frank Lamprecht), *Secrets of Pawn Endings*, is reached - The Rule of the Square in the first example of Chapter 1 to be more precise.) **70...Kb4 71.Rc8 Rxh4 72.Kd2 ½–½**

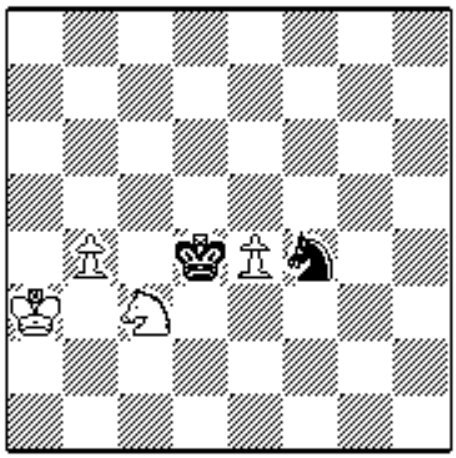


4.04 *Z.Almasi* (2668) - *K.Müller* (2523), Austrian Staatsliga Graz, Fürstenfeld-Gleisdorf, 1st board

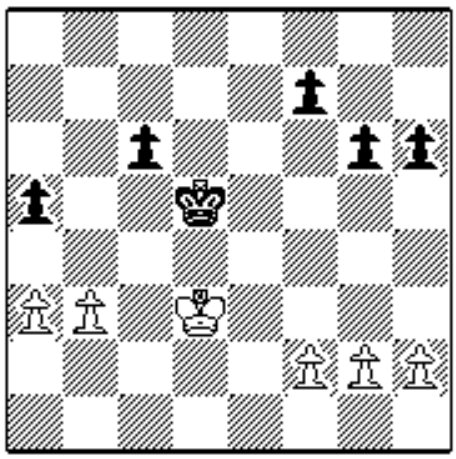
I start at an earlier stage as the complications are quite interesting. After the opening Zoltan Almasi was winning, but he had messed things up and now matters are not so easy any more: **43.bxc4 dxc4 44.d5 exd5 45.Qxf5 Qh7! 46.Kg2** (Of course not 46.f4? Qh2+ 47.Kf1 Qxe2+ 48.Kxe2 Nbd4+) **46...Nxe5** (46...Nbd4 came strongly into consideration as well e.g. 47.Nxd4 Nxd4 48.Qf6 [48.Qg5? allows 48...Qh2+] 48...Nxc2 49.e6 c3 50.Qf7+ Qxf7 51.exf7 Ne3+ 52.Kf2 c2 53.f8Q Nd1+ 54.Ke1 c1Q) **47.Qxe5 Qxg6 48.Qxd5+ Qc6 49.Qf7+ Ka6 50.g4 a4 51.g5 b3 52.cxb3 cxb3 53.axb3 a3 54.b4 Qc2 55.Qe6+ Kb7 56.g6 Nc7!** (After 56...a2 57.g7 a1Q 58.g8Q I was afraid, that my King wouldn't be as safe as White's.) **57.Qe4+ Qxe4 58.fxe4 Ne6 59.Nc3 Nf4+ 60.Kf3 Nxg6 61.Ke3 Kc6 62.Kd4** (*See Diagram*)



Although it looks very difficult for me it seems, that I still could have saved the day **62...Nf4** (62...Nf8 leads to a draw as well.) **63.Kc4 Kd6** (At first I wanted to play 63...Ne2? but this fails due to 64.Nxe2 a2 65.Nd4+ Kd6 66.Nc2+-) **64.Kb3 Ke5 65.Kxa3 Kd4!** the active position of Black's King is very annoing for White (*See Diagram*)

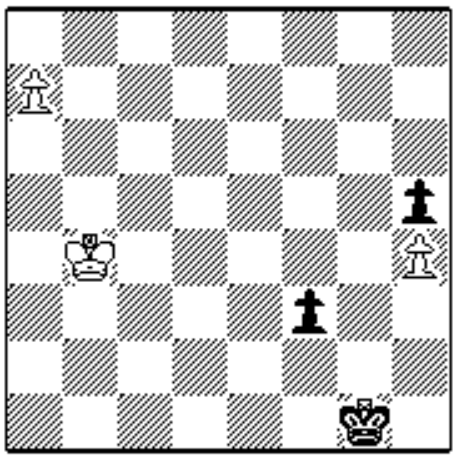


66.b5!? Nd3 (66...Kc5? 67.Ka4 Nd3 68.Ka5 Ne5 69.Ka6 Kd4 70.b6 Kxc3 71.b7 Nd7 72.e5+-) **67.b6 Nc5 68.Kb4** and now I blew it with **68...Na6+?** (Instead 68...Nb7! was called for: 69.Na4 [69.Kb5 Nd8 70.Ka6 Kxc3 71.e5 Kd4 72.e6 Nxe6 73.b7 Nc5+=] 69...Kxe4 70.Nc5+ Kd5 71.Nxb7 Kc6=) **69.Kb5 Sb8 70.b7 Kxc3 71.e5 1–0**



4.05 *G.Kasparov* (2849) - *E.Bareev* (2709) World Cup of Rapid Chess Final Cannes 2001

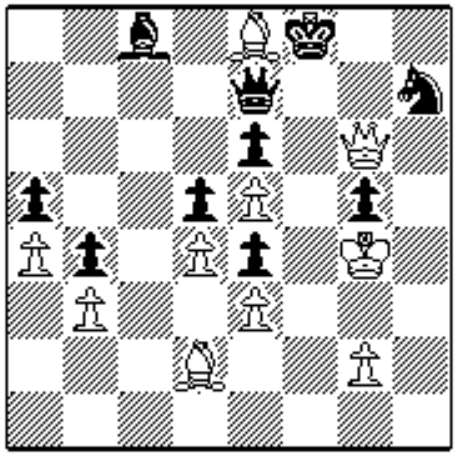
34.Kc3 34.g4!? to create more spare tempi on the kingside is very interesting as well. I couldn't find a win for White, but it is very close: (A) 34...f6 35.Kc3 h5 36.gxh5 gxh5 37.h4 (37.a4 c5 38.h4 f5 39.Kd3 Ke5 40.Kc4 Ke4 41.Kxc5 Kf3 42.b4 axb4 43.Kxb4 Kxf2 44.a5 f4 45.a6 f3 46.a7 Kg1



and the position is a theoretical draw, although in practice it is much more difficult to defend than with help of the endgame database.) 37...f5 38.a4 c5 39.Kd3 Ke5 (39...f4? 40.f3 Ke5 41.Kc4 Kd6 42.Kb5+-) 40.Kc4 Ke4 41.Kxc5 Kf3 42.b4 axb4 43.Kxb4 Kxf2 44.a5 f4 45.a6 f3 46.a7 Kg1=; (B) 34...h5? 35.g5+-; (C) 34...Ke5? 35.Kc4 Kf4 36.b4+- and White is much faster than Black. (D) 34...f5 35.gxf5 gxf5 36.h3 h5 37.h4 Kc5 (37...Ke5 38.Kc4 Kf4 39.b4 axb4 40.a4+-) 38.Kc3 Kd5 39.a4 c5 40.Kd3 Ke5 *(40...f4? 41.f3+-)* 41.Kc4 Ke4 42.Kxc5 Kf3 43.b4 axb4 44.Kxb4 Kxf2 45.a5 f4 46.a6 f3 47.a7 Kg1 48.a8Q f2= **34...h5 35.h4 f6 36.Kd3 g5 37.g3 gxh4?!** (37...g4 was better as Black's counterplay on the kingside is stronger and he has the tempo f6-f5 in reserve.) **38.gxh4 f5 39.f3** (39.f4 c5 40.a4 [40.Ke3 c4 41.b4 axb4 42.axb4 c3 43.Kd3 c2 44.Kxc2 Kc4=] 40...Kd6 41.Kc4 Kc6=) **39...Ke5 40.Ke3 c5 41.f4+ Kd6 42.Kd2!** much more tricky than 42.Kd3 **42...Kc6** (even 42...Kd5 is playable: 43.Kd3 Kc6 44.Kc4 Kd6 45.Kb5 Kd5 46.Kxa5 Ke4=) **43.Kc3 Kb5 44.Kd3 1-0** and

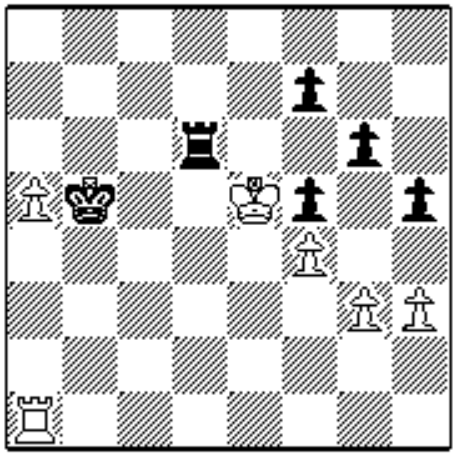
Bareev having only two seconds left resigned. But the position seems to be tenable with more time on the clock: **44...Kc6!** (44...Kb6? 45.Kc4 Kc6 46.a4+-) **45.Kc4 Kd6! 46.Kb5 Kd5 47.Kxa5 Ke4 48.Kb6 Kxf4 49.a4 Kg3 50.a5 f4 51.a6 f3 52.a7 f2 53.a8Q f1Q=**

Exercises (Solutions next month):



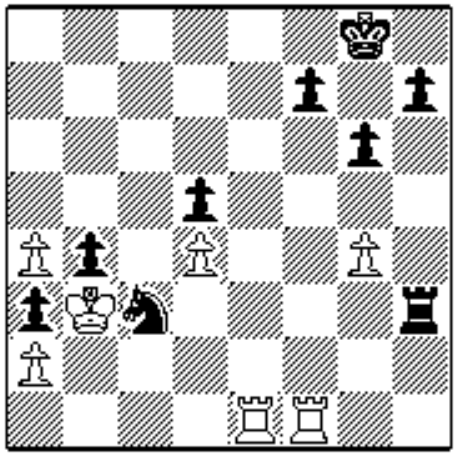
E4.01 V.Georgiev (2538) - K.Müller (2527), Hamburg 2000

Can White to move convert his advantage?



E4.02 G.Meins (2465) - S.Reschke (2390), German Bundesliga 1997

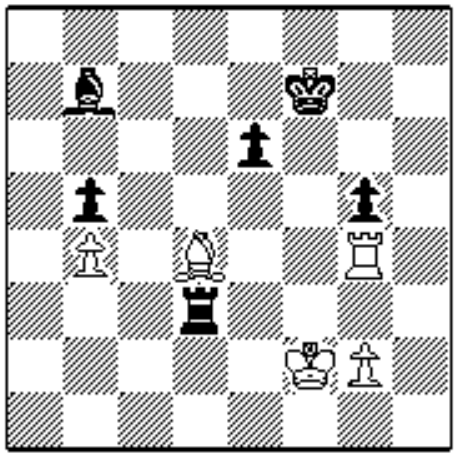
White's King is very active isn't he?



E4.03 J.Hjartarson (2605) - S.Sulskis (2510), FIDE-Wch Groningen 1997

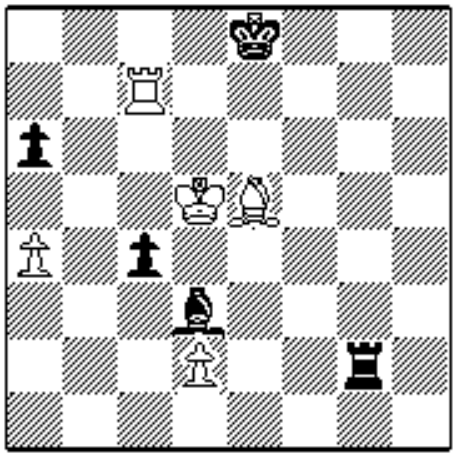
White played Re7. Was this a fortunate choice?

Solutions to last month's exercises



S 3.01 V.Kramnik - G.Kasparov, Braingames WCh London 2000

35...Rd2+?! was an unfortunate choice as Kramnik could force the exchange of Rooks immediately. (35...Kg6!? was a better try although Kramnik claims in New in Chess Magazine 01/2001, that White is still able to defend e.g. 36.Ke2 [36.Be3?! Rd5] 36...Rb3 37.Be3 Bd5 [37...Kf6 38.Bd2 Rb2 39.Ke1 e5 40.Rg3 Bd5 41.Bxg5+ Kf5 42.Bd2] 38.Rxg5+ Kf6 39.Bd2 Bc4+ 40.Kd1 e5 41.Rh5) **36.Ke3 Rxg2 37.Rxg2 Bxg2 38.Be5** (see *Endgame Corner* No.2) ½–½



S 3.02 I.Radziewicz (2379) - R.Fernandez Blanco (2096), EU-ch U20 Girls Aviles 2000

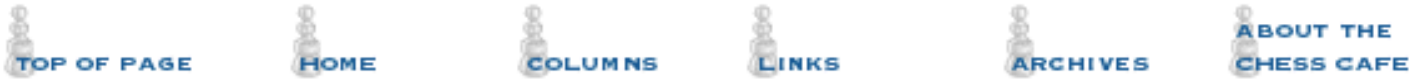
White won with **59.Ke6! Rg6+** (59...Kd8 60.Rc6 Rg6+ 61.Bf6++-) **60.Bf6 Rxf6+ 61.Kxf6 Kd8 62.Ra7 Kc8 63.a5 Kb8 64.Rxa6 Kb7 65.Rb6+ Ka7 66.Ke6 Bf1 67.Kd5 Be2 68.Kc5 Bd3 69.Rc6 Be2 70.Rc7+ Ka6 71.Kb4 Bd3 72.Rc6+ Kb7 73.Rxc4 Bxc4 74.Kxc4 1-0**

Sources:

A.Soltis, *GM Secrets:Endings*, Thinkers Press 1997
J.Emms, *The Survival Guide to Rook Endings*, Everyman 1999
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
New in Chess 01/2001

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Endgame Corner

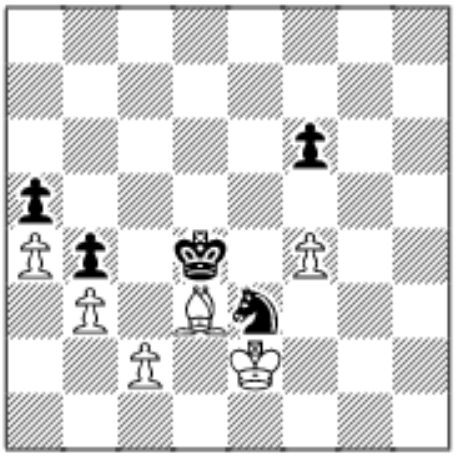
Karsten Müller

Chess Cafe Reader E-books Articles

Bishop vs Knight

Part I

It is very surprising, that Bishop and Knight and are of almost equal strength on an 8x8 board as they move in completely different ways. The Knight is a short range piece. When it moves, it loses contact with all (!!) the squares it controlled before and the colour of the square it occupies changes with each move. The Bishop is a long range piece, which can visit only half of the squares of the board. So depending on the given pawn structure, it can dominate the Knight in an open position with play on both wings or look like an overgrown pawn, if the pawns are blocked on squares of the same colour and it has very limited scope. In the first part of my discussion I will look at positions, in which the player with the Knight is behind on material and tries to set up a fortress on squares opposite to the Bishop's colour:



5.01 L.Gutman (2533) - K.Müller (2513) German Ch, Heringsdorf 2000 =/=

White can't make any meaningful progress so Gutman decided to call it a day after **53.Kf3 Nd5 ½–½**

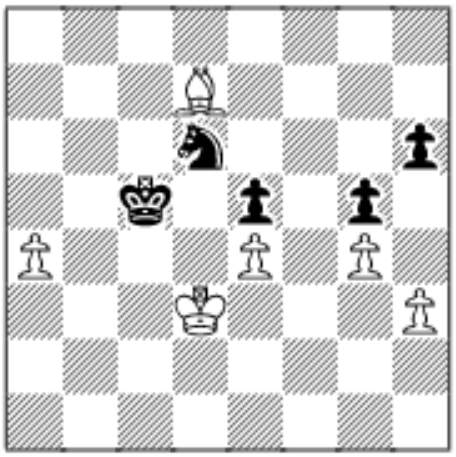
The next fortress shows a curious special case:



5.02 C.Cohrs (2205) - W.Gerstner (2400) Dresden 1999 /=

46...Nd1 47.Kf3 Kf6 48.Bc8 Nc3 49.Ke3 Nxa2 50.Kd4 Nc3 51.Kc5 Na2 52.Bd7 ½–½

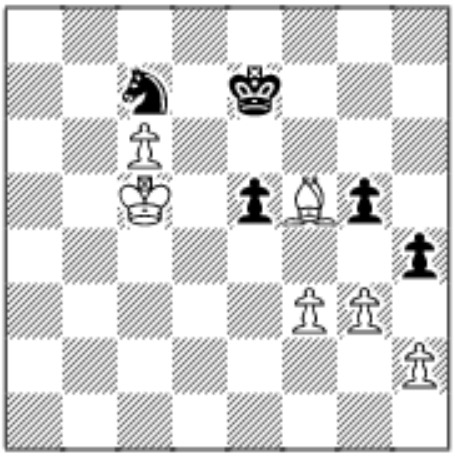
In the next example Black has even better chances than White due to her more active King:



5.03 R.Borer (2015) - A.Frank Elista ol (Women) 1998 /=

53...Kb4! 54.Ke3 (54.Bc6 Kc5=) **54...Nc4+** (54...Nb7!? was worth trying e.g. 55.Be8 Nc5 56.Kd2 [56.Bc6? is bad as the pawn ending after 56...Nxa4 57.Bxa4? Kxa4 58.Kd2 Kb4 59.Kd3 Kb3 is lost.] 56...Ne6 [56...Nxe4+ 57.Ke3 Nc5 58.Bc6=] 57.Bb5 Nf4 58.Bf1 Kxa4 59.Kc3 Ka5 and Black is slightly better) **55.Kd3** and a draw was agreed as the pawn ending after **55...Nb2+ 56.Kc2 Nxa4 57.Bxa4 Kxa4 58.Kc3 Kb5 59.Kb3** is equal.

The most powerful weapon to break such fortresses is zugzwang. The next two examples demonstrate this:



5.04 P.Leko (2701) - A.Khalifman (2628) Budapest 2000 +/-

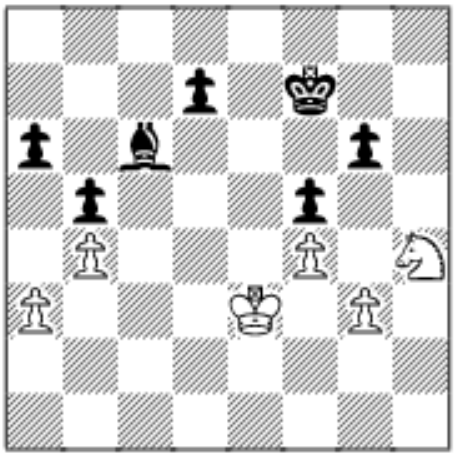
52.Bd7 1–0 If Black's Knight on c7 were a Bishop, the position would be dead drawn as Black wouldn't fall into zugzwang.



5.05 S.Ivanov (2538) - J.van der Wiel (2544) 15th EUCup final, Bugojno 1999 +/-

59.Bd7 and van der Wiel resigned as he has no move after **59...Ng7 60.Kh6+-**

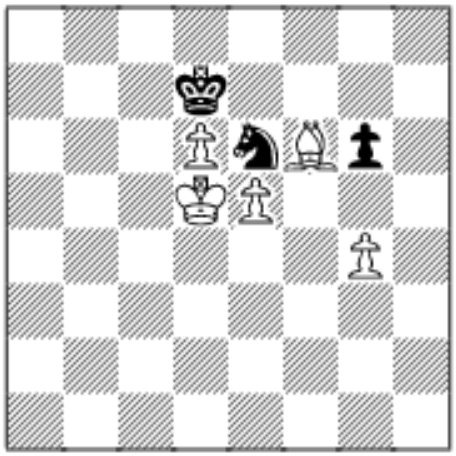
Sometimes the Bishop dominates the Knight:



5.06 M.Socko (2438) - K.Lerner (2588)
MK Cafe Cup-A Koszalin 1999 -/+

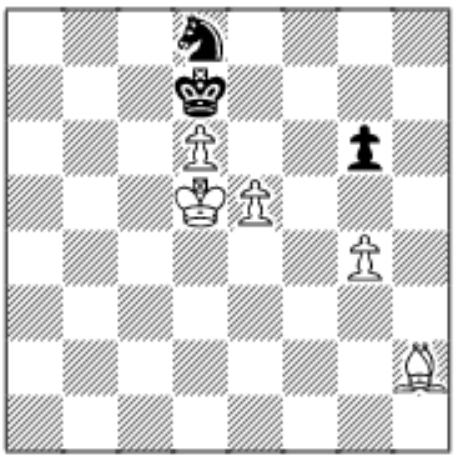
53.Kd4 (The pawn ending after 53.Nf3 Bxf3 54.Kxf3 is lost: 54...Ke6 55.Ke3 Kd5 56.Kd3 d6–+) **53...Kf6 54.Kc5 g5 55.fxg5+ Kxg5 56.Kd6** (56.Kb6 f4 57.gxf4+ Kxh4 58.Kxa6 Kg4–+ [Hecht in *ChessBase Magazin* 73]) **56...f4 0–1**

I want to end the discussion with a very complicated example:



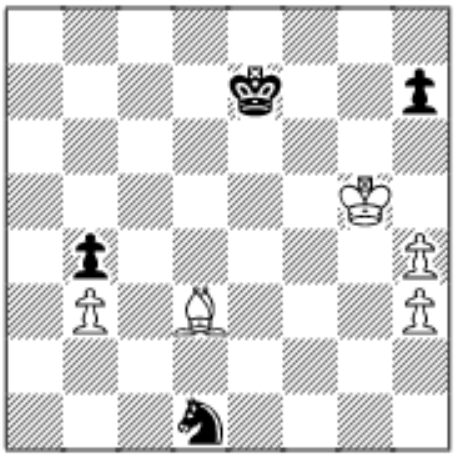
5.07 H. Berliner in *The System* +/

Without the g-pawns, the position is dead drawn, but with them White can break through by a well-timed sacrifice of the e-pawn: **1.Bh4 Nf4+ 2.Kc5** (After 2.Ke4?! Ne6 3.Be1? Black's king gets to a more active position with 3...Kc6! making a win extremely difficult, if not impossible.) **2...Ne6+** (2...Nd3+ 3.Kd4 Nf4 4.Bg3 Ne2+ 5.Kd5 Nxg3 6.e6+ Kd8 7.Kc6 Ne4 8.e7+ Ke8 9.d7+ Kxe7 10.Kc7+-) **3.Kb6 Nd4** (3...g5 4.Bg3 Nd8 5.Bh2 Ne6 6.Kb5 Nd8 7.Kc5 Ne6+ 8.Kd5 Nd8 9.Bg1 Ne6 10.Be3+-) **4.Bf2 Ne6** (4...Nf3 5.Bg3 Ng5 6.Bf4 Ne6 7.Bh2+- see the main line) **5.Bg3 Nd4 6.Kc5 Ne6+ 7.Kd5 Nd8 8.Bf4 Ne6 9.Bh2 Nd8**



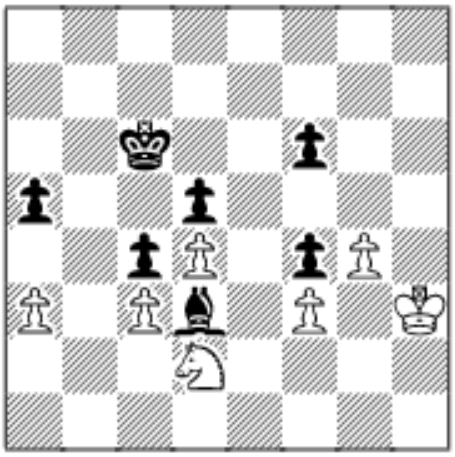
now the appropriate time for e6+ has come: **10.e6+! Nxe6 11.Ke5 g5** (11...Ng5 12.Kf6 Nf3 13.Bf4 g5 14.Be5+-) **12.Kf6 Nd4 13.Be5 Ne6 14.Kf5 Nc5 15.Kxg5 Ke6 16.Bh2 Kf7 17.Kf5 Nd7 18.Be5+-**

Exercises (Solutions next month)



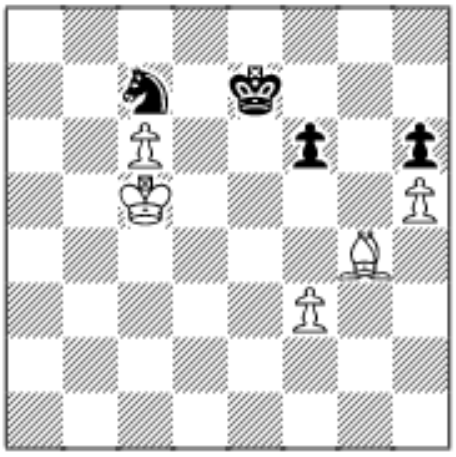
E5.01 Gambit Tiger 1.0 - Deep Fritz Computer Chess Match Tournament Cadaques 2001

How to assess the position with Black to move?



E5.02 K.van der Weide (2434) - J.Nilssen (2326) Politiken Cup Copenhagen 1999

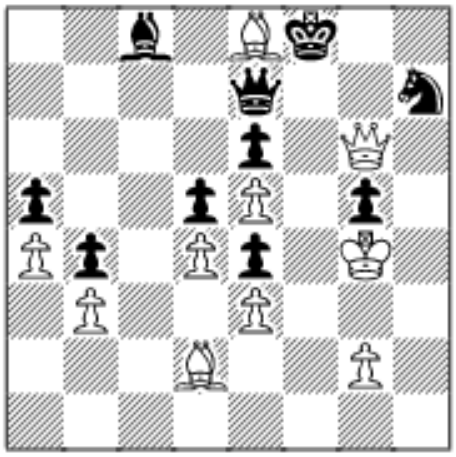
Van der Weide found a way to defend his position. Can you do the same?



E5.03 V.Potkin (2470) - V.Milov (2604) Linares Anibal open 2001

Did Potkin manage to storm Milov's barricades? (White is to move)

Solutions to last month exercises



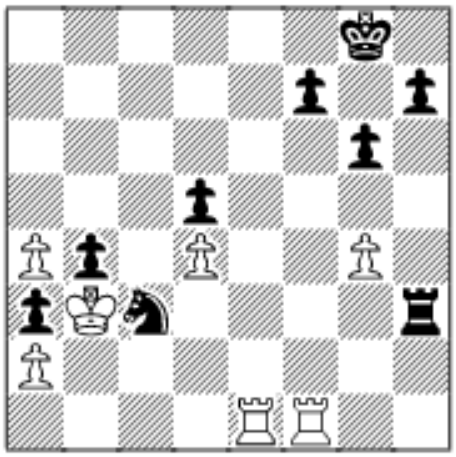
E4.01 V.Georgiev (2538) - K.Müller (2527), Hamburg 2000

White can indeed win: **73.Bb5 Qf7 74.Kh5 Ke7** (74...Qxg6+ 75.Kxg6 Kg8 76.Kh6 Bb7 77.Be1 Bc8 78.Be8 Bb7 79.Bg6 Nf8 80.Kxg5+-) **75.Kh6 Qxg6+ 76.Kxg6 Nf8+ 77.Kxg5 Kf7 78.Kh6 Ng6 79.Be1 Ne7 80.g4 Ng6 81.Be8+ Kxe8 82.Kxg6 Ba6 83.g5 Be2 84.Kh7 Bg4 85.g6 Bf5 86.Kg7** (86.Bxb4 wins as well.) **86...Ke7 87.Bh4+ Ke8 88.Bg5 1–0**



E4.02 G.Meins (2465) - S.Reschke (2390), German Bundesliga 1997

In the game Reschke missed the mate with **57...Kc6!** and played instead 57...Re6+? The game ended in a draw several moves later. **58.Rc1+ Kd7 59.Ra1 f6#**



E4.03 J.Hjartarson (2605) - S.Sulskis (2510), FIDE-Wch Groningen 1997

30.Re7? allowed Black to save himself in a spectacular way. (30.Re8+ Kg7 31.Re7 Nxa2+ 32.Kxa2 Rh2+ 33.Ka1 b3 34.Rexf7+ Kh6 35.R7f2+- [Tsesarsky in *ChessBase Magazin* 63]; 30.a5 Ne2+ [30...Nxa2+ 31.Kxa2 Rh2+ 32.Kb3 Rb2+ 33.Ka4+] 31.Kxb4 Nxd4 32.a6+- [Hjartarson]) **30...Nxa2+! 31.Kxa2 Rh2+ 32.Kb1** (32.Kb3?? Rb2#) **32...b3 33.Rb7 Rb2+ 34.Ka1 Ra2+ 35.Kb1**

½–½

Sources:
The System, Hans Berliner, GAMBIT 1999
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
ChessBase Magazin Nos.63, 73

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

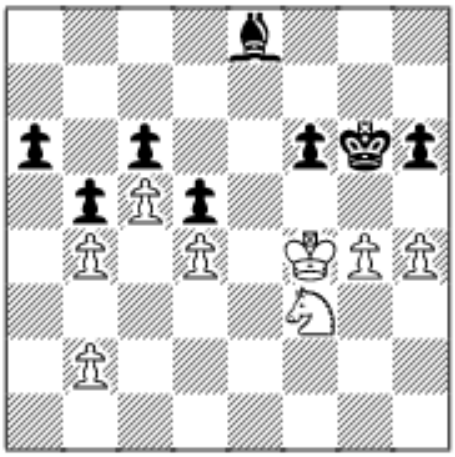
Karsten Müller



Bishop vs Knight

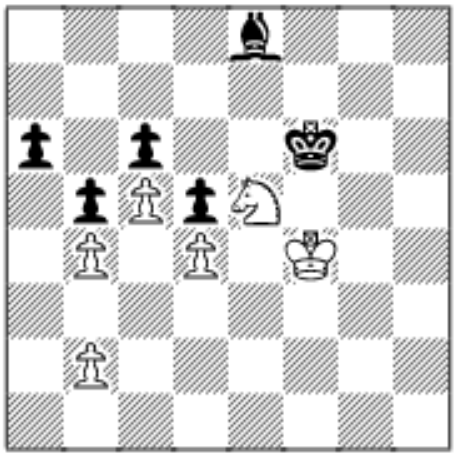
Part II

IN THE SECOND PART of my analysis of knight vs bishop I want to deal with positions, where the knight feels at home. His manoeuvres in the first example are quite common in a position with many of the defender's pawns blocked on squares of the bishop's colour:

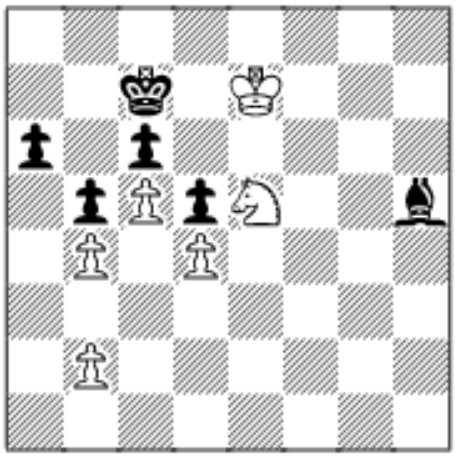


6.01 *J.Gdanski* (2435) - *A.Volzhin* (2370), Oakham 1992

First White liquidates the kingside pawns in order to penetrate there with his king: **46.g5 hxg5+ 47.hxg5 fxg5+ 48.Nxg5 Kf6 49.Nf3 Bh5 50.Ne5 Be8**

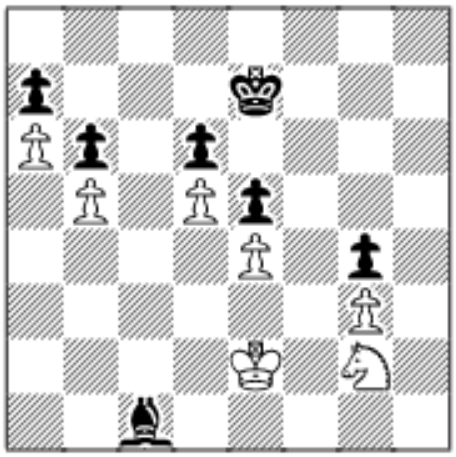


In the next step, White breaks through to the fifth rank as Black's king cannot maintain the opposition because the knight controls g6 **51.Kg4! Ke6 52.Kg5 Ke7 53.Kf5! Kd8 54.Ke6 Kc7 55.Ke7 Bh5**



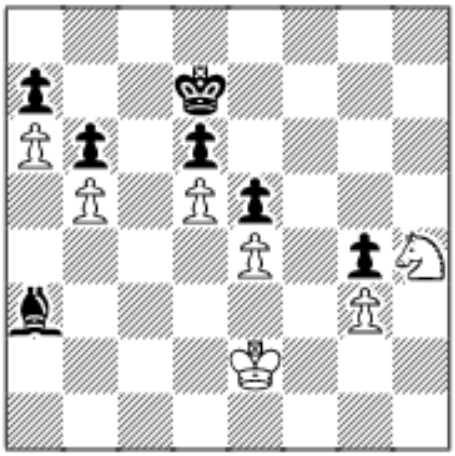
Now White's knight heads for e6 to force Black's king away to penetrate with the king to d6: **56.Nf7 Bg6 57.Ng5 Bh5 58.Ne6+ Kc8 59.Kd6 Be8** (59...Bg4 60.Nf4 Kb7 61.Ng6 Bh5 62.Ne5 Be8 63.Ke7 Bh5 64.Kd7+-) **60.Nc7 Bd7 61.Nxa6 Be8 62.Nc7 Bd7 63.Ne6 Be8 64.Nf4** and Volzhin resigned due to **64...Bd7** (64...Kb7 65.Ke7+-) **65.Nd3 Be8 66.Ne5 Kb7 67.b3+-**

In the next example the attacking king can't penetrate and everything depends on whether the knight can overcome the resistance.



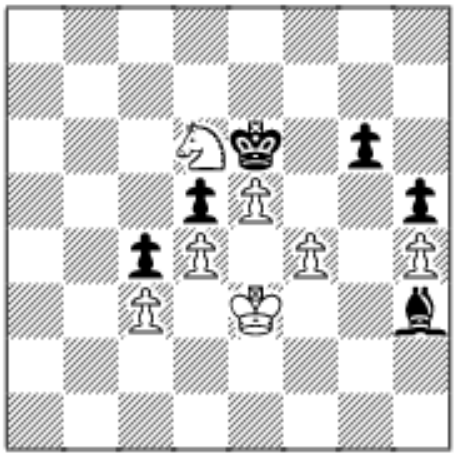
6.02 *Z. Peng* (2403) - *V. Shklovski* (2220) Hoogeveen, 2000

Black can't prevent White's knight from reaching c6 or winning the g- or d-pawn: **55.Kd1 Bg5 56.Ne1 Be3 57.Ke2 Bc5** (57...Bc1 58.Nc2 Kd7 59.Nb4 Kc7 60.Nc6+-) **58.Ng2 Kd7 59.Nh4 Ba3**



And now White's king hinders the bishop from going back to the kingside with **60.Kd1! Bc5** (60...Ke7 61.Nf5+ Kf6 62.Nh6 Kg5 63.Nf7+ Kf6 64.Nd8+-) **61.Nf5 Bg1 62.Ke2 1–0**

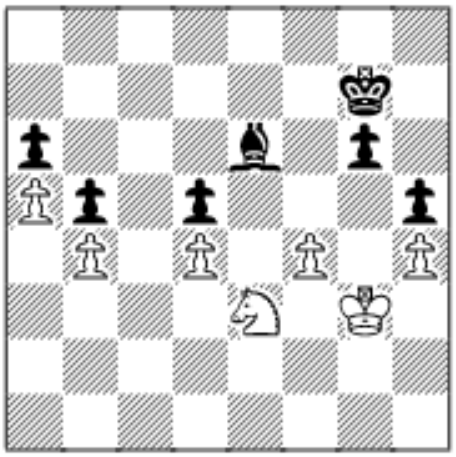
The following position is much easier to win.



6.03 *A.Burn* - *A.Alekhine*, Karlsbad 1911

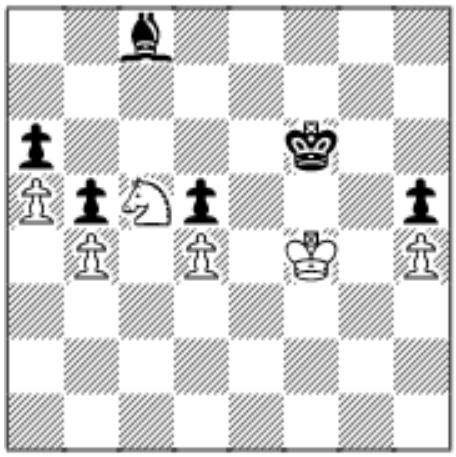
76.f5+ gxf5 (76...Bxf5 77.Nxf5 Kxf5 78.Kf3 g5 *(78...Ke6 79.Kf4 Ke7 80.Kg5 Kf7 81.Kh6+-)* 79.hxg5 Kxg5 80.Kg3 Kf5 81.Kh4 Kg6 82.e6+-) **77.Kf4 Bg4 78.Kg5 Bh3 79.Ne8 Kf7 80.Nf6 f4 81.Kxf4 Be6 82.Kg5 1–0**

Alexander Khalifman combined a lot of techniques to win this very complicated position.



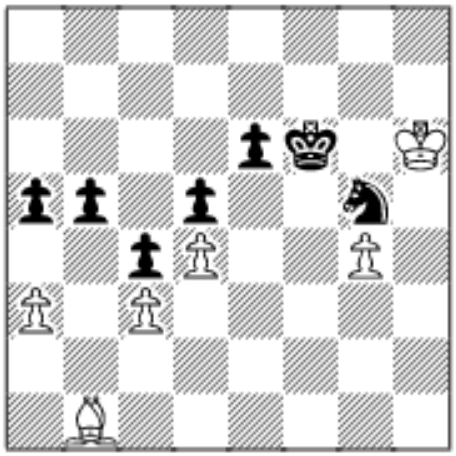
6.04 *A.Khalifman* (2628) - *D.Barua* (2550) FIDE-Wch k.o. Las Vegas 1999

69.f5!! opening a path for White's king **69...gxf5** (69...Bxf5 70.Nxd5 Kf7 71.Nc7 Bc8 72.Kf4 Ke7 73.Ke5 g5 74.hxg5 h4 75.g6 h3 76.Nd5+ Ke8 77.Kf6 Bf5 78.Kxf5 h2 79.g7 Kf7 80.Nf6 Kxg7 81.Nh5+ Kf7 82.Ng3+-) **70.Kf4 Kf6 71.Nc2 Bd7 72.Ne1 Bc8 73.Nd3 Be6** (73...Bb7 74.Ke3 Kg7 75.Nf4 Kh6 76.Ne2 Kg6 77.Kf4 Kf6 78.Ng3 Bc8 79.Nxh5++-) **74.Kf3 Ke7** (74...Kg7 75.Ke3 Kf6 *(75...Kf7 76.Nf4+-)* 76.Nc5 Bc8 77.Kf4+- see the game) **75.Kg3 Kf6 76.Nc5 Bc8 77.Kf4 Kg6 78.Ke5 f4** (78...Kf7 79.Nd3+-) **79.Kxf4 Kf6**



The next move looks strange at first sight, but White's king has to retreat to win the fight for the opposition as the knight can't lose a tempo **80.Kg3 Kg7 81.Kf3 Kg6** (81...Kf7 82.Nd3 Bg4+ 83.Kf2 Kf6 *(83...Ke7 84.Nc5 Bc8 85.Ke3 Kf7 86.Nd3 Kf6 87.Nf4+-)* 84.Nf4 Kf5 85.Nxd5 Ke4 86.Nf6+ Kxd4 87.Nxg4 hxg4 *(87...Kc3 88.Nf6 Kxb4 89.Nxh5 Kxa5 90.Nf4+-)* 88.Kg3+-; 81...Kf6 82.Kf4+- and White has managed to lose the tempo by the triangulation of his King.) **82.Nd3 Bg4+** (82...Bb7 83.Nf4+ Kh6 84.Ke3 Ba8 85.Nd3 Kg6 86.Kf4 Kf6 87.Nc5+-) **83.Ke3! Be6 84.Nf4+ Kf5 85.Nxh5** (Of course not 85.Nxe6?? Kxe6 86.Kf4 Kf6=) **85...Kg4 86.Nf4 Bf7 87.Nd3 Be6 88.Nc5 Bc8 89.h5 1–0** Very well played by Alexander Khalifman!

The last two examples show different themes.



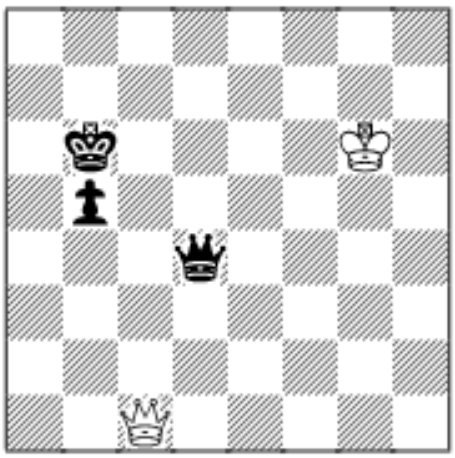
6.05 *K.Müller* - *Curt Hansen* German Bundesliga 6th board, Hamburg-Porz 2001

Curt Hansen breaks through with a nice sacrifice of the knight: **42...Nf3!** (42...Ne4? 43.Bxe4 dxe4 44.g5+ Ke7 45.g6 e3 46.g7 e2 47.g8Q e1Q 48.Qg5+=) **43.Bc2 e5 44.g5+ Nxg5** (Of course not 44...Kf7?? 45.g6+ Kg8 46.Bf5+-) **45.dxe5+ Kxe5 46.Kxg5 d4 47.a4** (47.cxd4+ Kxd4 48.Kf4 b4 49.axb4 axb4 50.Kf3 b3 51.Bd1 b2 52.Bc2 Kc3 53.Bf5 Kd2–+; 47.Kg4 d3 48.Bb1 Ke4 49.Kg5 b4 50.axb4 axb4 51.cxb4 c3–+) **47...d3 48.Bd1 b4 49.cxb4 c3 0–1**



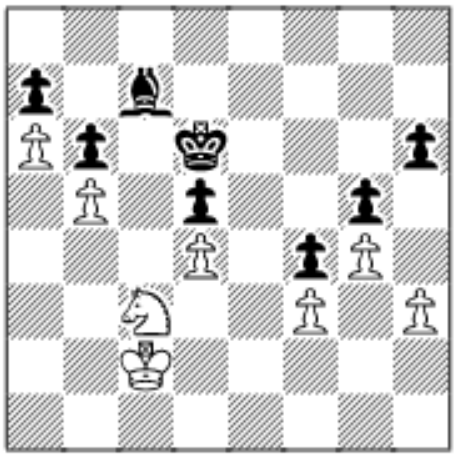
6.06 *J.Pelikian* (2393) - *J.Sunye Neto* (2555) Sao Paulo zt 2000

Black can't make progress by normal means, so Sunye Neto takes drastic measures: **68...Nxd4!? 69.exd4 e3 70.Kh6** (70.Bh4 comes into consideration as well e.g. 70...Ke4 71.Kg6 Kxd4 72.Kf6 Kc4 73.Kxe6 d4 74.Kf5 d3 75.e6 d2 76.e7 d1Q 77.e8Q Qf3+ 78.Ke5 Kxb4 79.Kd4=) **70...Ke4 71.Kg6 Kxd4 72.Kf6 Kc4 73.Kxe6?!** (73.Kg5! was better e.g. 73...d4 74.Kf4 Kd3 75.Kf3 e2 76.Kf2 Ke4 77.Kxe2 Kxe5 78.Kd3 Kd5 79.Bh4 e5 80.Be7 e4+ 81.Kd2 Kc4 82.Bc5 e3+ 83.Kc2 d3+ 84.Kd1 e2+ 85.Kd2=) **73...d4 74.Kf5 d3 75.e6 d2 76.Bxd2 exd2 77.e7 d1Q 78.e8Q Qd5+ 79.Kg6 Kxb4 80.Qe1+ Kc5 81.Qe3+ Qd4 82.Qc1+ Kb6**



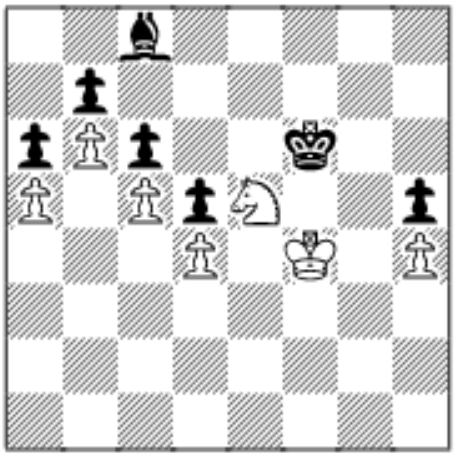
This endgame is drawn according to the tablebase, but over the board it is extremely difficult to hold the draw. White shows, that he knows the rule, that his king should be near the north east corner, but unfortunately Black's king march to b6 involved a trick: **83.Kh7? Qd7+** and White resigned as he can't prevent the exchange of queens.

Exercises (Solutions next month)



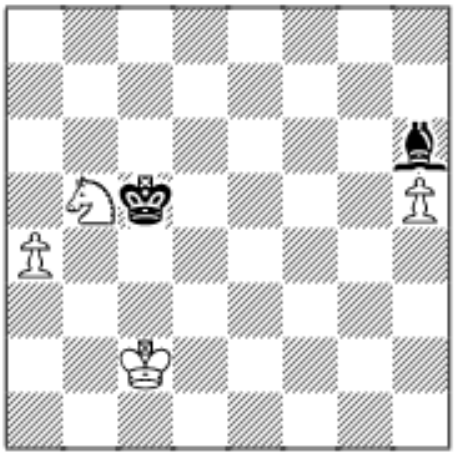
E6.01 ***J.H.Blackburne*** **-** ***J.Mason*** **Paris 1878**

Can White to move convert his advantage?



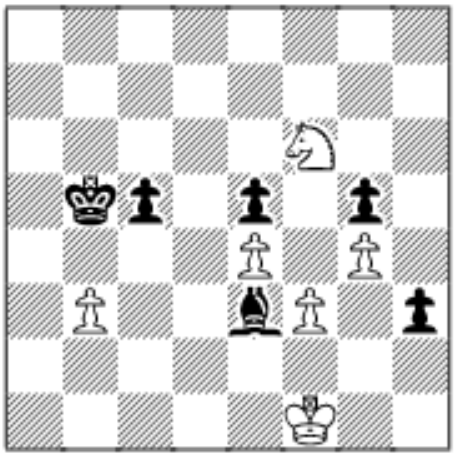
E6.02 ***C.Schlechter*** **-** ***K.Walbrodt*** **Wien 1898**

This example is very famous. White can indeed win but how?



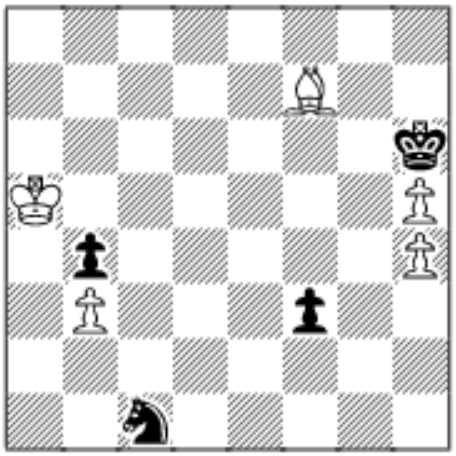
E6.03 After ***Z.Varga*** **-** ***P.Acs*** **Budapest 1999**

Black to move and draw



E6.04 *G.Vescovi* (2526) - *K.Sakaev* (2627) Istanbul ol 2000

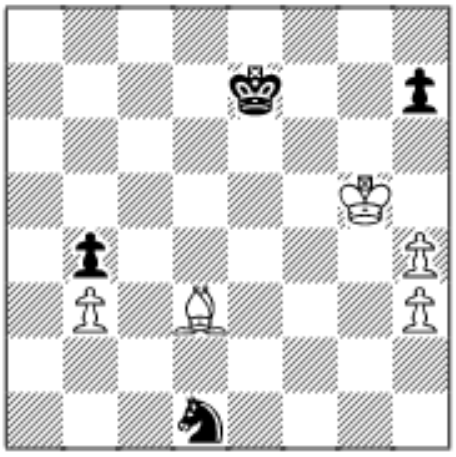
Black to move and win



E6.05 *H.Camilleri* (2156) - *Nirosh De Silva* (2162) Istanbul ol 2000

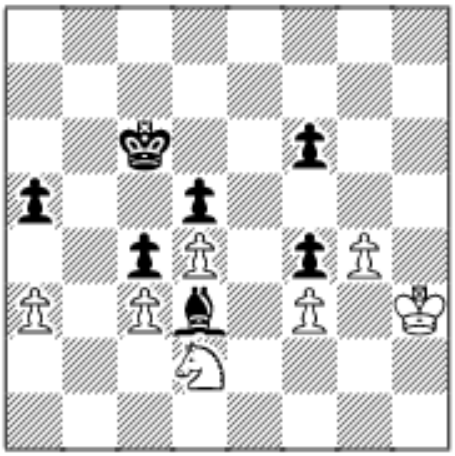
How to asses the position with White to move?

Solutions to last month's exercises



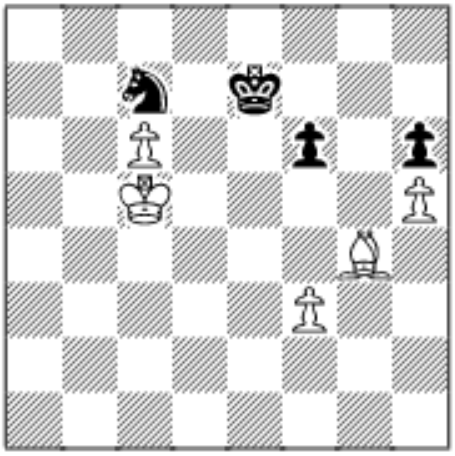
S5.01 *Gambit Tiger 1.0* - *Deep Fritz* Computer Chess Match Tournament Cadaques 2001

The position is drawn: **57...Kf7 58.Bxh7 Kg7 59.Bg6 Nc3 60.h5 Ne2 61.h6+ Kh8 62.Bf7 Nd4 63.Bd5 Nxb3 64.Bxb3** and Gambit Tiger made another 68 moves before conceding the draw.



S5.02 *K. van der Weide* (2434) - *J.A.Nilssen* (2326) Politiken Cup Copenhagen 1999

Van der Weide saved the game as follows: **48.a4!!** closing the path of Black's king via b5-a4 **48...Bc2 49.g5 fxg5 50.Kg4 Bxa4 51.Nb1!** the point: the knight goes to a3, where it locks the queenside. **51...Bd1 52.Na3 Kd6 53.Kxg5 Bxf3 54.Kxf4 ½–½**



S5.03 *V.Potkin* (2470) - *V.Milov* (2604) Linares Anibal op 2001

White managed to storm Black's castle: **57.Bd7 Na8 58.Kd5 Nc7+** (58...Nb6+ 59.Ke4 Nxd7 60.cxd7 Kxd7 61.Kf5 Ke7 62.Kg6+-) **59.Ke4 Kf8 60.Kf5 Kf7 61.Bc8 Nb5 62.Be6+ Ke7** (62...Kg7 63.Bd5 Nc7 64.Bc4+-) **63.Bd5 Nd4+ 64.Kg6 Ne2 65.Kxh6 Nf4 66.Be4 Kd6 67.Bg6 1–0**

Sources:
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
The Week in Chess
Awerbach, *Endspiele Läufer gegen Springer und Turm gegen Leichtfigur*, Sportverlag Berlin 1989

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COLUMNISTS

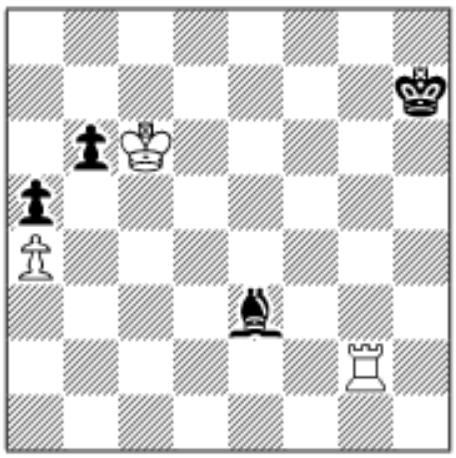
Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



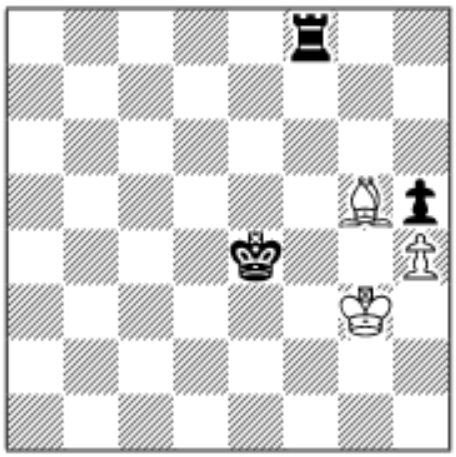
Rook vs Bishop

Richard Forster analysed a very interesting ending in his April 2001 Late Knight column, which was reached in a game between Staunton and Horwitz and asked me about my opinion. I answered his question (it was on the **ChessCafe.com** Bulletin Board item no. 320–1) and promised to deal with the subject in more detail. Now I want to keep my promise:



7.01 *Staunton - Horwitz* London match 1846 17th game +/-

"Since Staunton just says 'and wins', we do not know whether Horwitz resigned at this point or whether further moves were played"(Forster). The position is winning for White in any case: **1...Kh6 2.Kb5!?** The easiest way to win is to transfer the king to a6 first. But 2.Rb2 immediately wins as well: 2...Kg6 3.Rxb6 Bd2 *(3...Kf6 4.Rb2 Ke5 5.Rb5++-)* 4.Rb2 Be1 5.Re2 Bb4 6.Rf2 Kg5 7.Kb6 Be1 8.Rf8 Bb4 9.Ra8 Kf6 10.Rxa5+- **2...Bc5 3.Ka6 Kh7 4.Rb2 Kg6** (4...Bb4 5.Kxb6 Kg6 6.Rf2+-) **5.Rxb6+ Kf7 6.Kxa5+-**



The following classic shows, how complicated this ending can be. My discussion follows Averbakh.

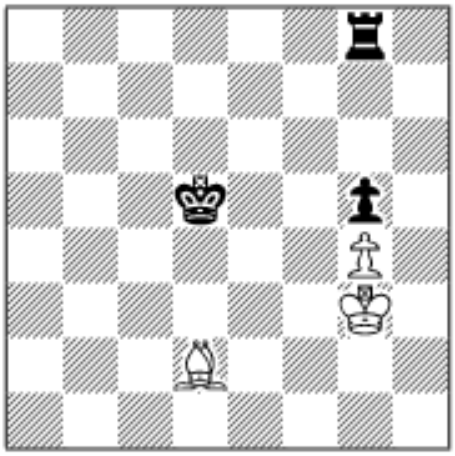
7.02 *Salwe - Rubinstein* Prague 1909

1...Rf7 Maizelis showed the right path, which is surprisingly not driving the king into the open field, but attacking him near the edge: 1...Kd3 2.Bf4 Ke2 3.Bg5 Rf3+ 4.Kg2 Ra3 5.Be7 Ra4 6.Bd8 Rg4+ 7.Kh3 Kf3 8.Bc7 Rg1 9.Bh2 Rf1 10.Bg3 Rh1+ 11.Bh2 Ke4 12.Kg2 Rd1 13.Bg3 *(13.Bg1 Kf4 14.Bc5 Kg4 15.Be7 Rd2+ 16.Kf1 Kf3 17.Kg1 Kg3 18.Kf1 Rd4 19.Bg5 Re4 20.Bd8 Re6 21.Bg5 Re8–+)* 13...Rd2+ 14.Kh3 *(14.Bf2 Kf4 15.Kh3 Rd3+ 16.Kg2 Kg4–+)* 14...Kf5 15.Bh2 *(15.Be1 Rd3+ 16.Kg2 Kg4 17.Kf2 Rd7 18.Ke2 Re7+ 19.Kd2 Kf3 20.Kd1 Re4 21.Kd2 Re2+ 22.Kd1 Rh2 23.Kc1 Ke2 24.Bg3 Rh3–+)* 15...Rd3+ 16.Bg3 Ra3 17.Kg2 Kg4 18.Bf2 Ra2 19.Kg1 Kf3 20.Bd4 Kg3 21.Bf6 Rg2+ 22.Kh1 Re2–+ **2.Bh6 Rf3+ 3.Kg2 Rd3?** this let's White's king

out of the corner. But it must be stressed, that this plan was not known at Rubinstein's time. **4.Bg5?** 4.Kf2 was called for. **4...Kf5? 5.Kf2!** I think, that there are two ways of looking at this: 1) the modern view: now Salwe escapes from the corner into the open field, which is the right plan.2) the way valid at the time of the game: now Rubinstein has forced Salwe away from his pawn **5...Kg4 6.Ke2 Rf3 7.Bh6 Kg3 8.Bg5 Rf8 9.Ke3 Re8+ 10.Kd3 Kf3 11.Kd4 Re6**



12.Kd5? the decisive mistake. Baranow proved, that Black can't break through after 12.Kd3 Rd6+ 13.Kc3! Rd7 14.Kc4 Ke4 15.Kc3 Rd3+ 16.Kc2! and Black can't make meaningful progress. 16.Kc4? is wrong: Rg3 17.Bd8 Rg8 18.Be7 Rc8+–+ **12...Re4 13.Bf6 Kf4 14.Bd8 Kf5 15.Bg5 Rg4 16.Be7 Rg7 17.Bf8** (17.Bg5 Rxg5 18.hxg5 Kxg5 19.Ke4 Kg4–+) **17...Rd7+ 18.Kc6 Rd4 19.Be7 Ke6 20.Kc5 Rd5+ 21.Kc4 Rf5 22.Bd8 Kd7 23.Bb6** (23.Bg5 Rxg5 24.hxg5 h4 25.g6 Ke7–+) **23...Rf4+** and Rubinstein won the game after a few more moves.



In the next game Rubinstein reaches his aim again . This time he manages to draw with the bishop.

7.03 *A.Rubinstein - S.Tartakower* Vienna 1922

Black has to protect the g5 pawn, so one of his pieces is tied down and he can't break through: **68.Kf3 Kd4 69.Be3+ Kd3 70.Bc1 Rg7 71.Kf2** The brutal 71.Bxg5? fails: 71...Rxg5 72.Kf4 Rg8 73.g5 Kd4 74.Kf5 Kd5 75.Kf6 Kd6–+ **71...Kc2 72.Be3 Rg8 73.Kf3 Kd3 74.Bc1 ½–½**



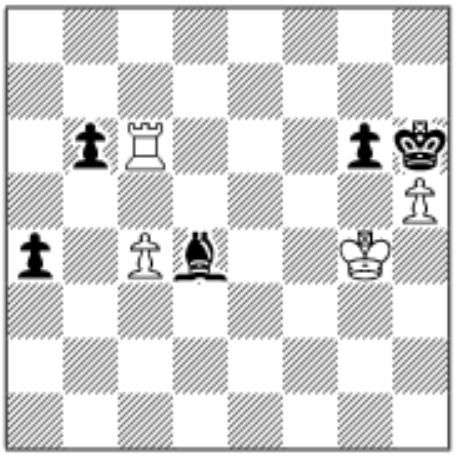
The following fortress is very important as it occurs quite often in practical play:

7.04 *P.Leko* (2743) - *A.Beliavsky* (2654) Istanbul Ol (Men) 2000

72.g4!? (72.Rc7+ Kg8=) **72...hxg4 73.Rxg4 Kh6!** this counterattack against the weak h4-pawn secures the draw. **74.Rg5 Bc3 75.Kf7 Be1 76.Rxg6+ Kh5 77.Rg1 Bf2** (77...Bxh4 is playable as well.) **78.Rg2 Be1 79.Kf6 Kxh4** 79...Bc3+ draws as well, but all other moves lose. 79...Bb4 loses for example in 44 moves according to the Nalimov endgame tablebase. **80.Kf5 Bg3 81.Rc2 Kh3 82.Rc3 Kh4 83.Rc8 Bd6 84.Rc3 Bb8 85.Rc8 Bd6 86.Rg8 Kh3 87.Ke4 Kh4** and after some further moves a draw was agreed.

I want to end this article with a very complicated example, that was analysed in detail by German chess trainer and columnist Claus Dieter Meyer, who was a trainer in Hamburg for a long time:

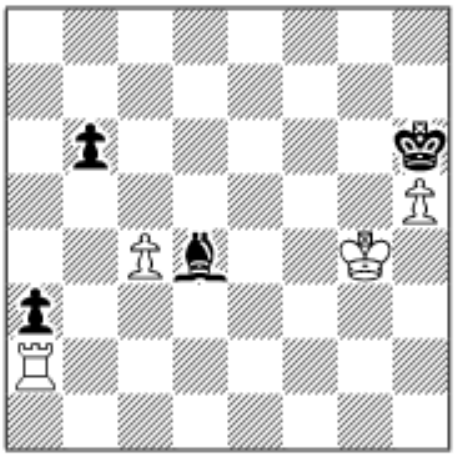
7.05 Claus Dieter Meyer Hamburg 1997, *ChessBase Magazine* 77



1.c5!? was my proposal at a training session in 1997 to break through Black's defence. Other tries include 1.Rxg6+ Kh7 2.Re6 *(2.Rd6 Bc5 3.Re6 a3 4.Rc6 Bd4 5.Rc7+ Kh6 6.Ra7*



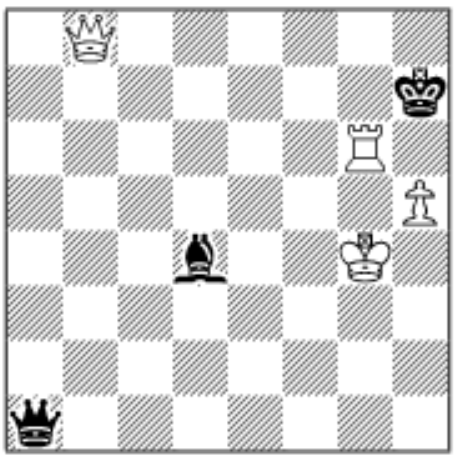
6...Bc5=) 2...a3 3.Re2 Kh6 4.Ra2



4...Bc5 *(4...Bb2? 5.Kf5 Kxh5 6.Ke6 Kg5 7.Kd5 Kf5 8.Kc6 Ke5 9.Kxb6 Kd4 10.c5 Kc4 11.c6 Kb3 12.Rxa3++-)* 5.Kf5 Bb4 6.Rg2 Bc3 7.Rg6+ Kh7 *(7...Kxh5? 8.Rg3 Be1 9.Rh3+ Bh4 10.Rxa3+-)* 8.Rxb6 a2= and 1.hxg6 a3= **1...a3** (1...bxc5? gives White's rook free access to the a-file: 2.Rxg6+ Kh7 3.Ra6 a3 *(3...Kg7 4.h6+ Kh7 5.Kh5 c4 6.Rxa4 Be3 7.Rxc4 Bxh6 8.Rc7+ Bg7 9.Kg5+-* as Black's king is in the wrong corner.*)* 4.Rxa3 Kg7 5.Ra6 Be3 6.Rc6 Kh7 7.Kf3 Bd4 8.h6 c4 9.Kg4+-, but not 9.Rxc4? Bf6 10.Kg4 Kxh6=. After 1...Bxc5? 2.hxg6 wins e.g. 2...a3 3.Kf5 Kg7 4.Rc7+ Kg8 5.Ra7 b5 *(5...Bb4 6.g7 Kh7 7.Kf6 Bc3+ 8.Kf7 Bxg7 9.Rxa3+-)* 6.Ra8+ Kg7 7.Ra5 Bb4 8.Ra7+ Kg8 9.g7+-) **2.Rxg6+ Kh7**



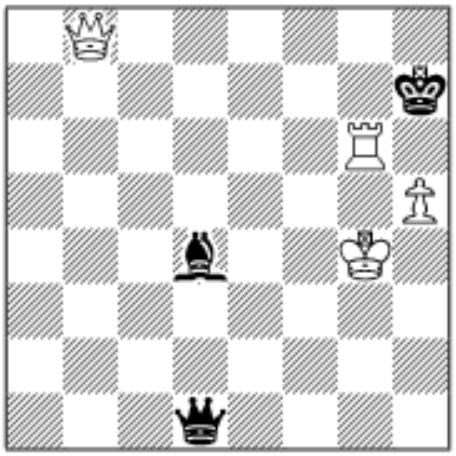
3.c6! 3.cxb6?! allows stalemate motives: 3...a2 4.b7 a1Q 5.b8Q



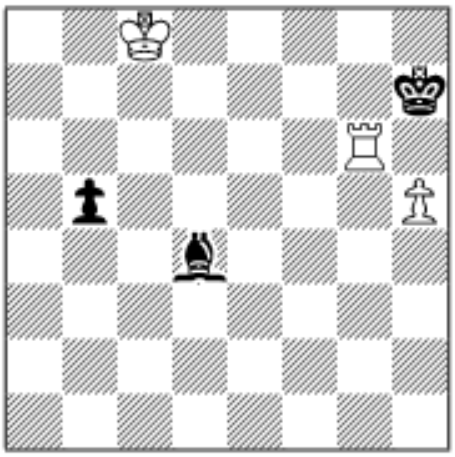
and now neither **A)** 5...Qg1+? 6.Qg3 **A1)** 6...Qc1 7.Rd6 Qd1+ *(7...Qc4 8.Qf4+-)* 8.Qf3 Qg1+ 9.Kh3+-; **A2)** 6...Qd1+ 7.Qf3 Qg1+ 8.Kh3+- nor

B) 5...Bg7? 6.Qf4 Qg1+ *(6...Qd1+ 7.Qf3 Qd7+ 8.Kh4+-)* 7.Qg3 Qc1 8.Qf3+-, but

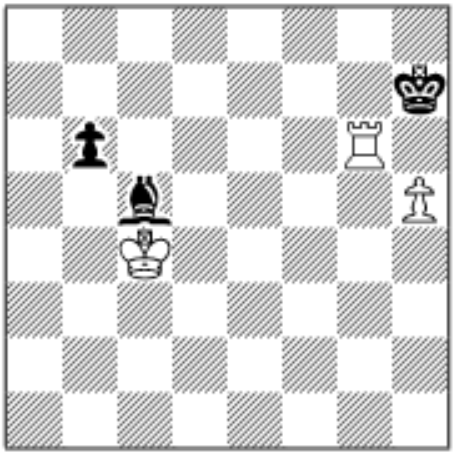
C) 5...Qd1+!



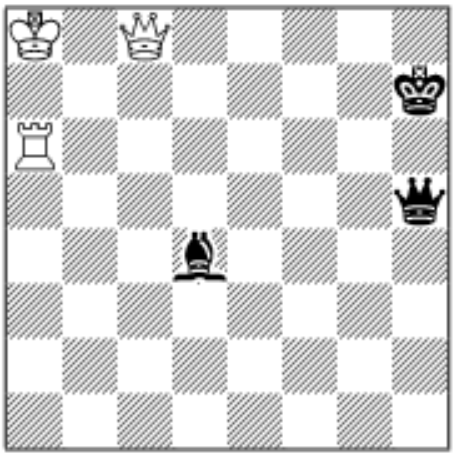
6.Kg5 *(6.Kg3 Be5+! 7.Qxe5 Qf3+ 8.Kh4 Qh3+ 9.Kg5 Qxh5+ 10.Kxh5* stalemate*; 6.Kf5 Qxh5+ 7.Rg5 Qh3+=; 6.Kf4 Be5+!=)* 6...Be3+ 7.Kf6 Qf3+ 8.Ke7 Bc5+ 9.Ke6 Qh3+! 10.Kf6 Qf3+ 11.Ke6 Qh3+= **3...a2 4.c7 a1Q 5.c8Q** and now C.D.Meyer's main line runs as follows: **5...Qd1+ 6.Kf4! Qd2+ 7.Ke4 Qe3+ 8.Kd5 Qe5+ 9.Kc4!** After 9.Kc6? Black can exchange the queens as White's king is too far away from his h-pawn, e.g. 9...Qc5+ 10.Kb7 Qxc8+ 11.Kxc8 b5



12.Rg5 *(12.Kd7 b4 13.Ke6 b3 14.Rg3 Kh6 15.Kf5 b2=)* 12...b4 *(12...Kh6? 13.Rxb5+-)* 13.Rb5 Bc3 *(13...Kh6? 14.Rxb4+-)* 14.Rb6 *(14.Kd7 Kh6=)* 14...Be1 and now both **A)** 15.Kd7 Bd2 16.Ke8 *(16.Ke6 Kh6=)* 16...Bg5 17.Kf7 Bd2 18.Rg6 Bc3 *(18...b3? 19.Rb6+-)* 19.Ke6 b3= and **B)** 15.Kb7 Bf2! 16.Rxb4 Kh6= are not sufficient to win. **9...b5+** (9...Qc5+? 10.Qxc5 Bxc5 (See Diagram)

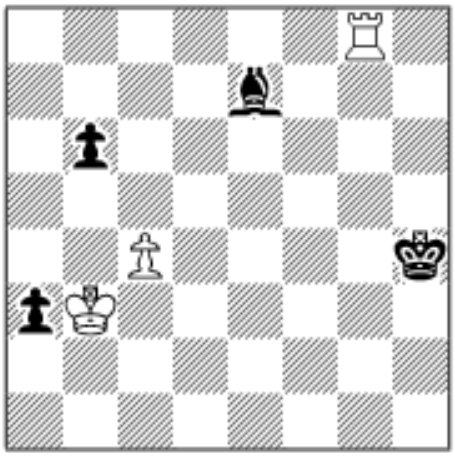


11.Kd5 Bf2 12.Ke4 b5 13.Kf3 Be1 14.Rb6 b4 15.Kg4 Bd2 16.Rb7+ Kh6 17.Rc7!+-) **10.Kb4 Qe7+ 11.Ka5 Qa3+ 12.Kxb5 Qb3+ 13.Kc6 Qc4+ 14.Kb7 Qb5+ 15.Ka8 Qa5+ 16.Ra6 Qxh5**



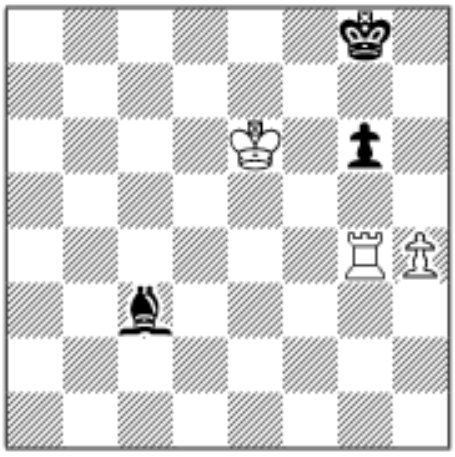
Meyer's main line ends here with the statement, that “we have to wait for 6 man databases to evaluate this position.” Ken Thompson's 6-man database states that it is drawn. Amazing stuff!

Exercises (Solutions next month)



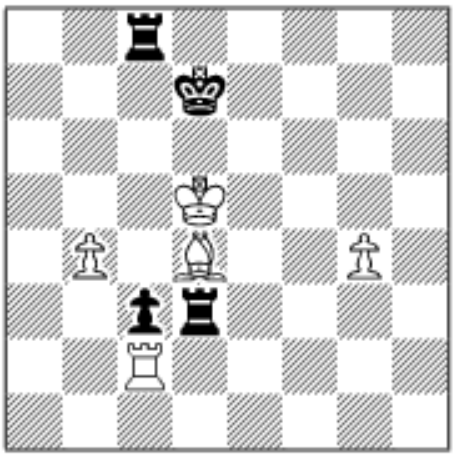
E7.01 Claus Dieter Meyer

White to move and win.



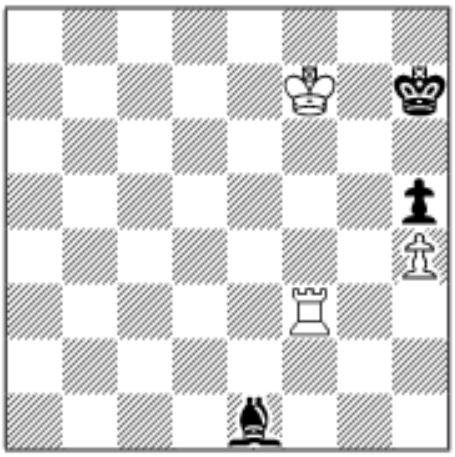
E7.02 *R.Vera* (2584) - *A.Baburin* (2590) Istanbul Ol (Men) 2000

Is Black lost or did Alexander Baburin find a way to survive?



E7.03 *R.Knaak* - *K.Müller* German Bundesliga 2001, Hamburger SK-Werder Bremen, 5th board

Can White to move defend the position?



E7.04 W.Pajeken (2337) - M.Kopylov (2444) International Hamburg City Championship 2001

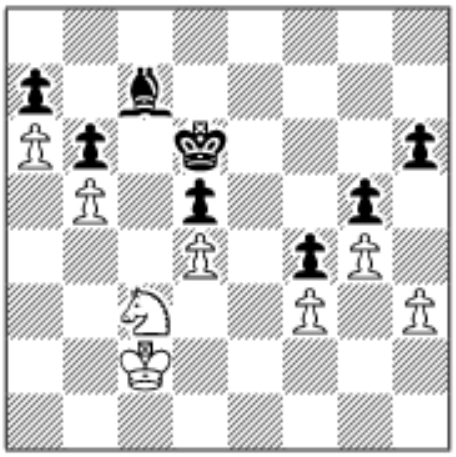
The position is more complicated than it seems at first sight. In the game it was White to move and he can indeed win. How? Black to move on the other hand could reach a draw by force.



E7.05 *A.Greenfeld* (2570) - *A.Graf* (2649) European Championship Ohrid 2001

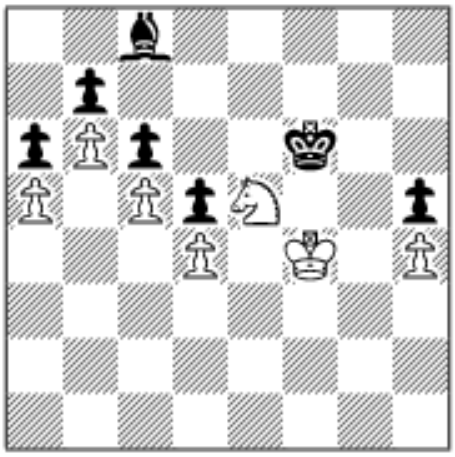
Can Black to move convert his advantage?

Solutions to last month exercises



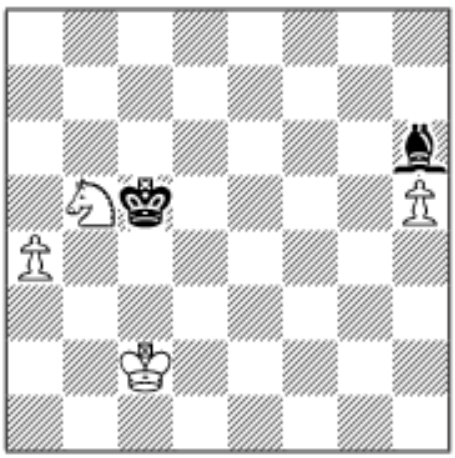
E6.01 J.H.Blackburne - J.Mason Paris 1878

Blackburne sent his Knight to c6 and won: **79.Na2 Bd8 80.Nb4 Kd7 81.Nc6 Be7 82.Nxa7 Kc7 83.Nc6 Bd6 84.Ne5 Kc8 85.Nd7** and Mason resigned. After **85...Bc7 86.Nf6** the d5-pawn falls and it is over.



E6.02 *C.Schlechter - K.Walbrodt* Wien 1898

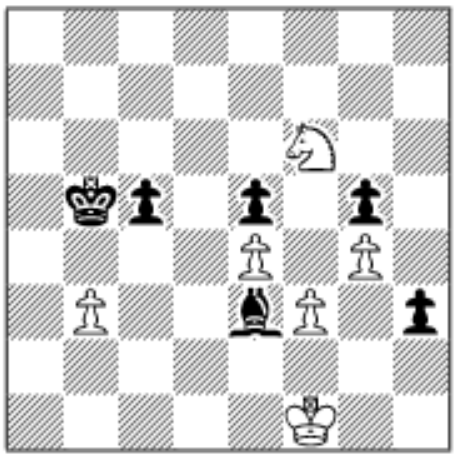
Black to move is in zugzwang and loses immediately. But transferring the move to Black is quite tricky: **60.Nf3?!** 60.Ke3!? Ke6 *(60...Kf5?! 61.Nf7+-; 60...Ke7 61.Kf3 Ke6 62.Nd3 Kf6 63.Ke3 Kf5 64.Nf4 Kg4 65.Nxh5 Kxh5 66.Kf4+-)* 61.Ke2 Kf6 62.Kf2 Ke6 63.Ke3 Ke7 64.Kf3 Ke6 65.Nd3 Kf6 66.Ke3 Kf7 67.Kf4 Kf6 68.Ne5 and the position E6.02 is reached with Black to move and he is lost e.g. 68...Be6 *(68...Ke6 69.Kg5 Ke7 70.Kxh5+-)* 69.Nxc6 bxc6 70.b7+- **60...Bf5 61.Ke3 Bc8 62.Ne5 Ke6 63.Kf3 Ke7 64.Nd3 Bf5 65.Nf4 Bg4+ 66.Ke3 Kf7 67.Nd3 Ke7 68.Ne5 Bc8 69.Kf3! Ke6 70.Nd3 Kf6 71.Ke3 1–0**



S6.03 After *Z.Varga - P.Acs* Budapest 1999

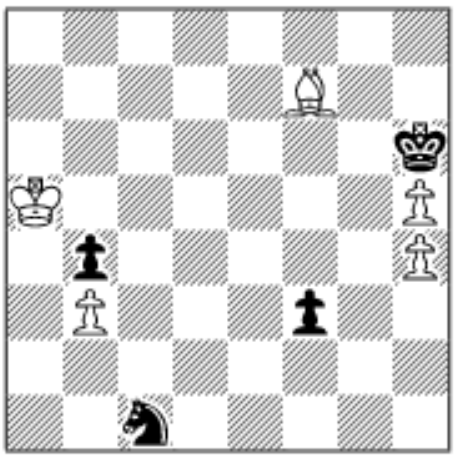
This exercises was not so easy due to the many reciprocal zugzwangs lurking around: **1...Kc4!!** reciprocal zugzwang no.1. All other moves lose e.g. 1...Kb4? 2.Nc3 Bf8 3.Kd2 Bh6+ 4.Ke2 **A)** 4...Bf8 5.Kf3 Bg7 6.Ne4 Kxa4 7.Kg4 Kb5 8.Kf5 Kc6 9.Kg6 Be5 *(9...Bf8 10.Nf6 Kd6 11.Ne8+ Ke7 12.Ng7+-)* 10.h6 Kd7 11.Kf7 Bh8 12.h7 Kc6 13.Kg8 Bb2 14.Ng3 Kd7 15.Nf5+-; **B)** 4...Bg7 5.Kd3 Bf8 6.Ke4 Kxc3 7.a5 Kb4 8.a6 Bc5 9.h6 Kb5 10.h7+- or 1...Kd5? 2.a5 Kc6 3.a6 Kb6 4.a7 Kb7 5.Kd3 Bg5 6.Ke4 Ka8 7.Kf5 Bd2 8.Kg6 Kb7 9.Nd6++- **2.Nc3 Kb4** reciprocal zugzwang no.2 **3.Kd3** and we have reached the game, which ended in a draw: **3...Bg7** reciprocal zugzwang no.3 **4.Ne2** (4.Kc2 Bh6

5.Kd3 Bg7 6.Nd5+ Kxa4 7.Ke4 Kb5 8.Kf5 Kc5 9.Kg6 Bd4 10.Nf4 Kd6 11.h6 Ke7 12.h7 Bb2 13.Nh5 Bh8!=) **4...Kxa4 5.Ke4 Bh6 6.Nd4 Kb4 7.Ne6 Kb5 8.Kf5 Kc6 9.Kg6 Bc1 10.Ng5 Kd7 11.h6 Ke8 12.h7 Bb2** and the game was drawn after some further moves.



S6.04 *G.Vescovi* (2526) - *K.Sakaev* (2627) Istanbul ol 2000

This exercise was probably not so difficult: **49...Ka5!** and Vescovi resigned. A possible finish is **50.Nd5 Bd4 51.Nf6 Kb4 52.Nh7 Kxb3 53.Nxg5 c4 54.Nxh3 c3–+**



S6.05 *H.Camilleri* (2156) - *Nirosh de Silva* (2162) Istanbul ol 2000

White lost the game, but the position is drawn: **51.Bc4?** (51.Bd5! f2 52.Bc4 Na2 *(52...Nxb3+ 53.Kxb4 Nd2 54.Be2=)* 53.Be2=; 51.Kxb4 Nd3+ 52.Kc3 f2–+) **51...Na2 52.Kb6 Kxh5 53.Kc5 Kxh4 54.Kd4 Kg3 55.Ke3 f2 56.Bf1 Nc1 57.Ba6 Nxb3 58.Bf1 Nc5 59.Kd4 b3 60.Kc3 Kh2 61.Kd2 Kg1 62.Bc4 f1Q 63.Bxf1 Kxf1 64.Kc3 Ke2 65.Kb2 Kd2 66.Kb1 Kc3 67.Ka1 Ne4 0-1**

Sources:

Juri Awerbach, *Endspiele Springer gegen Läufer und Turm gegen Leichtfigur*, Sportverlag Berlin 1988
Claus Dieter Meyer's endgame analysis in *ChessBase Magazine 77*
Richard Forster's Late Knight column April 2001 and his contribution on Staunton vs Horwitz to the **ChessCafe.com** Bulletin Board (item no. 320–1).
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
Nalimov 5-man tablebase
Ken Thompson's 6-man database

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COLUMNISTS

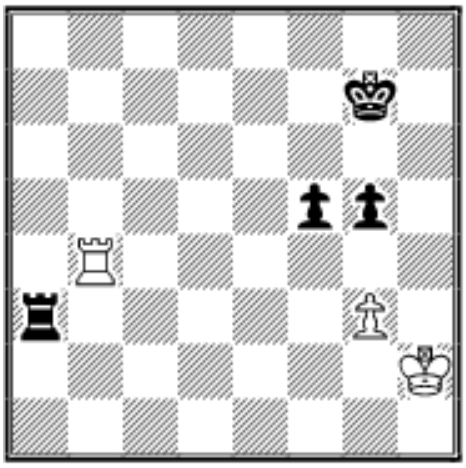
Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



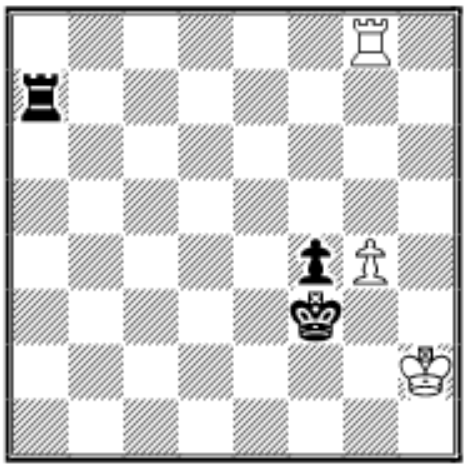
Recent Rook Endings

Rook Endings are very important as they happen so often in practical play. In my first column I dealt with some basic positions and the famous ending rook + h- and f-pawn vs rook. Now I want to look at seven games from this year including four double rook endings:



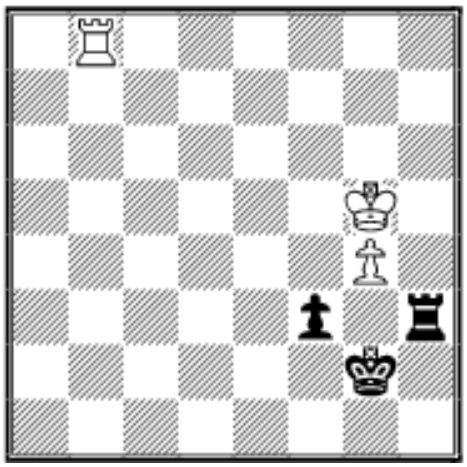
8.01 *D.King - K.Müller* German Bundesliga 2001, Castrop Rauxel - HSK, 4th board

Despite Black's extra pawn, the position is completely drawn, but care is required: **50.g4!?** If White manages to swap pawns he can use Philidor's well known defensive technique (see, e.g., my first *Endgame Corner* column); after **50...f4** Black's king lacks shelter and Black has to sacrifice the g-pawn in order to play on **51.Rb7+ Kf6 52.Rb6+ Ke5 53.Rb5+ Ke4 54.Rxg5 Kf3** (54...Ra2+ 55.Kh3! f3 56.Rb5=) **55.Rg8?!** King makes it difficult for himself. 55.Rb5 was called for: 55...Kxg4 (55...Ra2+ 56.Kh3!=) 56.Rb8 Ra2+ 57.Kg1 Kg3 58.Rg8+! Kf3 59.Rf8= as White's king is on the short side of the f-pawn. **55...Ra7**



setting a trap. White has now only two moves to hold the position. **56.Rh8** Moving back with 56.Rg5 is the only other option. All other moves lose, e.g., 56.g5? Rh7+ 57.Kg1 Kg3 58.g6 Ra7 59.Kf1 Ra1+ 60.Ke2 f3+ 61.Kd2 Ra6 62.g7 Ra7 63.Ke3 Re7+ –+ or 56.Rb8? Rh7+ 57.Kg1 Kg3 58.Rb3+ f3 59.g5 Ra7 60.Rb1 Ra2 61.g6 Rg2+ –+ **56...Kf2 57.Kh3** (57.g5?! Rg7 58.Kh3 [58.Rh5? f3 59.Kh3 Kg1 60.Rh4 Rxg5 61.Ra4 f2–+; 58.Rh4?! f3 59.Kh3 Rxg5 60.Ra4=] 58...Rxg5 59.Ra8=) **57...Ra3+** (57...Ra1 58.Kh2 f3 59.Rb8 Ke1 60.Kg3 f2 61.Re8+ Kf1 62.g5 [Not 62.Rf8? Ra3+ 63.Kh4 (63.Kh2 Re3–+) 63...Kg2 64.Rxf2+ Kxf2 65.g5 Kf3 66.Kh5 Kf4 67.Kh6 Rh3+–+] 62...Kg1 63.Rf8 f1Q 64.Rxf1+ Kxf1 65.Kf4=) **58.Kh4** 58.Kh2 was playable as well, but King wanted to activate his king. **58...Kg2 59.Rb8?!** 59.Rf8 Rh3+ 60.Kg5 f3 61.Kg6!= was somewhat easier.

59...Rh3+ 60.Kg5 f3



Again White has only two moves to save his skin and the following king move is essential in both lines: **61.Kg6!!** 61.Rb1 is possible as well, but after 61...f2, 62.Kg6!!= has to be played anyway. All other moves lose, e.g., 61.Kf6? f2 62.Rb1 (62.Rb2 Rf3+ 63.Kg6 Kg3 64.Rxf2 Rxf2 65.g5 Kg4 66.Kh6 Rh2+ 67.Kg6 Rh5–+) 62...Rf3+ 63.Ke6 Kg3 64.g5 Re3+ 65.Kf5 Re1–+, 61.Rb2+? f2 62.Rxf2+ (62.Rb1 Rg3 63.Kh4 Rb3–+) 62...Kxf2 63.Kf6 Rf3+ 64.Ke6 Rg3 65.Kf5 Kg2 66.g5 Kh3 67.g6 Kh4 68.Kf6 Kh5 69.g7 Kh6–+ and 61.Kf4? f2 62.Rb1 Rf3+ 63.Ke5 Kh3 64.g5 Re3+–+ **61...f2 62.Rb1!** 62.Rb2? loses in an instructive way: 62...Rf3 63.g5 Kg3 64.Rxf2 Rxf2 65.Kh7 Rh2+ 66.Kg8 Kg4 67.g6 Kg5 68.g7 Kg6 69.Kf8 Rf2+ 70.Kg8 Rf1 71.Kh8 Rh1+ 72.Kg8 Rh7–+ **62...Rh1 63.Rb2 Kg3 64.Rxf2 Kxf2 65.g5 Kg3 66.Kf7 Rf1+ 67.Ke7 Re1+ 68.Kf7 Rf1+ 69.Ke7 Kh4** in sharp contrast to the variation 62.Rb2? Black's king now chases the pawn in vain: **70.g6 Rg1 71.Kf7 Kh5 72.g7 Rf1+ 73.Ke7 Rg1 74.Kf7 Kh6 75.g8R** and King had his rook back **75...Rxg8 76.Kxg8 ½–½**

Garry Kasparov had two instructive rook endings recently. In the first example he won convincingly:



8.02 *A.Morozevich* (2749) - *G.Kasparov* (2827), Astana 2001

Black's e4-pawn will cost white his rook: **47...Rc7 48.Rxe5** 48.Kg3 doesn't help: 48...Rg7+ 49.Kh4 (49.Kh2 Kd2 50.Rxe5 e3–+) 49...Kd2 50.Rxe5 e3 51.Rd5+ Kxc2 52.Re5 Kd3 53.Rd5+ Ke4–+ **48...Kf4!** not allowing White any counterplay **49.Rb5 Rxc2+ 50.Kg1 e3 51.Rxb4+** 51.Kf1 Rxa2 52.h4 (52.Rxb4+ Kf3 53.Rb1 Rh2 54.Kg1 Rg2+ 55.Kh1 e2 56.Re1 Rg8–+) 52...Kf3 53.Rf5+ Ke4 54.Rb5 Kd3 55.Rd5+ Kc4 56.Rd8 b3–+ **51...Kf3 52.Rb1 Rg2+ 53.Kh1 e2 54.a4 Kf2 55.a5 Rg5 56.Kh2 Rxa5 57.h4**



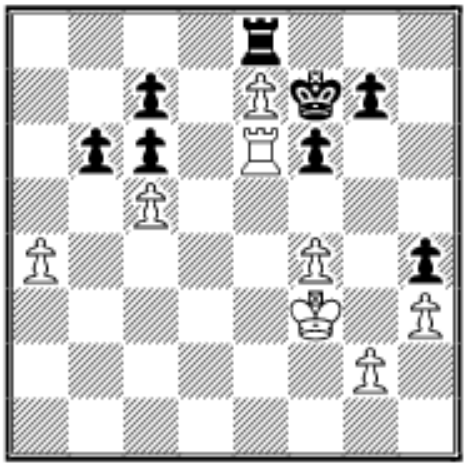
57...Ra3 0-1 good technique! Kasparov cuts the king off making it very easy for him. But 57...e1Q 58.Rxe1 Kxe1 59.Kg3 Ra4! wins as well.

The next example is more complicated:



8.03 *G.Kasparov* (2849) - *V.Kramnik* (2772), Corus Wijk aan Zee 2001

Kasparov's position is much better as he has the initiative and Black's pawn majority on the queenside is crippled. Nevertheless the drawish tendency inherent in rook endings is great and Kramnik is by no means easy to defeat: **30...a5!?** seeking active counterplay is usually a good idea in rook endings. **31.bxa5 Ra8 32.Ra3 Kf5** Of course not 32...Rxa5? 33.Rxa5 bxa5 as White's pawn majority can produce a passed pawn while Black's can't. One sample line runs 34.g4 hxg3+ 35.Kxg3 Kf5 36.c5 Ke4 (36...Ke6 37.h4 f6 38.exf6 Kxf6 39.Kg4 g6 40.a4+-; 36...g5 37.fxg5 Kxg5 38.a4 Kf5 39.h4 Kxe5 40.Kg4 Ke4 41.h5 f5+ 42.Kh3+-) 37.h4 Kd5 38.h5 Kxc5 39.f5 Kd5 40.f6+- **33.Kf3 Ra6!** 33...Rxa5? is wrong again: 34.Rxa5 bxa5 35.c5 a4 (35...g5 36.fxg5 Kxg5 37.Ke4+-) 36.a3 g6 37.g4+ hxg3 38.Kxg3 g5 39.fxg5 Kxg5 40.h4+ Kf5 41.Kf3 Kxe5 42.Kg4+- **34.c5 f6?** Kramnik underestimates the dangerous e-pawn. 34...bxc5 was called for, when Black should be able to hold the draw e.g. 35.Ra4 c4 36.Rxc4 Rxa5 37.a4 Ra6 **35.Re3! Rxa5 36.e6 Ra8 37.e7 Re8 38.a4! Kg6 39.Re6 Kf7**



until this moment Kasparov had played very strong. But in the 40th move he spoiled it as he pointed out on www.kasparovchess.com:

40.Rxc6? 40.f5! was much more precise:

A) 40...bxc5? 41.a5 g6 (41...Ra8 42.e8Q+ Rxe8 43.Rxe8 Kxe8 44.a6+-; 41...c4 42.a6 c3 43.Ke2 g6 44.Kd3 gxf5 45.Re1+-) 42.a6 gxf5 43.Re3 c4 44.a7 c3 45.Ke2 f4 46.Re4 f5 47.Re5 Kf6 48.a8Q+-

B) 40...Rxe7 41.Rxc6 bxc5 42.a5 and Black's forces are very bad coordinated to fight against the passed a-pawn, but it is not so easy to prove the win for White. **40...Ra8! 41.cxb6 cxb6 42.Rxb6 Rxa4 43.Re6 Ke8!** (43...Ra8? 44.e8Q+ Rxe8 45.Rxe8 Kxe8 46.Kg4+-) **44.Re4 Ra3+** Of course not 44...Rxe4?? 45.Kxe4 g6 (45...Kxe7 46.Kf5 Kf7 47.Kg4+-) 46.f5 g5 47.Kd5 Kxe7 48.Kc6+- **45.Re3 Rxe3+ 46.Kxe3 f5 ½–½**

Double-rook endings are a bit different from single rook endings. **King safety** is more important as more firepower is on the board, two doubled rooks on the seventh rank are very strong (sometimes called "**Seventh Heaven**"), an **extra pawn is easier to convert** and **activity and coordination of the rooks** play a crucial role, to name just a few major differences. Alexander Grischuk won two very interesting double-rook endings in his first appearance at Linares this year:

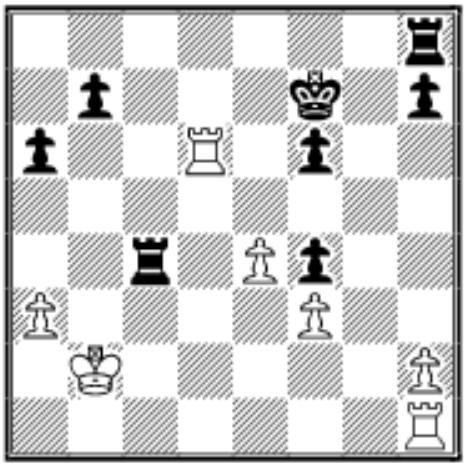


8.04 *A.Grischuk* (2663) - *A.Karpov* (2679), Linares 2001

35.Bxg5+!? Bxg5 36.Rdf7+ Ke5 37.Rxg5+ Kd4 38.Ra7 38.Rxa5?! allows 38...Rb1+ 39.Kg2 Rg8+ 40.Kh3 Rh8+= **38...Rb1+?!** Karpov is in time trouble and makes it more difficult for himself. Both 38...e3! 39.Rg4+ Kd3 40.Rg3 Rg8 41.fxe3 Rb1+= (Lukacs in CBM 82) and 38...Rd5! 39.Rxa5 Rxg5+ 40.Rxg5 Ra8 41.h4 Rxa2 42.h5 e3 43.fxe3+ Kxe3 44.h6 Ra8 45.h7 Rh8= (Hecht) lead to a draw. Note that in both variations Black exchanges one pair of rooks to reduce the danger to his exposed king. **39.Kg2 Rb2?!** 39...Rd5!= should still save the draw. **40.Raxa5**

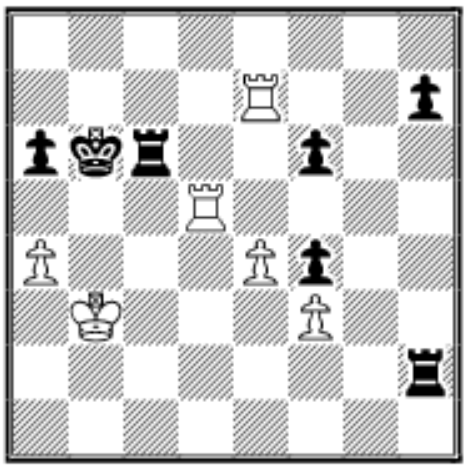


40...Rf8? as it happens so often in practical play: Karpov spoils it with his unfortunate 40th move. Again 40...Rd5! was the right way to defend e.g. 41.Ra4+ Kc5 42.h4 e3= (Lukacs) **41.Ra4+** and White wins easily due to the bad position of Black's king: **41...Kd3 42.Rg3+ Kd2 43.Rxe4 Rxa2 44.Rxe6 Ra4 45.Rd6+ Kc2 46.Rdd3 Raf4 47.Rdf3 Rxf3 48.Rxf3 Rh8 49.Rf4 Kd3 50.h4 1–0**



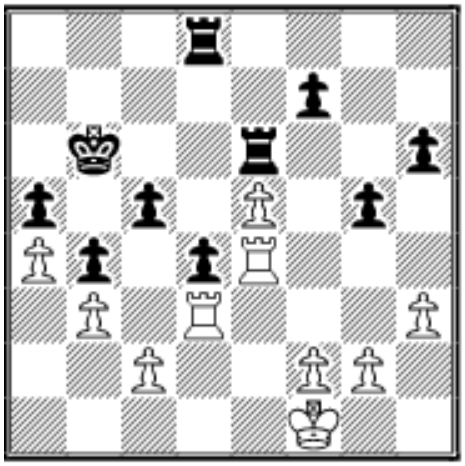
8.05 *A.Grischuk* (2663) - *A.Shirov* (2718), Linares 2001

The position is equal, but Shirov does not defend very accurately, allowing Grischuk to demonstrate the power of two well coordinated rooks in the attack: **29.Rd7+ Ke6 30.Rhd1 Rc6 31.Rxb7 Rg8?** The wrong way to activate the second rook as Black's rooks are now badly coordinated. 31...Rhc8!= was called for. **32.Rdd7 Rg2+ 33.Kb3 Rxh2** 33...Rf2 34.Re7+ Kd6 35.Rbd7+ Kc5 36.Rd3 Rxh2 37.Rd5+ Kb6 38.a4 leads to the game. **34.Re7+ Kd6 35.Rbd7+ Kc5 36.Rd5+ Kb6 37.a4**



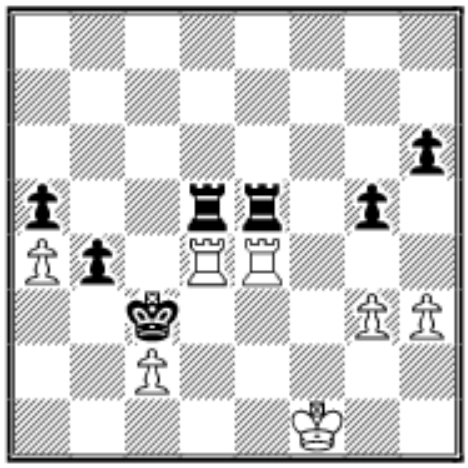
Grischuk has created a massive attack out of a seemingly quiet position. **37...a5!** (37...Rc7? 38.Rd6+ Kb7 [38...Kc5? 39.Ree6 Rh5 40.Rxf6 a5 41.Kc3+-] 39.Rxc7+ Kxc7 40.Rxf6+-; 37...Rc5? 38.Rd6+ Ka5 [38...Rc6 39.a5++-] 39.Ree6+-; 37...Rc1? 38.a5+ Kc6 39.Re6+ Kb7 40.Rxf6+-) **38.Rb5+ Ka6 39.Re8! Rb6?** 39...Ka7! was much more tenacious. Hecht gives in *ChessBase Magazine* 82 the following line: 40.Rxa5+ Kb6 41.Rb5+ Kc7 42.Re7+ Kd6 43.Rbb7 Rf2 44.Rbd7+ Kc5 45.Rd3 Rd6 46.Rc3+ Kd4 47.a5 h5 48.Rh7 Rh2 and Black is still fighting. **40.Ra8+ Kb7 41.Rb8+ Kxb8 42.Rxb6+ Kc7 43.Rxf6 h5** 43...Rh4 44.Kc4 Kd7 45.Kd5 Ke7 46.Ke5+- (Ftacnik) **44.Rxf4 h4 45.Kc4 h3 46.Rh4 Rh1 47.Kd5** Of course not 47.e5?? h2–+ **47...h2 48.Ke5 Rf1 49.Rxh2 Rxf3 50.Rc2+ Kb6 51.Rc4 1–0**

The next example shows a nice breakthrough:



8.06 *J.van der Wiel* (2493) - *E.van den Doel* (2574), NED-ch Leeuwarden 2001

Black's king has to be activated: **29...f5!** Both 29...Kc6 30.Rf3 Kd5 31.Re1 and 29...f6 30.Rf3 fxe5 31.Ke2 are not so clear. **30.Re2 c4! 31.bxc4** (31.Rf3 d3 32.cxd3 cxb3 33.Rb2 [33.Rxf5 Rc8 34.Rb2 Rc1+ 35.Ke2 Rc2+ 36.Rxc2 bxc2 37.Kd2 Rc6 38.Kc1 b3–+] 33...Rxe5 34.Rxb3 Rde8 35.Rb1 Kc5 36.Rc1+ Kd4 37.Rc4+ Kd5 38.Rc1 f4! with the idea to answer 39.g3 with 39...b3 40.gxf4 b2 41.Rb1 Re1+–+) **31...Kc5 32.Rf3 f4 33.g3 fxg3 34.fxg3 Kxc4 35.Re4 Rd5 36.Rd3 Rexe5 37.Rdxd4+ Kc3**

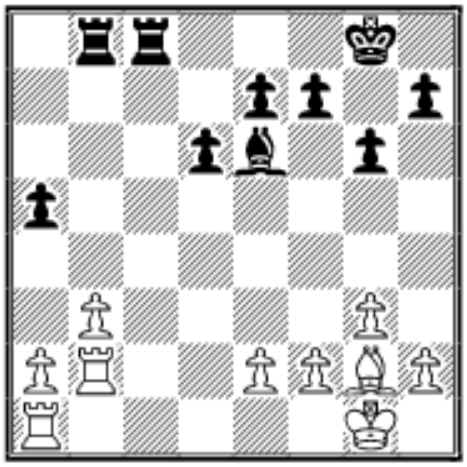


"A very picturesque position - all four Rooks are in the centre!" (Barsky in *Chess Today* 228) **38.Rc4+ Kb2 39.Rxe5 Rxe5 40.Kf2 Ka3 41.Rc6 Kxa4 42.g4 Ka3 43.Rxh6 Rc5 0–1**

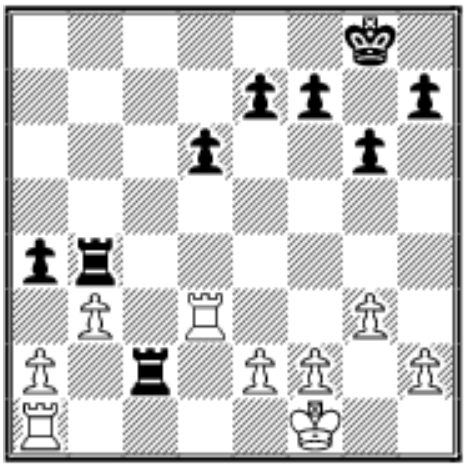
I want to end this article with a complete game by the Swedish grandmaster Ulf Andersson. His technique is really superb.

8.07 *S.Giardelli* (2438) - *U.Andersson* (2640) [A39], Pinamar 2001

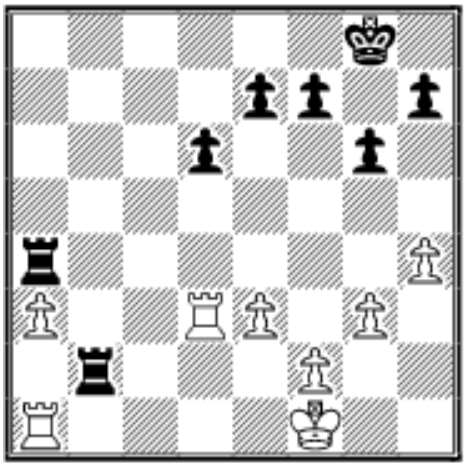
1.c4 c5 2.g3 g6 3.Bg2 Bg7 4.Nc3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Nf6 6.d4 cxd4 7.Nxd4 0–0 8.0–0 Nxd4 9.Qxd4 d6 10.Qd2?! this move is rarely played and allows Black to equalize easily. **10...Be6 11.Bxb7 Rb8 12.Bg2?!** now Black even seizes the initiative. 12.Bd5 was better e.g. 12...Nxd5 13.Nxd5 Qd7 14.e4 Rfc8 15.Qe2 Bxd5 16.cxd5 Qb5 17.Qxb5 Rxb5 18.Rb1 Rc2 19.Bg5 f6 20.Be3 a5 21.Bd4 f5= V.Korchnoi-E.Geller, URS-ch Leningrad 1963 **12...Bxc4 13.b3 Be6 14.Bb2 Qa5 15.Rfd1 Rfc8 16.Nd5 Qxd2 17.Nxf6+ Bxf6 18.Rxd2 Bxb2 19.Rxb2 a5**



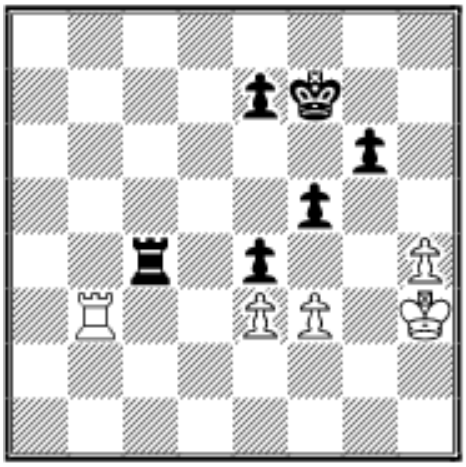
Black is better as White's pawn majority on the queenside is more a weakness than a strength due to Black's very active pieces. **20.Rd2 Rb4!** preparing a4 to expose White's a-pawn **21.Bd5 Bxd5 22.Rxd5 a4 23.Rd3?!** This allows Black to penetrate to the second rank. 23.bxa4 Rxa4 24.Rd2 and Black is slightly better (Ribli in CBM 82) **23...Rc2 24.Kf1**



24...Re4! forces White to weaken his second rank further. **25.e3 Rb4 26.h4 Rb2 27.bxa4 Rxa4 28.a3**

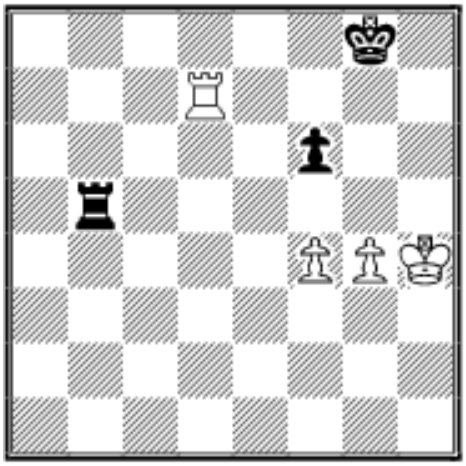


Now the point of 24...Re4 is revealed: **28...Rc4! 29.Kg2** After 29.a4?! one sample line runs 29...Rcc2 30.f4 Rh2 31.Kg1 Rbg2+ 32.Kf1 Rxg3 33.Raa3 Rgg2 34.a5 Rb2 35.Kg1 Rhc2 36.Rd1 Rg2+ 37.Kh1 Rh2+ 38.Kg1 Rbg2+ 39.Kf1 Ra2 40.Rxa2 Rxa2 41.Rd5 Kg7 and Black is clearly better. **29...Rcc2 30.Rf1 Ra2 31.Kf3 Rc5 32.g4?! h5!** Before taking the a3-pawn, Andersson fixes a second weakness - the h4-pawn. **33.Rg1** 33.g5 is answered by 33...Rc4 34.Kg3 Rg4+ 35.Kh3 Ra4 **33...Kg7 34.gxh5 Rxh5 35.Rg4 Rf5+ 36.Rf4 Ra5 37.Re4 Kf6 38.Rf4+ Ke6 39.Rdd4** 39.Re4+ came into consideration as well: 39...Kd7 (39...Kf6 40.Rf4+ Kg7 41.Re4 Kf8 42.Rb3) 40.Rf4 f5 41.Rb4 R5xa3 42.Rxa3 Rxa3 43.Kf4 and in both cases it is not clear if Black can convert his advantage. **39...R2xa3 40.Rde4+ Re5 41.Rxe5+ dxe5 42.Rb4 f6 43.Rb7?!** (43.h5!?) **43...Ra4 44.Kg3?! f5 45.Rb6+ Kf7 46.Kh3 Rg4 47.f3 Rc4 48.Rb3 e4**



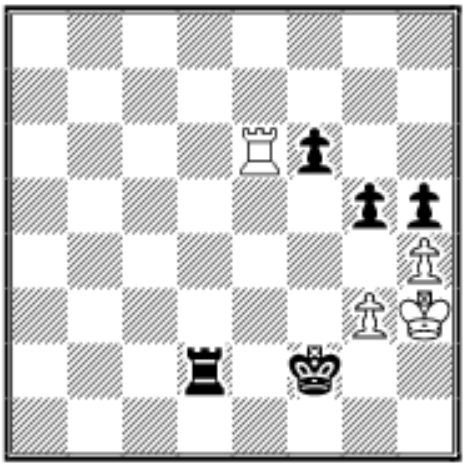
49.fxe4? a last mistake. After 49.f4 White's task is much more difficult e.g., 49...Rc2 50.Kg3 Rd2 51.Rb6 Re2 52.Rb3 Ke6 53.Rb6+ (53.Ra3 Kd5 54.Rc3 e6 55.Kh3 Rf2 56.Kg3 Rf3+ 57.Kg2 Kd6 58.Ra3 Ke7 59.Rb3 Kf7 60.Ra3 Kg7 61.Rb3 Kh6–+) 53...Kd5 54.Rxg6 Rxe3+ 55.Kg2 Rf3 56.h5 Rxf4 57.h6 Rh4 58.Kg3 Rh5–+ **49...Rxe4 50.Ra3 Kg7 0-1** and White resigned as he can't prevent Black's king marching to h5 with devastating effect.

Exercises (Solutions next month)



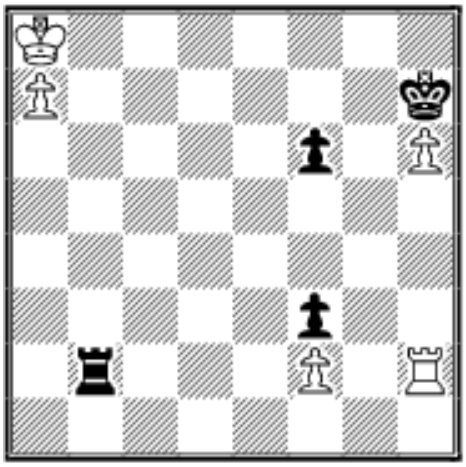
E8.01 ***A.N.Zaitsev*** **-** ***R.Hübner*****, Büsum 1969**

Black has to be very careful to save the draw. What shall he do?



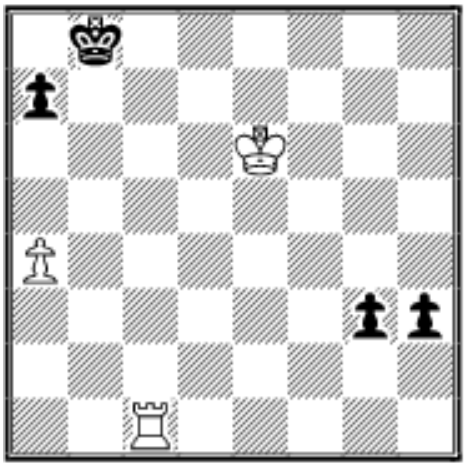
E8.02 ***F.de Gleria*** **(2432) -** ***A.Kveinys*** **(2533)** Julian Borowski-B Essen 2001

White to move and draw.



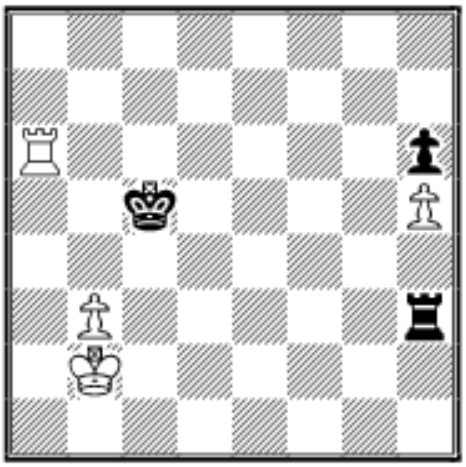
E8.03 *A.Ehrke* - *K.Müller*, Hamburg 1994

How to asses the position with Black to move?



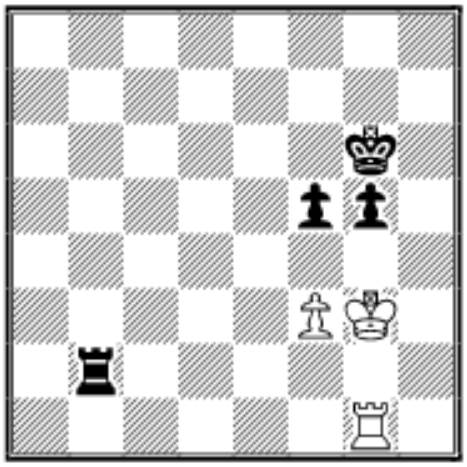
E8.04

While preparing this column, one line of my analysis reached this position. It is White to move and draw.



E8.05 *A.Shirov* (2722) - *A.Morozevich* (2749), Astana 2001

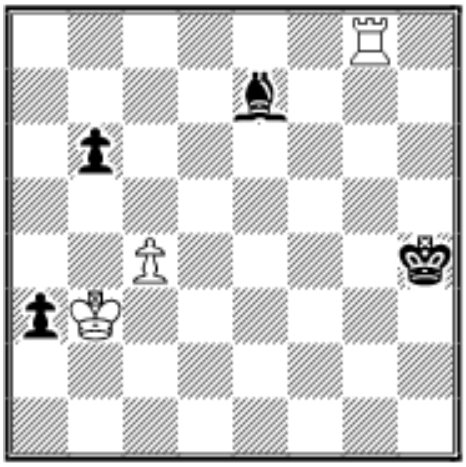
Black to move and draw.



E8.06 *R.Mamedov* (2306) - *Z.Izoria* (2489), Batumi Open 2001

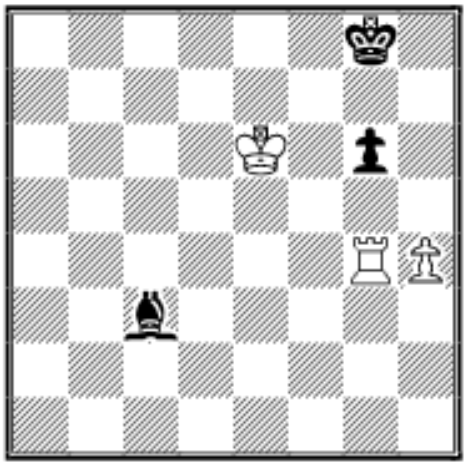
Rook endings with f- and g- vs f-pawn are usually drawn. Is this position an exception or not? Black is to move.

Solutions to last month's exercises



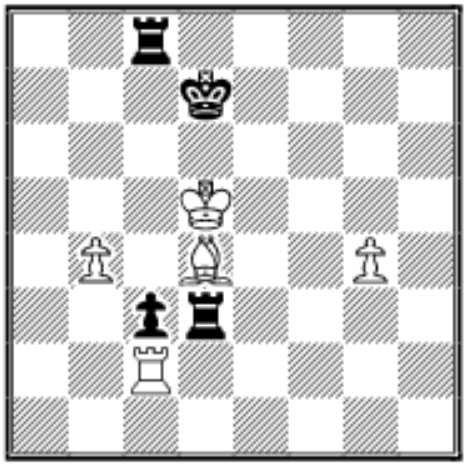
E7.1 Claus Dieter Meyer

White puts Black in zugzwang as follows: **1.Rg6!** (1.Rg7? Bc5 2.Rg2 Kh5 3.Ka2 Bd6=) **1...Bc5 2.Ka2!! Kh3** (2...Kh5 3.Rg3 Kh4 4.Rxa3+-) **3.Rg5 Bd6** (3...Kh4 4.Rxc5 bxc5 5.Kxa3 Kg4 6.Ka4+-) **4.Rb5 Bc5 5.Rxc5+-**



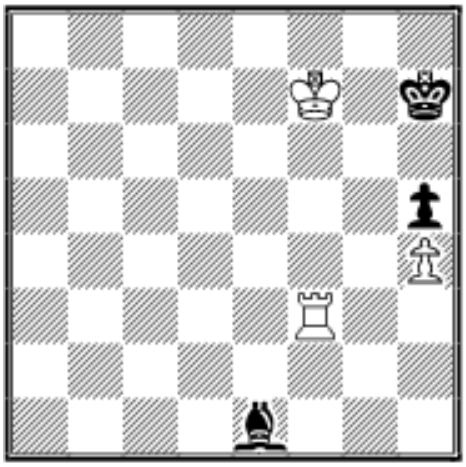
E7.2 *R.Vera* (2584) - *A.Baburin* (2590), Istanbul ol (Men) 2000

You should know, that this position is drawn: **83...Kh7!** (83...Kg7? 84.h5 g5 85.Rxg5+ Kh6 86.Kf5 Bd2 87.Rg6+ Kxh5 88.Rg2+-) **84.Kf7 Kh6 85.Rg5** (85.Rxg6+ Kh5 86.Rg3 Be1 87.Rh3 Bxh4=) **85...Be1 86.Rxg6+ Kh5 87.Kf6 Kxh4** Not 87...Bxh4+? 88.Kf5 Be7 89.Rg7+-) **88.Kf5 Bd2 89.Rg2 Be3 90.Rb2 Kg3** ½–½



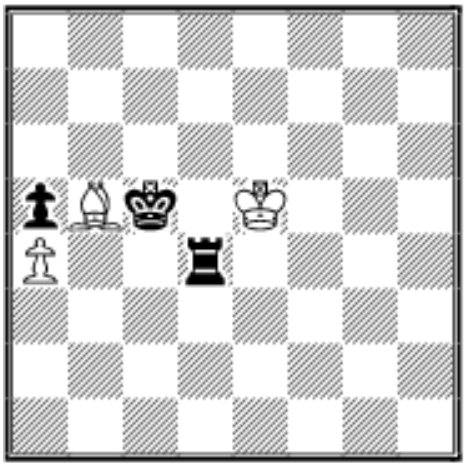
E7.3 *R.Knaak* - *K.Müller*, German Bundesliga 2001, HSK-Werder Bremen, 5th board

Knaak drew easily: **45.Ke4!** (45.b5? Rd2 46.Rc1 c2 47.b6 Rd1 48.b7 Rxc1 49.bxc8Q+ Kxc8–+; 45.Rc1? c2 46.Ke4 Rd1 47.Bb2 Re8+ 48.Kf5 Rxc1 49.Bxc1 Re1–+) **45...Rd2** (45...Rg3 46.Kd5=) **46.Rxc3 Re8+ 47.Kd5 Re6 48.Kc4 Re4 49.Rd3 Rg2 50.Kb5 Rgxg4 51.Bc5+ ½–½**



E7.4 *W.Pajeken* (2337) - *M.Kopylov* (2444), International Hamburg City Championship 2001

Black to move draws with Bxh4! (see the game). White missed the narrow path to victory at this moment, but Black returned the favour later. White should have played 76.Rf4 Kh6 (76...Bc3 77.Rc4 Bb2 78.Rc5 Kh6 79.Ke6 Kg6 80.Rg5+ Kh6 81.Kf5 Ba3 82.Rg6+ Kh7 83.Re6 Bc1 84.Re7+ Kh6 85.Rc7 Bd2 86.Rc2 Be3 87.Ke4+-) 77.Kf6 Ba5 78.Kf5 Bd8 79.Rd4 Be7 80.Ke6 Bc5 81.Rc4 Be3 82.Kf5 Bd2 83.Rc2 Be3 84.Ke4 Bg1 85.Rc6+ Kg7 86.Kf4+-. The game went **76.Re3?** 76.Rh3? is wrong as well: 76...Kh6 77.Kf6 Ba5 78.Kf5 Bd8= **76...Bd2?** (76...Bxh4! was called for: 77.Rh3 Kh6! 78.Rxh4 Kg5 79.Rh1 h4 80.Ke6 Kg4 81.Ke5 h3 82.Ke4 Kg3 83.Rg1+ Kf2=) **77.Re4 Bc1 78.Kf6 Bd2 79.Re2 Bc1 80.Kf5 Kg7 81.Re7+ Kh6 82.Re6+ Kh7 83.Rg6 Bd2 84.Rg2 Bc1 85.Kf6 Be3 86.Kf7 Bc1 87.Kf6 Be3 88.Rg7+ Kh6 89.Re7 Bd2 90.Kf5 Bc1 91.Rc7 Be3 92.Rc3 Bd2 93.Rd3 Bc1 94.Rd1 Be3 95.Rd3 Bc1 96.Rc3 Bd2 97.Rc2 Be3 98.Ke4 Bg1 99.Rc6+ Kh7 100.Kf4! Bh2+ 101.Kg5 Kg7 102.Rb6 Bg3 103.Rb7+ Kf8 104.Kxh5 Bf2 105.Kg5 1–0**



E7.5 *A.Greenfeld* (2570) - *A.Graf* (2649), European Championship Ohrid 2001

It was not easy at all, was it? **64...Rb4! 65.Bd7** (65.Be8 Rb8 66.Bb5 Rxb5 67.axb5 Kxb5 68.Kd4 Kb4!–+; 65.Kf5 Rxb5 66.axb5 a4–+) **65...Rb1?** (65...Rb7! 66.Bg4 Kb4 67.Bd1 Re7+ 68.Kf4 Re1 69.Bc2 Rc1–+) **66.Ke4 Re1+ 67.Kf3 Kb4 68.Kf2 Re7 69.Bb5 Kb3 70.Kf3 Re1 71.Kf4 Kc3 72.Kf3 Kd4 73.Kf2 Re3 74.Ba6 Ke4 75.Bc4 Kf4 76.Bb5 Re4 77.Bc6 Re7** (77...Rc4 78.Bb5 Rc2+ 79.Ke1 Ke3 80.Kd1=) **78.Bb5 Re6 79.Bc4 Re3 80.Bb5 Ke4 81.Ba6 Kd4 82.Bb5 Re7 83.Kf3 Re4 84.Kf2 Re5 85.Kf3 Re6** (85...Rxb5 86.axb5 Kc5 87.Ke2 Kxb5 88.Kd2=) **86.Kf2 Kc5 87.Kf3 Kb4 88.Kf2 Re7 89.Kf3 Kb3 90.Kf4 Kc3 91.Kf3 Kd2 92.Kf4 Re3 93.Ba6 Rb3 94.Bb5 Rb4+ 95.Kf3 Rh4 96.Bc6 Kd3 97.Bb5+ Kd4 98.Ke2 Rh2+ 99.Kd1 Kc3 100.Ke1 Rd2 101.Bc6 Kd3 102.Bb5+ Ke3 103.Be8 Rd4 ½–½**

Sources:
Chess Today 228
ChessBase Magazine 82
The Week in Chess
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



Rook + Knight vs Rook + Bishop

Following the underlying concept of this column it is now time to deal with Rook+Knight vs Rook+Bishop. Although the ending rook and minor piece vs rook and minor piece occurs very often in practical play, there is much less literature about it than about pure rook endings. This is probably due to the great complexity inherent in these endings. So I can only scratch the surface of the ending rook+knight vs rook+bishop in this column, but I will try to stress some very important points:

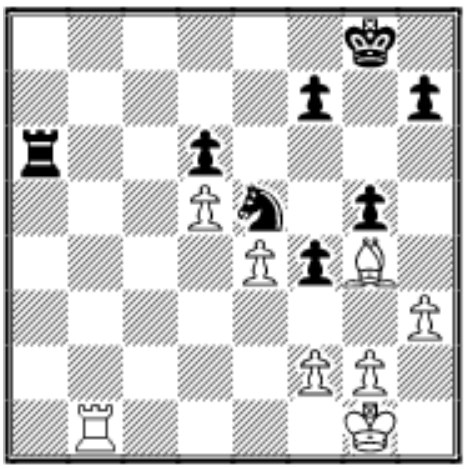
(1) The **pawn structure** is very important. If the knight occupies a strong, secure outpost it can dominate the board.

(2) Is there a **weak colour complex** (or weak pawns) on squares opposite to the bishop's colour? This is a good sign for the knight.

(3) The **bishop likes to play on both wings**. In open positions it can form a very powerful duo of long range pieces. Robert James Fischer was especially strong playing with rook and bishop. (for Fischer's endings with Bishop vs Knight see an article by Hanon W. Russell in the **ChessCafe.com Archives**)

(4) Is the knight on a **bad circuit or has limited scope**? This is usually a very good sign for the bishop.

Of course **activity** is almost as important as in pure rook endings and several of the themes and motifs of the ending knight vs bishop are valid here as well. I want to start with positions favorable for rook and knight:



9.01 *H.Herndl* (2365) - *S.Kindermann* (2530) AUT-chT9697

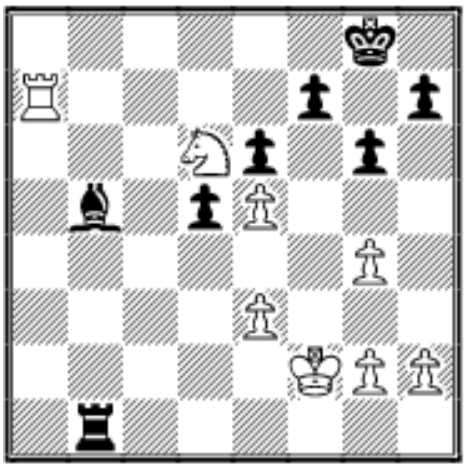
Black's knight has a dominating position and Kindermann managed to convert his advantage: **28...Ra4 29.Bf5** 29.Rb6 Nc4 30.Rc6? doesn't work: 30...Ra1+ 31.Kh2 Nd2 32.g3 *(32.Rxd6?? Nf1+ 33.Kg1 Ng3+ 34.Kh2 Rh1#)* 32...f3 33.Rxd6 h5 34.Bxh5 Nf1+ 35.Kg1 Nxg3+ 36.Kh2 Nxh5–+ **29...h5 30.f3?!** This weakens the dark squares further and gives Black's knight another strong outpost on

e3. But it is very difficult to give a better defence for White, e.g., 30.Rb6 Ra1+ 31.Kh2 Kg7 32.Rxd6?! Nd3 33.g4 hxg4 34.hxg4 Nxf2 35.Rc6 Ra2 36.Kg1 Nd1 37.Rc1 *(37.e5? f3–+)* 37...Ne3 38.Re1 Kf6 and Black is clearly on top. **30...Kg7!** Kindermann brings his last unit into play, threatening to penetrate White's position via f6-e5-d4. **31.Rc1 Kf6 32.Rc3 Nc4!** Opening the king's path and heading for e3 **33.Bd7 Ra1+ 34.Kf2 Ra2+ 35.Kg1 Ne3**



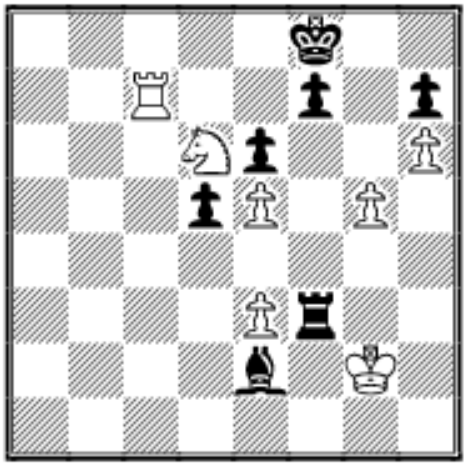
Now it is completely clear that Black is winning. **36.g4 h4** Black doesn't want to exchange pawns of course. **37.Rc7 Rg2+ 38.Kh1 Rg3 39.Be8 Rxh3+ 40.Kg1 Rxf3 41.Rxf7+ Ke5 42.Re7+ Kd4 43.e5 Rg3+ 44.Kh2?! f3** and Herndl resigned as he can't prevent mate: **45.exd6 Nxg4+ 46.Kh1 Nf2+ 47.Kh2 Rg2#**

The next example is favourable for the knight again:



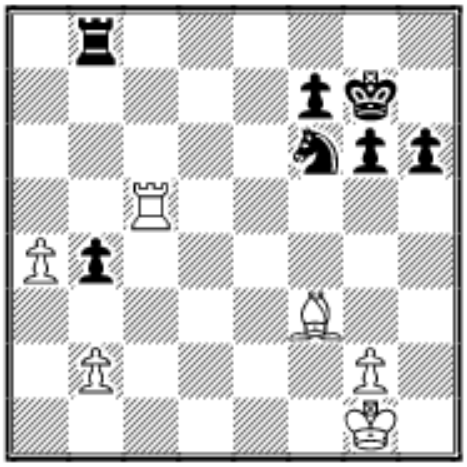
9.02 *M.Krasenkow* (2615) - *A.Miles* (2550) New York 1997

Black has to be play extremely precise in order to save the draw: **29...Rf1+?** 29...g5! to transfer the bishop to g6 was called for e.g. 30.Kg3 Rb3 31.Nxf7 Rxe3+ 32.Kf2 Re2+ 33.Kf3 Bd3 34.Nxg5 Rxe5 35.Kf4 Re2= (Krasenkow in Informator 69/344) **30.Kg3 Bc6 31.Rc7 Ba4 32.g5! F**ixing Black's pawns on light squares. The next step in Krasenkow's plan is to advance his kingside pawns. **32...Kg7 33.h4 Kf8 34.Kh2 Kg7 35.g4 Rf3 36.h5 gxh5** (36...Kf8 37.h6 Bd1 38.Rc8+ Ke7 39.Re8+ Kd7 40.Rh8+-) **37.gxh5 Kf8** After 37...Rxe3 Krasenkow gives 38.Nxf7! Kf8 39.g6! hxg6 40.h6 Re4 41.Kg3 Re3+ 42.Kg4 Bd1+ 43.Kg5+- **38.h6! Bd1 39.Kg2 Be2 40.Rc8+ Ke7 41.Rc7+ Kf8**



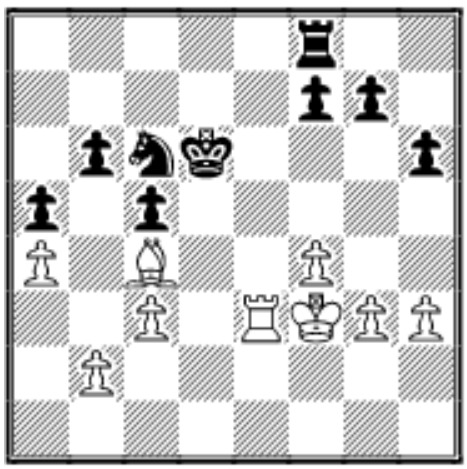
After the repetition of moves Krasenkow now deals the final blow: **42.g6! fxg6** (42...hxg6 43.Rc8+ Ke7 44.h7+-) **43.Rxh7 Rxe3** (43...Kg8 44.Rg7+ Kh8 45.Ne8+-) **44.Rh8+ Ke7 45.Re8+ Kd7 46.h7 1–0**

Now I want to show positions favouring the bishop:



9.03 *R.J.Fischer* - *M.Taimanov* Palma de Mallorca izt 1970

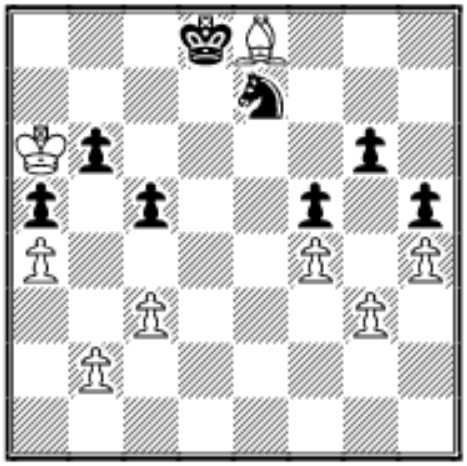
Black is a pawn up, but Fischer's bishop is too strong as it supports the advance of the passed a-pawn: **47.a5** 47.Rb5? spoils it of course: 47...Rxb5 48.axb5 Nd7 **47...Re8** (47...Nd7 48.Rc7 Ne5 49.Bb7 Rd8 50.Rc1+-) **48.Rc1** After 48.a6 Black's rook manages to get behind the a-pawn: 48...Re1+ 49.Kf2 Ra1 50.Rc6 but White has nevertheless good chances to win. **48...Re5 49.Ra1 Re7 50.Kf2** White's king heads to the queenside to support the a-pawn or to win Black's weak b-pawn **50...Ne8** After 50...Kf8, one sample line runs 51.a6 Ra7 52.Ke3 Ke7 53.Kd4 Kd6 54.Kc4 Kc7 55.Kxb4 Kb6 56.Bb7 Nd7 57.Rf1 f6 58.Rd1 Kc7 59.Ka5+- **51.a6 Ra7 52.Ke3 Nc7 53.Bb7 Ne6 54.Ra5 Kf6** (54...Nd8 55.Rb5+-) **55.Kd3 Ke7 56.Kc4 Kd6 57.Rd5+ Kc7 58.Kb5!** and Taimanov resigned due to **58...Nd8 59.Rc5+ Kd6 60.Kb6 Nxb7 61.Rc6++-**. It wasn't too late to blunder with 58.Kxb4? Nd8=.



9.04 *R.J.Fischer* (2740) - *M.Taimanov* (2620) Vancouver cqf 1971

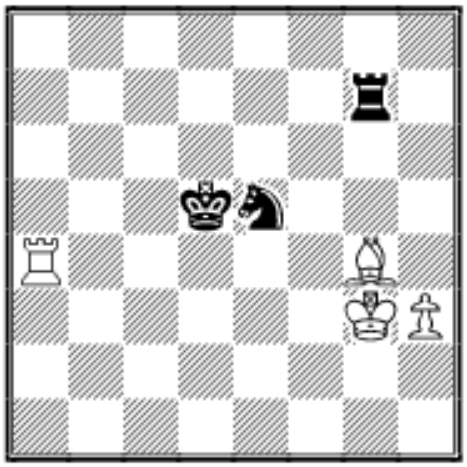
Black's knight has very limited scope and White's rook is more active than its counterpart, so Taimanov again faced a very tough job: **35.h4 h5?!** I don't like this move as it fixes the h-pawn on a light square. 35...Ne7 was probably preferable although Black's task is still very difficult. Putting all pawns on dark squares with 35...f6? loses unfortunately: 36.Re6+ Kd7 37.Ke4 f5+ *(37...Re8? 38.Rxe8 Kxe8 39.Bb5 Kd7 40.Kd5+-)* 38.Kf3 Rf6 39.Rxf6 gxf6 40.Bb5+- **36.Rd3+ Kc7 37.Rd5!?** Fischer forces more Black pawns onto light squares

- a good strategy in this type of ending. In the following lines, it is difficult to say, when exactly Taimanov's position was lost. **37...f5 38.Rd2 Rf6 39.Re2 Kd7 40.Re3 g6 41.Bb5 Rd6 42.Ke2 Kd8?!** This allows Fischer to simplify into a winning bishop vs knight ending. 42...Rd5 seems to be tougher. **43.Rd3! Kc7 44.Rxd6 Kxd6 45.Kd3** Of course not 45.Bxc6?? Kxc6 46.Kd3 Kd5 47.c4+= **45...Ne7** After 45...Kc7 simplifying into the pawn ending wins: 46.Bxc6 Kxc6 47.Kc4 Kd6 48.Kb5 Kc7 49.Ka6 Kc6 50.c4 Kc7 51.Ka7 Kc6 52.Kb8+- **46.Be8 Kd5 47.Bf7+ Kd6 48.Kc4 Kc6 49.Be8+ Kb7 50.Kb5 Nc8 51.Bc6+** (51.Bxg6?? Nd6#) **51...Kc7 52.Bd5 Ne7** (52...Nd6+ 53.Ka6 c4 54.Bg8 Kc6 55.Bh7 Ne4 56.Bxg6 Nxg3 57.Be8+ Kc5 58.Ka7 Ne2 59.Bxh5 Nxf4 60.Bf3+-) **53.Bf7 Kb7 54.Bb3 Ka7 55.Bd1 Kb7 56.Bf3+ Kc7 57.Ka6 Nc8 58.Bd5 Ne7 59.Bc4 Nc6 60.Bf7 Ne7 61.Be8 Kd8**



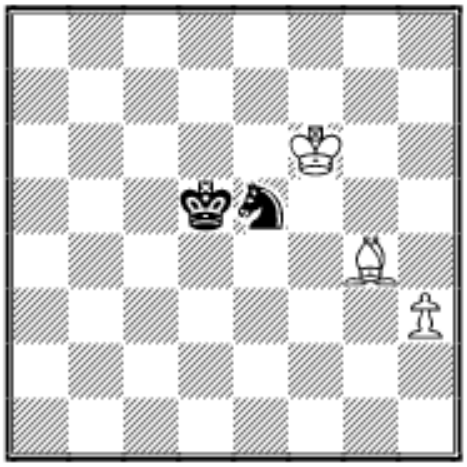
62.Bxg6! Now Black is defenceless against White's queenside pawns: **62...Nxg6 63.Kxb6 Kd7 64.Kxc5 Ne7 65.b4 axb4 66.cxb4 Nc8 67.a5 Nd6 68.b5 Ne4+ 69.Kb6 Kc8 70.Kc6 Kb8 71.b6 1–0**

The next example went no better for Taimanov:



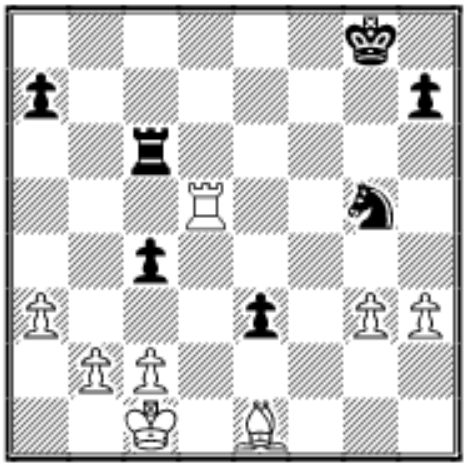
9.05 *R.J.Fischer* (2740) - *M.Taimanov* (2620) Vancouver cqf 1971

75...Ng6 75...Nxg4!? was easier: 76.Rxg4 *(76.hxg4 Ke6 77.Rf4 Rf7=)* 76...Re7 77.Rg6 Re6= **76.Ra6 Ne5 77.Kf4 Rf7+** Now 77...Nxg4? doesn't work any longer: 78.hxg4 Rg8 79.g5 Rf8+ 80.Kg4 Ke5 81.Kh5 Kf5 82.Kh6+- **78.Kg5 Rg7+ 79.Kf5 Rf7+ 80.Rf6 Rxf6+ 81.Kxf6**



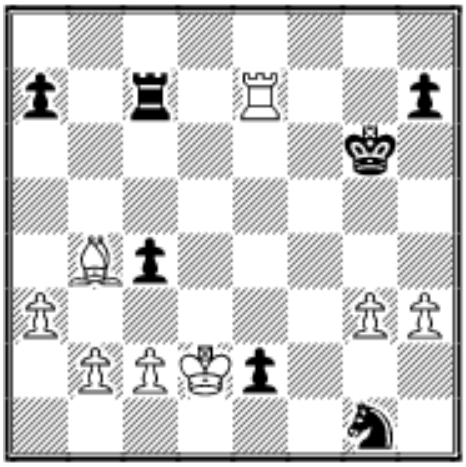
The position is still drawn, but now great care is required: **81...Ke4?** (81...Nd3 82.h4 Nf4 83.Kf5 Kd6 84.Kxf4 Ke7=; 81...Kd6 draws as well.) **82.Bc8 Kf4 83.h4 Nf3 84.h5 Ng5 85.Bf5 Nf3 86.h6 Ng5 87.Kg6** zugzwang **87...Nf3 88.h7 Nh4+ 89.Kf6 1–0**

I want to end this column with two of my own games:



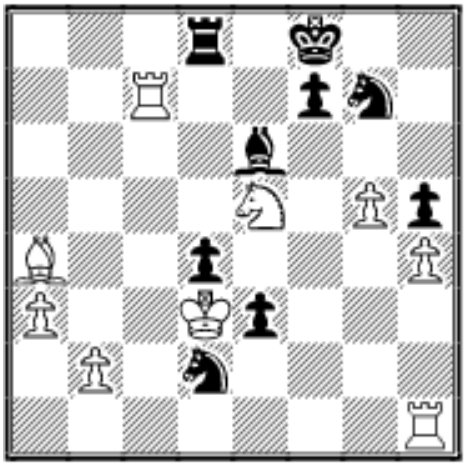
9.06 *J.Hector* (2546) - *K.Müller* (2523) International Hamburg City Championship 2001

Something had gone wrong after the opening and I had to pin all my hopes on the passed e-pawn: **29...Nf3 30.Rd8+ Kf7 31.Bb4 Ng1** I had originally planned to continue with 31...c3? until I spotted 32.Rf8+ Kg6 33.Rxf3 e2 34.Re3 Rd6 35.Bxd6+-. At first I had only seen 35.Rxe2 Rd1+ 36.Kxd1 cxb2 when I can fight on. **32.Rf8+ Kg6 33.Re8 e2 34.Kd2 Rc7 35.Re7**



35...Rc8?? a sad error in time trouble, which spoils everything as Black's rook can't move to f8 in the critical line. 35...Rc6! was called for, when it is very difficult to prove a win for White, e.g.,

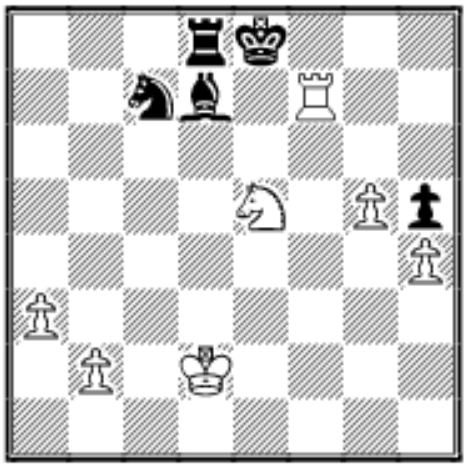
(A) 36.Bc3 Rc8 37.Re6+ *(37.g4 Rf8 38.Rg7+ Kh6 39.g5+ Kh5 40.Bf6 Re8)* 37...Kg5 38.Ke1 Rf8 39.Bd2+ Kf5 40.Re7 Kg6; or **B)** 36.g4 36...Kg5 37.Ke1 Rf6 38.Rg7+ Kh6 39.g5+ Kxg7 40.gxf6+ Kxf6 41.Bc5 Nxh3 42.Bxa7 Nf4 43.Bb8 Nd5 44.Kxe2 Ke6 and White is better, but is he winning ? **36.Ke1+- Rd8 37.Kf2 Rd1 38.Be1 Rc1 39.Kxg1 Rxe1+ 40.Kf2 Rb1 41.Kxe2 Rxb2 42.Kd2 a5 43.Re5 Rb1 44.Rxa5 Rg1 45.h4 h6 46.h5+ Kf6 47.Kc3 Rg2 48.Ra6+ Ke5 49.Rg6 Kd5 50.a4 1–0**



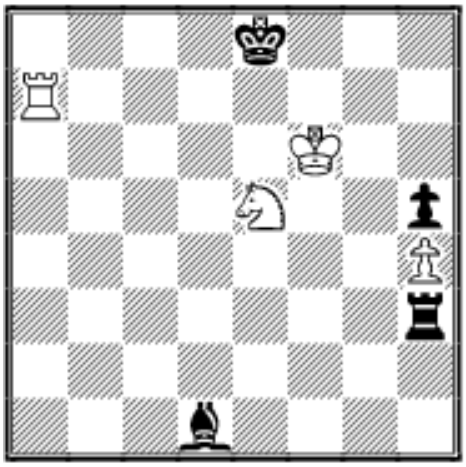
I start a bit earlier:

9.07 *K.Müller* (2523) - *C.C.Buhr* (2392)
International Hamburg City Championship

Black's passed pawns are not as dangerous as they seem to be: **34.Bd7! Bd5 35.Re1 Be4+ 36.Kxd4 Ne6+ 37.Kxe3 Nxc7 38.Kxd2** 38.Rd1! was even better: 38...Nd5+ 39.Kxd2 f6 40.gxf6 Nxf6 41.Ke3+- **38...Bf5 39.Rf1 Bxd7 40.Rxf7+ Ke8**



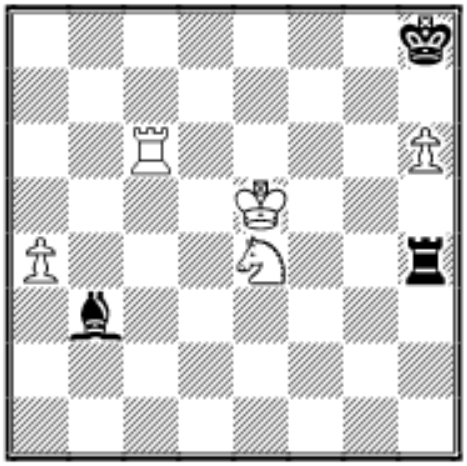
Time trouble was over and I had time to think again. Unfortunately I made the wrong decision: **41.Ke1?** 41.Rxd7! was called for, e.g., 41...Rxd7+ 42.Nxd7 Kxd7 43.a4 Nd5 44.g6! to avoid a blockade 44...Ke6 45.a5 Kf6 46.Kd3 Kxg6 47.Kd4 Ne7 48.Kc5 Kf5 49.a6 Nc8 50.b4+- **41...Ne6! 42.g6** 42.Rh7 Ba4 43.Rh8+ Ke7 44.Rxh5 Rd1+ 45.Kf2 Rd2+ 46.Ke3 Rxb2 and Black should be able to hold on. **42...Ba4 43.Rh7** After 43.g7 Rd1+ White's king lacks shelter: 44.Kf2 Rd2+ 45.Kg3 Rd3+= **43...Rd1+ 44.Kf2 Rd2+ 45.Ke3 Rxb2 46.g7 Nxg7 47.Rxg7 Rb3+ 48.Kf4 Rxa3 49.Ra7 Rh3 50.Kg5 Bd1 51.Kf6**



The position is now completely drawn of course and my opponent defended accurately: **51...Bf3!** 51...Kd8?! 52.Rd7+ Kc8 53.Rxd1 Rxh4 54.Rc1+ is unnessarily risky. **52.Ke6** 52.Rh7 Kd8 53.Nf7+ Kc8= *(53...Ke8? 54.Ng5 Rxh4 55.Ne6+-)* **52...Kd8 53.Kd6** (53.Rd7+!? Kc8 54.Nxf3 Rxf3 55.Rd5 Rf4 56.Rxh5 Re4+ 57.Kf5 Ra4=) **53...Kc8 54.Rc7+ Kb8 55.Nd7+ Ka8 56.Nb6+ Kb8 57.Nd7+ Ka8 58.Rc2 Kb7 59.Rb2+ Ka6 60.Ne5 Bh1 61.Rb4 Re3 62.Rf4 Re4 63.Rxe4 Bxe4 64.Nd7 Bf3 65.Ke5 Kb7 66.Kf4 Kc7 67.Nf6 ½–½**

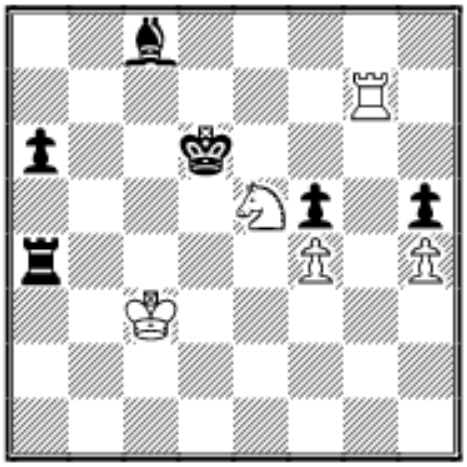
Sources:
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
Informator 69
The Week in Chess

Exercises
(Solutions next month)



E9.01 *Qin Kanying* (2501) - *A.Stefanova* (2514) FIDE World Cup-B (Women) Shenyang 2000

White to move and win

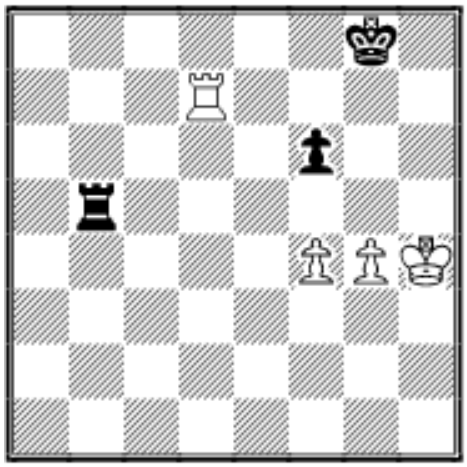


E9.02 *G.Kasparov* (2849) - *P.Svidler* (2695) World Cup of Rapid Chess-A Cannes 2001

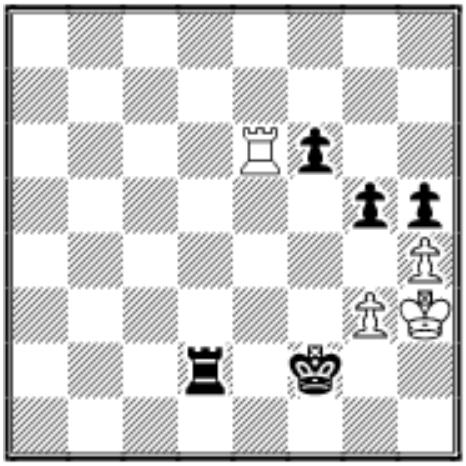
Kasparov found a convincing way to reach the draw. What did he play?

Solutions to last month's exercises

E8.01 *A.Zaitsev* - *R.Hübner* Büsum 1969

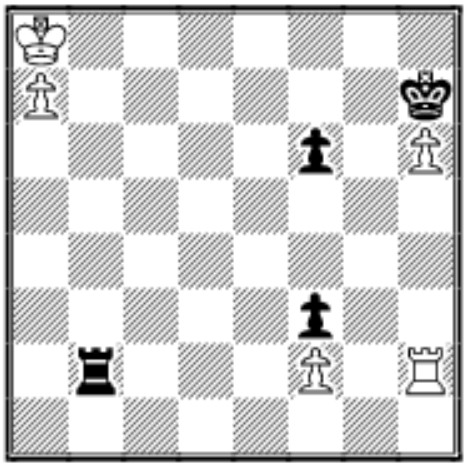


Black has to defend very carefully: **1...Rb1?** 1...Rb4 was called for e.g. 2.f5 Ra4 3.Kh5 Rf4! *(3...Kf8? 4.g5! Ke8 5.Rb7 fxg5 6.Kg6 g4 7.f6+-)* 4.Ra7 Kf8 **A)** 5.g5 Rxf5 6.Kg6 Rf1! *(6...Rxg5+?? 7.Kxf6+-)* 7.gxf6 Rg1+=; **B)** 5.Kg6 5...Rxg4+ 6.Kxf6 Kg8 7.Ra8+ Kh7 8.Kf7 Rb4= **2.Kh5 Rg1 3.g5 fxg5 4.f5! Kf8 5.f6** and Hübner resigned due to **5...Rf1 6.Kg6 Ke8 7.Ra7 g4 8.f7+ Kf8 9.Ra8+ Ke7 10.Re8+ Kd6 11.f8Q+ Rxf8 12.Rxf8 Ke5 13.Kg5 g3 14.Rf3 g2 15.Rg3+-**



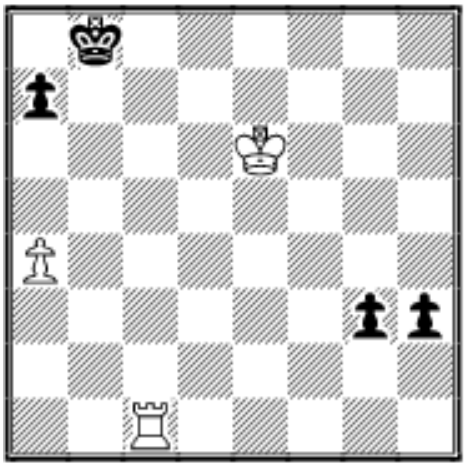
E8.02 *F. de Gleria* (2432) - *A.Kveinys* (2533) Julian Borowski-B Essen 2001

De Gleria drew as follows: **82.hxg5!** (82.g4? Rd3+ 83.Kh2 hxg4 84.Rxf6+ Rf3 85.Rxf3+ Kxf3 86.hxg5 Kf2 87.g6 g3+–+; 82.Kh2? Kf3+ 83.Kg1 Kxg3–+; 82.Rxf6+? Kg1 83.hxg5 Rh2#) **82...fxg5** (82...Kg1 83.Re1+ Kf2 84.Re6=) **83.Re5!? Kg1 84.Re1+ Kf2 85.Re5 Kg1 86.Re1+ Kf2 87.Re5 Kg1** ½–½



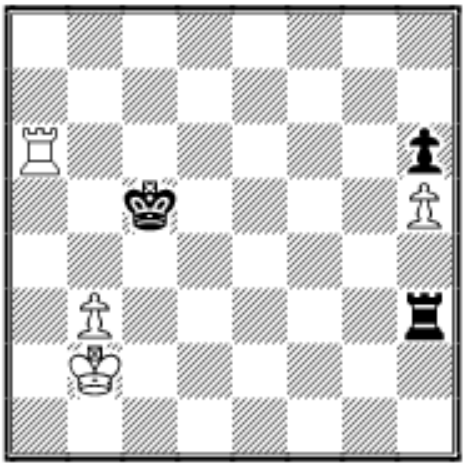
E8.03 *A.Ehrke* - *K.Müller* Hamburg 1994

After **53...Ra2** a draw was agreed as Black's counterplay is just in time, if White wins Black's rook for his a-pawn: **54.Rh5 Rxf2 55.Rb5 Ra2 56.Kb8** (56.Rf5 f2 57.Rxf6 Rb2=) **56...Kxh6 57.a8Q Rxa8+ 58.Kxa8 Kg6 59.Kb7 f2 60.Rb1 Kf5 61.Rf1 Ke4 62.Rxf2 f5 63.Kc6 f4 64.Kc5 Ke3=**



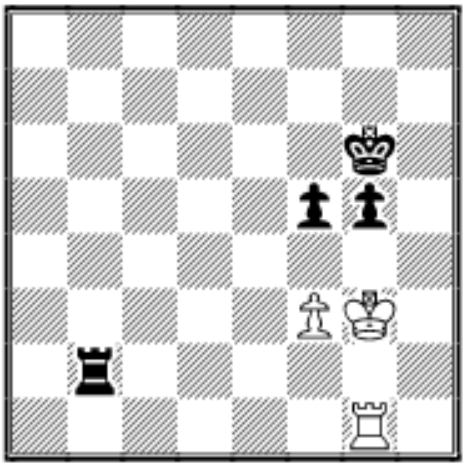
E8.04

The solution runs: **1.Kd7!** (1.a5? Kb7 2.a6+ Kxa6 3.Kd5 g2!–+) **1...Kb7 2.Rc6 h2 3.a5 a6 4.Rc7+=**



E8.05 *A.Shirov* (2722) - *A.Morozevich* (2749) Astana 2001

55...Kb4? Both players missed the surprising 55...Rxh5! 56.Ra5+ Kb4 57.Rxh5 stalemate **56.Rb6+ Kc5 57.Rxh6 Kb4 58.Kc2! Rc3+ 59.Kd2 Rh3 60.Rh8 Kc5 61.Kc2 Kb5 62.Kd2 Kc6 63.h6 Kb7 64.b4 Ka7 65.Ke2 Rh4 66.Kf3 Rxb4 67.Rg8 Rh4 68.Rg6 Kb7 69.Kg3 Rh1 70.Kf4 Kc7 71.Kf5 Kd7 72.Kf6 Ke8 73.Kg7 1–0**



E8.06 *R.Mamedov* (2306) - *Z.Izoria* (2489) Batumi open 2001

A nice stalemate trick saved the day: **81...f4+** 81...Kf6 82.Ra1 f4+ 83.Kh3 Rf2 84.Ra6+=) **82.Kh3** (82.Kg4?? Rh2 83.Rh1 Rg2+ 84.Kh3 Rg3+–+) **82...Rf2 83.Rxg5+! Kxg5** stalemate ½–½

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COLUMNISTS

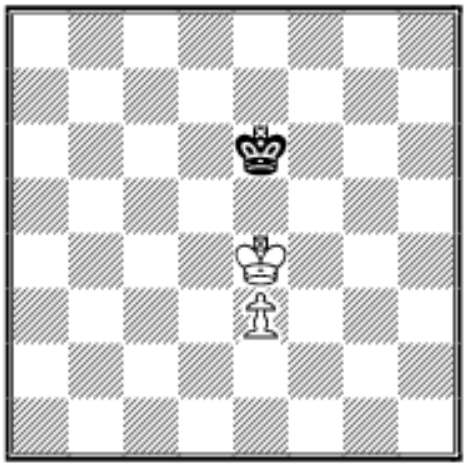
Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



Opposition, Triangulation and more

I start with a very fundamental example to illustrate the importance of opposition



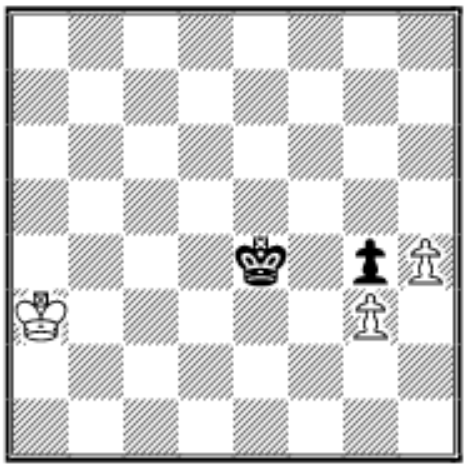
10.01 +/=

If White's king manages to advance to the key squares of the e3-pawn (d5,e5 and f5), then Black is lost. But if White is to move, he can't achieve that as Black has the opposition: **1.Kf4 Kf6! 2.Ke4 Ke6 3.Kd4 Kd6 4.e4 Ke6 5.e5 Ke7 6.Kd5 Kd7 7.e6+ Ke7 8.Ke5 Ke8! 9.Kd6 Kd8 10.e7+ Ke8** stalemate.

Black to move on the other hand is in zugzwang and loses: **1...Kd6 2.Kf5! Ke7 3.Ke5** 3.e4? Kf7!= (opposition) **3...Kf7 4.Kd6 Kf6 5.e4 Kf7 6.e5 Ke8 7.Ke6** (opposition, but in this exceptional case with the pawn on the fifth rank and his king in front White would also win, if it were his move) **7...Kd8 8.Kf7 Kd7 9.e6++-**

The opposition is the main weapon in the fight for 3 adjacent key squares.

The next example shows more forms of the opposition:



10.02 After van Nyevelt *Supériorité* 1792 +/=

I want to analyse the situation with Black to move in detail:

1) No counterattack against the g3 pawn is possible: 1...Kf3 2.h5 Kxg3 3.h6 Kf2 4.h7 g3 5.h8Q g2 6.Qh2 and White wins.

2) So Black's king has to stay inside the square of the protected passed pawn on h4.

3) Advancing the h-pawn doesn't win for White. After the black king has captured it, White manages to win the g4-pawn, but Black's king moves to g6 in the opposition and draws.

4) All key squares of the black g4-pawn are inside the square of the h4-pawn.

As d4, e4, f4, d5, d6 and d7 are key squares we can now conclude:

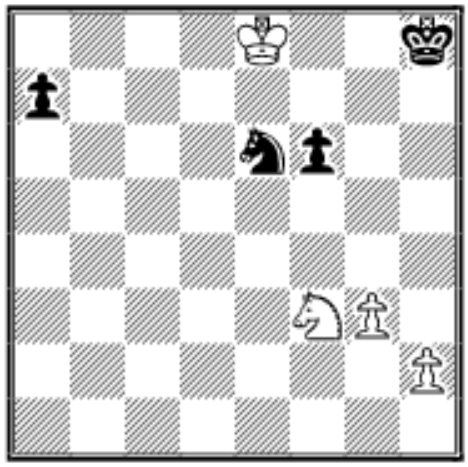
Black can defend according to the rules of opposition inside the square of the h4-pawn, but he has to choose the appropriate form carefully as he has to stay in the square of the h4-pawn and f4 is not accessible.

Definition: If all corners of the rectangle round the kings are of the same colour, the kings are in **opposition** (more precise: the player not to move has the opposition).

A sample line runs: **1...Ke5!** (virtual opposition) **2.Ka4 Ke4!** (distant opposition) Not 2...Ke6? 3.Kb4! and White's king creeps on the fourth rank to the key squares: 3...Kd6 4.Kc4! Ke6 5.Kd4! Kf6 6.Ke4! Kg6 7.Kf4 Kh5 8.Kf5+- **3.Kb3 Kd5!** (diagonal opposition) **4.Kb4 Kd4!** (opposition) **5.Ka3 Ke5! 6.Ka2 Ke4 7.Kb2 Kd4! 8.Kc2 Ke4! 9.Kd1 Kd5=**

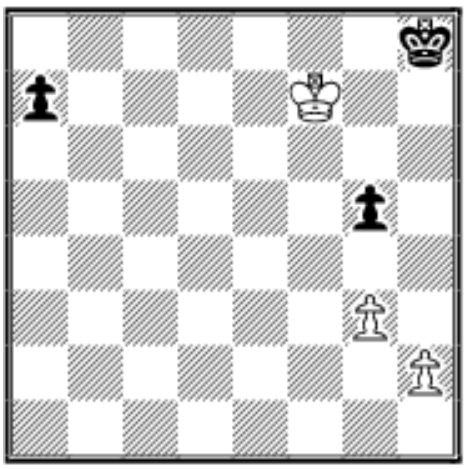
Remark: The key squares in 10.02 are f4, e4, d4, d5, d6, d7, e7, f7, g7 and h7. If you know, how to apply the theory of corresponding squares (see, e.g., Averbakh pp.369-409 or *Secrets of Pawn Endings* pp.188-203) it is an interesting exercise to number the squares of the board accordingly, but from Black's point of view this is not really necessary as it is enough to master the rules of the opposition (see the main line above).

The next example serves as an application of van Nyevelt's position (10.02):



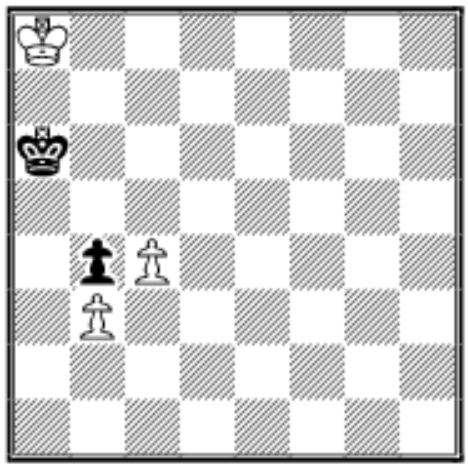
10.03 *Capablanca - Kalantarov* Simul St. Petersburg 1913

Kalantarov and his consultants - among them was the great Romanovsky - thought, that 1.Ke7 was called for as 1.Kf7 allowed Black to simplify into a seemingly favourable pawn ending. But when Capablanca came to the board he played nevertheless **1.Kf7!?** The next two moves followed immediately: **1...Ng5+?** After 1...Nc5 Black should be able to draw the knight ending. **2.Nxg5 fxg5**



3.g4!! and Capablanca left the board leaving the amazed Kalantarov behind. Black is now lost in all variations. 3.h4? is the wrong way to break through due to 3...g4! (3...gxh4? 4.g4 h3 5.g5 h2 6.g6 h1Q 7.g7+ Kh7 8.g8Q+ Kh6 9.Qg6#) 4.Ke6 a5 5.Kd5 Kg7 6.Kc4 Kf6 7.Kb5 Ke6 8.Ka4 Kd5 9.Kxa5 Ke5= (10.02) **3...Kh7** 3...a5 4.h4 gxh4 5.g5+- **4.h4 Kh6 5.Kf6 Kh7 6.h5!** 6.hxg5? Kg8= **6...a5 7.Ke5 1-0** and Kalantarov resigned as his a-pawn will fall prey to White's king. The remaining ending is won in sharp contrast to (10.02) as the key square d5 is outside the square of the protected passed pawn on h5.

If the protected passed pawn is a c-pawn it is different:

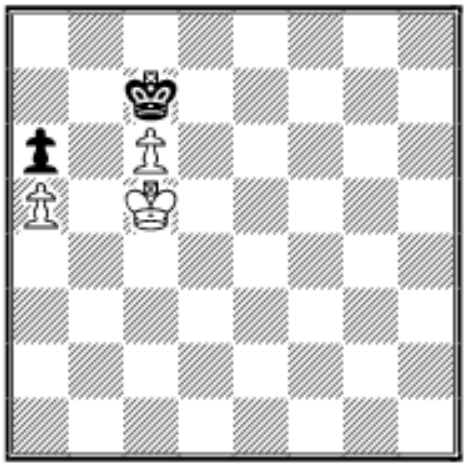


10.04 N.Grigoriev (end of a study) 64, 1930

White wins whoever moves first. When White moves first (with Black to move after 1...Ka5!? 2.Kb8 Kb6 the main line is reached) **1.Kb8! Kb6 2.Kc8! Kc6** A counterattack with 2...Kc5 is too slow: 3.Kb7 Kd4 4.Kb6 Kc3 5.c5! Kxb3 6.c6! Ka2 7.c7! b3 8.c8Q! b2 9.Qc2+- **3.Kd8! Kd6 4.Ke8! Ke6 5.Kf8! Kf6 6.Kg8! Kg6 7.Kh8! Kf6** 7...Kh6 leaves the square of the c-pawn: 8.c5!+- **8.Kh7! Kf7 9.Kh6! Kf6 10.Kh5! Kf5 11.Kh4! Kf4 12.Kh3! Kf5 13.Kg3 Kg5 14.Kf3 Kf5 15.Ke3 Ke5 16.Kd3 Ke6 17.Kd4 Kd6 18.c5+ Kc6 19.Kc4!+-**

In Grigoriev's study the pawns are on b2, c3 resp. b5 and Black's king is on b6. After 1.b3! b4 2.c4! Ka6 the position (10.04) is reached.

Now I want to deal with triangulation:

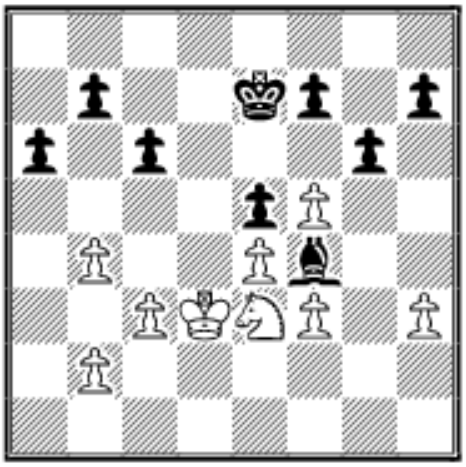


10.05 ***H.Fahrni - S.Alapin*** +/-

Black to move would be in zugzwang immediately as White's king could reach b6. White to move on the other hand seems to be in zugzwang as well as c5-c7, d6-d8 and d5-c8 are corresponding squares. But a careful observation shows of the squares on the 4th rank reveals, that he has more space to manoeuvre as c4, d4 - b8, d8 are corresponding squares as well. So Black perishes as c4 and d4 are connected while b8 and d8 are isolated: **1.Kd5! Kc8 2.Kd4 Kd8 3.Kc4 Kc8 4.Kd5! Kc7** 4...Kd8 5.Kd6! Kc8 6.c7! Kb7 7.Kd7! Ka7 8.Kc6+- Of course not 8.c8Q?? stalemate **5.Kc5!** reaching the starting position with Black to move **5...Kc8 6.Kb6!** and Alapin resigned because of **6...Kb8 7.Kxa6! Kc7 8.Kb5!+-**

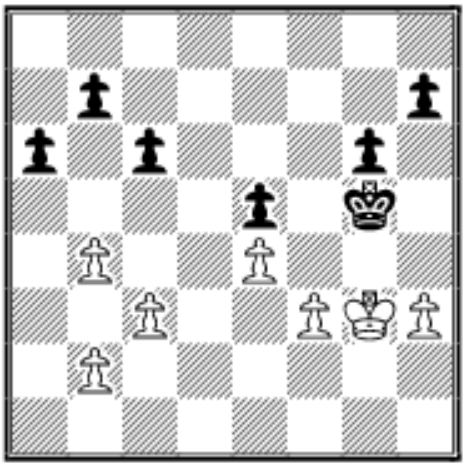
When and where was the game played ? I quote Edward Winter (Source: *Chess Notes* 2425): "The caption is usually "Fahrni-Alapin", sometimes with a date between 1909 and 1917 and occasionally with a mention of Munich. Although the exact occasion and complete game have yet to be found, we note that at a tournament in Munich in June 1909 Fahrni scored +3 –0 =1 against Alapin. When Fahrni himself gave the above position, on page 15 of his book *Das Endspiel im Schach* (Leipzig, 1917), he did so with just the vague heading "From a game Fahrni-Alapin". The position after 1 Kd5 Kc8 occurred in Fiebig-Tartakower, Barmen, 1905, but White missed the win, and the game was agreed drawn after 59 Kd6 Kd8 60 Kd5 Kc8. Source: Barmen, 1905 tournament book, page 250. A similar ending arose in W. Lange-C. Carls, Aachen, 1934. White's king was on e2 and he had a pawn at h3; Black had his king on e4 and pawns at f4 and h4. The game ended: 1 f3+ 2 Kf1 Kf5 3 Ke1 Ke5 4 Kf1 Ke4 5 Ke1 Ke3 6 Kf1 f2 and wins. Source: *Schackvärlden*, July 1934, page 254." To add to the problems, Winter found that (10.05) had already been published on page 82 of the March 1911 *La Stratégie*. I quote from *Chess Notes* 2458: "In an item which mentioned neither Fahrni nor any other player, Michel A.Tossizza gave an extract from his 1910 book *Etude explicative d'une partie d'échecs*. Le Gambit Evans."

To end this column I give several recent examples:

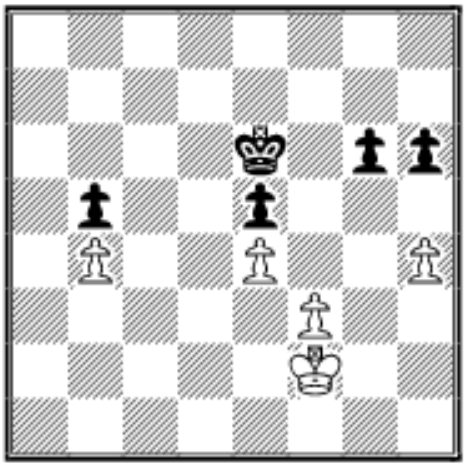


10.06 *R.Gerber* - *A.Miles* Crans Montana 2001

The first is from the excellent July 2001 "Miles Report" on the Chess Cafe website (Miles has analysed it in depth, see the Chess Cafe Archives): **1...Bxe3 2.Kxe3 Kf6 3.fxg6 fxg6 4.Kf2 Kg5 5.Kg3**



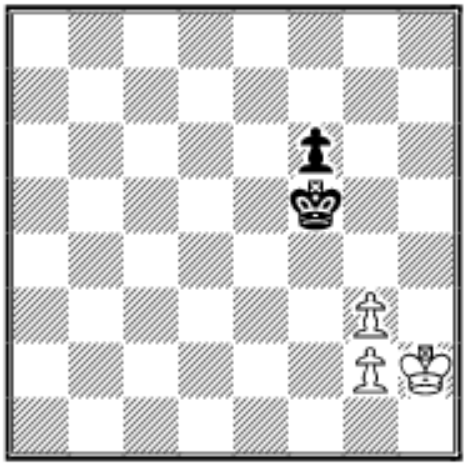
On the kingside an interesting formation is reached (please compare it with the next example) **5...b6 6.c4 c5 7.b5 axb5 8.cxb5 c4 9.h4+ Kf6 10.f4 h6 11.Kg4 exf4 12.Kxf4 g5+ 13.hxg5+ hxg5+ 14.Kg4 Ke5 15.Kxg5 Kxe4 16.Kf6 Kd5? 0-1** and Gerber resigned, but the position is astonishingly drawn: **17.Ke7 Kc5 18.Ke6 Kxb5 19.Kd5 Kb4 20.Kc6 b5 21.Kb6 Ka4 22.Kc5 Ka5 23.Kd5=** (Miles) Instead 16...Kd3 17.Ke5 c3 18.bxc3 Kxc3 19.Kd5 Kb4 20.Kc6 Ka5–+ was one way to win.



10.07 *A.Karpov* - *G.Kasparov* Las Palmas 1996

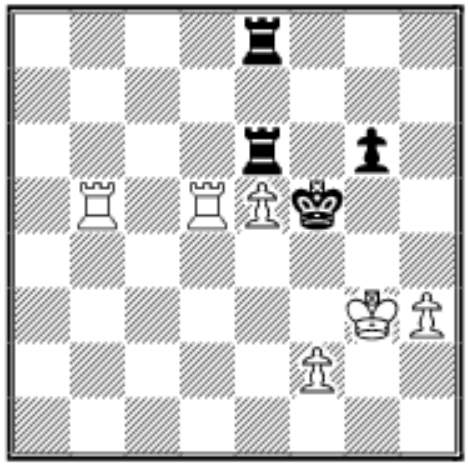
Karpov thought for a long time before he played **1.Kg2!? ½–½** and a draw was agreed, e.g., **1...Kf6 2.Kg3! g5 3.h5!=** 1.Ke2?! draws as well, but is very difficult to calculate: 1...Kf6 2.Ke3! g5 3.h5! g4!? 4.f4! exf4+ (4...Ke6 5.f5+!=) 5.Kxf4! g3! 6.e5+!! Ke6! 7.Kxg3! Kxe5 8.Kf3!=.

After 1.Kg3? Black manages to create an outside passed pawn: 1...Kf6 2.Kg4 h5+ 3.Kg3 g5 4.Kh3 gxh4 5.Kxh4 Kg6 6.Kh3 Kg5 7.Kg3 h4+ 8.Kh3 Kf4 9.Kxh4 Kxf3–+ and 1.Ke3? is wrong as well: 1...Kf6 2.f4 (2.Kf2 h5 3.Kg3 g5–+) 2...exf4+ 3.Kxf4 g5+–+



10.08 *N.Phan Koshnitsky* (2156) - *L.Moylan* (2110) Oceana zt 3.2b (Women) Gold Coast 2001 =/=

White's extra pawn can't be converted: **52.Kh3 Kg5 53.g4 Kh6** (53...Kf4? 54.Kh4 Ke3 55.g5 fxg5+ 56.Kxg5 Kf2 57.g4+-) **54.Kh2 Kg6!** (54...Kg5? 55.Kg3 Kh6 56.Kf4 Kg6 57.g3 Kg7 58.Kf5 (58.g5? Kg6!=) 58...Kf7 59.g5 fxg5 60.Kxg5 Kg7 61.g4+- (opposition)) **55.Kg3 Kg5 56.Kh3 Kh6 57.Kh4 Kg6 58.g5 fxg5+ 59.Kg4 Kf6 60.Kh5 Kf5 61.g3 g4 62.Kh4 Kf6! 63.Kxg4 Kg6!** (opposition) **64.Kf4 Kf6 65.g4 Kg6 66.g5 Kg7 ½–½**

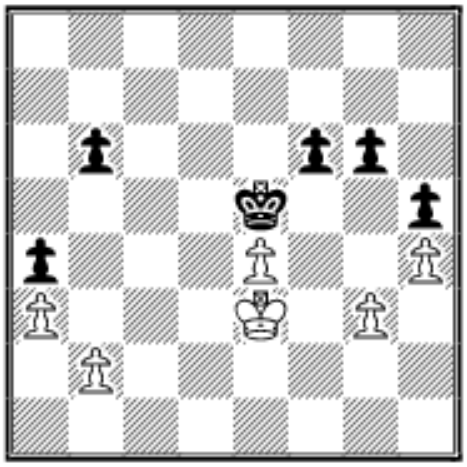


10.09 *A.Khamatgaleev* (2412) - *N.Sanjay* (2364) Goodricke 12th op Calcutta 2001

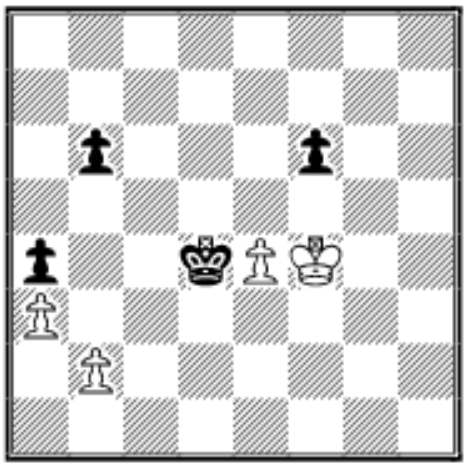
Simplifying into the pawn ending with **50...Rxe5??** is a fatal error. The correct strategy is 50...g5!: 51.Kf3 (51.h4 gxh4+ 52.Kxh4 Rg8=) 51...R8e7 (51...Rxe5? 52.Rxe5+ Rxe5 53.Rxe5+ Kxe5 54.Kg4 Kf6 55.Kh5+-) 52.Ke3 Rxe5+ 53.Rxe5+ Rxe5+ 54.Rxe5+ Kxe5 55.Kf3 Kf5 56.Kg3 Kf6 57.Kg4 Kg6 58.f3 Kf6 59.Kh5 Kf5 60.Kh6 Kf6 61.Kh7 Kf7= (Hecht in CBM 82) **51.Rxe5+ Rxe5 52.Rxe5+ Kxe5 53.Kg4 Kf6 54.h4! Kf7 55.Kg5 Kg7 56.h5 gxh5 57.Kxh5 Kf6 58.Kg4 Kg6 59.Kf4 Kf6 60.f3 1–0** White has the opposition and wins (see 10.01).

Addendum

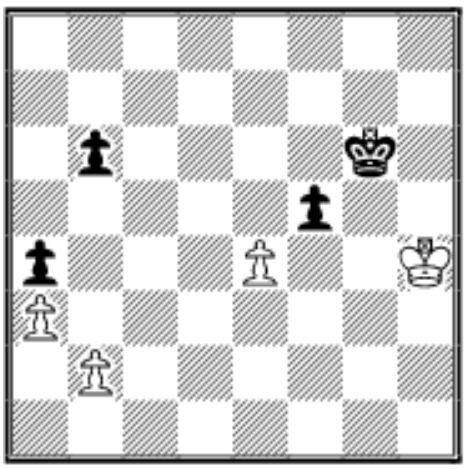
After finishing my work on Endgame Corner No.10 I studied Mark Dvoretsky's excellent column "Tragicomedies in Pawn Endings", especially his comments on Ree vs Ftacnik, Kiev 1978:



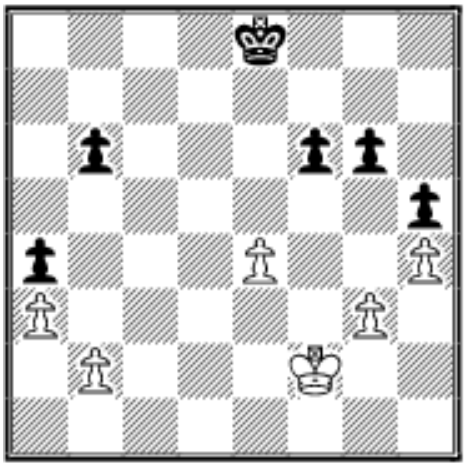
I sent him my observations and want to thank him for his very valueable insights. Together we can now prove, that Lubomir Ftacnik could have won by using the theory of corresponding squares: e5-e3, d6-e2, e6-f2,f7-g2 and e7-f1 are pairs of corresponding squares as White has to able to answer g5 with g4 and to be in time on the queenside. From this we can conclude, that Black has more squares on the 8th rank at his disposal and can force a decisive zugzwang: **1...Kd6** (instead of the game continuation 1...g5??, when Ree could turn the tables completely with 2.g4!+-) **2.Ke2** (2.Kd4 g5–+; 2.Kf4 Ke6 3.Kf3 (3.Ke3 Ke5 4.Kd3 g5–+) 3...g5 4.Ke3 (4.Ke2 gxh4 5.gxh4 Ke5 6.Ke3 f5 7.exf5 Kxf5 8.Kf3 b5–+) 4...gxh4 5.gxh4 Ke5 6.Kf3 f5–+; 2.Kf2 Kc5–+) **2...Ke6** After 2...Kc5 3.Kd3 g5? doesn't work because of 4.e5!= **3.Kf2 Kf7 4.Kg2** 4.Kf3 allows 4...g5 as Black takes on g4 with check: 5.g4 hxg4+ 6.Kxg4 gxh4 7.Kxh4 Ke6 8.Kg4 Ke5 9.Kf3 Kd4 10.Kf4



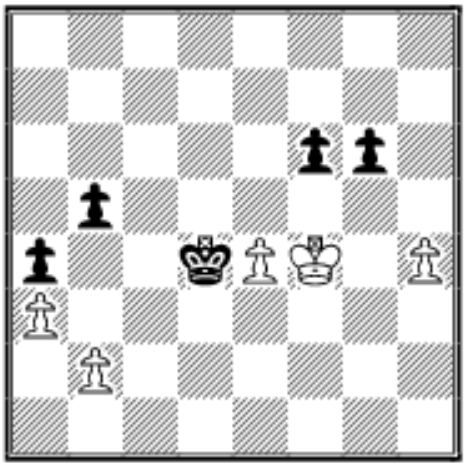
10...b5 11.Kf3 (11.Kf5 Ke3 12.Kxf6 Kxe4 13.Ke6 Kd3–+) 11...Kd3 12.Kf4 Ke2 13.Kg4 Kd2 14.Kf4 Kd3 15.Kf3 Kc2–+ **4...Ke7** After 4...g5? 5.g4! Kg6 6.Kg3 hxg4 7.Kxg4 gxh4 8.Kxh4 f5



the only move to save White's skin is 9.Kg3!= **5.Kf1 Kf8 6.Kf2 Ke8**



and now White can't hold the correspondence as Mark Dvoretsky proved: **7.Kf3** (7.Kg2 Kf7 8.Kf3 g5–+; 7.Ke3 Kf7 8.Kf2 Ke6 9.Ke2 Kd6–+; 7.Kg1 Kd7 8.Kf1 [8.Kg2 Kd6–+; 8.Kf2 Ke6–+] 8...Ke7 9.Ke2 Kd6 10.Kd3 g5–+) **7...Ke7 8.g4** (8.Ke3 Kf7–+) **8...Kd6 9.Kf4 hxg4 10.Kxg4 Ke5 11.Kf3 Kd4 12.Kf4 b5**



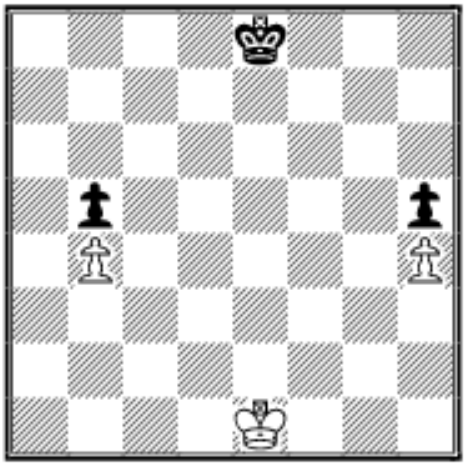
(mutual zugzwang) **13.Kf3 Kd3 14.Kf4 Kc2–+**

The whole work is a joint analysis by Mark Dvoretsky and me. I want to thank Mark for his kind permission to publish it in my column.

Sources:

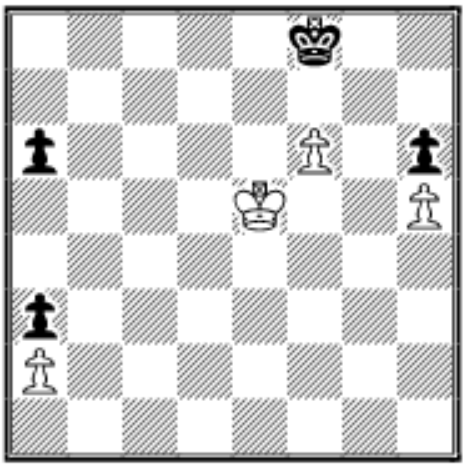
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The Week in Chess

Exercises
(Solutions next month)



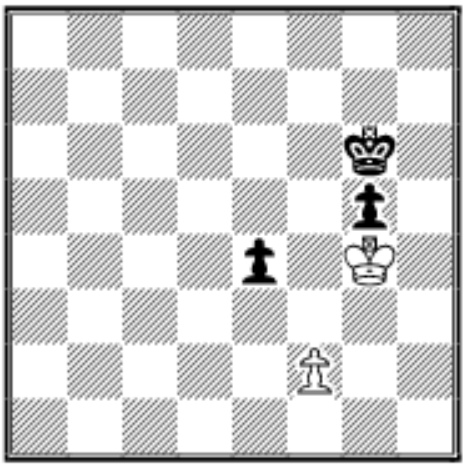
E10.01 Capablanca 1921

White to move and win.



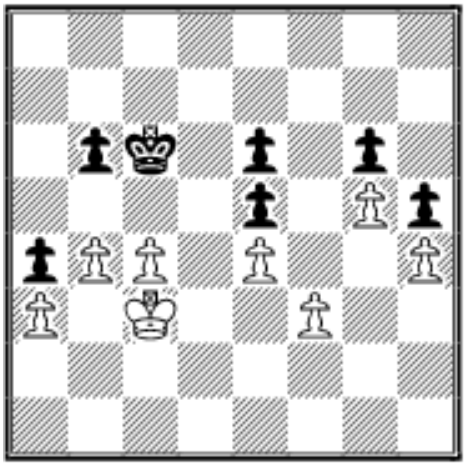
E10.02 After H.van Riemsdijk 1974

White wins by triangulation. Please find the solution to the end.



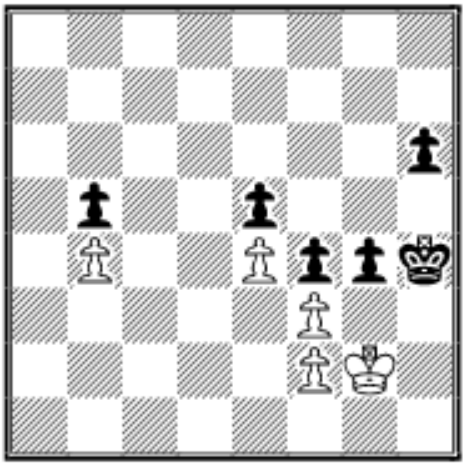
E10.03 After *E.Krassilnikov* (2257) - *Y.Meister* (2450) White Nights St Petersburg 2001

Can White to move save himself?



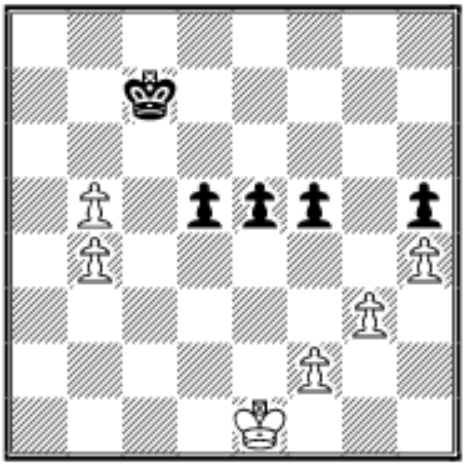
E10.04 *J.Gallagher* (2480) - *Peetoom* Bargteheide op 1988

The position is quite closed. Is there a way for White to break through?



E10.05 *K.Schlenga* - *B.Donner* NRW 1992

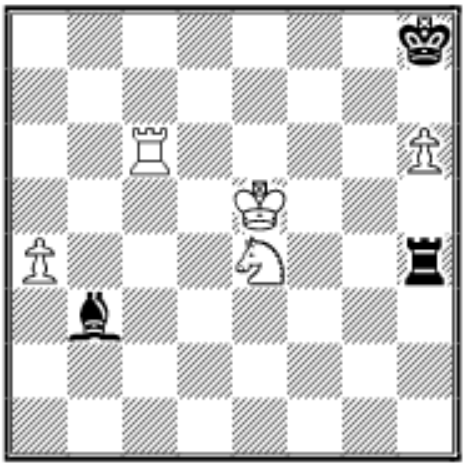
Can Black to move storm White's castle?



E10.06 After *J.Shaw* - *J.Rowson* Edinburgh 2000

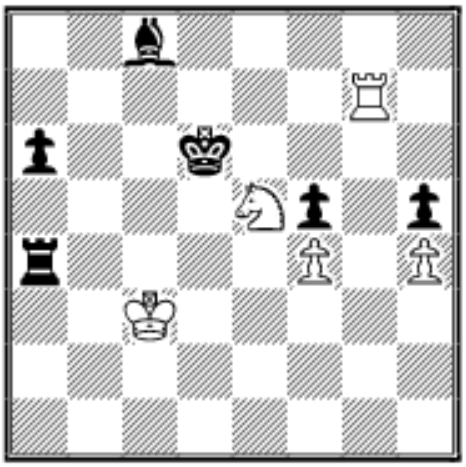
In the game White's king was on e3 and Rowson remarks in his book *The Seven Deadly Chess Sins*: "For a while I thought this ending was interesting and subtle but after a while it dawned on me that it was a fairly clear draw." With the white king on e3 this is correct, but his first point also has its merits as with the king on e1 it is White to move and win (note that in the main line White reaches a won queen ending).

Solutions to last month exercises



E9.01 *Qin Kanying* (2501) - *A.Stefanova* (2514) FIDE World Cup-B (Women) Shenyang 2000

The solution was not easy to find: In the game Qin Kanying went wrong with **45.Ng5?** (45.Nf6! Rxh6 46.a5 wins as Tsesarsky proved in CBM 79. One sample line runs 46...Rh1 47.Rc7 Re1+ 48.Kd4 Rd1+ 49.Ke3 Re1+ 50.Kd2 Rh1 51.a6 Bd1 52.Rc1+-; 45.a5? Rh5+ 46.Kd4 Rxa5=; 45.Kf5? Rxe4! (45...Bxa4? 46.Rc8+ Kh7 47.Nf6+ Kxh6 48.Rh8++-) 46.Kxe4 Bxa4 47.Rc7 Bb5 48.Kf5 Bd3+ 49.Kf6 Be4=) **45...Rxa4 46.Rc8+ Bg8 47.h7 Ra5+ 48.Kf4** (48.Kf6 Rxg5=) **48...Rxg5 49.Kxg5 Kxh7** ½–½



E9.02 *G.Kasparov* (2849) - *P.Svidler* (2695) World Cup of Rapid Chess-A Cannes 2001

Kasparov drew as follows: **43.Nc4+ Ke6 44.Rg6+ Kf7 45.Rb6 Be6 46.Ne5+ Ke7** (46...Kf6 47.Nd7+ Ke7 48.Ne5=) **47.Ng6+ Kf7 48.Ne5+** ½–½

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



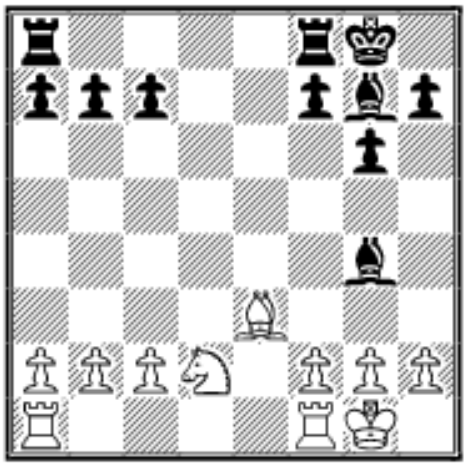
The Bishop Pair

Part 1

Two bishops are usually very strong as the **main disadvantage of a single bishop, his monocromacity, is compensated by the second bishop**. Jonathan Rowson describes this in his recent work *The Seven Deadly Chess Sins* (page 130) as follows:

"Although the pair of knights can be very effective, we don't see them as 'a pair' because there is nothing one knight can do that the other can't in principle...There may be something good about 'the two knights' in a particular position, but this is purely accidental, for there is no reason in principle why a pair of them should be more than the sum of their parts. On the other hand, one bishop makes up for the shortcomings of the other, *and takes care of its own shortcomings in the process*. So what happens when you capture the opponent's bishop is not only that you remove one piece of value, but that you 'weaken' the other bishop too."

The following game of Steinitz shows is an example of how to play with the two bishops in an otherwise almost symmetrical position:



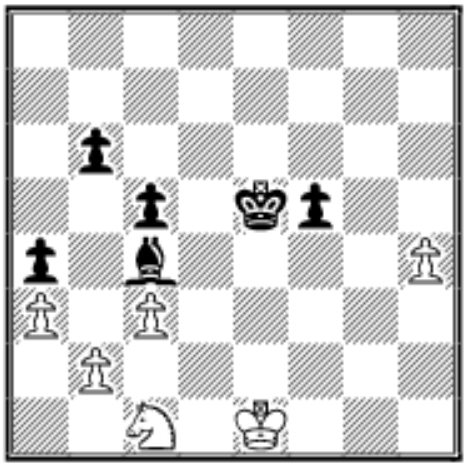
11.01 ***B.Englisch - W.Steinitz*** **London 1883**

15...Rad8!? 15...Bxb2? only activates White: 16.Rab1 Be5 17.Rxb7= **16.c3 Rfe8 17.Nb3 b6!** a typical strategy: Black strengthens his light squared bishop as it has no counterpart and restricts White's knight at the same time. **18.h3 Be6 19.Rfd1 c5** Continuing the strategy **20.Bg5 f6 21.Bf4 Kf7 22.f3 g5 23.Rxd8 Rxd8 24.Be3 h6** Finally all six black pawns are on dark squares **25.Re1 f5** Steinitz wants to grab space on the kingside with f5-f4 to follow up with a7-a5-a4-a3 or with a further advance on the kingside. **26.f4 Bf6 27.g3 a5!** Planning to create weaknesses on White's queenside with a5-a4-a3 **28.Nc1 a4 29.a3 Bc4** This domination of White's knight is called **corralling**. You should know this important motif by heart! **30.Kf2 gxf4 31.Bxf4 Bg5!**



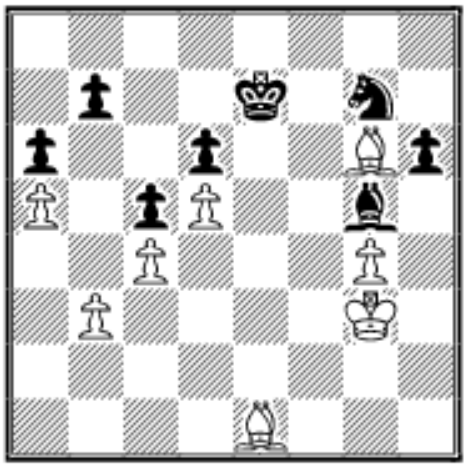
Threatening to exchange White's best defender, the dark squared bishop. This transformation of one advantage into another is one major advantage of the bishop pair as it is usually easier for the player with the bishops to exchange one pair of minor pieces. **32.Bxg5** After 32.Ke3, trading rooks is a mistake: 32...Re8+?! (32...Kg6 (Tartakover) and Black is much better.) 33.Kf2 Rxe1? 34.Kxe1 Bxf4 35.gxf4 Ke6 36.Kf2 Kd5 37.Ke3 Bf1 38.h4 Kc4 39.Kd2 and Black can't break through, e.g., 39...b5 40.Ke3 Bg2 41.Kd2 Bf3 42.Ke3 Be4 43.Kd2 b4 44.cxb4

cxb4 45.axb4 Kxb4 46.Ne2 Kb3 (46...Kc4 47.Nc3 Bc6 48.Ne2=) 47.Nc3 Bc6 48.Nd1= **32...hxg5 33.Ke3 Kf6 34.h4?** this loses by force as does 34.Ne2? Rd3+ 35.Kf2 Rd2–+. White had to try something like 34.Rg1 or 34.Rh1 **34...gxh4 35.gxh4?! Re8+ 36.Kf2 Rxe1 37.Kxe1 Ke5!**

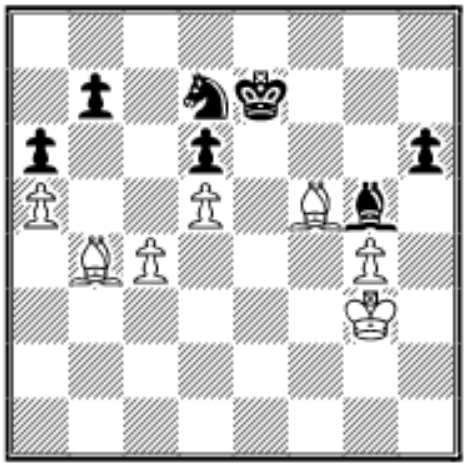


38.Ne2 Bxe2 39.Kxe2 the pawn ending is winning for Black as his active king is more important than White's outside passed pawn: **39...Kf4 40.c4 Kg4 41.Ke3 f4+ 42.Ke4 f3 43.Ke3 Kg3 0–1**

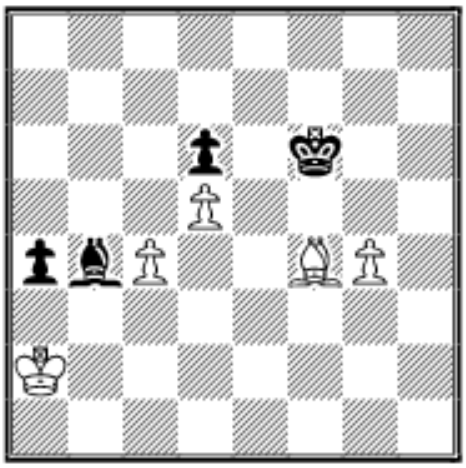
In a **pure endgame the advantage of the bishop pair can easily be decisive** (for a statistical research see *Secrets of Modern Chess Strategy* by John Watson, page 149):



11.02 *B.Gulko* (2622) - *T.Radjabov* (2483) Corus-B Wijk aan Zee 2001
41...Ne8 41...Kf6 42.Bc2 Ke7 (42...Ke5?? 43.Bc3#) 43.b4 is similar to the game continuation. **42.b4!** White opens a second front on the queenside and plans to attack the pawn b7. **42...cxb4** After 42...Nf6 one sample line runs 43.Bf5 Kd8 44.bxc5 dxc5 45.Bf2 (45.Kf3!?) 45...Bd2 46.Bxc5 Bxa5 47.Be3 and White has a large advantage. **43.Bxb4 Nf6 44.Bf5 Nd7** 44...Bc1 45.Kf3!+- (The immediate 45.Bc8? is wrong due to 45...Ne4+ 46.Kf3 Nc5 when it is not clear, if White can break through **Black's dark squared blockade**.) **(DIAGRAM)**

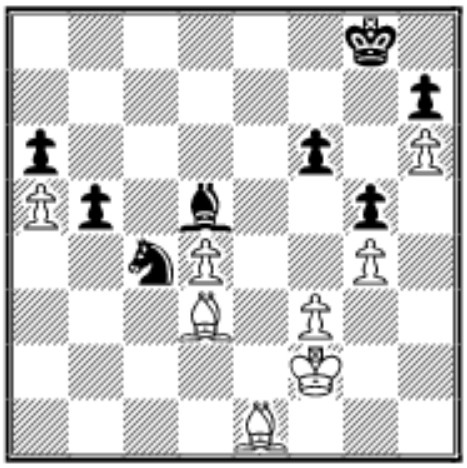


45.Bxd7! "The advantage of the bishop pair consists the possibility of a favourable exchange of it!" (Hazai in CBM 81) **45...Kxd7 46.Kf3 Bd8 47.Ke4 b6** Keeping the structure with 47...Bg5 isn't sufficient either: 48.Kf5 Be3 49.Kg6 Bc1 50.Bc3 Be3 51.Bg7 Bd2 (I want to add the following variation to Hazai's line: 51...b6 52.axb6 a5 53.Bxh6 Bxh6 54.Kxh6 a4 55.b7 Kc7 56.b8Q+ Kxb8 57.g5+-) 52.Bxh6 Bxa5 53.Kf7 b5 54.cxb5 axb5 55.Bc1+- (Hazai) **48.axb6 Bxb6 49.Bd2 a5 50.Bxh6 a4 51.Kd3 Ke7 52.Bg5+ Kf7 53.Kc3 Bc5 54.Kb2 Kg6 55.Bf4 Kf6 56.Ka2 Bb4**



57.Bc1! Ke5 58.g5 Ba5 58...Kf5 59.Ba3 Ba5 60.Bxd6 Kxg5 61.Ka3+- **59.Ka3 1–0**

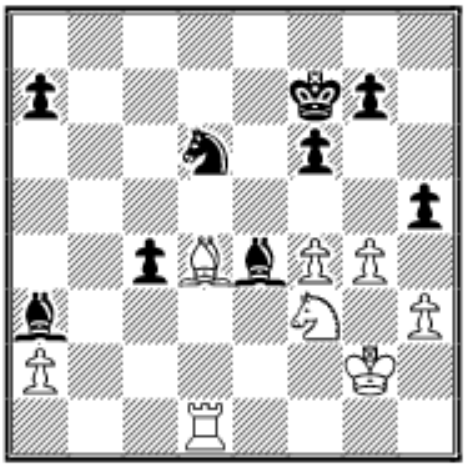
In the next example Kasparov shows his superb technique:



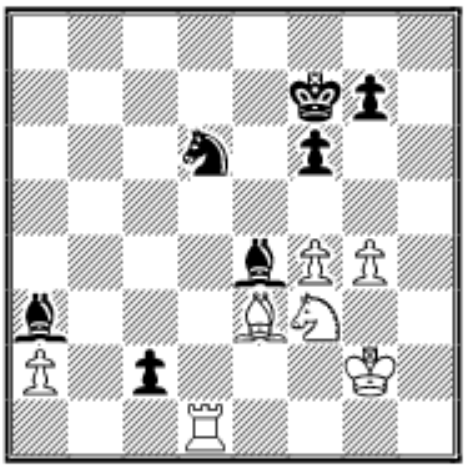
11.03 *G.Kasparov* (2849) - *J.Timman* (2629) Corus Wijk aan Zee 2001
Diagram after 42...b7-b5 **43.Bb4!** with the terrible threat of Bd3-f5-c8. Capturing en passant with 43.axb6?! is wrong **in principle as White's winning potential is then very**

reduced. His winning chances are nevertheless alive e.g. 43...Nxb6 44.Bxa6 (44.Ba5!?) 44...Bc4 (44...Nc4 45.Bb4 Nb2 46.Ke3 Nc4+ 47.Kd3 Nb2+ 48.Ke2 Nc4 49.Bc8) 45.Bxc4+ Nxc4 46.Ke2 Kf7 47.Kd3 Nb6 48.Ba5 Nd5 49.Kc4 Ke6 50.Kc5 **43...Nb2 44.Bf5** 44.Be2? Kf7 45.Ke1 Bc4 allows Black to halve the bishop pair on his terms. **44...Bc4** 44...Bb7? 45.Be6+ Kh8 46.Bf8 Nd3+ 47.Ke3 Nf4 48.Bg7# **45.Ke3 Bd5** 45...Nd1+ 46.Kd2 Nf2 47.Bc8 Nd3 48.Bd6 b4 49.Bf5+- **46.Bc8 Nc4+ 47.Ke2 1–0**

In the following example White has an extra exchange but must not underestimate the power of the bishops:



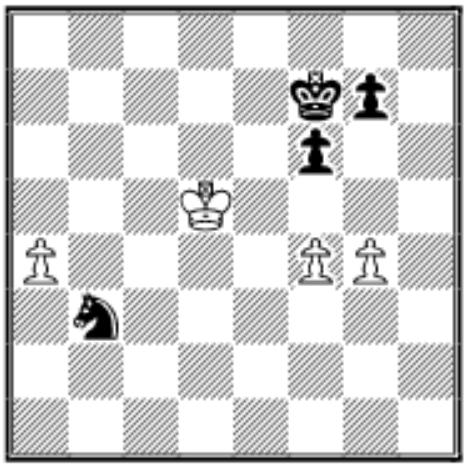
11.04 *I.Hausner* (2440) - *K.Müller* (2380) Hamburg 1990
42.Bxa7? allowing the c-pawn to advance further is extremely risky. After 42.Kf2!? it is Black who has to look for equality. **42...hxg4 43.hxg4 c3 44.Be3** For 44.Re1 c2 45.Be3 see the game. **44...c2**



Now White faces an awkward choice: Where shall his rook go? **45.Re1!** Certainly not 45.Ra1? as Black wins after 45...Nc4 46.Bc1 Bc5!

46...Bb2?! wins as well, but is much more complicated: 47.Bxb2 Nxb2 48.Kf2 Bxf3 49.Kxf3 Nd3 **A)** 50.a4 c1Q 51.Rxc1 Nxc1 52.a5 Nb3 53.a6 Nd4+ 54.Kg3 (54.Ke4 Nc6–+) 54...Nc6 55.f5 Ke8 56.Kh4 Kd7 57.Kh5 Kc7 58.Kg6 Ne5+ 59.Kxg7 Nxg4–+; **B)** 50.Ke4 c1Q 51.Rxc1

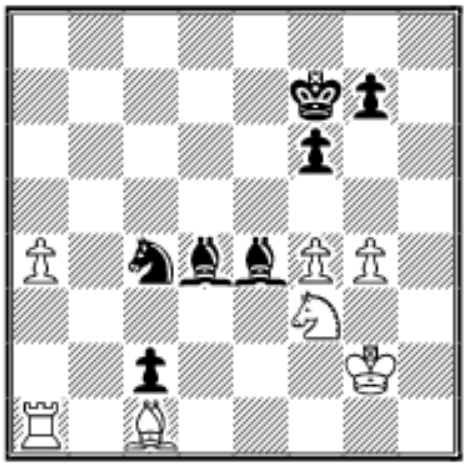
Nxc1 52.a4 Nb3 53.Kd5



Now a fascinating battle between the knight and White's king has arisen. With precise play Black can decide it in his favour: 53...Ke7 54.Kc4 Nc1

B1) 55.Kb5 Kd7 56.Kb6 Nd3 57.f5 Kc8–+;
B2) 55.a5 Kd6 56.a6 Kc6 57.a7 Kb7 58.Kd5 Ne2
B2a) 59.Ke4 Ng3+ 60.Kf3 Nf1 61.Kf2 (61.Ke4 Kxa7 62.g5 Ng3+ 63.Kf3 Nf5 64.Kg4 Ne7–+) 61...Nd2 62.Ke3 Nc4+ 63.Kd4 Nb6 64.g5 (64.Ke4 Nd7 65.Kd5 Nf8 66.f5 Nh7 67.Ke6 Ng5+ 68.Ke7 Nf3 69.Kf7 Ne5+–+) 64...fxg5 65.fxg5 Nd7 66.Kd5 Nf8 67.Kd6 Ng6 68.Ke6 Nh4 69.g6 Kxa7 70.Kf7 Nf5–+;
B2b) 59.f5 Nf4+ 60.Kd6 Kxa7 61.Ke7 Nd5+ 62.Kf7 Ne3 63.Kxg7 Nxg4 64.Kg6 Kb6 65.Kh5 Ne5–+;
B3) 55.Kd5 Ne2 56.a5 Nxf4+ 57.Kc6 Ne6 58.a6 Kd8 59.a7 Nc7 60.Kd6 Nb5+–+;

47.a4 Bd4



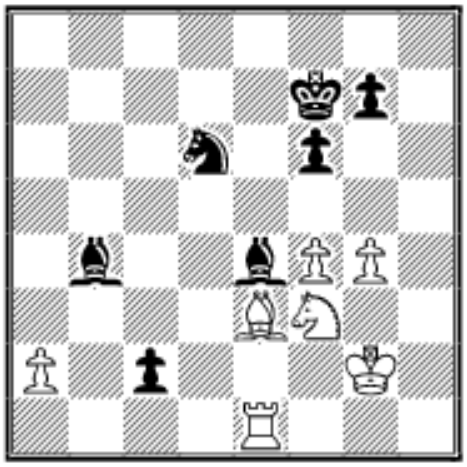
The raking bishop pair (sometimes called **Horwitz bishops**) dominates the board. White is completely lost: 48.Ra2 Be3 49.Ra1 Nd2 50.Kg3 (50.Ra3 Bxf3+ 51.Kh3 Bxf4 52.Rxf3 Nxf3 53.Bxf4 Ng1+ 54.Kg2 Ne2 55.Be3 c1Q 56.Bxc1 Nxc1 57.a5 Nd3 58.a6 Nf4+ 59.Kf3 Ne6 60.a7 Nc7–+) 50...Bxf3 51.Bxd2 Bxd2 52.Kxf3 c1Q 53.Rxc1 Bxc1 54.a5 Ba3 55.a6 Bc5–+; 45.Rxd6? is a better practical try, but the

position after 45...Bxd6 46.Bc1 g5 47.fxg5 fxg5 48.Bxg5 (48.Kf2 Bxf3 49.Kxf3 Bf4–+) 48...Ba3 49.Kf2 c1Q 50.Bxc1 Bxc1–+ is theoretically lost as both white pawns will fall prey to the bishops and the pawnless ending 2 bishops vs knight is always won for the bishops, if the side with the knight can't force an immediate draw. This fact was discovered by Ken Thompson using a computer database. His result overturned pre database theory, which assumed that the ending is drawn, if the defender can reach the "Kling and Horwitz position" (wKd5,Ba4,f8; bKb6,Nb7. See, e.g., Nunn in *Secrets of Minor-Piece Endings*, p.277). John Nunn deals with the subject very extensively in *Secrets of Minor-Piece Endings* (p.265-281).

45.Rf1?! seems to be playable as well, although it looks suspicious: 45...Nb5 (45...Nc4? 46.Bc1 Bxc1 47.Rxc1 Nd2 48.Rxc2! is certainly not better for Black.)

A) 46.Bc1? Bxc1 47.Rxc1 Nc3–+;
B) 46.Kf2?! Nc3 47.Nd4 Bb2 48.Rc1 (48.Nxc2 Bxc2 49.Bd4 Ne4+ 50.Ke3 Ba3) 48...Bxc1 49.Bxc1 Nxa2 and in both cases it is not completely clear, if White can reach the draw.
C) 46.Re1?! Bb4 and Black's threats are very dangerous, e.g., **C1)** 47.Ra1? Bc3 48.Rf1 (48.Rc1 Bb2 49.Rf1 Nd4–+) 48...Nd4 49.Bc1 Ke6–+; **C2)** 47.Rh1 Nc3 48.a4 Ba3 49.a5 Nd1 50.Bd2 Bc5 51.Bc1 Be3 52.Ba3 Bxf4;
D) 46.Kg3 46...Bd3 (46...Nc3 47.Nd4 Bb2 48.Bc1! Bxc1 49.Rxc1 Nxa2 50.Rxc2=) 47.Re1 Nc3 48.Nd4 Bb2 (48...Nxa2 49.Ra1 Bb2 50.Rxa2 Bxd4 51.Rxc2 Bxc2 52.Bxd4=) 49.Nxc2 Bxc2 50.Bd4=;

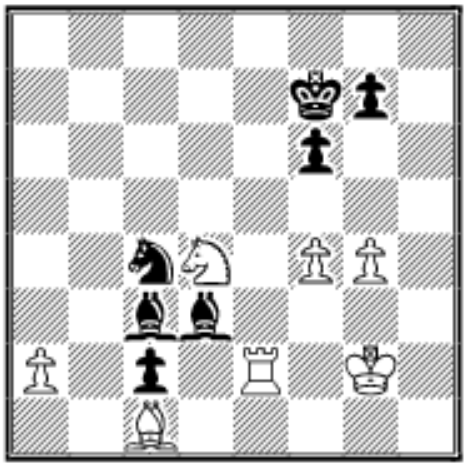
45...Bb4 After 45...Nc4?! 46.Bc1 Bxc1 47.Rxc1 Nd2 White has the resource 48.Rxc2!



asking the rook to move again and now Hausner failed to find the right square: **46.Re2?**

A) 46.Rc1! Nc4 47.Kf2 Nb2 (47...Ba3 48.Nd4 Bxc1 49.Bxc1=) 48.Nd4 (48.Ne1? Nd1+ 49.Ke2 Bxe1 50.Kxe1 Nxe3–+) 48...Nd3+ (48...Nd1+ 49.Ke2 Nc3+=) 49.Ke2 Nxc1+ 50.Bxc1 and Black's advantage is probably insufficient.
B) 46.Rf1? Nc4 47.Bc1 (47.Kf2? Bxf3 48.Kxf3 Nd2+–+) 47...Nd2 48.Rf2 Nxf3 49.Rxf3 Ke6 50.Kf2 Bxf3 51.Kxf3 Kd5 52.Ke3 Kc4 and I can't see a way for White to hold on, but on the other hand it is not so easy to prove that he is lost.
C) 46.Ra1? Nc4 47.Kf2 Nxe3 48.Kxe3 Bxf3 49.Kxf3 Ba3–+

46...Bd3 47.Nd4 Nc4 48.Bc1 48.Nxc2 Bxc2 49.Bc1 Bd3 50.Rf2 Be1 51.Rf3 Be4–+ **48...Bc3**

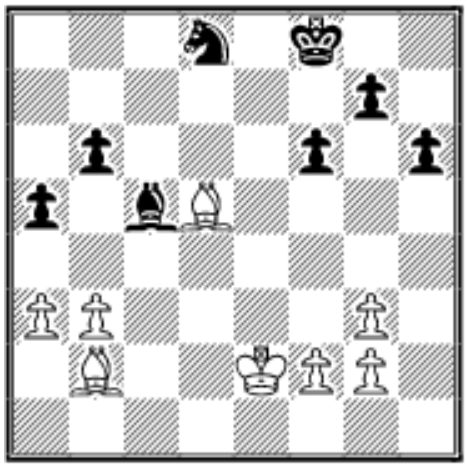


wins the exchange while keeping the strong passed c-pawn alive **49.Nb5!** 49.Rxc2? Bxd4–+ **49...Bxe2** After 49...Bb2? 50.Re1! White is in full command as Black's attack is over. **50.Nxc3 Bxg4 51.Nd5 Be6 52.Nb4 Bf5 53.Kf2 Be4 54.Na6 Ke6 55.Nc5+ Kd5 56.Nb3** 56.Nxe4 Kxe4 57.Ke2 Kd4–+ **56...Bf5 57.Ke2 Bg6 58.Nd2 Nb6 59.Nf1 Kd4 60.Bb2+ Ke4 61.Bc1 Kd4 62.Bb2+ Ke4 63.Bc1** 63.Ne3? Na4 64.Bc1 Nc3+ 65.Kd2 Nxa2–+ **63...Bh5+ 64.Kf2?** Hausner is tired and makes it easy. 64.Kd2! was called for,

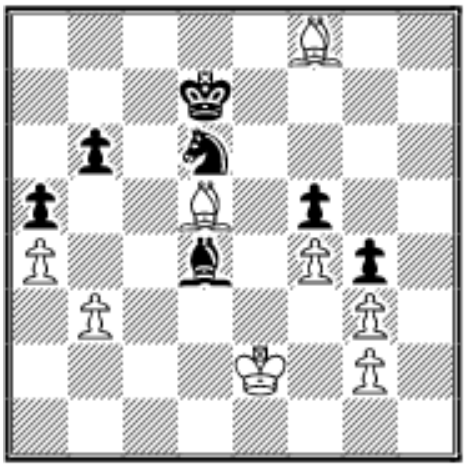
when it is not totally clear, if Black is winning e.g. 64...Kxf4 65.Kxc2+ Kf3 66.Bb2 **64...Kd3! 65.Ne3 Bf7 66.a3 Na4 67.Ng2 Nc5 68.Ne1+ Kc3 69.Ke3 Bg6 70.Bd2+ Kb2 71.Nxc2 Bxc2–+** and Black won after some further moves.

I want to end the first part of my discussion of the bishop pair with two games illustrating the power of the bishops in a pure ending:

11.05 *L.van Wely* (2670) - *M.van der Werf* (2450) [D46] ch-NED Leeuwarden 2001
1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 c6 4.e3 Nd7 5.Bd3 Ngf6 6.Nf3 Be7 7.0–0 0–0 8.b3 b6 9.Bb2 Bb7 10.Qe2 Qc7 11.Rac1 Rad8 12.Ne5 dxc4 13.Nxc4 c5 14.Rfd1 cxd4 15.exd4 Qf4 16.Qe3 Qg4 17.Qg3 Qxg3 18.hxg3 Nb8 19.Be2 Nd5 20.Nxd5 Bxd5 21.Ne3 Bc6 22.d5 Bxd5 23.Nxd5 exd5 24.Bf3 Bc5 25.Bxd5 a5 26.Bf3 h6 27.Kf1 Rfe8 28.Be2 Nc6 29.a3 Rxd1+ 30.Rxd1 Rd8 31.Rxd8+ Nxd8 32.Bf3 Kf8 33.Ke2 f6 34.Bd5



34...Ke7 35.f4 Kd6 36.Bc4 Nc6 37.Kd3 Ne7 38.Ke4 f5+ 39.Kf3 g5 40.Be5+ Kc6 41.a4 g4+ 42.Ke2 Kd7 43.Bg7 Nc8 44.Bxh6 Nd6 45.Bd5 Bd4 46.Bf8



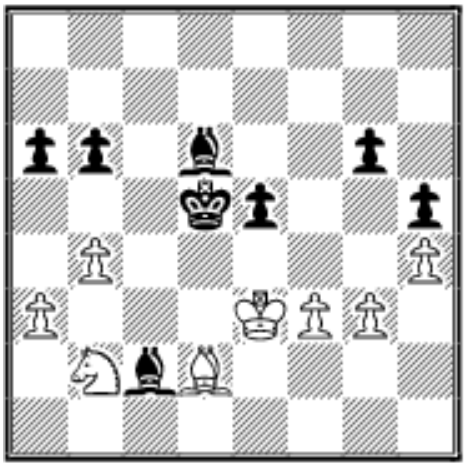
46...Bh8? 46...Bc5 is more tenacious, when it is not completely clear, if White can win. **47.Kd3 Bf6 48.Bg8 Ne4 49.Kc4 Ke8 50.Ba3 Kd7 51.Bc1 Bd8 52.Be3 Nf6 53.Bf7 Ne4 54.Kd5 Ke7 55.Be6 Nxg3 56.Bf2 Ne2 57.Bh4+ Ke8 58.Bxd8 Kxd8 59.Ke5 Ke7 60.Bxf5 g3 61.Bd3 Nc3 62.Bc4 Nd1 63.Ke4 Nf2+ 64.Kf3 Nh1 65.Bd3 Kf6 66.Bc2 Ke6 67.Kg4 Kf6 68.Kh4 Ke6 69.Kg5 Kf7 70.Be4 Nf2 71.Bd5+ Ke7 72.f5 Nh1 73.f6+ Kf8 74.Kf4 Ke8 75.Ke5 Nf2 76.Kd6 Ng4 77.Kc7 Nxf6 78.Bf3 Ke7 79.Kxb6 Kd6 80.Kxa5 Nd7 81.Kb5 Nc5 82.b4 Nb3 83.Ba8 Nd4+ 84.Kc4 Ne6 85.a5 1–0**

11.06 *T.Heinemann* (2420) - *C.Wilhelmi* (2355) [B53] Hamburg HSK 1996

1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d6 4.d4 cxd4 5.Qxd4 Bd7 6.Bxc6 Bxc6 7.c4 f5 8.Nc3 e5 9.Qd3 fxe4 10.Nxe4 Nf6 11.Nfd2 Be7 12.0–0 0–0 13.Nc3 d5 14.cxd5 Nxd5 15.Nxd5 Qxd5 16.Qxd5+ Bxd5 17.Nb3 Rac8 18.Be3 b6 19.Rac1 Rfd8 20.Rxc8 Rxc8 21.Rc1 Rxc1+ 22.Nxc1



22...Bc4 23.b3 Ba6 24.f3 Kf7 25.Kf2 Bb4 26.Ne2 Bd3 27.Bc1 Bc5+ 28.Be3 Bb4 29.Bc1 Ke6 30.Bb2 Bc5+ 31.Ke1 g6 32.Kd2 Ba6 33.Bc3 h5 34.Kd1 Bf2 35.Be1 Bc5 36.h4 Be7 37.Bf2 Bb7 38.Nc3 Kf5 39.Ke2 Bc6 40.g3 Bb4 41.Be1 a6 42.Bd2 Bd6 43.Nd1 Bb5+ 44.Kf2 Bd3 45.b4 Ke6 46.a3 Kd5 47.Ke3 Bc2 48.Nb2



48...e4 49.f4 b5 50.Bc1 Bc7 51.Kd2 Ba4 52.Ke2 Bd8 53.Be3 Bf6 54.Nxa4 bxa4 55.Kd2 Kc4 56.Bc5 Bb2 57.Ke3 Bxa3 58.Kxe4 Bb2 0-1

Sources:

The Seven Deadly Chess Sins, Jonathan Rowson, GAMBIT 2001

Secrets of Modern Chess Strategy, John Watson, GAMBIT 1998

Secrets of Minor-Piece Endings, John Nunn, Batsford 1995

ChessBase MEGABASE 2000

ChessBase Magazine 81

The Week in Chess

Exercises (Solutions next month)

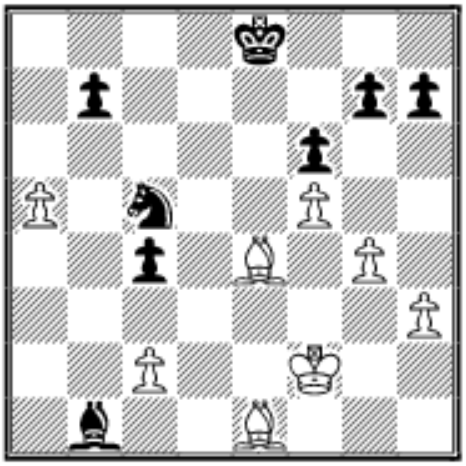


E11.01 *V.Kramnik* (2740) - *V.Topalov* (2725) Novgorod 1997

Where is Black's Archilles heel? (White to move and win.)



E11.02 *V.Anand* (2794) - *V.Kramnik* (2797) Champions duel Mainz 2001 Kramnik to move and win.



E11.03 *V.Anand* (2725) - *J.Lautier* (2645) PCA-Intel GP London 1995

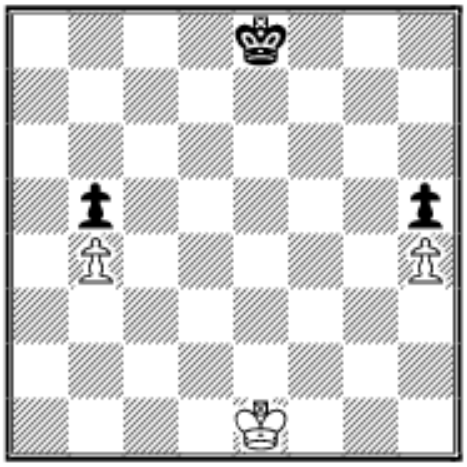
How to evaluate the position with White to move?



E11.04 *K.Bischoff* (2533) - *A.Khalifman* (2690) Bundesliga 2000/01 Plauen-Porz

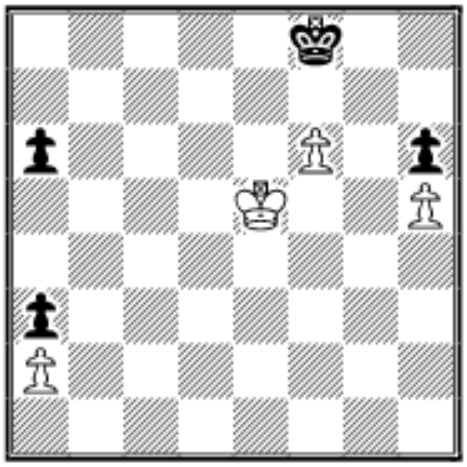
Khalifman found an ingenious way to smoke out White's fortress. Can you do the same? (Bischoff had the pair of bishops earlier in the game, so I found this game in my preparations for this column.)

Solutions to last month excercises



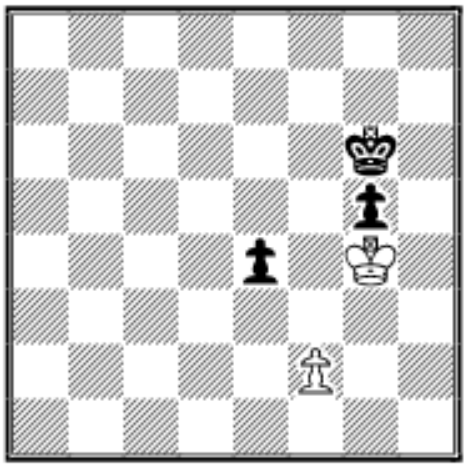
E10.01 Capablanca 1921

White wins by using the opposition: **1.Ke2!** (distant opposition) **1...Kd8 2.Kf3 Ke7 3.Ke3 Ke6** 3...Kf7 4.Kd4 Kf6 5.Kc5 Kf5 6.Kxb5 Kg4 7.Kc4 Kxh4 8.b5+- **4.Ke4! Kd6 5.Kd4!** In the race after 5.Kf5? Black is in time: 5...Kd5 6.Kg5 Kc4 7.Kxh5 Kxb4 8.Kg4 Ka3= **5...Kc6** 5...Ke6 6.Kc5 Kf5 7.Kxb5 Kg4 8.Kc4 Kxh4 9.b5+- **6.Ke5 Kc7 7.Kd5 Kb6 8.Kd6 Kb7 9.Kc5 Ka6 10.Kc6+-**



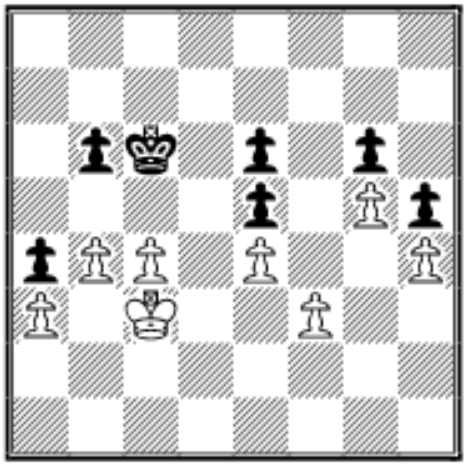
10.02 After H.van Riemsdijk 1974

White has to triangulate several times: **1.Kf4 Ke8 2.Ke4 Kf8 3.Ke5!** with the pawn on a6 this is the correct way as Black has an even number of spare moves with his a-pawn. **3...Kf7 4.Kf5 a5 5.Ke5 Ke8 6.Kf4 Kf8 7.Ke4 Ke8 8.Ke5!** with the pawn on a5, e8 is the corresponding square to e5 as Black has only one spare move with his a-pawn. **8...Kf7 9.Kf5 a4** and finally a "normal" triangulation wins because Black has no spare moves left **10.Ke5 Kf8 11.Kf4 Ke8 12.Ke4 Kf8 13.Ke5 Kf7 14.Kf5 Kf8 15.Kg6+-**



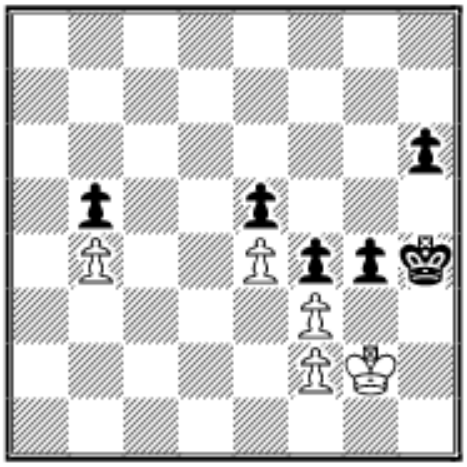
E10.03 After *E.Krassilnikov* (2257) - *Y.Meister* (2450) St Petersburg White Nights 2001

White has only one move to save the position: **1.Kh3!** 1.Kg3? Kf5 and we have reached the game, which continued: 2.Kg2 Kf4 3.Kg1 Kf3 4.Kf1 g4 5.Kg1 Ke2 6.Kg2 Ke1 7.Kg1 (7.Kg3 Kf1 8.Kxg4 Kxf2 9.Kf4 e3–+) 7...g3! 8.fxg3 e3 0–1; 1.f3? e3 2.Kg3 Kf5–+; 1.f4? e3 2.f5+ Kf6 3.Kf3 Kxf5 4.Kxe3 Kg4 5.Kf2 Kh3–+ **1...Kf5 2.Kg3! g4 3.Kh2 Kf4 4.Kg2 g3 5.fxg3+ Ke3 6.g4 Kd2 7.g5=**



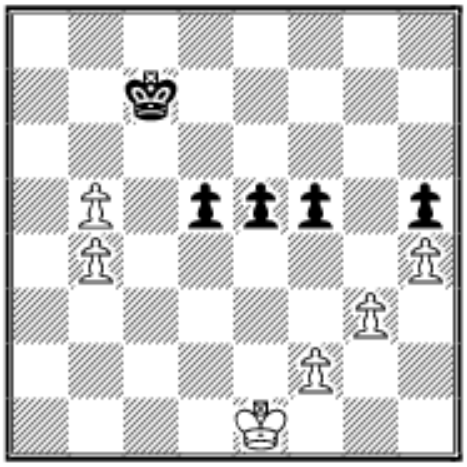
E10.04 *J.Gallagher* (2480) – *Peetoom* Bargteheide op 1988

Gallagher won easily: **37.b5+ Kc5 38.Kd3 Kd6 39.Kd2!** zugzwang **1–0**



E10.05 *K.Schlenga* - *B.Donner* Germany 1992

Black won by **46...g3! 0-1** He had to avoid 46...gxf3+? 47.Kh2!=



E10.06 After *J.Shaw - J.Rowson* Edinburgh 2000

White can break through as follows: **1.f4! e4** 1...exf4 2.gxf4 Kb6 3.Kd2 Kxb5 4.Kc3 Ka4 5.Kd4 Kxb4 6.Kxd5+- **2.g4 hxg4 3.h5 g3 4.h6 e3 5.Kf1 d4 6.h7 e2+ 7.Kxe2 d3+ 8.Kd2 g2 9.h8Q g1Q 10.Qe5+ Kb7 11.Qd5+ Kb8 12.Qxf5+-**

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



The Bishop Pair

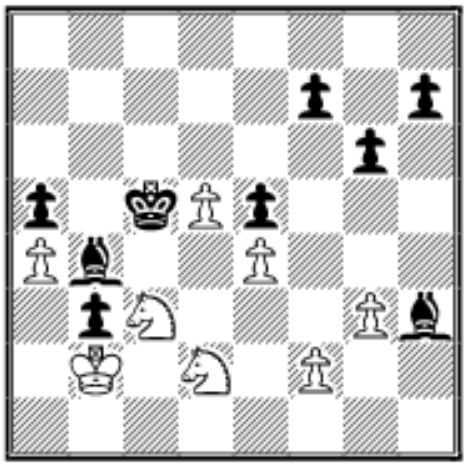
Part 2

In my last column of the year I want to deal with two bishops vs two knights. The knights have one principle advantage over the bishops: they can attack one square twice. Nevertheless the bishops are superior in the majority of cases. John Watson gives the following figure in *Secrets of Modern Chess Strategy* on page 149f based on the ChessBase MEGABASE 1997: the bishops scored 63% in the pure ending with even pawns. The first example is no exception:

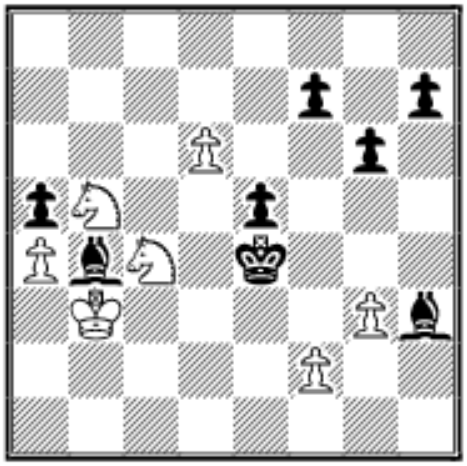


12.01 *C.Sandipan* (2446) - *E.Vladimirov* (2598) Penta Media GM Kelamabakkam IND 2000

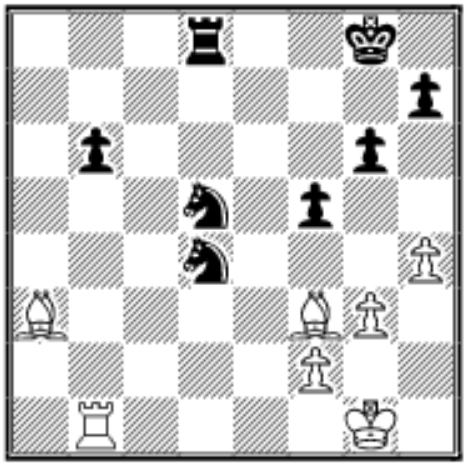
I start earlier as Vladimirov's play is quite instructive: **32...Reb8 33.Nf1 Bc5 34.Ng3 Nd7 35.Nge2 Bd6 36.Na2 Rb2 37.Rxb2 Rxb2 38.Nac3 Nc5 39.Nd1 Rb4 40.Ndc3** now Black's last unit - his majesty himself - enters the fight on the queenside: **40...Kf8 41.Rb1 Ke7 42.Nc1 Kd7 43.N1a2 Rxb1+ 44.Nxb1 Nb3 45.Nac3 Bb4 46.Kf1 Kd6 47.Ke2 Kc5 48.Kd1 Bc8 49.Bxb3 cxb3 50.Kc1 Ba6 51.Kb2 Bf1 52.g3 Bxh3 53.Nd2**



Black's king has become too active and White is lost: **53...Bg2! 54.Kxb3** 54.Nxb3+ Kc4 55.Nd1 Kd3–+ **54...Kd4 55.Nb5+ Kd3 56.Nc4 Kxe4 57.d6 Bh3**

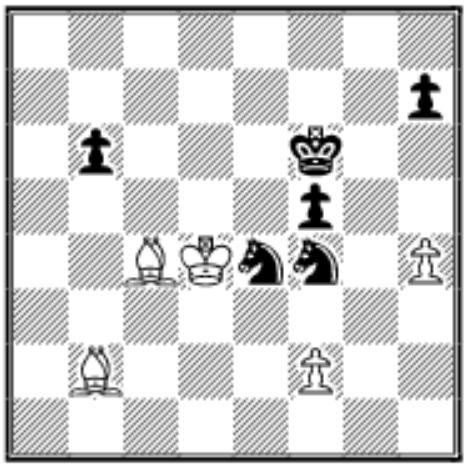


White's counterplay with the d-pawn comes too late: **58.Nb6** 58.g4 Bxg4 59.Nc3+ Kd4 60.Nb5+ Kc5 61.Nxe5 Be6+ 62.Kb2 Kd5 63.d7 Be7–+ **58...Be6+! 59.Kc2 Bc5 60.Na8 Bxf2 61.Nac7 Bf5 0–1**

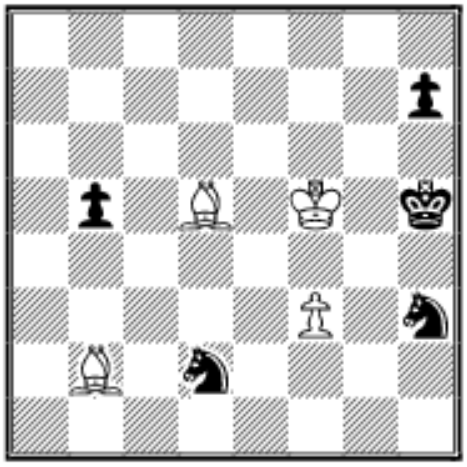


12.02 *A.Rustemov* (2620) - *I.Sokolov* (2659) Dos Hermanas Internet KO ICC Internet 2001

Rustemov plays on despite his pawn deficit. A brave decision! **35.Bh1!?** Fritz naturally prefers 35.Bxd5+ Rxd5 36.Rxb6 with total equality **35...Ne2+ 36.Kf1 Nec3 37.Rb3 Ne4 38.Rd3 Rd7** (38...Kf7!?) **39.g4 Ndf6 40.Rxd7 Nxd7 41.gxf5 gxf5 42.Ke2 Kf7 43.Ke3 Ndf6 44.Bf3 Ke6 45.Be2 Nd5+ 46.Kd4 Nf4?! 47.Bc4+ Kf6 48.Bb2**

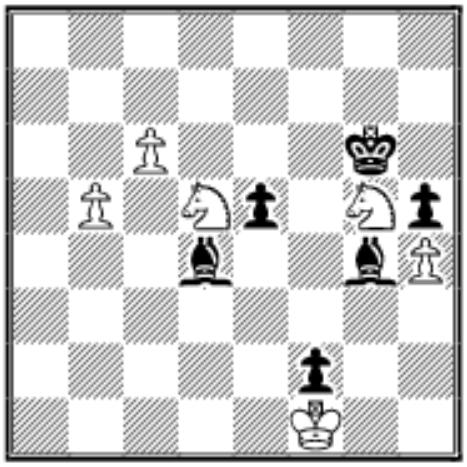


Black has to be careful now as the bishops form a powerful attacking force **48...Kg6?!** Of course not 48...Nxf2?? 49.Ke3++-, but 48...Ng2 was called for. **49.Ke5 Nh3 50.f3 Nd2 51.Bd5 b5 52.h5+ Kxh5 53.Kxf5**



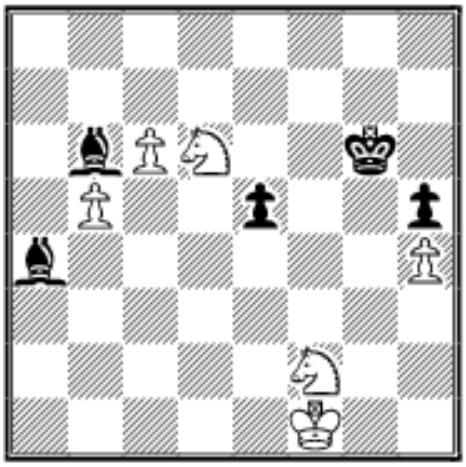
Now Sokolov has to defend very well to hold on **53...Kh4?!** 53...Ng1 54.f4 Ne2= **54.Bc3 Nc4?** The decisive error. 54...Nf1! was the only move to save Black's skin, e.g., 55.Be1+ Kh5 56.Bf7+ Kh6 57.Be8 Ne3+ 58.Kf6 Nf4 59.Bxb5 Kh5 60.Bd2 Kh4 61.Ke5 Ng6+ 62.Ke4 Ng2=. 54...Nxf3? 55.Bxf3 is lost for Black as the pawnless endgame 2 bishops vs knight is always won. **55.Be1+ Kh5 56.Bf7+ Kh6 57.Kf6 Ng5** 57...Nf4 loses due to 58.Bxc4 Nh5+ (58...bxc4 59.Bd2 Kh5 60.Bxf4 Kh4 61.Bg5+ Kg3 62.f4 Kg4 63.f5 c3 64.Bh6 c2 65.Ke6+-) 59.Kf7 bxc4 60.Bd2++- **58.Be8 Nxf3?** allows a nice mate. But even after 58...Nd6 59.Bc6 Ngf7 60.Bb4+- Black is completely tied down. **59.Bb4 Nce5 60.Bf8# 1–0**

But the bishops do not always win:



12.03 *Zaw Win Lay* (2633) - *J.Ehlvest* (2622) Japfa Classic Bali 2000

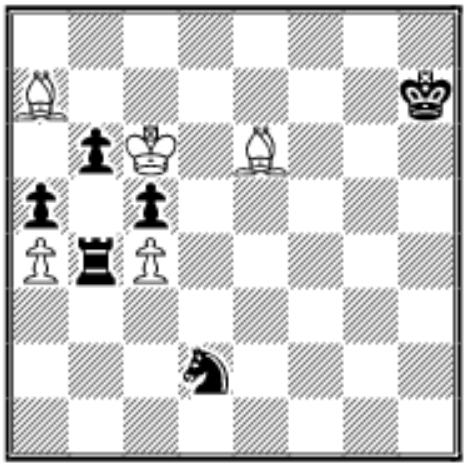
Ehlvest played too optimistically and even lost the game: **51...Kh6?** 51...e4! was called for: 52.Nf4+ Kf5 53.Ne2 Bb6 54.Ng3+ Kf4 55.N3xe4 Ke3 56.Nxf2 Be2+ 57.Kg2 Bxb5 58.Nfe4 Bxc6 59.Kh3= **52.Nf6! Bd1?** 52...Bf5! was a better chance to fight on although White is clearly better after 53.Nfe4 Kg7 54.Nxf2 Kf6 55.Ke2 Bb6 56.Nfe4+. Of course not 52...Bb6? 53.Nxg4+ hxg4 54.Ne6+- **53.Nfe4?!** makes the win very complicated. 53.c7? surprisingly only leads to a draw: 53...Bc2! 54.Nf7+ Kg7 55.Nxh5+ Kxf7 56.Ng3 Bd3+ 57.Ne2 Bf5 58.Nxd4 exd4 59.Kxf2 (59.b6 Bc8 60.Kxf2 Kg6 61.Ke2 Ba6+ 62.Kd2 Kh5=) 59...Ke7 60.b6 Kd7 61.h5 Kc6 62.h6 Kb7 63.Ke2 d3+ 64.Kd2 Bh7=, but 53.Ng8+! wins on the spot: 53...Kg6 (53...Kg7 54.Ne6+ Kxg8 55.Nxd4+-) 54.Ne7+ Kf6 55.Nd5+ Kg6 56.Ne6 Ba7 57.b6+- **53...Ba4** 53...Bb3 54.Nd2 Bc2 55.Kg2 Be3 56.Nf7+ Kh7 (56...Kg7 57.Nd6+-) 57.Nd6 Bb6 58.N6c4+- **54.Nf7+ Kg6 55.Nfd6 Bb6 56.Nxf2**



56...Kf6? 56...Bc7! was a tougher defence. But White is winning nevertheless. One sample line runs: 57.Nfe4 Bc2 58.Ke2 Bb3 59.Ne8 Bc4+ 60.Kf3 Bxb5 61.Nxc7 Bxc6 62.Ke3 Kf5 63.Nf2+- **57.c7! Bxc7 58.Ne8+ Ke7 59.Nxc7 Kd7 60.b6 Kc6?!** 60...Bb3 61.Ke2 Kc6 62.Ne8 Kxb6 63.Nd3+- **61.Nd5 Bb3 62.Nd3** and Ehlvest resigned due to

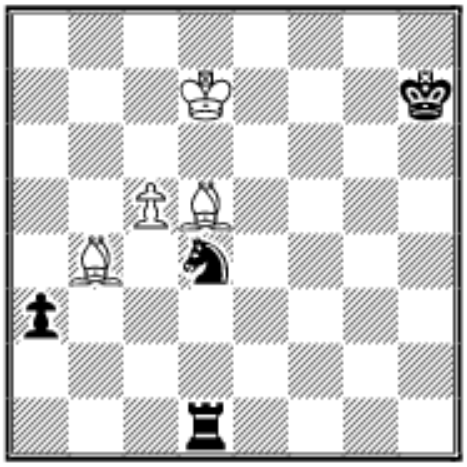
62...Bc4 63.Kf2 e4 64.N3f4+-

Another famous question is whether the bishop pair is as strong as rook + knight in the endgame:



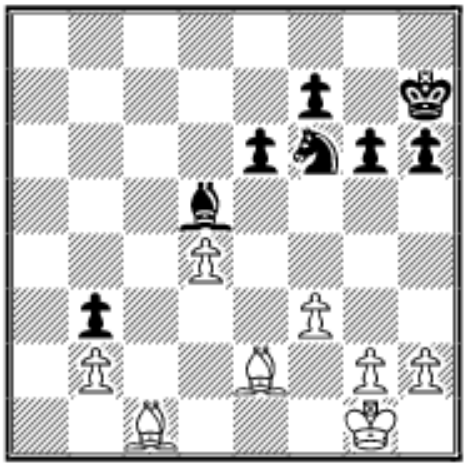
12.04 *B.Spassky* (2560) - *R.J.Fischer* (2785) Sveti Stefan/Belgrade match 1992

White's activity is not enough compensation for his material deficit: **50...Nb3?** 50...Nxc4! was called for: 51.Bxc4 Rxc4 52.Bxb6 Rxa4 53.Kxc5 Ra2 54.Kc4 a4–+ (Ftacnik in CBM 31) **51.Bd5! Rxa4** 51...Nd4+ 52.Kc7= **52.Bxb6 Ra1 53.Bxc5 a4** 53...Nxc5 54.Kxc5 a4 55.Kd6 a3 56.c5 Rd1 57.c6 a2 58.c7 a1Q 59.c8Q Qf6+ 60.Qe6= (Ftacnik) **54.Bb4 a3 55.c5 Nd4+ 56.Kd7 Rd1**



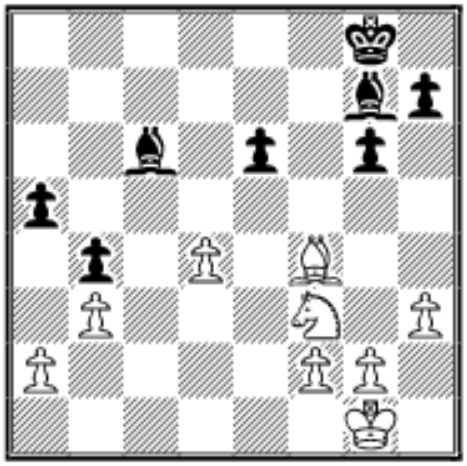
57.Bxa3! Nc2 57...Nb5 58.Bb4! (58.c6? Rxd5+ 59.Ke6 Rd1–+) 58...Rxd5+ 59.Kc6 Rd8 60.Kxb5= **58.c6 Rxd5+** 58...Nxa3 59.c7 Rxd5+ 60.Ke7 Rc5 61.Kd8= **59.Bd6 ½–½**

I want to end this column with two games, where Einar Gausel managed to save inferior positions:



12.05 *J.Nilssen* (2333) - *E.Gausel* (2520) Nordic Championships Bergen 2001

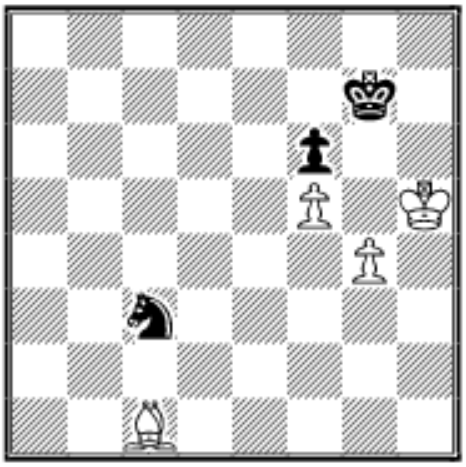
36...Nd7 37.Kf2 Nb6 38.Ke3 Bc6 39.Ba6 g5 40.Kd3 f5 41.Kc3 Bd5 42.Kb4 Kg6 43.Bb5 Kf6 44.Kc5 Nc8 45.Bc4 Ne7 46.Bxd5 Nxd5 47.Kc4 Ke7 48.Kxb3 Kd6 49.Kc4 Kc6 50.Bd2 Nb6+ 51.Kd3 Kd5 52.h4 Nc4 53.hxg5 hxg5 54.Bc3 f4 55.b3 Nd6 56.Ba5 Nf5 57.Bd8 Nxd4 58.Bxg5 Nxb3 59.Bxf4 Nd4 60.Bg5 e5 61.Be3 Nf5 62.Bf2 Nd6 63.Ke2 Nf5 64.g4 Ne7 65.Be3 Ng6 66.Bg5 Ke6 67.Kf2 Kd5 68.Bc1 Ke6 69.Kg3 Kf6 70.Bh6 Ke6 71.Bg5 Kd6 72.Kf2 Ke6 73.Ke3 Kd5 74.Kd3 Nf8 75.Kc3 Ne6 76.Be3 Nf8 ½–½



12.06 *F.Christenson* (2218) - *E.Gausel* (2520) ch-NOR Kristiansund 2001

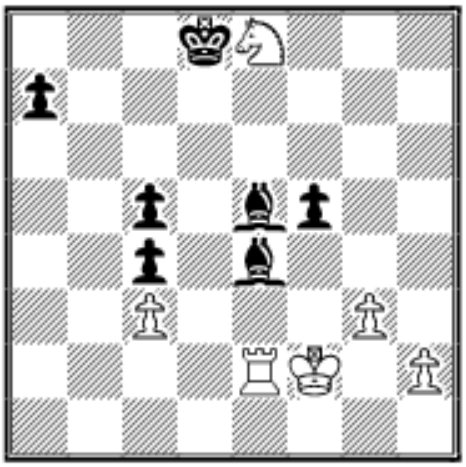
38.Bc7 a4 39.Bd6 axb3 40.axb3 Bd5 41.Bxb4 Bxb3 42.Bd6 Bd5 43.Be5 Bxf3 44.gxf3 Bf8 45.Kf1 Kf7 46.f4 Be7 47.Ke2 Bb4 48.Ke3 Be7 49.Ke4 Bb4 50.Kf3 Be7 51.Kg3 Bd8 52.Kf3 Be7 53.Ke4 Bb4 54.Bc7 Be7 55.Bb6 Bd6 56.Bd8 Bb8 57.f3 ½–½

Exercises (Solutions next month)



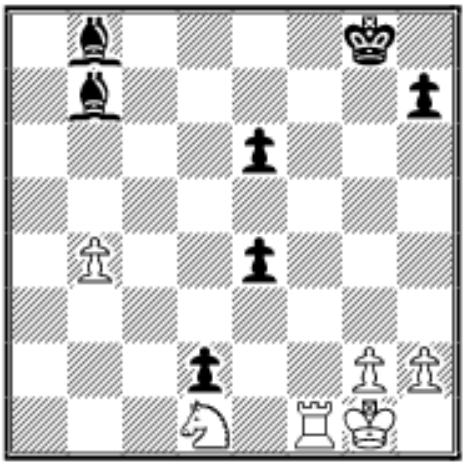
E12.01 *Ki.Georgiev* (2676) - *R.Rabiega* (2517) 2nd IECC Ohrid 2001

Rabiega's last move was somewhat careless. How did Kiril Georgiev exploit it? (Earlier in the game White had the pair of bishops.)



E12.02 *S.Volkov* (2558) - *R.Ponomariov* (2673) 2nd IECC Ohrid 2001

Ponomariov found an amazing move to demonstrate the superiority of his bishops.



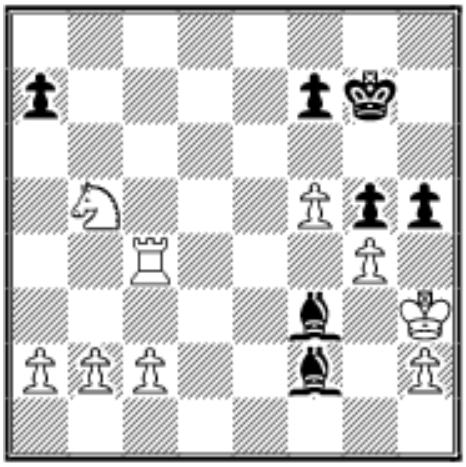
E12.03 *C.Lutz* (2600) - *A.Morozevich* (2625) Elista (ol) 1998

How to assess the position with Black to move? What about White to move?



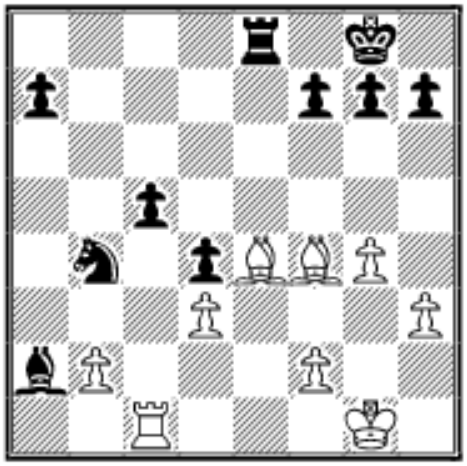
E12.04 G.Kasparyan *Revista Romana de Sah* 1978, 1st hon. mention

White to move and draw.



E12.05 *M.Bier* - *E.Flechsig* Leipzig 1879

Black is to move. Which of the following is true:
A) Black is better, the only real questions is whether he can convert his advantage.
B) Black can force a draw.
C) White is better.



E12.06 *R.Fischer* (2785) - *B.Spassky* (2560) Sveti Stefan/Belgrade match 1992

How to assess the position with White to move?

Solutions to last month exercises



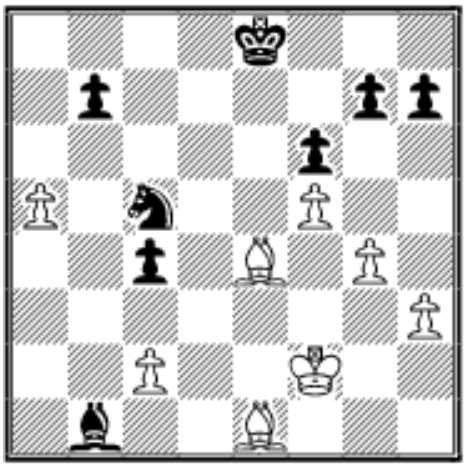
E11.01 *V.Kramnik* (2740) - *V.Topalov* (2725) Novgorod 1997

Kramnik won very quickly: **40.Bc4!** aiming at Black's Achilles' heel, the knight on f7. After other moves, Black can fight on, e.g., 40.Rd7? Rxd7 41.cxd7 Ke7; 40.Bd8? Nxd8 41.Rxd8 Bc7; 40.Bb4? Re8 41.Rd7 Rb8 and 40.Rc1? Bc7 **40...f4** (40...Nd6 41.Bd8! Nxc4 42.Rd7+- (Huzman in CBM 60); 40...Bc7 41.Bb4+- look at the powerful white bishops!; 40...Re8 41.c7 Rc8 42.Rd7 Nd6 43.Ba6+-) **41.Rd7 1–0**



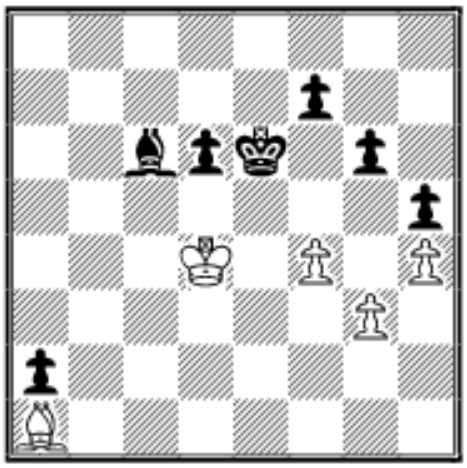
E11.02 *V.Anand* (2794) - *V.Kramnik* (2797) Mainz Chess Classics Champions duel 2001

Kramnik turned the tables with **25...g3!! 26.Nf1** 26.fxg3 Bc5+ 27.Rd4 Bxd4+ 28.Bxd4 Rd8–+ **26...gxf2+ 27.Kh2** 27.Kg2 Rg8+ 28.Kf3 Bxc4 29.Ba3 Bxa3 30.Rxg8 Bxf1 31.Kxf2 Bc4–+ **27...Bxc4 0–1**



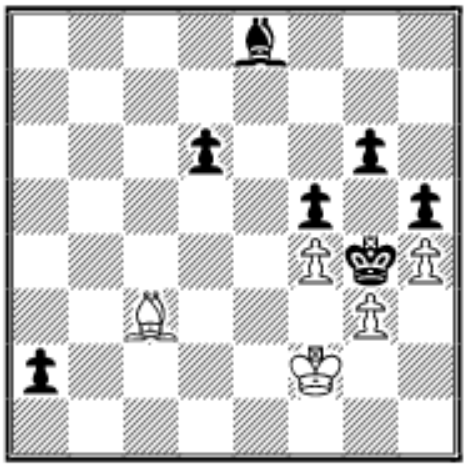
E11.03 *V.Anand* (2725) - *J.Lautier* (2645) London PCA-Intel GP 1995

The following motif is worth remembering: **34.Bxb7!! Kd7** 34...Nxb7? 35.a6 Kd7 36.a7+- **35.Bb4 Kc7** The bishop is still poisoned: 35...Nxb7 36.a6 Kc7 37.a7+- as the unfortunate knight hinders his own king. **36.Bd5 Na6 37.c3** 37.Bf8 g6 38.g5 wins as well. **37...Nxb4 38.cxb4 c3 39.Ke3 Kd6 40.Bf3** 40.a6 Kxd5 41.a7+- **40...h5 41.a6 1–0**



E11.04 *K.Bischoff* (2533) - *A.Khalifman* (2690) Bundesliga 2000/01 Plauen-Porz

Alexander Khalifman demonstrated superb technique: **52...Kf5 53.Ke3 Kg4 54.Kf2 f5 55.Bb2 Be8 56.Bc3**



and now dealt the decisive blow: **56...g5!!** Bischoff resigned as he can't prevent the creation of a third black passed pawn, destroying his fortress: **57.fxg5** 57.hxg5 h4 58.gxh4 Kxf4 59.Bf6 Ke4 60.Ba1 d5 61.Bb2 Bh5 62.Ba1 d4 63.Bb2 f4–+ **57...f4 58.gxf4 Kxh4 59.Kf3** 59.Bf6 Kg4–+ **59...Bg6 60.Bf6 Kh3–+**

Sources:
Secrets of Modern Chess Strategy, John Watson, GAMBIT 1998.
ChessBase MEGABASE 2000
No Regrets, Fischer-Spassky 1992, Yasser Seirawan and George Stefanovic, ICE, Seattle 1992
The Complete Studies of Genrikh Kasparyan, John Roycroft ed., Russell Enterprises 1997
ChessBase Magazine 31
The Week in Chess

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



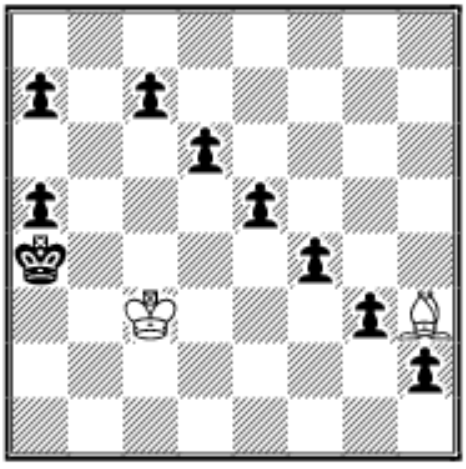
Bishop vs Pawns

Part 1

The value of the bishop as long range piece is quite high in a pure ending - especially zugzwang is a very sharp weapon. Of course sometimes it is not easy to win (or even to draw) against dangerous passed pawns in a blocked position or because of problems caused by having a wrong rook's pawn. I start with a very important theme:

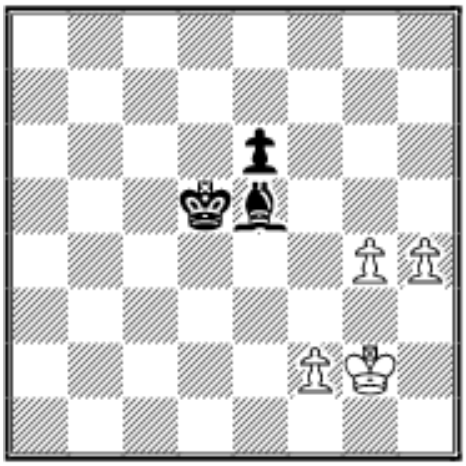
A) The Principle of One Diagonal

If the bishop has all its duties on one diagonal, it will never fall into zugzwang and can't be diverted. It can become a real ruler of the board and tame a hord of 8 pawns:



13.01 Loyd, 1868

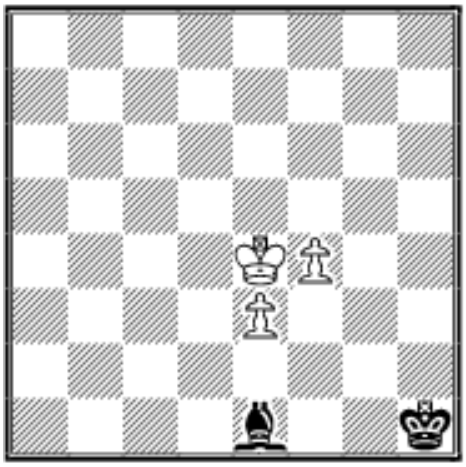
1.Bd7+ Ka3 2.Bc6 a4 3.Bh1 c5 4.Bd5 a5 5.Bh1 Ka2 6.Kc2 Ka3 7.Kc3= Black can't make any meaningful progress.



B) Pawns on One Wing/Few Pawns

13.02 *Y.Pelletier* (2474) - *A.Galkin* (2587) MTO Open Biel 2000

Black has to penetrate with his king first so as not to risk the exchange of his last pawn: **43...Ke4! 44.f3+ Ke3 45.g5 Kf4 46.Kf2 Bh8 47.Ke2** (47.Kg2 Bd4 48.g6 Kf5 49.Kh3 Kxg6 50.Kg4 Bf6 51.h5+ Kh6 52.f4 Be7 53.f5 e5–+) **47...Kg3** and Pelletier resigned due to **48.Ke3 Kxh4 49.f4 Kg4 50.Ke4 Bg7 51.Ke3 Kf5 52.Kf3 Bf8 53.Ke3 Bd6–+**



13.03 *Xu Jun* (2668) - *A.Onichuk* (2627) Tan Chin Nam Cup 6th Beijing 2000

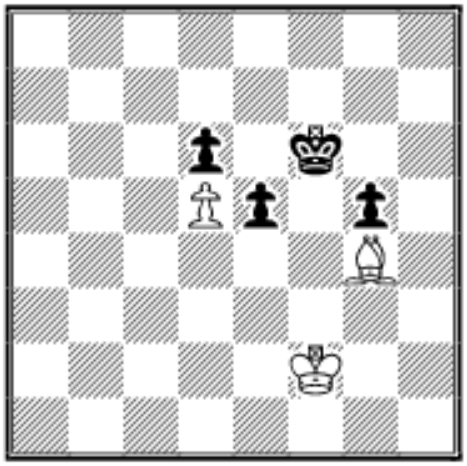
When fighting enemy pawns, the bishop is also very strong (with a knight on e1 Black would be lost): **81.Kf3** 81.f5 Kg2 82.f6 Bh4

A) 83.Kf5 Kf3 (even 83...Bxf6 is possible.) 84.f7 (84.e4 Bxf6=) 84...Be7 85.e4 Ke3!=

B) 83.f7 Be7 84.Kf4 Kf2 85.e4 Ke2 86.e5 Kd3 87.Kf5 Kd4 88.Ke6 Bf8 89.Kf6 Kd5 90.e6 Kd6= **81...Kh2!** Onichuk improves the slower king first, which is of crucial importance. After 81...Bd2? 82.e4 Kh2 White can shoulder Black's king away: 83.Kg4! Kg2 84.e5 Bc3 85.e6 Bf6 86.f5 Kf2 87.Kh5+- **82.f5** (82.e4 Kh3 83.e5 Kh4 84.e6 Bb4=; 82.Kg4!? was worth trying as Black's king now has to take the long route through the centre: 82...Kg2 83.e4 Kf2 84.e5

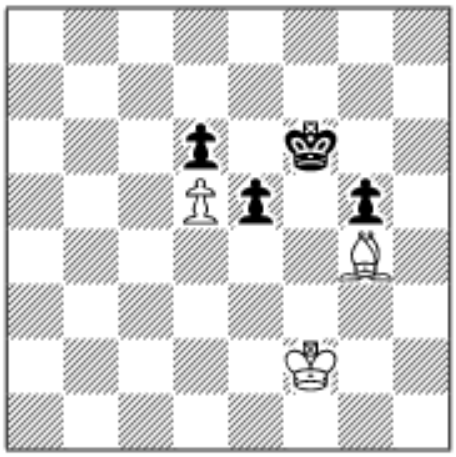
Ke3 85.f5 Bc3 (85...Ke4? 86.e6 Bb4 87.f6+-) 86.e6 Bf6 87.Kh5 Kf4 88.Kg6 Ke5=) **82...Kh3 83.f6 Kh4 84.Kf4 Kh5 85.Kf5 Kh6 86.e4 Kh7 87.Ke6** (87.e5 Kg8 88.e6 Bb4 89.Kg6 Kf8=) **87...Kg6 88.e5 Bb4 ½–½**

The next example is taken from Pal Benko's excellent book *Chess Endgame Lessons*:



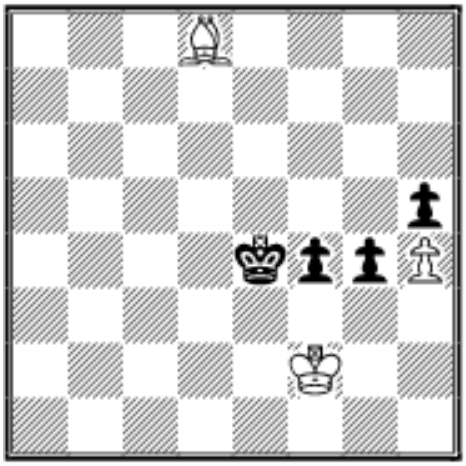
13.04 *A.Strojevs* - *M.Deschamps* New York Open 1990

1...e4! Otherwise Black is dead lost, e.g., 1...Kg6? 2.Kf3 Kf6 3.Ke4 Kg6 4.Be2 Kf6 5.Bh5 Kg7 6.Kf5 Kh6 7.Bf3+- **2.Be6 Ke5 3.Ke3 g4 4.Bg8 g3 5.Be6 Kf6** 5...g2 6.Kf2 Kd4 draws as well. **6.Bd7 Ke5 7.Bc6 Kf6 8.Ba4 Ke5 9.Bb3 Kf5?** A fatal error allowing White's bishop to win the e-pawn with check. 9...g2 10.Kf2 Kd4 11.Kxg2 Ke3 12.Kf1 Kd4 13.Ke2 e3 14.Kd1 Ke4 15.Ke2 Kd4= and 9...Kf6 draw. **10.Bc2! Ke5** (10...g2 11.Bxe4++-) **11.Bxe4 Kf6 12.Kf4 Ke7 13.Kxg3 1–0** In the next position the defender misses the draw again:



13.05 *K.Stefanov* (2378) - *I.Manolov* (2331) TCh-BUL Pamporovo 2001

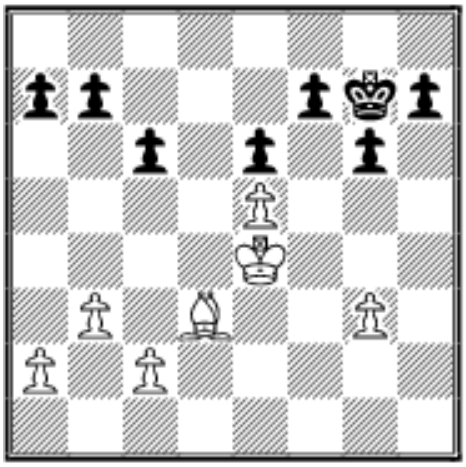
53.Kf2 sidestepping g5-g4+ **53...Ke4 54.Bd8 g4 55.h4** White has to keep his h-pawn in order to preserve his winning chances.



Black can now draw by adopting a sit-and-wait policy, but instead he rushes forward: **55...g3+?** 55...Kd3 56.Bc7 Ke4 and White can't make progress as 57.Ke2 Kf5 58.Kd3 allows 58...g3=; 55...f3 is playable as well. **56.Kg2 Ke3 57.Bb6+ Ke4 58.Ba7** By using zugzwang White forces Black to give ground: **58...Kf5 59.Kf3 g2 60.Bf2 Ke5** and Black resigned, as all his pawn's will fall prey to White's king, e.g., **61.Kxg2 Ke4 62.Bg1 f3+ 63.Kg3 Ke5 64.Kxf3 Kf5 65.Bd4 Kg6 66.Kf4 Kh6 67.Kf5 Kh7 68.Kg5+-**

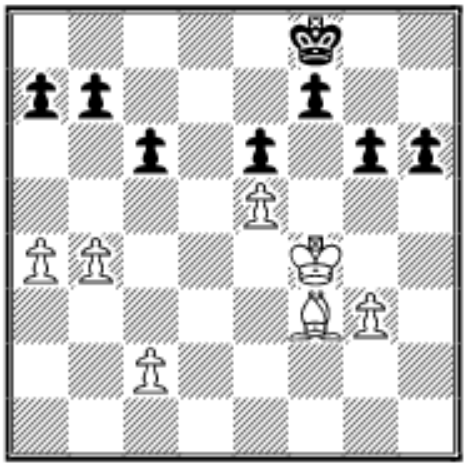
C) Blocked Positions

In positions with many pawns, the bishop sometimes has a problem finding targets:

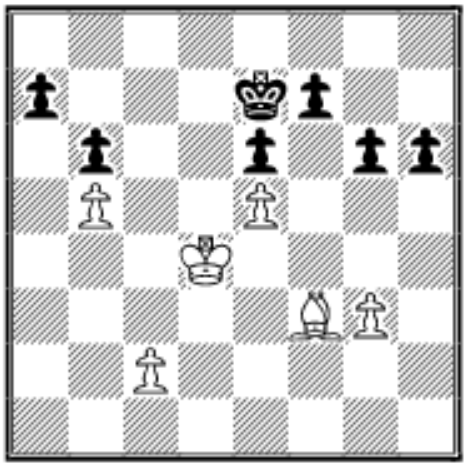


13.06 *E.Schiller* (2200) - *S.Nath* (1742) US Open 1996

White has to be careful to prevent Black from constructing a fortress: **1...Kh6 2.Kf4 Kh5 3.Be2+ Kh6 4.b4 Kg7 5.a4 h6 6.Bf3 Kf8**



7.b5? 7.a5! a6 (7...Ke7 8.a6 bxa6 9.Bxc6+-) 8.b5 axb5 9.Bxc6+- was the right way to proceed as Pal Benko showed in *Chess Endgame Lessons*. **7...cxb5 8.axb5?** Again 8.a5! was correct, e.g., 8...b6 9.axb6 axb6 10.Ke3 Ke7 11.Kd4 f6 12.exf6+ Kxf6 13.Kc3 Kf5 14.Kb4 e5 (14...Ke5 15.c3 Kd6 16.Kxb5 Kc7 17.c4+-) 15.Kxb5 e4 16.Be2 g5 17.Kxb6 h5 18.Bxh5 g4 19.Be8 e3 20.Bd7+ Kg5 21.Bb5 Kf5 22.Be2+- **8...b6!** Now Black's castle is watertight. **9.Ke4 Ke7 10.Kd4**



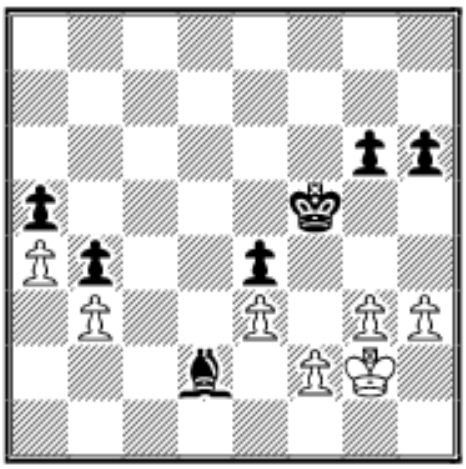
10...f5?? Opening the position proves fatal. Black has to sit inside the walls of his fortress as Pal Benko has demonstrated, e.g., 10...Kd7 11.Ke3 Ke7 12.Kf4 Kd7 13.g4 Ke7 14.g5 h5 15.Kg3 Kd7 16.Kh4 Ke7 17.Bxh5 Kd7 (17...gxh5? 18.Kxh5 Kf8 19.Kh6 Kg8 20.g6 fxg6 21.Kxg6+-) 18.Bf3 Ke7 19.Kg3 Kd7 20.Kf4 Ke7 21.Ke3 Kd7 22.Kd4 Ke7 23.c4 Kd7 24.c5 Ke7 25.Bc6 Kd8 26.Kc4 Ke7 27.Be4 Kd7 28.c6+ Kc7= **11.exf6+ Kxf6 12.c4 e5+** (12...Kf5 13.Be4+ Kf6 14.Bd3 h5 15.Bc2 g5 16.Bd1 h4 (16...g4 17.Bc2 e5+ 18.Kd5+-; 16...e5+ 17.Kd5 h4 18.g4 h3 19.Bf3+-) 17.gxh4 gxh4 18.Bg4 Kg5 19.Bxe6 Kf4 20.Kd5+-) **13.Kd5 Kf5 14.Be4+ Kf6 15.Kc6 Kg5 16.Kb7 Kg4 17.Bxg6 Kxg3 18.Kxa7 Kf4 19.Bh5 e4 20.c5 1–0**

Eingorn managed to save his skin using a similar defensive technique in the following example:



13.07 *V.Eingorn* (2597) - *M.Bobrowska* (2417) Bank Pocztowy Open Bydgoszcz 2000

Black's position is clearly superior due to the activity of his rook: **33...Rc1+! 34.Kg2!?** After 34.Nf1?! Rb1 35.Rxa5 Rxb3 White's position is very awkward, e.g., 36.Kg2 (36.Rb5 Bc3 37.a5 Ra3 38.Rc5 Ra2 39.g4 Be1–+) 36...Rd3 37.Rc5 b3 38.Rc1 b2 39.Rb1 Ra3 40.Nd2 Rxa4–+ **34...Rd1** The pin seems to be deadly, but Eingorn has prepared a nice trick **35.Rd7! Bc3?!** It was easier to preserve the f-pawn with 35...h5!?, e.g., 36.Rd6 (36.g4 hxg4 37.hxg4 Kh6 38.g5+ Kh7 39.Kg3 Be5+ 40.f4 Bc3 41.Rxf7+ Kg8 42.Rd7 Rxd2 43.Rxd2 Bxd2 44.Kf2 Kf7–+) 36...Be5 37.Rd7 Kg7 38.Rd5 Bc3 39.Rd7 Rxd2 40.Rxd2 Bxd2 41.Kf1 f5 42.Ke2 Bc3 43.Kf1 (43.h4 g5 44.hxg5 Kg6–+) 43...h4 44.Kg2 Kh6 45.Kf1 Kh5 46.Kg2 Be1–+ **36.Rxf7+ Kg8 37.Rd7! Rxd2!** After 37...Bxd2? White should be able to save himself. One sample line runs: 38.f3 Rb1 39.Rxd2 Rxb3 40.fxe4 Ra3 41.Rd7 Rxa4 42.Rb7 Ra3 43.Kf3 b3 44.e5 a4 45.e6 Kf8 46.Kf4= **38.Rxd2 Bxd2 39.Kf1 Kf7 40.Kg2 Ke6 41.Kf1 Kf5 42.Kg2**

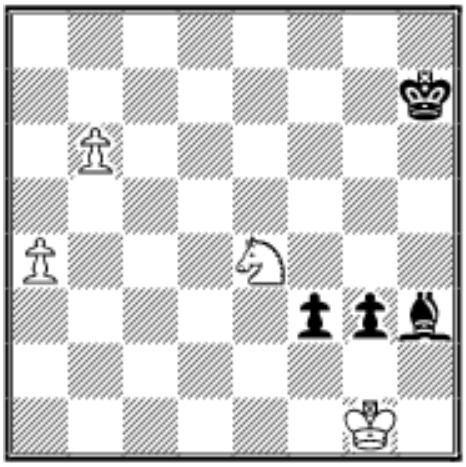


42...h5? Now the position is indeed drawn. Black can smoke out White's fortress as follows: 42...Kg5 43.Kf1 Kh5 44.Kg2 g5 45.Kh2 (45.f3 exf3+ 46.Kxf3 g4+ 47.hxg4+ Kg5 48.Ke2 Bc3 49.Kf3 Be5–+) 45...g4 46.h4 Bc3 47.Kg2 Bf6 48.Kh2 Bxh4 49.gxh4 (49.Kg2

Bf6 50.Kf1 Bc3 51.Ke2 Kg5 52.Kf1 h5 53.Kg2 h4 54.Kf1 h3 55.Kg1 Be1 56.Kf1 h2 57.Kg2 Bxf2 58.Kxh2 Bxe3–+) 49...Kxh4 50.Kg2 h5 51.Kh2 Kg5 52.Kg2 h4 53.Kh2 h3 54.Kg3 Kh5 55.Kh2 Kh4 56.Kg1 g3–+ **43.Kh2 Bc3 44.Kg2 Be5 45.Kg1** ½–½

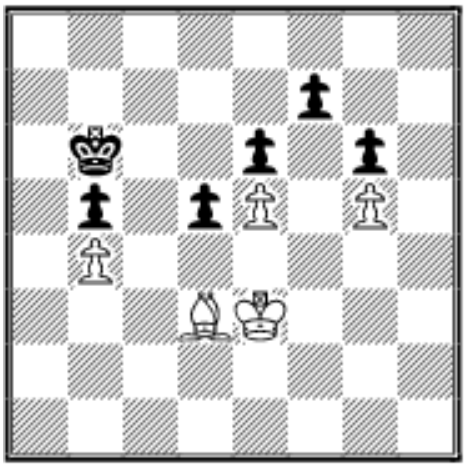
Sources:
ChessBase Magazine 73
Chess Endgame Lessons Volume 2, Pal Benko 1999.
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
The Week in Chess
The Ultimate Chess Puzzle Book, John Emms, GAMBIT 2001

Exercises (Solutions next month)



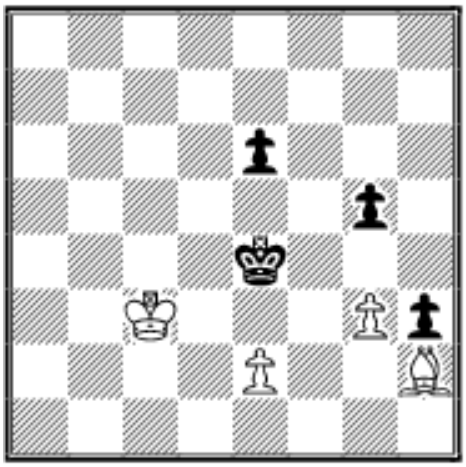
E13.01 *L.Helm - S.Germann* BL9900 (Women) Germany 2000

Can Black to move save himself?



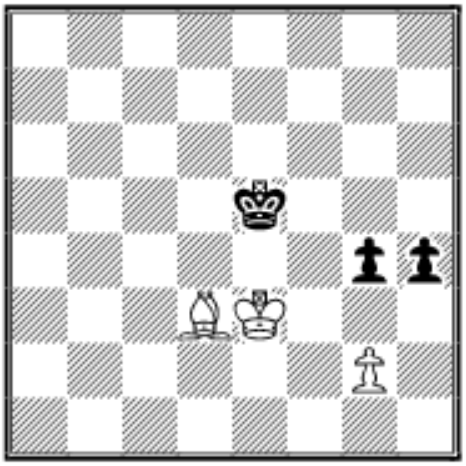
E13.02 *D.Lam - L.Chipkin* (2156) ch-New York State Rochester 2001

Can White to move convert his advantage?



E13.03 *A.Potapov* (2490) - *E.Pigusov* (2584) RUS-ch 54th Elista 2001

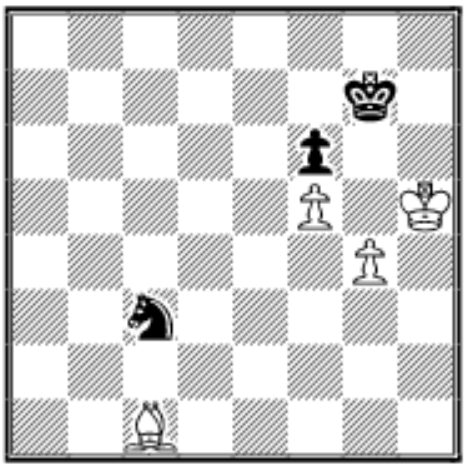
How to assess the position with Black to move?



E13.04 *H.Shehab* - *T.Moudallal* ch-LIB Beruit 2001

How to assess the position with White to move? What about Black to move?

Solutions to last month exercises

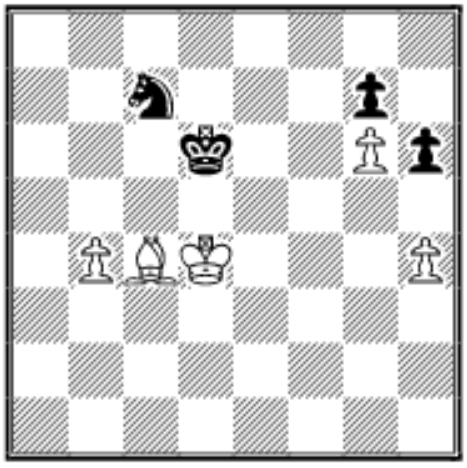


E12.01 *Ki.Georgiev* (2676) - *R.Rabiega* (2517) 2nd IECC Ohrid 2001

Georgiev seized his chance as follows: **81.g5!** (81.Bb2? Ne4!=) **81...Ne4** (81...fxg5? 82.Bb2 Kf6 83.Kg4+-; 81...Nd5 82.g6 (82.Bb2 Ne3=) 82...Ne7 83.Bh6+ Kg8 84.Kg4 Nc8 85.Be3 Nd6 86.Bc5 Nc4 87.Kh5 Kg7=) **82.g6 Ng3+?** This is the decisive mistake. After 82...Nd6 83.Bh6+ Kg8 84.Kg4 Nc8 White can't make progress, e.g. 85.Be3 Nd6 86.Bc5 (86.Kf4 Kg7 87.Ba7 Kg8 88.Bb8 Nc8 89.Bc7 Kg7 90.Bd8 Nd6 91.Ba5 Kg8 92.Bb4 Nc4 93.Ke4 Kg7 94.Bc3

Nd6+=) 86...Nc4 87.Kf4 Kg7 88.Bd4 Nd6 89.Bb6 Kg8 (89...Nc4? 90.Bc7+-) 90.Bc5 Nc4 91.Ke4 Kg7 92.Bd4 Nd6+= **83.Kg4+- Ne4** 83...Ne2 84.Bb2 Ng1 85.Kg3 Ne2+ 86.Kf3 Ng1+ 87.Ke3 Nh3 88.Bd4 Ng1 (88...Ng5 89.Kf4 Nh3+ 90.Kg4 Ng5 91.Be3 Ne4 92.Bf4+-) 89.Kf2 Nh3+ 90.Kg3 Ng5 91.Kf4 Nh3+ 92.Kg4 Ng5 93.Be3 Ne4 94.Bf4+- **84.Bf4 Nc3 85.Kf3 Nd5 86.Bd6!** (86.Ke4? Ne7=) **86...Nc3** After 86...Nb6 one sample line runs: 87.Ke4 Nc4 88.Bc7 Nd2+ 89.Ke3 Nc4+ 90.Kd3 Na3 91.Bd6 Nb5 92.Be7 Na7 93.Ke4 Nb5 94.Kd5 Nc3+ 95.Ke6 Ne4 96.Ba3 Ng3 97.Bb2 Nh5 98.Ke7+- **87.Ke3 Nd1+** 87...Nb5 88.Bb4 Kh8 (88...Nc7 89.Kd4 Ne8 90.Be7 Kg8 91.Ke4 Kh8 92.Kd5+-) 89.Ke4 Kg8 90.Be7 Nc3+ 91.Kd3 Nd5 92.Bd6 Nb6 93.Kd4 Kg7 94.Kc5 Na4+ 95.Kc4 Nb6+ 96.Kd4 Na4 97.Bc5 Nb2 98.Ba7 Na4 99.Kc4 Nb2+ 100.Kc3 Na4+ 101.Kb3+- finally the brave knight can't escape any more! **88.Kd4 Nf2 89.Bf4 Kg8 90.Be3 Ng4 91.Bf4 Nf2 92.Kd5 Kg7 93.Ke6 Ne4** 93...Ng4 94.Bd6 Nf2 95.Be5 Ne4 (95...fxe5 96.f6+ Kxg6 97.f7 Kg7 98.Ke7+-) 96.Bb2+- **94.Be3 Ng3** (94...Kg8 95.Bh6+-) **95.Bd4** and Rabiega resigned due to **95...Nh5 96.Ke7 Nf4 97.Bxf6+ Kg8** (97...Kh6 98.g7 Kh7 99.Kf7+-) **98.Bh8 Nd5+ 99.Kd7 Nf4 100.Be5 Nd3 101.Ke6+-**

The following game features a similar fight of a brave knight:



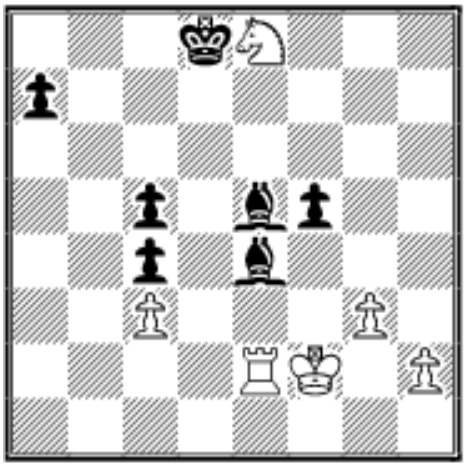
E12.01A *T.Radjabov* (2558) - *H.Mecking* (2552) Miguel Najdorf Memorial Buenos Aires 2001

Is this ending won for White? **42...Na8 43.Bb3 Nb6 44.Bf7 Nd7 45.Bd5 Nb6 46.Be4 Nd7 47.Kc4 Nf6 48.Bf3 Nd7 49.Kb5 Ne5 50.Be4 Nd7**

51.Bb1 Nf6 52.Ba2 Nd7 53.Bf7 Ne5 54.Kb6 Nf3 55.h5 Nd4 56.Kb7 Kd7 57.Bd5 Kd6 58.Be4 Kd7 59.Bd3 Kd8 60.Kb6 Kd7 61.Bb5+ Kd6 62.Ba4 Ne6 63.Kb7 Nd4 64.Kc8 Ke7 65.Kc7 Ne6+ 66.Kc6 Nd4+ 67.Kd5 Ne6 68.Ke5 Nc7 69.Bc6 Ne6 70.b5 Nd8 71.Bd5 Kd7 72.b6 Ke7 73.Be4 Kd7 74.Bg2 Ke7 75.Bh3 Nb7 76.Kd5 Nd8 I can prove, that White wins after 76...Nd6: 77.Be6 Nb7 78.Bc8

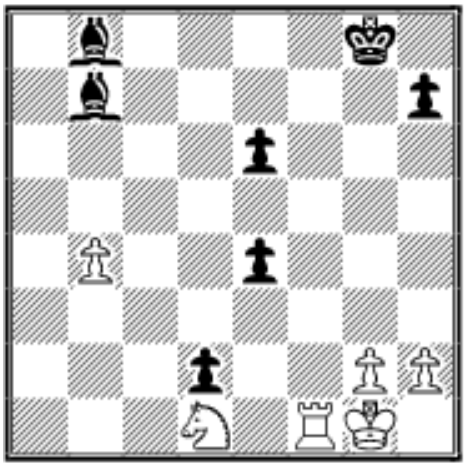
A) 78...Na5 79.Kc5 Kd8 (79...Nb3+ 80.Kc4 Nd2+ 81.Kd5 Kd8 82.Be6 Nb3 83.Kd6 Na5 84.Bd5+-) 80.Be6 Nb7+ 81.Kc6 Na5+ 82.Kb5 Nb7 83.Bd5 Nd6+ 84.Kc6 Ke7 85.Ba2+-

B) 78...Nd6 79.Kc5 Ne4+ 80.Kc6 Nd6 81.Ba6 Ke6 82.Bf1 Ke7 83.Bd3 Ke6 84.Be4 Ke7 85.Bd5+- **77.Bc8 1–0**



E12.02 *S.Volkov* (2558) - *R.Ponomariov* (2673) 2nd IECC Ohrid 2001

Ponomariov uncorked the amazing **35...Kd7!!** After 35...Kxe8? 36.g4! wins a bishop. **36.g4 Bxc3 37.gxf5 Bxf5 38.h4 Bd3 39.Ra2 Kxe8 40.Ke3 Bd4+ 41.Kd2 Bb1 42.Rxa7 c3+ 43.Kc1 Be4 0–1**



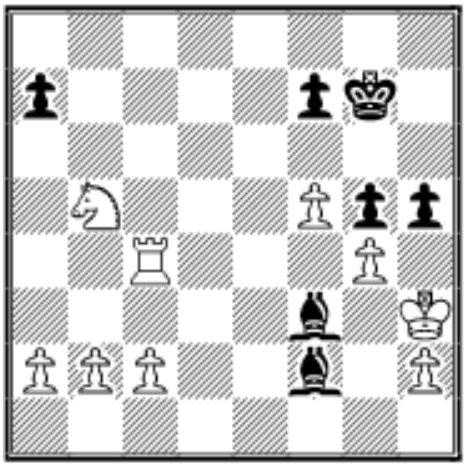
E12.03 *C.Lutz* (2600) - *A.Morozevich* (2625) Elista (ol) 1998

Morozevich's bishops wrecked havoc: **29...Ba7+ 30.Rf2** 30.Nf2 e3–+ **30...Ba6 0–1** With White to move it is completely different as his knight finds a very good square: **29.Ne3!** and White is much better.



E12.04 G.Kasparyan, Revista Romana de Sah 1978, 1st hon. mention

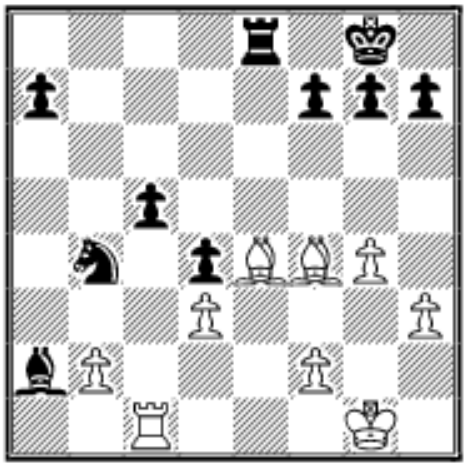
Kasparyan composed several studies with the theme 2B vs R+2N underlining the power of the bishop pair on an open board: **1.Kf7 Rxc6 2.Bg5+** (2.Bxb8? Rb6–+) **2...Kc7** (2...Kc8 3.Be6+ Nd7 4.Ke7 Rc7 5.Be3=) **3.Bf4+ Kc8 4.Be6+ Nd7 5.Ke7 Nab6 6.Be3 Kc7 7.Bf4+ Kc8 8.Be3=**



E12.05 *M.Bier - E.Flechsig* Leipzig 1879

Black is better. Hübner analysed the postion extensively in CBM 41 and I have used his notes as source: **32...Kf6?** (32...Be2? 33.Kg2 Bxc4 34.Na3+-; 32...Kh6! is the right way to increase the pressure: 33.Nd6 hxg4+ 34.Rxg4 Kh5 35.Rxg5+ Kxg5 36.Nxf7+ Kxf5–+) **33.gxh5 Be2** 33...Kg7 34.Nd6 Kh6

(34...f6 35.Rg4 Kh6 36.Ne4+-) 35.Nxf7+ Kxh5 36.Ne5 Be2 37.Kg2+- **34.Kg2 Bxc4 35.Na3 Ba6 36.Kxf2 Kxf5 37.h3 Bc8 38.Nc4 Kf6 39.Kg3 Bf5 40.Ne3 Be4 41.h4 gxh4+ 42.Kxh4 Ke5 43.c3 Bb1 44.Nc4+ Kf4 45.Nd6 f6 46.h6 Bg6 47.c4 Ke5 48.c5 a5 49.Nc4+ Kd5 50.Nxa5 Kxc5 51.Nb3+ Kc4 52.Kg4 1–0**



E12.06 *R.J.Fischer* (2785) - *B.Spassky* (2560) Sveti Stefan/Belgrade 1992

Fischer reached a solid advantage with **25.Bd2!** The automatic 25.Rxc5? only leads to an equal position after 25...Bb1= **25...Bd5** (25...Na6? 26.Ra1+-; 25...Rc8?? 26.Bxb4+-) **26.Bxd5 Nxd5 27.Rxc5** as his pieces are more active and the bishop is better than the knight. The game went: **27...Nb6 28.Kf1 f6 29.Ra5 Re7 30.Bb4 Rd7 31.Bc5 Kf7 32.Ke2 g5?! 33.Kf3 Kg6 34.Ke4 h5 35.Bxd4 Re7+ 36.Kf3 h4 37.Bc5 Re1 38.Rxa7 Nd5 39.Bf8 Re8 40.Bd6 Re6 41.Rd7 Nb6 42.Rd8 Nd5 43.b4 Re1 44.b5 Rb1 45.Rb8 Rb3 46.Ke4 Nc3+ 47.Kd4 Nxb5+ 48.Kc4 Rc3+ 49.Kxb5 Rxd3 50.Kc6 Rxh3 51.Kd5 Rf3 52.Ke6 Rxf2 53.Rg8+ Kh7 54.Kf7 Ra2 55.Rg7+ Kh6 56.Bf8 Ra7+ 57.Kxf6 Ra6+ 58.Kf7 1–0**

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



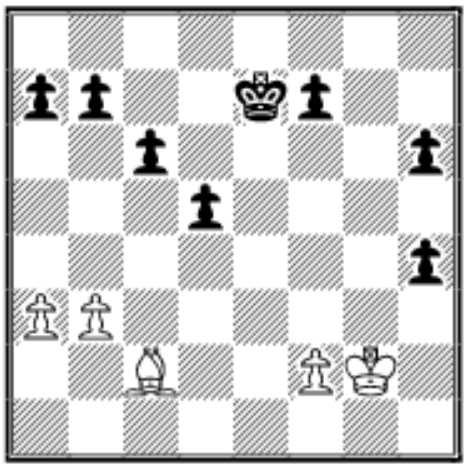
Bishop vs Pawns

Part 2

I continue the Bishop vs Pawns debate started last month (for the first part see the **ChessCafe.com Archives**):

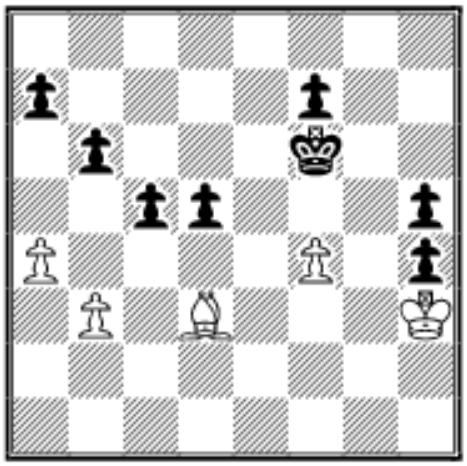
D) Pawns on Both Wings

With a lot of pawns still on the board matters can become quite complicated:



14.01 *G.Hertneck - K.Müller* Austrian Staatsliga 2001, Mozart Salzburg-Gleisdorf, 1st board

Shortly before the time control I made a big mistake: **40...Kf6?** 40...Kd6! was called for: 41.Kh3 Ke5 42.Kxh4 c5 43.a4 (43.Kh5 b5 44.Kxh6 c4 45.Kg7 d4 46.bxc4 bxc4 47.Kxf7 d3 48.Bb1 Kd4 49.f4 c3–+) 43...Kd4 44.Kh5 (44.Bd1 c4 45.bxc4 dxc4 46.Kh5 Kd3 47.Bg4 c3 48.Bf5+ Kd2 49.Kxh6 c2 50.Bxc2 Kxc2 51.f4 Kd3–+) 44...Kc3 45.Bd1 c4 46.bxc4 dxc4 47.Bf3 b6 48.Bd5 f6 49.Kxh6 a6 50.Kg6 b5 51.axb5 axb5 52.Be4 Kd2 53.Kxf6 c3–+ **41.f4!** Now Black's king is severely restricted and I had to fight hard to get a draw: **41...c5 42.Bd3 Ke6 43.a4 b6 44.Kf3 h5 45.Kg2 Kf6 46.Kh3**

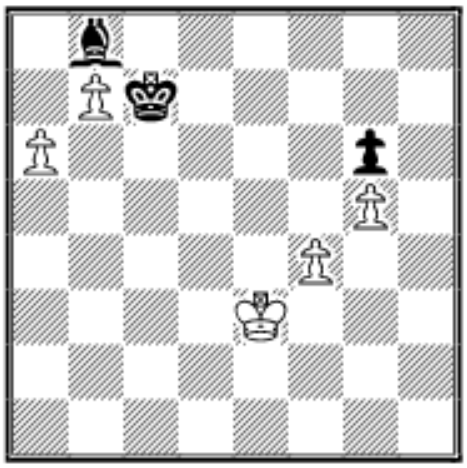


46...c4! I want to exchange as many pawns as possible, especially White's very valuable f-pawn. After 46...Kg7? White will use zugzwang to force Black back step by step, e.g., 47.Kxh4 Kh6 48.f5 f6 49.Be2 Kg7 50.Kxh5 d4 51.Bf1 Kh7 52.Kg4 Kh6 53.Kf3 Kg5 54.Ke4 Kg4 55.Bd3 a5 56.Kd5 Kf4 57.Ke6 Ke3 58.Bc4+- **47.bxc4 dxc4 48.Be4** 48.Bxc4 Kf5 49.Bxf7 Kxf4 50.Bc4 Ke5 51.Kxh4 Kd4 52.Bb5 Kc5 53.Kxh5 Kb4 54.Kg4 a6 55.Be8 b5= **48...a6 49.Kxh4 b5 50.axb5** After 50.a5?? b4 it is White who is losing:

A) 51.Bd5 c3 52.Bb3 Kf5 53.Kg3 h4+ 54.Kf3 h3 55.Bc2+ (55.Kg3 f6 56.Bc2+ Ke6 57.Kxh3 Kd5–+) 55...Ke6 56.Bb3+ Kd6 57.Kg3 Kc5 58.Kxh3 Kd4–+

B) 51.Kxh5 Ke6 52.Kg4 b3 53.Kf3 f5 54.Bb1 c3–+

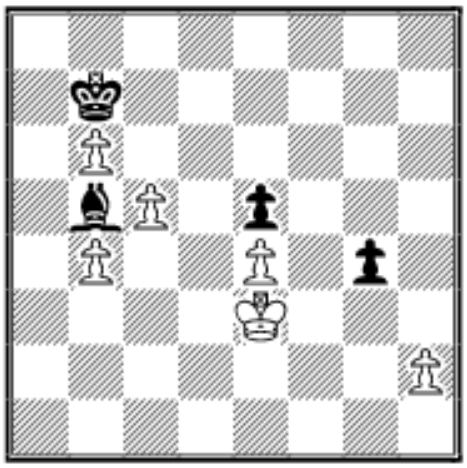
50...axb5 51.Kxh5 b4 52.Kg4 Ke6 53.Kf3 b3 54.Ke3 c3 55.Kd3 c2 56.Kd2 Kf6 57.Bd5 Kf5 58.Bxf7 Kxf4 ½–½



14.02 *H.Ilieva* (2190) - *E.Djingarova* (2235) ch-BUL Women Plovdiv 2001

White can't win despite her mighty connected passed pawns on the queenside: **58...Kd6 59.Kd4 Ba7+ 60.Ke4** 60.Kc4 isn't sufficient to win either: 60...Ke6! 61.Kb5 Kd5 and now not 62.b8Q? Bxb8 63.Kb6 (63.f5 gxf5 64.Kb6 Bf4–+)

63...Bxf4! (avoiding the trap 63...Ke4?? 64.Kb7+-) 64.a7 Be3+–+ but 62.f5 gxf5 63.g6 Ke6 64.Kc6 f4 65.Kc7 f3 66.b8Q Bxb8+ 67.Kxb8 f2 68.g7 Kf7= **60...Ke6 61.Kf3 Kf5 62.Kg3 Bb8 63.Kf3 Ke6 64.Ke4** After 64.Kg4 Black has the defence 64...Ba7 65.f5+ gxf5+ 66.Kh5 f4! (66...Kf7? 67.g6+ Kg7 68.Kg5 f4 69.Kxf4 Kxg6 70.Ke5 Kf7 71.Kd6 Ke8 72.Kc7+-) 67.g6 f3 68.Kh6 f2 69.g7 f1Q 70.g8Q+ Ke7 71.Qh7+ Qf7= **64...Ba7 65.Kf3 Kf5 ½–½**



14.03 *C.Aarefjord - H.Nordahl* (2272) Open NOR-ch Oslo 2001

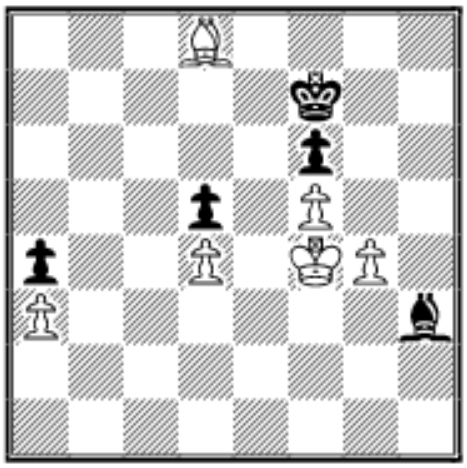
Black can win the e4-pawn but not the game: **53...Kc6** 53...Bc6!? 54.Kd3 Ka6 55.Kc4 Bxe4 56.b5+ Kb7 (56...Ka5 57.b7 Bxb7 58.c6 Bc8 59.Kc5 e4 60.b6 Ka6 61.b7 Bxb7 62.cxb7 Kxb7 63.Kd4 Kc6=) the active 57.Kb4? is now wrong: 57...Bd3 58.Ka5 Bf5 59.c6+ (59.Kb4 e4 60.Kc4 e3 61.Kc3 Bg6–+) 59...Kb8! 60.Ka6 Bc8+ 61.b7 Bxb7+ 62.Ka5 e4 63.Kb4 Bc8 64.b6 e3 65.Kc3 Bf5–+. After the correct 57.Kc3! Black can't make meaningful progress, e.g., 57...Bg6 58.Kd2 Be8 59.Ke3 Bxb5 60.Ke4 Kc6 61.Kxe5 Ba6 62.Kf4 Bc8 63.Kg3 Kxc5 64.b7= **54.Kf2 Bd3 55.Kg3 Bxe4 56.Kxg4 Kb5 57.h4 Kxb4 58.h5 Kxc5**



Until this moment White has defended accurately but now he blunders: **59.b7?** 59.Kg5 Kxb6 60.Kf6= **59...Bxb7 60.Kf5 Kd4** and White resigned due to **61.h6 Be4+ 62.Kf6 Bh7 63.Kg7 Bf5 64.Kf6 Ke4 65.Kg5 Bh7 66.Kf6 Kf4 67.Kg7 Bf5–+**

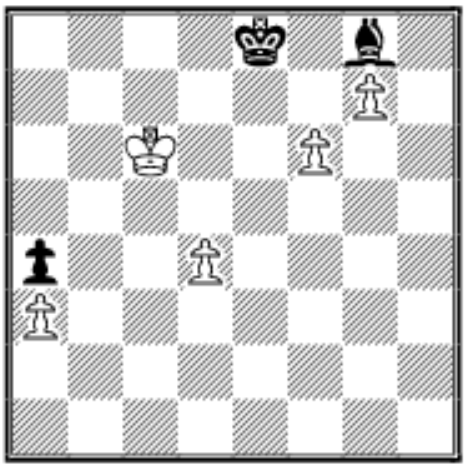
E) Examples with More Pieces

I want to end this article with three examples where the exchange into a pure bishop vs pawns ending plays a crucial role:

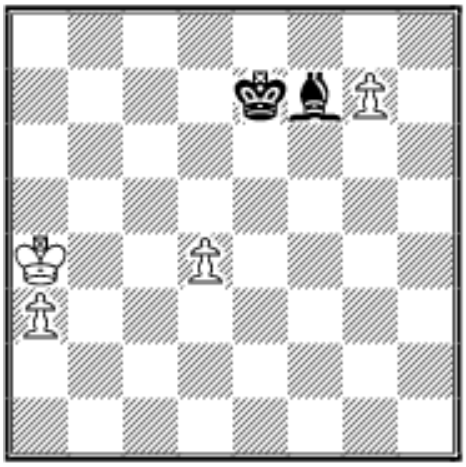


14.04 *Ye Jiangchuan* (2671) - *Wang Rui* (2526) zt3.3 HeiBei CHN 2001

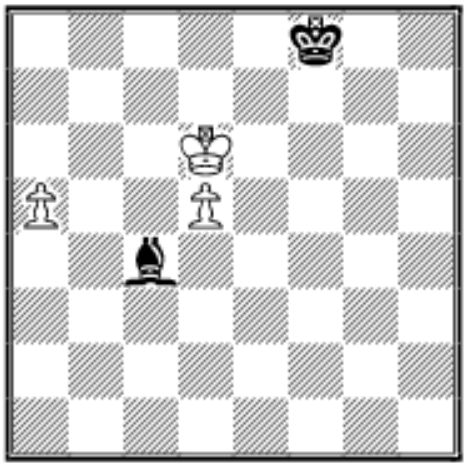
White can't make progress by normal means so he decides to sacrifice his bishop: **50.Bxf6!? Kxf6 51.g5+ Kf7 52.Ke5 Bg2 53.Kd6 Be4 54.Ke5 Bc2 55.g6+ Ke7 56.f6+ Ke8 57.g7 Bh7** 57...Kf7 is playable as well: 58.Kxd5 Bh7 (58...Kxf6? loses to 59.g8N+! Kf7 60.Nh6+ Ke7 61.Ng4+-) 59.Ke5 Bg8 60.d5 Ke8 61.Ke4 Kf7 62.Kf5 Bh7+ 63.Ke5 Ke8 64.Kd6 Bg8 65.Kc6 Bf7= **58.Kxd5 Bg8+ 59.Kc6**



Now Black cracks under the pressure, but the ending remains very tricky: **59...Kd8?** 59...Kf7 60.d5 Ke8!= **60.Kb5! Bb3 61.f7 Bxf7 62.Kxa4 Ke7**



The natural move is not the right one as it allows Black to set up a defence on the e8-a4 resp a8-h1 diagonal **63.Kb5?** 63.Kb4! was called for: 63...Kd6 (for 63...Kf6 64.Kc5 see the game.) 64.Kb5 Kd5 65.a4 Kxd4 66.a5 Ke5 67.a6 Kf6 68.a7+- **63...Kf6?** 63...Be8+! 64.Kb6 (64.Kb4 Kf7 65.a4 Kxg7 66.a5 Bc6 67.Kc5 Ba8 68.d5 Kf7 69.d6 Ke8 70.Kb6 Kd7=) 64...Kf7 65.Kc7 (65.d5 Kxg7 66.Kc7 Kf6 67.d6 Ke6=) 65...Kxg7 66.Kd8 Ba4 67.Ke7 Kg6 68.d5 Kf5 69.d6 Ke5 70.d7 Bxd7 71.Kxd7 Kd5 72.Kc7 Kc5= **64.Kc5 Kxg7 65.a4 Bh5 66.Kd6** 66.a5 was possible immediately: 66...Be2 67.d5 Kf8 68.Kb6 Ke7 69.Kc7 Bb5 70.d6+ Ke6 71.a6+- **66...Kf8 67.a5 Be2** 67...Ke8 68.a6 Bf3 69.d5+- **68.d5 Bc4**

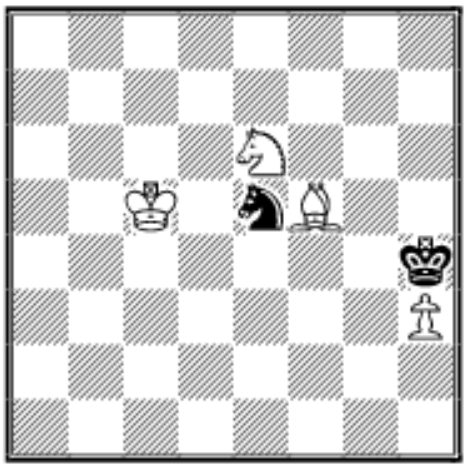


White's following finish is quite instructive: **69.Kc5!** 69.Kc6? Ke7 70.d6+ Kd8= **69...Be2 70.Kc6 Ke7 71.Kc7 1–0**



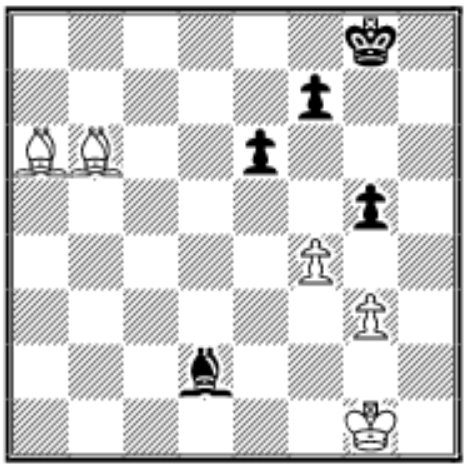
14.05 *Y.Kraidman* (2322) - *A.Luboshitz* (2200) European Seniors Saint Vincent 2001

White has the wrong rook's pawn but Black's task is not as easy as he thought: **51...c4+!? 52.bxc4 Nxc4?** too early. Using the b-pawn as decoy was the right way to proceed: 52...b3! 53.c5 Nd5 and Black should be able to hold the draw. **53.Kxc4 Ng6 54.Nc5 Kf4 55.Kxb4 Kg5 56.Ne6+ Kh4 57.Kc5 Ne5 58.Bf5**



Black can exchange knight's now but it is not sufficient to draw: **58...Nf3** 58...Nf7 59.Nf8 Ng5 60.Ng6+ Kh5 61.Nf4+ Kh4 62.Ng2+ Kg3 63.h4 Nf7 64.Be4+- **59.Kd5 Ng5 60.Nxg5 Kxg5 61.Ke6 Kh6 62.Kf6 Kh5 63.Kg7 Kg5 64.Bg4 1–0**

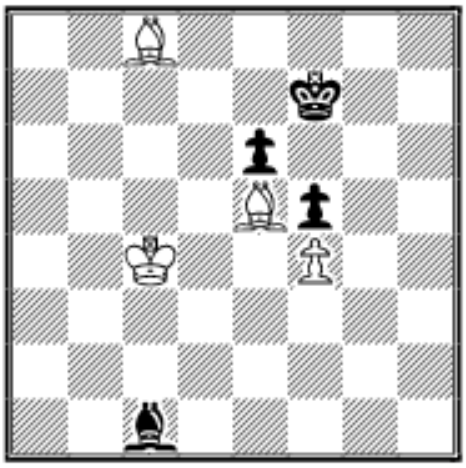
The analysis of the next example follows my article "The Fortress of Lippstadt" in CBM 73:



14.06 *K.Müller* (2533) - *I.Csom* (2472) Lippstadt 1999

I had won a bishop earlier and now thought that I could win easily. But Istvan Csom had prepared a nasty surprise: **37.fxg5?** 37.Bc7? gxf4 38.gxf4 f5 39.Kf2 Kf7 40.Ke2 (40.Kg3 Be1+=) 40...Bc1 41.Kd3 Kf6

42.Be5+ Kg6 43.Bc8 Kf7 44.Kc4



White can't win the e6-pawn: 44...Ke7 45.Kc5 Ba3+ 46.Kc6 Bb4 47.Ba6 (47.Bg7 Bd2 48.Bh6 e5=) 47...Ba3 48.Kc7 (48.Bd3 Bb4 49.Bc4 Ba3 50.Bd4 Bc1 51.Bc5+ Kf6 52.Bd6 Bb2 53.Kd7 e5=) 48...Bb4 49.Bc4 Ba3 50.Kc8 Bb4 51.Bc7 Bc3 52.Bd8+ Kd6=;

37.f5! was called for: 37...exf5 38.Bd3 f4 39.g4 Bc3 40.Kf2

A) 40...Kg7 41.Kf3 Bb2 42.Bd8 Bf6 43.Bxf6+ Kxf6 44.Ke4 Ke6 45.Bc4+ Kf6 46.Bd5 Ke7 47.Kf5 f6 48.Bc4 f3 49.Ke4 f2 50.Kf3 Kd6 (50...f5 51.gxf5 Kf6 52.Kg4+-) 51.Kxf2 Ke5 52.Bd3+-;

B) 40...f6 41.Kf3 Kf7 42.Ke4 Ke7 43.Bc5+ Kf7 44.Bc4+ Kg7 45.Be6 Bb2 46.Bd4 Ba3 47.Kf5 Be7 48.Bd5 Bd8 49.Ke6 Kg6 50.Be4+ Kg7 51.Kd7 Ba5 52.Ke7 Bb4+ 53.Ke6+-

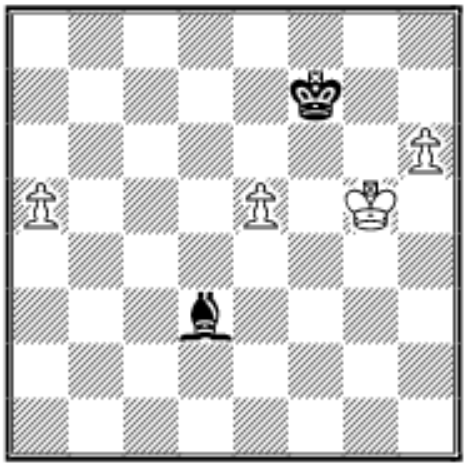
37...Bxg5 38.Bc4 Bf6 39.Bc7 Kg7 40.Kg2 Bc3 41.Kf3 Kg6 42.Kf4 Bd2+ 43.Ke4 Bc3 44.Be5 Be1 45.Kf4 f6 46.Bd3+ Kf7 47.Bb2 Bb4 48.Kf3 Bd6 49.Bc4 f5= and I tried to break through for some further moves before we finally agreed to the draw.

Sources:

Chess Endgame Lessons Volume 2, Pal Benko 1999
The Ultimate Chess Puzzle Book, John Emms, Gambit 2001

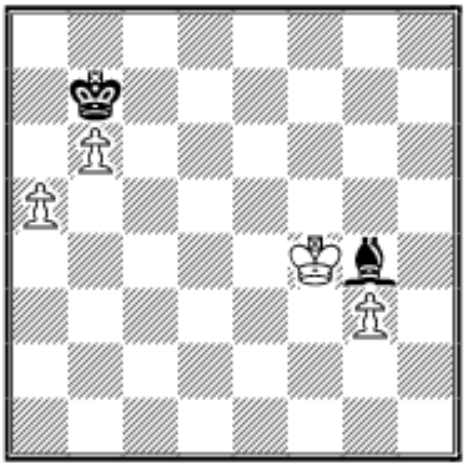
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
CBM 73
The Week in Chess

Exercises (Solutions next month)



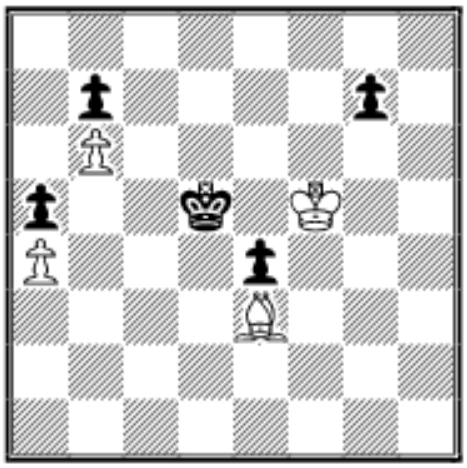
E14.01 *J.Sunye Neto* (2375) - *D.Velimirovic* (2515) Rio de Janeiro izt 1979

White to move and win.



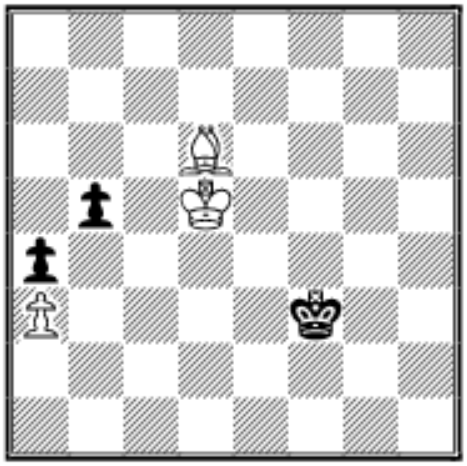
E14.02 *J.Whitehead* (2325) - *J.Tarjan* (2535) USA-ch 1983

Black to move and draw.



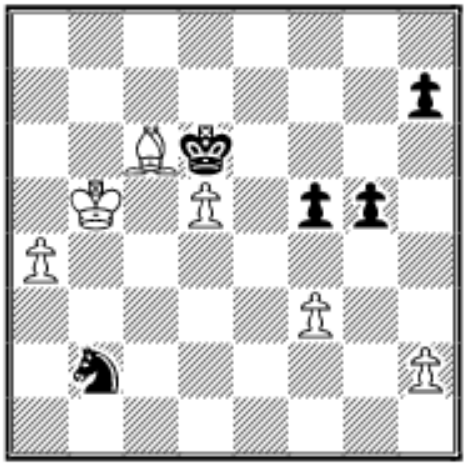
E14.03 *B.Spassky* (2660) - *R.Fischer* (2785) Wch28-Reykjavik 1972

Spassky found a convincing way to victory. How did he proceed?



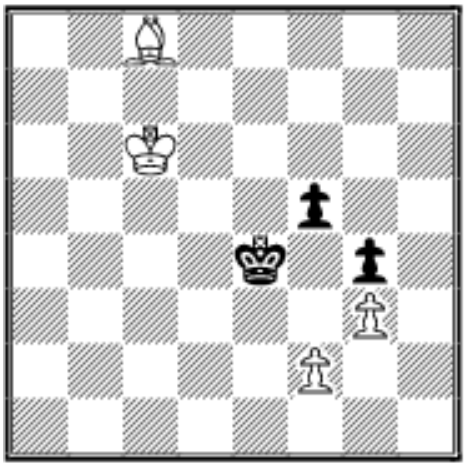
E14.04 *V.Kortschnoj* (2665) - *A.Karpov* (2725)

How to asses the position with Black to move? What about White to move?



E14.05 *M.Euwe* - *M.Sultan Khan* Hastings 1931

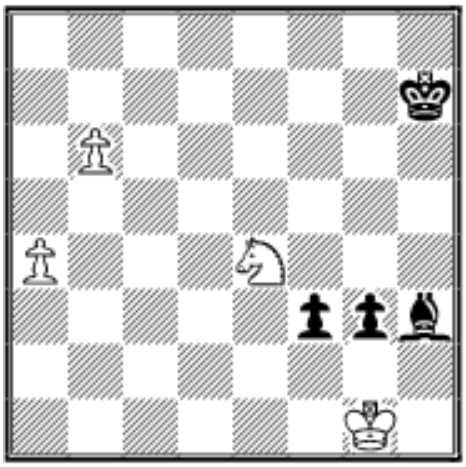
Is Black lost?



E14.06 *M.Zwettler* - *F.Loidl* Ybbs 2002

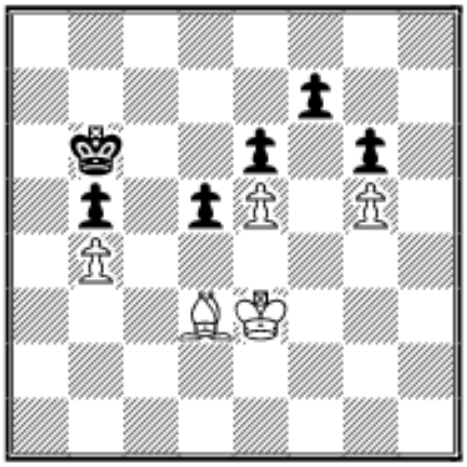
Was **67.Bxf5+** a fortunate choice?

Solutions to last month's exercises



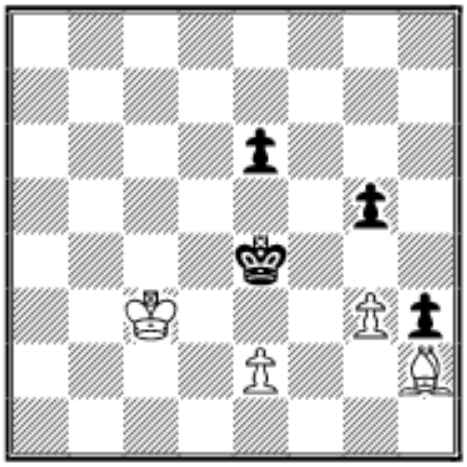
E13.01 *L.Helm - S.Germann* BL9900 (Women) Germany 2000

White is winning: **60...f2+** 60...Bc8 61.Nxg3 Kg6 62.Ne4 Ba6 63.Nc5+- **61.Nxf2 gxf2+ 62.Kxf2 Bc8 63.Ke3 Kg6 64.Kd4 Kf6 65.Kd5 Ke7 66.Kc6 Kd8 67.b7 1–0**



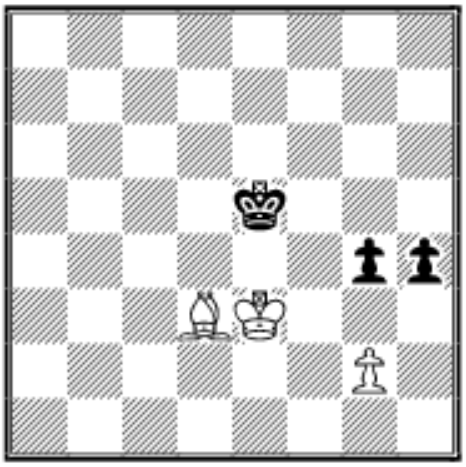
E13.02 *D.Lam - L.Chipkin* (2156) ch-New York State Rochester 2001

White won as follows: **45.Kd4 Kc6 46.Bc2 Kb6 47.Bb3 Kc6 48.Ba2 Kd7** 48...Kb6 49.Bxd5 exd5 50.Kxd5 Kc7 51.Kc5+- **49.Kc5 1–0**



E13.03 *A.Potapov* (2490) - *E.Pigusov* (2584) RUS-ch 54th Elista 2001

Black is surprisingly winning: **53...Ke3!** 53...g4?? 54.Bg1 h2 55.Bxh2 Ke3 56.Bg1+ Kxe2 57.Bd4 Kf3 58.Be5 Ke4 59.Bc7+- **54.g4** 54.Kc4 Kxe2 55.Kd4 Kf3 56.g4 Kg2 57.Bd6 h2 58.Bxh2 Kxh2 59.Ke5 Kg3–+ **54...Kxe2 55.Kd4 Kf3** and White resigned as **56.Ke5** loses to **56...Kg2 57.Bf4 gxf4 58.g5 h2 59.g6 h1Q–+**



E13.04 *H.Shehab* - *T.Moudallal* ch-LIB Beruit 2001

Black to move was easy:**1...g3!** followed by h4-h3 leaves White with a wrong rook's pawn. White to move on the other hand could have won the game, but blew it with **48.Be4??** One way to victory was 48.Ba6 Kf5 (48...h3 49.g3 Kf5 50.Bb7 Kg5 51.Ke4 h2 52.Ke5+-) 49.Bc8+ Kg5 50.Bd7 h3 51.g3 h2 52.Bc6 Kf5 53.Kd4 Ke6 54.Bg2 Kf5 55.Kd5 Kf6 56.Ke4 Kg5 57.Ke5 Kg6 58.Kf4 Kh5 59.Kf5+- **48...g3 49.Bb7 h3 50.gxh3 Kf6 51.Kf4 g2 52.Bxg2 Kg7** ½–½

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

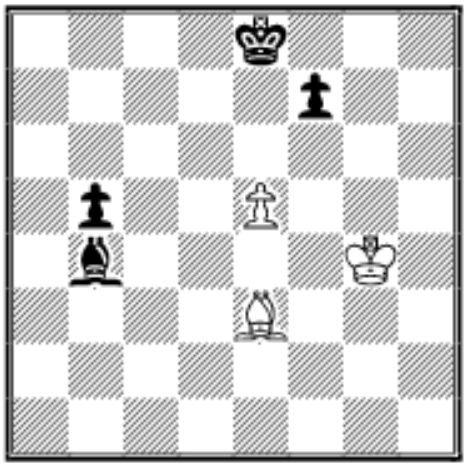
Karsten Müller



Ponomariov's Technique

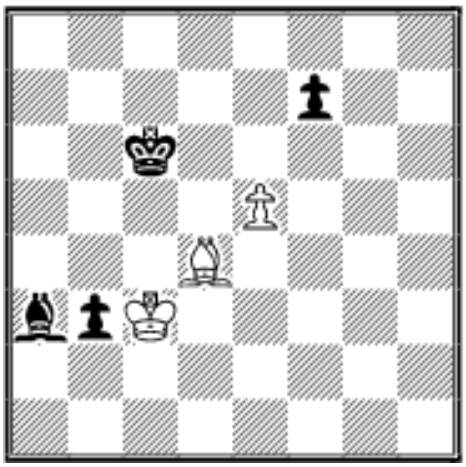
Part 1

The new FIDE world champion Ruslan Ponomariov has a very strong fighting spirit. He plays long games and fights hard and manages to squeeze a lot of points out of his endgames, which is really remarkable for his young age. I would like to show some of his recent achievements. I start with a difficult bishop ending, which he drew easily:



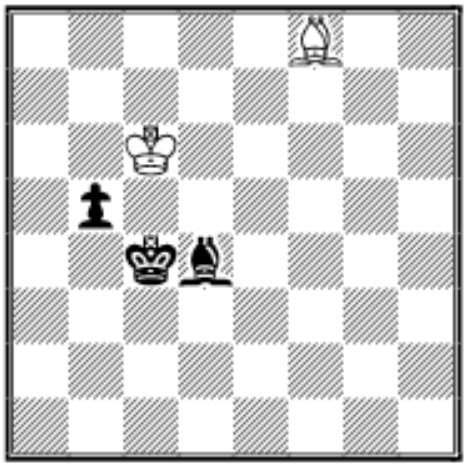
15.01 *R.Ponomariov* (2673) - *L.Aronian* (2528) Lausanne Young Masters 2001

63.Kf5! (63.Bd4? Kd7 64.Kf5 Be7 65.Bb2 *(65.Ke4 Ke6 66.Be3 Bb4 67.Kd4 Be1 68.Bf4 b4 69.Kc4 Bc3–+)* 65...b4 66.Bd4 Kc6 67.Ke4 b3 68.Bb2 *(*after *68.Kd3 Ba3 69.Kc3*



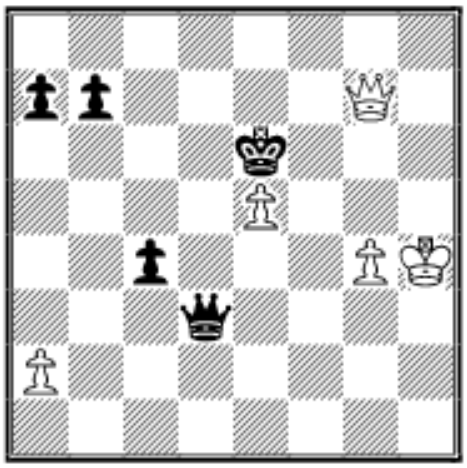
Black has the shot *69...Bc5!–+)* 68...Kb5 69.Kd3 Ka4 70.Bc1 Ba3 71.Bf4 Bb2 followed by Ka3 –+.) **63...Kd7** (63...Ke7 64.Bd4 Ba3 65.Be3 Bb2 66.Bc5+ Kd7 67.Bb4 Bd4 68.Kf6 Ke8 69.Kf5=) **64.Kf6 Bc3** (64...Ke8 65.e6 Be7+ 66.Kf5 f6 67.Bd2 Kf8 68.Kg6

Ke8 69.Kf5 Kd8 70.Ba5+ Kc8 71.Bc3 b4 72.Bxb4=) **65.Kxf7 Bxe5 66.Bd2** or 66.Kg6 Ke6 67.Bd2 Kd5 68.Kf5 Bg7 69.Kg4 Kc4 70.Kf3 Bc3 71.Bf4 *(71.Bc1? b4 72.Ke2 Kb3 73.Kd3 Ka2 74.Kc4 Be1 75.Bf4 b3 76.Be5 Bd2 77.Kb5 Bc1 78.Bd4 Bb2 79.Be3 Bf6 80.Bc1 Be7 81.Ka4 Bg5 82.Ba3 Bd2–+* zugzwang*)* 71...b4 *(71...Kd3 72.Bd6=)* 72.Ke2 b3 *(72...Kb3 73.Bd6=)* 73.Kd1 Kd3 74.Kc1= *(74.Bg5* draws as well due to the stalemate trick *74...b2 75.Bc1!*) **66...Kd6 67.Ke8 Bf6 68.Bb4+ Kd5 69.Kd7!** (69.Kf7? Kc4 70.Ba3 Bd4 71.Ke6 Bc5 72.Bc1 b4 73.Ke5 b3 74.Ke4 Kc3 75.Bf4 Kc2 76.Be5 Bb4–+) **69...Kc4 70.Bf8** ½–½ and a draw was agreed as Ponomariov reaches a standard drawing formation after **70...Bd4 71.Kc6=**



White's king helps his bishop and reaches a well known drawing formation according to **Centurini's rule** (see Averbakh No.167 or *Fundamental Chess Endings* No.4.26). **The strategy used by Ponomariov is well worth remembering!**

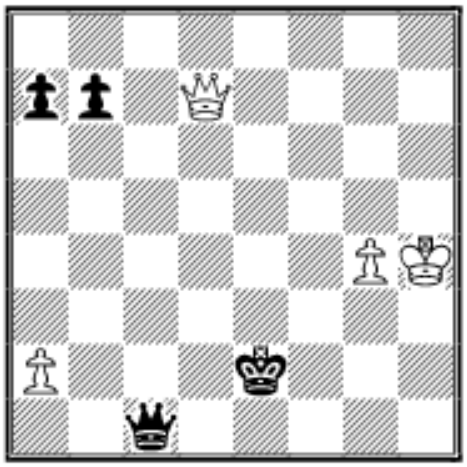
In the next example he demonstrates, that the **most important factor in queen endings is usually a far advanced passed pawn:**



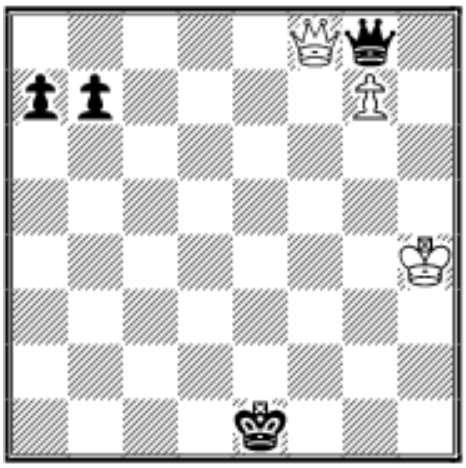
15.02 *R.Ponomariov* (2673) - *M.Turov* (2553) 3rd Rector Cup Kharkov 2001

First he exchanges queens to win with his g-pawn in the new queen ending: **40.Qf6+ Kd5** (40...Kd7? 41.e6+ Kc8 42.Qf8+ Kc7 *(42...Qd8+ 43.e7+-)* 43.Qf7+ Kd6 44.e7+-)

41.Qd6+ Ke4 42.Qxd3+ Kxd3 42...cxd3 43.e6 results in a similar queen ending. **43.e6 c3 44.e7 c2 45.e8Q c1Q 46.Qd7+ Ke2**

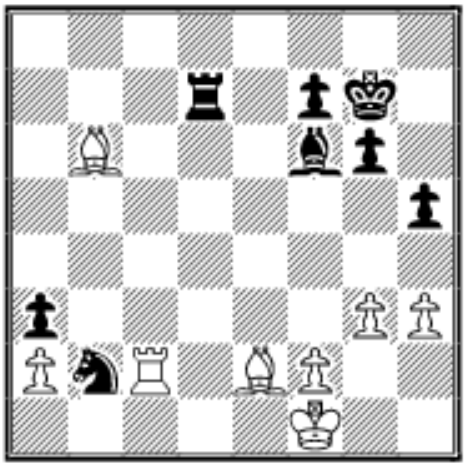


White's g-pawn is too strong: **47.g5 Qh1+ 48.Qh3 Qd5 49.Qg4+ Kf2 50.Qf4+ Ke1 51.g6 Qxa2 52.g7 Qg8 53.Qf8!**



Ponomariov plans to hide his king on a8! **53...Qc4+ 54.Kg5 Qd5+ 55.Kf6 Qc6+ 56.Ke7 Qc7+ 57.Ke6 Qc6+ 58.Qd6 Qc4+ 59.Kd7 Qa4+ 60.Kd8 Qb3 61.Qf8 1-0** and Turov resigned, not waiting for **61...Qd3+ 62.Kc8 Qh3+ 63.Kb8 Qg3+ 64.Ka8+-**

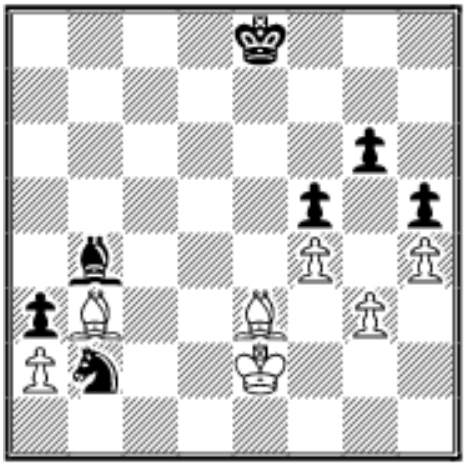
He also knows how to use **the bishop pair**:



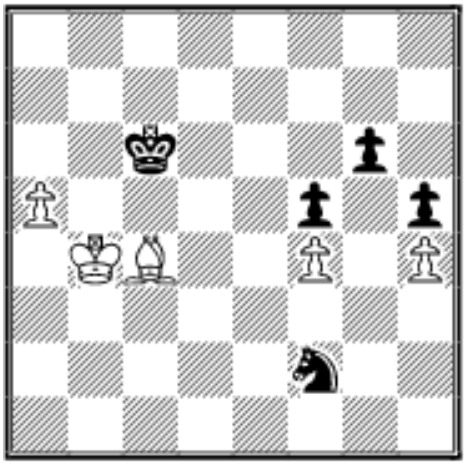
15.03 *R.Ponomariov* (2684) - *C.Lutz* (2643) World Teams Yerevan ARM 2001

44.Rc7!? exchanging rooks gives White more attacking possibilities **44...Rxc7 45.Bxc7 Be7 46.f4 f6 47.Kf2 Bc5+ 48.Kf3 Kf7 49.Bb5 Nd1 50.Ba5 f5 51.Be1 Ke7 52.Ke2 Nb2!** (52...Ne3? 53.Bf2+-) **53.Bc3 Bd6 54.h4 Bc5 55.Be5**

Bb4 56.Bd4 Kf7 57.Bc6 Ke7 58.Bd5 Ke8 59.Bf6 Kf8 60.Bb3 Ke8 61.Bd4 Ke7 62.Be3 Ke8



Black's knight is dominated, but how to make progress? **63.Bd2! White tries to trade one advantage for another**: the bishop pair for the play against Black's cornered knight. **63...Bc5! 64.Bc3 Ke7 65.Kd2 Ke8 66.Kc2 Ke7** (66...Bf2? 67.Bb4 Bxg3 68.Bxa3+-) **67.Be1** (67.Bxb2?? **is no winning plan due to the opposite coloured bishops and their notorious drawing tendency**.) **67...Ke8 68.Kc3 Ke7 69.Bd2 Bf2 70.Kc2 Bc5 71.Bd5 Na4 72.Be1 Nb6?** Why not 72...Nb2 ? **73.Bg8 Nd7 74.Kb3 Nf6 75.Bc4 Ne4 76.Ka4 Ke8 77.Kb5 Bd4 78.Kc6 Bc3?** 78...Nc3 is more tenacious, e.g. 79.Kd6 Kf8 80.Ke6 Kg7 **79.Bxc3 Nxc3 80.Kc5 Ne4+ 81.Kb4 Nxg3 82.Kxa3 Kd7 83.Kb4 Kc6 84.a4 Ne4 85.a5 Nf2**



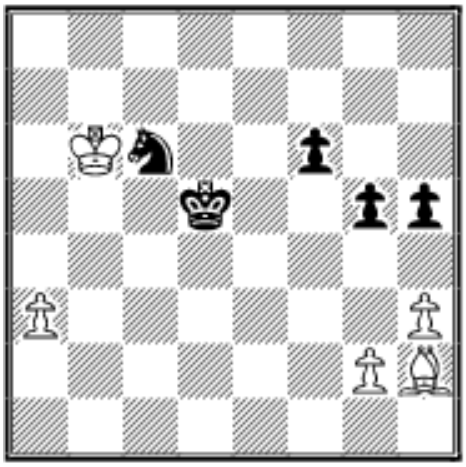
86.Bf1! preserving the pawn f4 **86...Kb7 87.Kc5 Ng4 88.Kd4 Nh2 89.Be2 Ka7 90.Ke5 Ng4+ 91.Ke6 Ne3 92.Kf6 Nd5+ 93.Kg5 1–0**

In the following bishop vs knight ending White is better due to his more active king and better minor piece unter these circumstances:

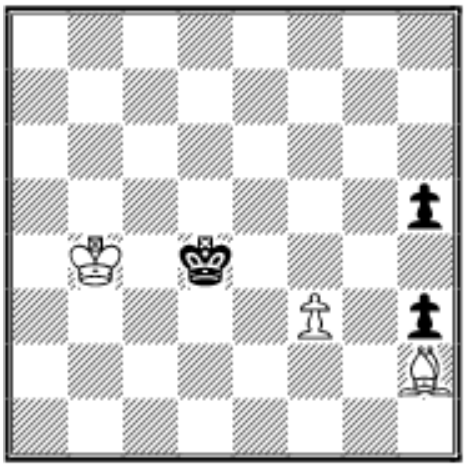


15.04 *R.Ponomariov* (2684) - *V.Borovikov* (2593)
Governor's Cup Kramatorsk UKR 2001

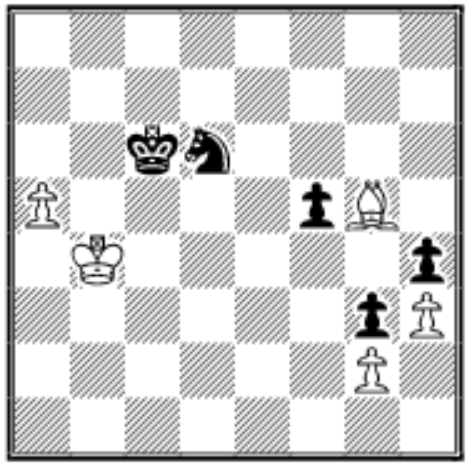
40.Bd2 Ke6?! 40...Kc6!? may be easier for Black, e.g. 41.Bb4 Ng6 42.a4 Ne5 43.Bf8 g6 44.Kd4 Nd7 45.Be7 a5 46.h4 Nb6 47.Bd8 Nxa4 48.Bxa5 Nc5= **41.Kd4 Nf5+** After 41...Kd6? White simplifies into an easily won pawn ending (**you should watch out carefully for such possibilities**): 42.Bb4+ Kd7 43.Bxe7 Kxe7 44.Kc5+- **42.Kc5 Nd6 43.Bf4 Ne4+ 44.Kb6 g5 45.Bh2?!** (45.Bc1!?) **45...Nd2 46.c5 Nc4+ 47.Kb7 Kd5 48.c6 Na5+ 49.Kxa6 Nxc6 50.Kb6**



50...f5 50...Ne5!? deserved consideration as well, e.g. 51.Bxe5 *(51.a4 Nc4+ 52.Kb5 Na3+ 53.Ka6 Kc6=)* 51...fxe5 52.a4 e4 53.a5 e3 54.a6 e2 55.a7 e1Q 56.a8Q+ Kc4 57.Qg8+ Kd3 58.Qxg5 Qe3+ 59.Qxe3+ Kxe3 60.g4 hxg4 61.hxg4 Kf4= **51.a4 h4** 51...f4? 52.h4! and White wins, e.g. 52...f3 53.gxf3 gxh4 54.a5 Nxa5 55.Kxa5 Kd4 56.Kb4 h3

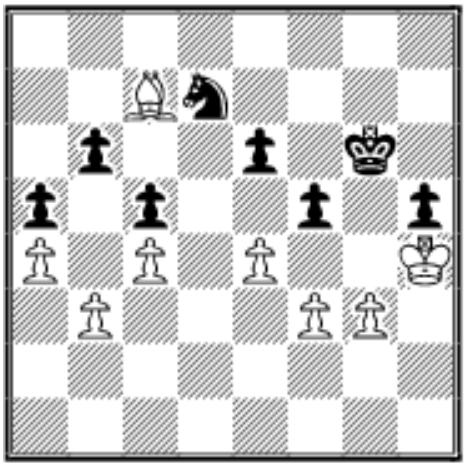


Now follows a well known finish: 57.f4 Ke4 58.Kc4 Kf3 59.Kd3 Kg2 60.Ke2 Kxh2 61.Kf2 h4 62.f5 Kh1 63.f6 h2 64.f7 h3 65.Kg3+- **52.Bg1 g4 53.Be3 Ne5 54.Bg5 g3** 54...gxh3 55.gxh3 to reduce White's winning potential is interesting as well. **55.Kb5 Nc4** (55...Ng6? 56.a5 f4 57.a6 f3 58.gxf3 g2 59.Be3+-) **56.Kb4** (56.a5?! Nxa5 57.Kxa5 Ke4 58.Bxh4 f4 59.Kb4 f3 60.Bxg3 fxg2 61.Bh2 Kf3 62.Kc3 g1Q 63.Bxg1 Kg3=) **56...Nd6 57.a5 Kc6**



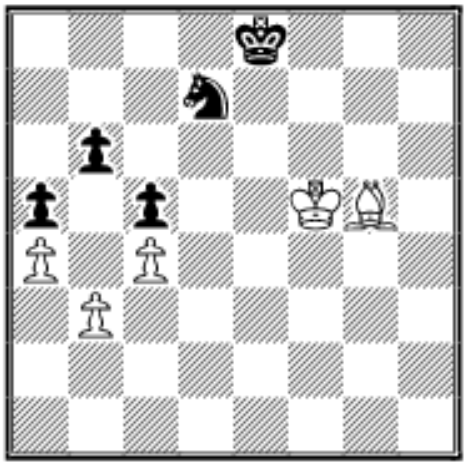
58.Bxh4? Too greedy. 58.Be3! was called for. Black has very serious problems now, e.g. 58...Nf7 59.Kc4 Ne5+ 60.Kd4 Ng6 61.Bd2 Kb5 62.Kd5 Ka6 63.Ke6 f4 64.Kf5 f3 65.gxf3 Ne7+ 66.Kg4 Nd5 67.Be1 g2 68.Bf2 Nc3 69.f4+- **58...f4 59.Bg5 f3 60.gxf3 g2?** 60...Nf5! equalizes: 61.Bd8 *(61.Bf4 g2 62.Bh2 Nh4=)* 61...Nd4 62.Bh4 g2 63.Bf2 Nxf3= **61.Be3 Nf5 62.Bf2 Nh4 63.f4 Nf3** 63...Ng6!? is more tenacious, but White should be winning as well after 64.f5 Ne7 65.h4 Nxf5 66.h5 **64.f5 g1Q 65.Bxg1 Nxg1 66.f6 Kd7 67.f7 Ke7 68.a6 1–0**

This reminds me of an interesting endgame by Miles, which Mark Dvoretsky analysed in his December 2001 column:



15.05 *A.Miles* - *R.Dzindzichashvili* Tilburg 1978

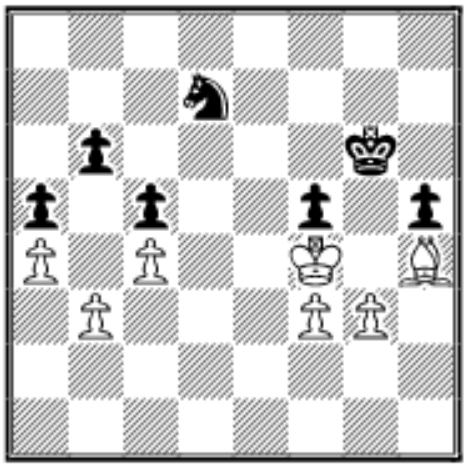
I asked myself how to win, if Black makes the plan expanding the bridgehead by g3-g4 more difficult to realise. I sent Mark my ideas and here is the result of our joint analysis: **1...f5!?** (instead of the game continuation 1...Kh6) **2.exf5+ exf5 3.Kh3!** the white king goes the long way to f4 to force a decisive zugzwang position. After 3.Bd8 Kh6 4.g4? **too many pawns are exchanged** and Black can save himself: 4...hxg4 5.fxg4 fxg4 6.Kxg4 Kg6 7.Kf4 Kf7 8.Kf5 Ke8 9.Bg5



A) 9...Kf7? loses in an instructive way: 10.Bf4 Ke7 11.Bc7 Kf7 12.Bd6 Ke8 *(12...Nf6 13.Ke5 Ne8 14.Kd5+-)* 13.Ke6 Kd8 14.Kd5+- (Dvoretsky)

B) 9...Nb8! 10.Ke6 Nc6 11.Kd6 Nd4 12.Bf6 Kf7 13.Bd8 *(13.Be5 Nxb3 14.Bf4 Kg6 15.Kc6 Kf5 16.Bc7 Ke6 17.Kb5 Kd7=)* 13...Nxb3 14.Bxb6 Nd2 15.Kxc5 Ke8 16.Kb5 Nxc4= due to the wrong rook's pawn.

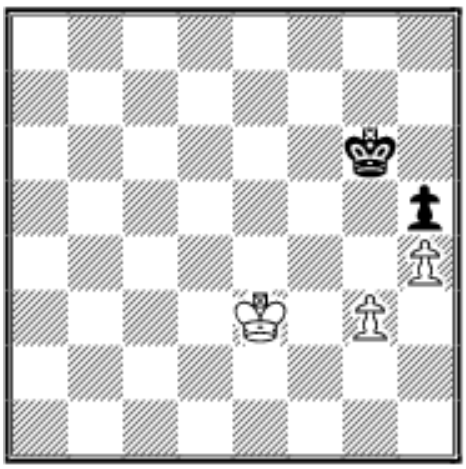
3...Kf7 4.Kg2 Ke6 5.Kf2 Ke7 6.Ke3 Ke6 7.Kf4 Kf6 8.Bd8+ Kg6 9.Bh4



White has finally reached his aim and Black has to make a concession. **9...Nb8 10.Ke5 Nc6+ 11.Kd5 Nd4 12.f4 Kf7** (12...Nxb3 13.Bd8 Nd2 14.Bxb6 Ne4 15.Bxa5+-) **13.Bd8 Ne2 14.Bxb6 Nxg3 15.Bxa5 Ne2 16.Be1 Nxf4+ 17.Kd6 Ke8 18.a5 Kd8 19.a6 Kc8 20.Kc6+-**

Sources:
ChessBase MEGABASE 2001
The Week in Chess
Schach Magazin 64 No.1/2002
Mark Dvoretsky's December 2001 *Instructor* column
Fundamental Chess Endings, Karsten Müller and Frank Lamprecht, GAMBIT 2001
Läufer und Springerendspiele, Yury Averbakh , Sportverlag Berrlin 1988.

Exercises (Solutions next month)



E15.01 *R.Ponomariov* (2673) - *A.Moiseenko* (2561) 3rd Rector Cup Kharkov 2001 DIAGRAM

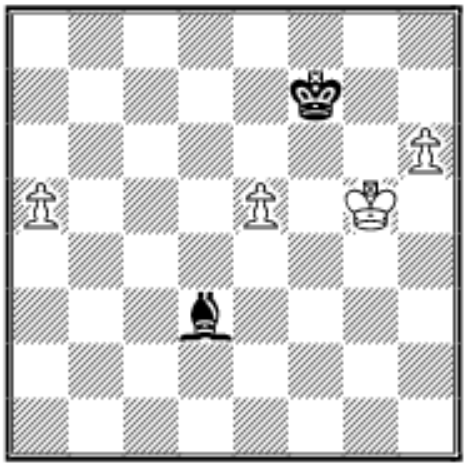
Black has two moves to draw. Find both!



E15.02 *R.Ponomariov* (2684) - *R.Vaganian* (2650) World Teams Yerevan ARM 2001 DIAGRAM

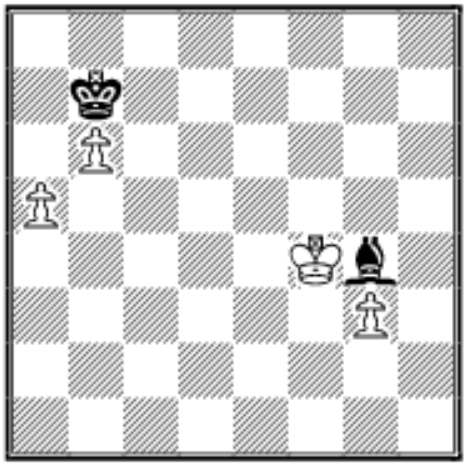
How did Ponomariov continue his attack?

Solutions to last month's exercises



E14.01 *J.Sunye Neto* (2375) - *D.Velimirovic* (2515) Rio de Janeiro izt 1979 DIAGRAM

White won as follows: **72.Kf4 Bc4** (72...Kg6 73.e6 Kxh6 74.e7 Bb5 75.a6+-) **73.Ke4 1-0** and Black resigned due to **73...Kg6 74.Kd4+-** and his bishop is overloaded.



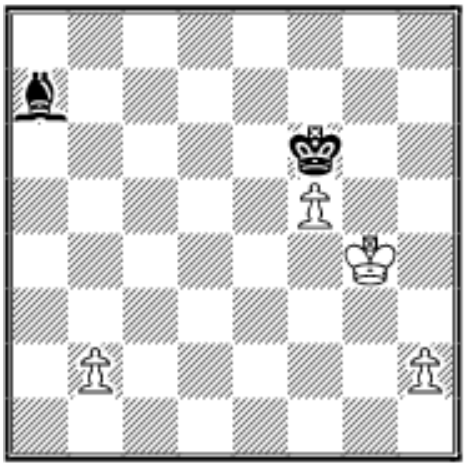
E14.02 *J.Whitehead* (2325) - *J.Tarjan* (2535) USA-ch 1983

Tarjan managed to save his skin: **68...Bc8!** (68...Be2? 69.g4 and Black is lost, e.g. 69...Ba6 70.g5 Kc6 71.Ke5 Kd7 72.g6 Ke7 73.g7 Kf7 74.Kd6 Kxg7 75.Kc7+-) **69.Ke5** (69.g4 Ka6! 70.g5 Kxa5 71.g6 Kxb6 72.Ke5 Ba6 73.Kd4 Bc8 74.g7 Be6=) **69...Bg4 70.Kd6 Bf3 71.Kc5** (71.a6+ Kxb6!=) **71...Be2** the careless 71...Bg4 loses due to 72.a6+! Kxa6 73.Kc6 Bf3+ 74.Kc7 Kb5 75.g4 Kc5 76.g5+-

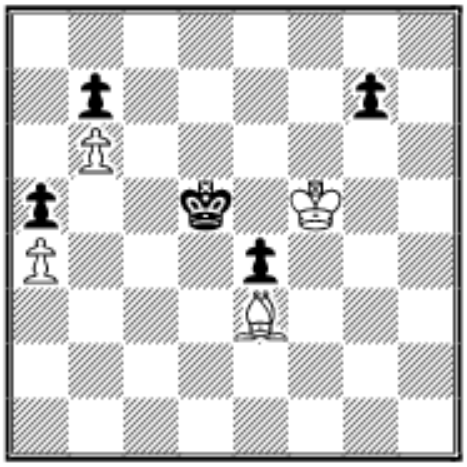
72.Kd4 Bg4 73.Kd5 Bf3+ 74.Ke5 ½–½

E14.02A *J.Whitehead* (2325) - *B.Kogan* (2475) USA-ch 1983

Whitehead had a similar ending in the same tournament two rounds before and couldn't win as well:



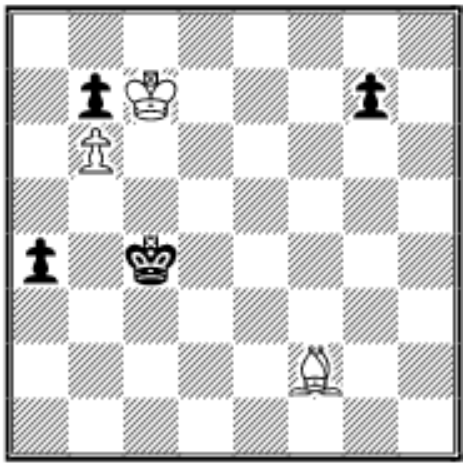
53...Bb8 54.h3 Bd6 55.h4 Bf8 56.Kf4 Bb4 57.h5 Bf8 58.b3 Bh6+ 59.Ke4 Bf8 60.Kf4 Bh6+ ½–½



E14.03 *B.Spassky* (2660) - *R.J.Fischer* (2785) Wch28-Reykjavik 1972

Spassky solved the technical problems as follows: **51.Bf2!** putting Black in zugzwang. 51.Bd2? is wrong as the valuable b-pawn has to be preserved: 51...Kc5 52.Bxa5 e3 53.Kg6 e2 54.Kxg7 e1Q 55.Bxe1 Kxb6= as White's rook's pawn is wrong. **51...g5** (51...Kc4 52.Kxe4 Kb3 53.Kd5 Kxa4 54.Kc5 Kb3 *(54...g5 55.Be1 g4 56.Kc4+-)*

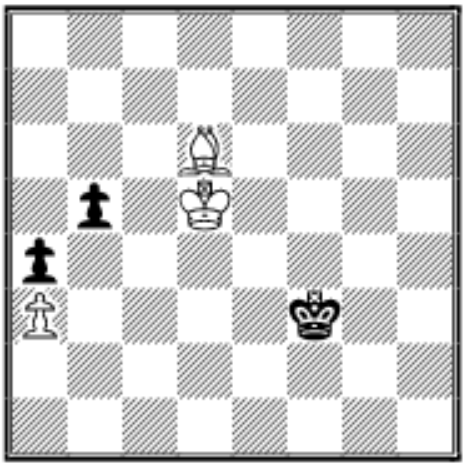
A) 55.Kd6 Kc4 56.Kc7 a4



57.Bg3 *(57.Kxb7? a3 58.Bg3 Kd5=)* 57...Kd4 58.Kxb7 a3 59.Kc6 a2 60.Kd6+-

B) 55.Bd4 55...g5 56.Kd6 Kc4 57.Kc7 Kxd4 58.Kxb7+-)

52.Kxg5 Kc4 53.Kf5 Kb4 54.Kxe4 Kxa4 55.Kd5 55.Kd3?? Kb5 56.Kc3 Kc6 57.Kc4 Kd7= and Black has an impregnable fortress. **55...Kb5 56.Kd6 1-0** and Fischer resigned due to **56...a4 57.Kc7 Ka6 58.Bc5 Kb5 59.Bf8 Ka6 60.Ba3+-**



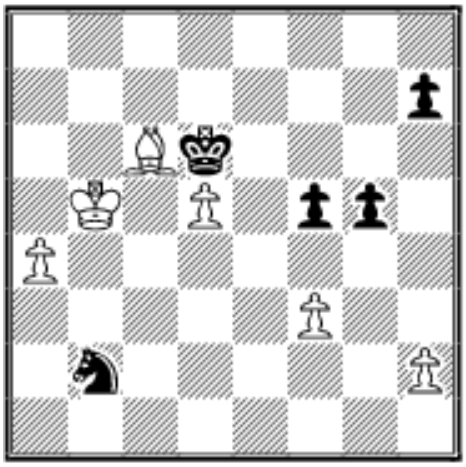
E14.04 *V.Kortschnoj* (2665) - *A.Karpov* (2725) Wch29-Baguio City 1978

In the game Karpov (with Black) was to move and managed to draw the game as his king gets back to the drawing zone in time: **105...Kg4! 106.Kc5** (106.Ke4 Kg5 107.Be7+ Kg6 108.Ke5 Kf7 109.Bf6 Ke8 110.Ke6 Kf8 111.Bg5 Kg7 *(111...Ke8?? 112.Be7+-)* 112.Kf5 Kf7=) **106...Kf5! 107.Kxb5 Ke6** reaching Rauzer's drawing zone **108.Kc6 Kf6 109.Kd7 Kg7 110.Be7 Kg8 111.Ke6 Kg7 112.Bc5 Kg8 113.Kf6 Kh7 114.Kf7 Kh8 115.Bd4+ Kh7 116.Bb2 Kh6 117.Kg8 Kg6 118.Bg7 Kf5 119.Kf7 Kg5 120.Bb2 Kh6 121.Bc1+ Kh7!** (121...Kh5? 122.Kf6 Kg4 123.Kg6 Kh4 124.Bf4 Kg4 125.Bg5+-) **122.Bd2 Kh8 123.Bc3+ Kh7 124.Bg7** ½–½ stalemate.

More details on this position can be obtained from *Fundamenbtal Chess Endings* (4.11 and 4.11A) or

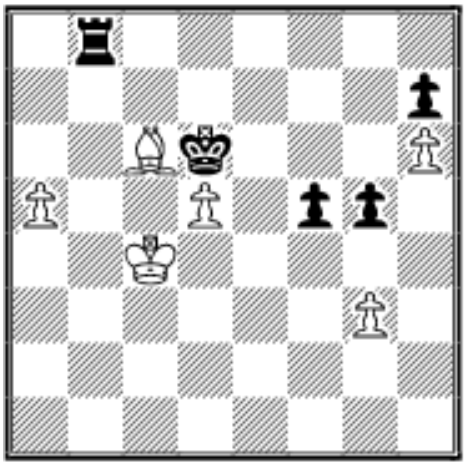
Averbakh (No.93).

White to move in E14.04 wins as he is just fast enough: **105.Kc5 Ke4 106.Kxb5 Kd5 107.Bg3 Ke6 108.Kxa4 Kd7 109.Kb5 Kc8 110.Kc6+-**



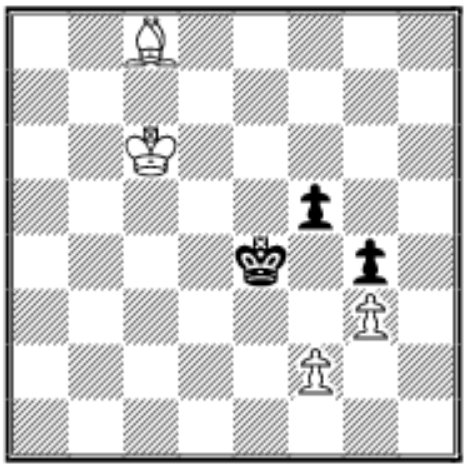
E14.05 *M.Euwe - M.Sultan Khan* Hastings 1931

Sultan Khan made a Houdini like escape: **43...Nxa4!!** 43...f4?! might also be sufficient. But it looks very suspicious, e.g. 44.h3 h5 *(*now *44...Nxa4?* comes too late: *45.Kxa4 h5 46.Kb4 g4 47.fxg4 hxg4 48.hxg4 f3 49.Kc3 f2 50.Bb5 Kxd5 51.Kd2 Ke4 52.Ke2 Kf4 53.Bd7 Kg3 54.Kf1+-)* 45.Kb4 g4 *(45...Nd3+?!* looks very risky, but it is still not easy to break through e.g. *46.Kc3 Ne5 47.a5 Kc5!* and Black may be able to hold the position.*)* 46.fxg4 hxg4 47.hxg4 f3 48.Bb5 Nxa4! *(48...Nd1? 49.a5 Ne3 50.a6 Nxd5+ 51.Ka5 Nc7 52.a7 f2 53.Bf1+-)* 49.Kxa4 Kxd5= **44.Kxa4 g4 45.fxg4** (45.f4 h5 46.Bb5 Kxd5 47.Bd3 h4 48.Bxf5 g3 49.hxg3 hxg3 50.Bh3 Ke4=) **45...fxg4 46.Kb4 h5 47.Be8** 47.Kc4? runs into 47...h4 48.Kd4 g3 49.hxg3 h3!–+ **47...Kxd5 48.Bxh5 Ke5 49.Bxg4** ½–½



E14.05A *K.Müller* (2533) - *A.Khalifman* (2628) German Bundesliga 2000, SG Porz - Hamburger SK, 3rd board

Khalifman used a similar motif against me: **59...g4! 60.a6 f4 61.a7 Rf8 62.a8Q Rxa8 63.Bxa8 fxg3 0–1**



E14.06 *M.Zwettler - F.Loidl*
Ybbs 2002

67.Bxf5+?? was very unfortunate as **67...Kf3! 68.Bxg4+ Kxf2 ½–½** draws. 67.Kd6 was called for: 67...Kf3 68.Ke5 Kxf2 69.Kf4+-

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller

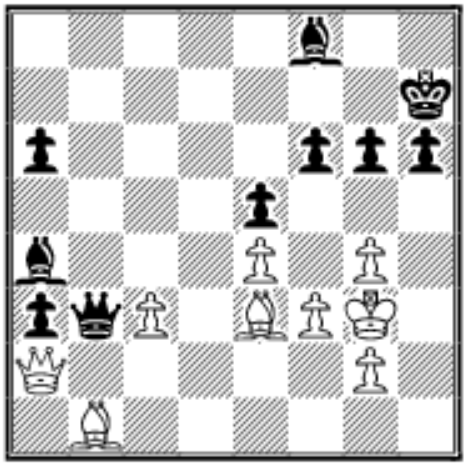


Ponomariov's Technique

Part 2

I continue my analysis of Ponomariov's recent endgames (for the first part see the **ChessCafe.com Archives**):

16.01 *R.Ponomariov* (2727) - *V.Ivanchuk* (2717) FIDE WCh Final Moscow 2002



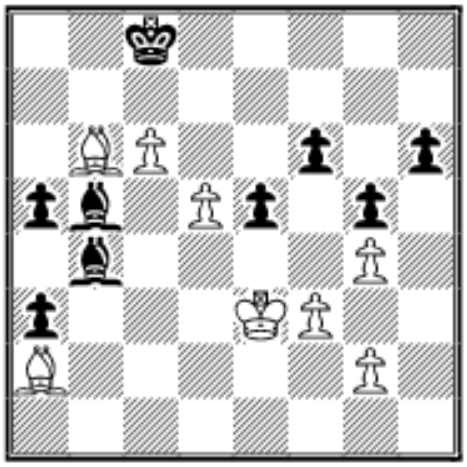
I start with two examples from the final of the FIDE World Championship, where he was a bit lucky:

47...Kg7?? A very unfortunate idea. In principle it is good to activate the king to prepare for the endgame, but the queens are still on the board and so more care was required.

47...a5 with the idea to exchange queens was the right way to proceed. White is defenceless, e.g., 48.Kf2 Qxa2+ 49.Bxa2 Bc2 50.Ke2 a4 51.Bd5 (51.Kd2 Bb3 52.Bxb3 axb3 53.Kc1 Kg7–+) 51...Bb3 52.Bc1 Bc5 53.Kd3 Kg7 54.Bc4 g5 55.Bd5 Kf8–+ (Hübner in *Schach* 3/2002)

48.Qd2! This counterattack gives White equality. **48...g5** (48...Qxb1 49.Bxh6+ Kg8 (49...Kh8? 50.Bxf8 a2?? 51.Qh6+ Kg8 52.Qg7#) 50.Qd5+ Kh7 51.Bxf8 Qe1+=)

49.Ba2 Qb7 50.Qd3 Be8 (50...Bb3?? 51.Qb1+-; 50...Bc6?? 51.Qc4+-) **51.Qd5 Qxd5 52.exd5 a5 53.c4 Bb4 54.c5 Kf8 55.Kf2 Bb5 56.c6 Ke7 57.Ba7 Kd8** (57...Kd6!?=) **58.Bb6+ Kc8** 58...Ke7 draws as well. **59.Ke3**



59...a4? wastes precious time and allows White's king to support his connected passed pawns. 59...Bf1! was called for: 60.g3 a4 61.Bb1 Bd6 62.Ba2= (Hübner) **60.Ke4 Be2** (60...Bf1 61.Kf5 Bxg2 62.Bc4 a2 [62...Bd6 63.Ke6 Bc7 64.Bxc7 Kxc7 65.d6++-] 63.Ba6+ Kb8 64.c7+ Ka8 65.c8Q#; 60...Bd6 61.Kf5 Bc7 62.Bxc7 Kxc7 63.Ke6 Bxc6 [63...Kb6 64.Ke7 Kc7 65.d6++-] 64.dxc6 Kxc6 65.Kxf6 Kd6 66.g3 Kc5 67.Kxe5 Kb4 68.Kd4 Kb5 69.f4+-) **61.Kf5 e4 62.Ke6 exf3 63.d6 Bxd6 64.Kxd6 1–0**

In the second round he even managed to reach a draw a piece down:

16.02 *V.Ivanchuk* (2717) - *R.Ponomariov* (2727) FIDE WCh Final Moscow 2002



39...h3!? opens lines against White's king and prepares the following king march. **40.gxh3** Of course not 40.g4?? h2+ 41.Kg2 Rf1–+ **40...Kd5 41.Rxa4 Ke4 42.Nf2+ Kf3**



White has to be careful now as his king is under attack:
43.Rxd4?

43.Rc4! was much stronger, e.g. 43...Re5 44.Nd3 Re2 45.b4 Rg2+ 46.Kf1 Rh2 47.Ne1+ Ke4 48.Bg7 Rd2 49.Rc2+-

43...Bc5 44.Rd2

44.Rd3+ comes into consideration as well: 44...Ke2 45.Rd2+ Ke1 (45...Kf3? 46.Kf1 Kg3 47.Rd3+ Kh2 48.Be3+-) 46.Kg2 *(46.Rc2 Bxf2+ 47.Kg2 Rf6)* 46...Bxf2 47.Rd7 Bh4 48.Be3 Ke2 49.Bg1 Rg5+ 50.Kh1 Rh5 51.Rxc7 Bf6 and in both cases it is not completely clear, if White can win.

44...Rf6! Continuing the attack is stronger than regaining the piece with 44...Kg3? 45.Rd3+ Rf3 46.Rxf3+ Kxf3 47.a4 Bxf2+ 48.Kf1+- **45.Bg5?!**

45.Rc2!? Bd4

A) 46.Bg5?! is less clear than 46.Bc1 although after 46...Rg6 47.Kf1 Rxg5 48.Rxc7 White's winning chances are still alive, e.g.,

A1) 48...Bxf2 49.Rf7+ Kg3 50.Rxf2 Ra5

A2) 48...Rf5 49.Nd1 Ke4+ 50.Ke2 Rh5 51.Nc3+

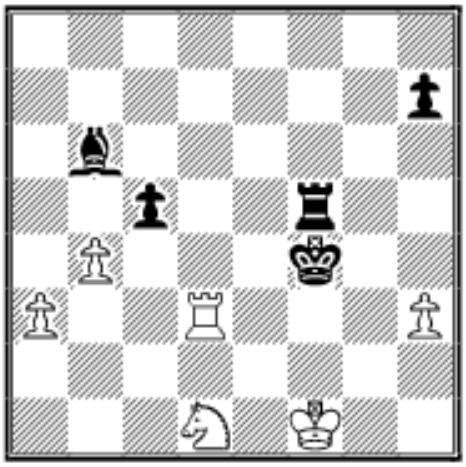
A3) 48...Bxb2? 49.Rf7+ Kg3 *(49...Ke3 50.Nd1++-)* 50.Ne4++-

B) 46.Bc1!? 46...Kg3 *(46...Rg6+ 47.Kf1 Rg2 48.a4+-)* 47.Rc3++-

45...Rg6 46.Kf1?

46.h4! h6 47.Kf1 (47.Rc2?! Be3 48.Kf1 hxg5 49.hxg5 c5 50.Nh3 Rd6) 47...hxg5 48.Rd3+ Kf4 49.Nh3+ Ke4 50.Rc3 (Kasparov according to *New in Chess* magazine 2/2002) and White should still have excellent winning chances,e.g. 50...g4 51.Nf2+ Kd5 52.Rd3+ Ke5 53.b4 Bb6 54.Kg2

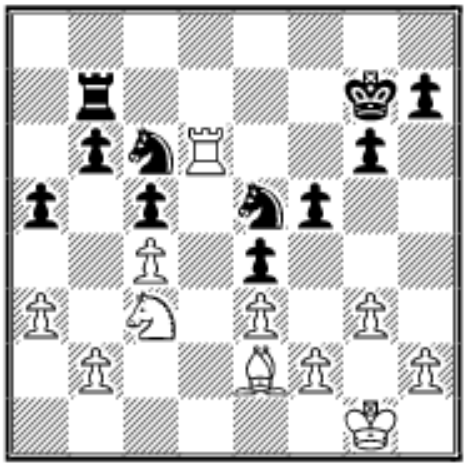
46...Rxg5 Black's activity is now enough compensation for the missing pawn. **47.Rd3+ Kf4 48.Rc3 Bb6 49.b4 Rd5 50.Rd3 Rf5 51.Nd1 c5**



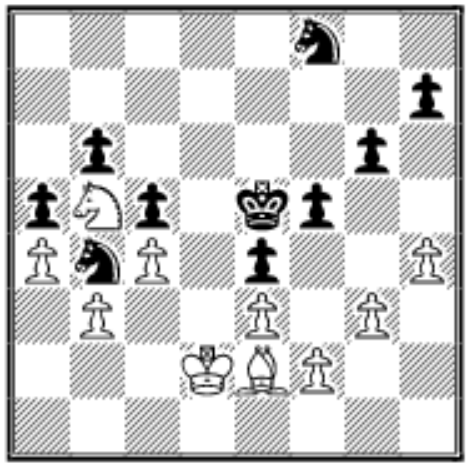
52.Nc3 (52.Rd6?? Ke5+–+) **52...cxb4 53.axb4 Ke5+ 54.Ke1 Rf4 55.Rd5+ Ke6 56.Rb5 Bc7 57.Nd5 Re4+ 58.Kf2 Bd6 ½–½**

In the next example Ponomariov defeated a very strong and experienced grandmaster:

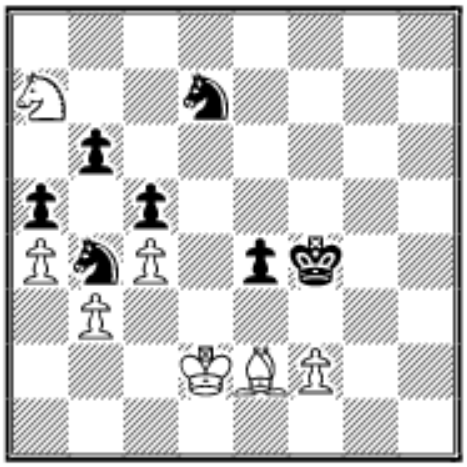
16.03 *A.Beliavsky* (2659) - *R.Ponomariov* (2684) EUCup 17th Panormo 2001



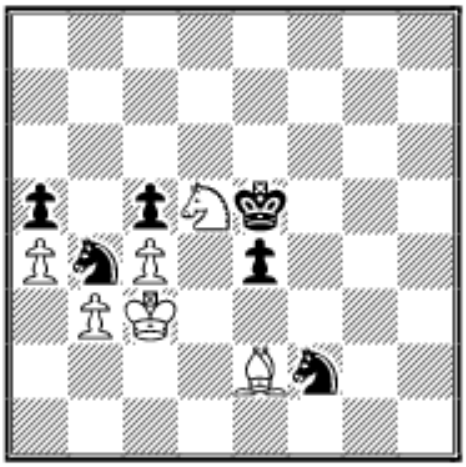
Black's knights are a powerful force, but it is still a lot of work ahead of him. First he exchanges the active white rook: **27...Rd7! 28.Rxd7+ Nxd7 29.h4 Nce5 30.Kf1 Kf6 31.Ke1 Ke6 32.Nd5 Kd6 33.a4 Nc6 34.b3** White has protected the weak pawn c4, but the price is high as all his queenside pawns are now on light squares. **34...Nb4 35.Nc3 Ke5 36.Kd2 Nf8 37.Nb5**



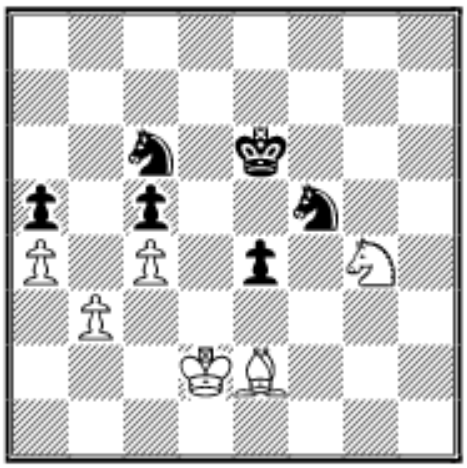
After activating his king he now advances his kingside pawns to gain further space. **37...h6 38.Nc3 g5 39.hxg5 hxg5 40.Nd1 Nd7 41.Nc3 Nf6 42.Nb5 f4 43.gxf4+ gxf4 44.exf4+ Kxf4 45.Na7 Nd7**



46.Kc3? Now f2 becomes really weak. 46.Nc8 looks more logical. **46...Ne5 47.Nc8** (47.Kd2?! Nbd3 48.Bxd3 Nxd3 49.Ke2 [49.Nc8 Kf3 50.Nxb6 Kxf2 51.Nd5 Ne5–+) 49...Nc1+–+] **47...Ned3 48.Nxb6 Nxf2 49.Nd5+ Ke5**



50.Ne3 Exchanging the knights loses in a common way. First Black's knight is transferred to his optimal blockading outpost c5 and then his king penetrates decisively: 50.Nxb4? cxb4+ 51.Kd2 Kd4 52.Kc1 (52.Ke1 e3 53.Bf3 Nd3+ 54.Kf1 Kc3 55.Ke2 Nc1+ 56.Kxe3 Nxb3–+) 52...e3 53.Kc2 Ne4 54.Bd1 Nc5 55.Be2 now Black's king breaks through on the kingside: 55...Ke4 56.Bh5 Kf4 57.Be2 Kg3–+ **50...Nh3 51.Bd1 Ng5 52.Bh5 Ne6 53.Bd1 Nd4 54.Ng2 Nf3 55.Ne3** (55.Bxf3? exf3 56.Ne3 Kf4 57.Kd2 Nc6 58.Nd5+ Kg3 59.Ke1 Nd4–+) **55...Nh4 56.Ng4+ Kf5 57.Ne3+ Kf4 58.Nd5+ Ke5 59.Nb6 Nf5 60.Nd7+ Kd6 61.Nf6 Ng3 62.Ng4 Ke6 63.Kd2 Nf5 64.Be2 Nc6**

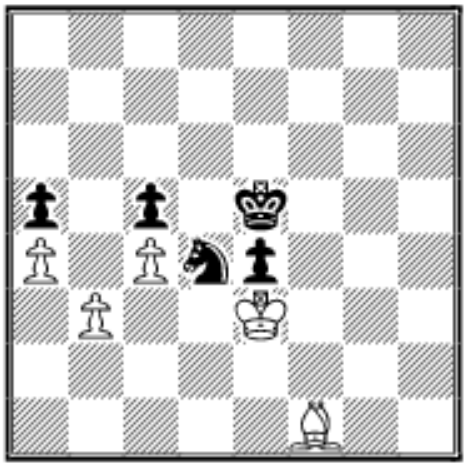


65.Bf1? Can Black win against the alternatives 65.Bd1 and 65.Kc3?

I 65.Bd1! Ncd4 66.Nh2 Ke5 67.Ng4+ Kf4 68.Nf6 Nf3+ 69.Kc3 N5d4 70.Nd7 Ne6 71.Nf6 Kf5 72.Nd5! *(72.Nd7? Ne5 73.Nb6 Kf4 74.Nd5+ Kg3 75.Bc2 Ng5 76.Bd1 Kf2–+)* 72...Kg4 73.Nf6+

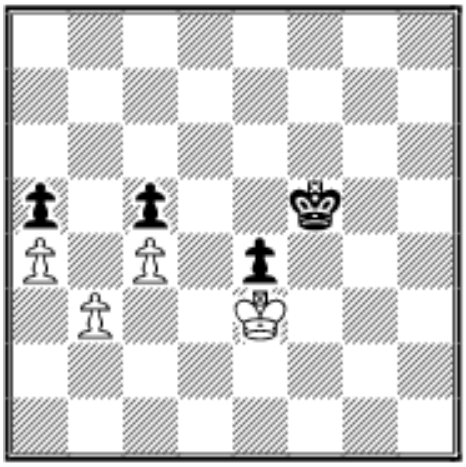
II 65.Kc3 Ne5 66.Nf2 Ng3 67.Kd2 *(67.Bd1? e3 68.Nh3 Kf5 69.Ng1 Ne4+ 70.Kc2 Nc6 71.Bh5 Nb4+ 72.Kd1 Ng3 73.Bf3 Ke5–+)* 67...Nc6 68.Bd1 *(68.Ng4? Nxe2 69.Kxe2 Kf5 70.Ne3+ Ke5 71.Nd5 Nd4+ 72.Ke3 Nf5+–+)* 68...Ke5 69.Ng4+ Kf4 70.Ne3 Nf5 71.Nd5+ Ke5 72.Kc3

65...Ne5! 66.Ne3 (66.Bh3 Nxg4 67.Bxg4 Ke5 68.Be2 Nd4 69.Bd1 Kf4 70.Kc3 Ke3–+) **66...Nf3+! 67.Ke2 N3d4+ 68.Kf2 Nxe3 69.Kxe3 Ke5 0-1**



and White resigned. A possible finish is **70.Bg2**

The pawn ending after 70.Bh3 Nf5+ 71.Bxf5 Kxf5

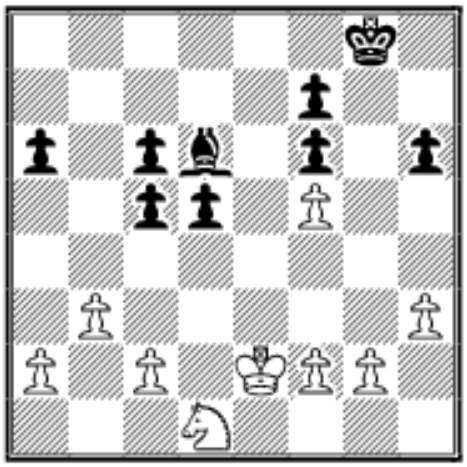


is completely lost **(the technique is worth knowing!):** 72.Ke2 Kf4 73.Kf2 e3+ 74.Ke2 Ke4 75.Ke1 Kf3 76.Kf1 e2+ 77.Ke1 Ke3 and now White has to commit suicide: 78.b4 cxb4–+

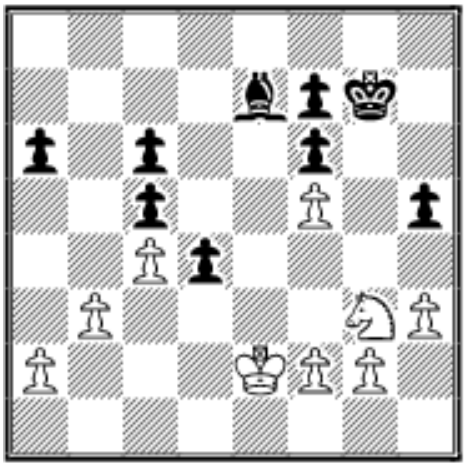
70...Nf5+ 71.Ke2 Kf4 72.Kf2 Nd4 73.Ke1 Nxb3 74.Ke2 Nd4+ 75.Kf2 Nf3 76.Ke2 Ne5–+

The next example is easier:

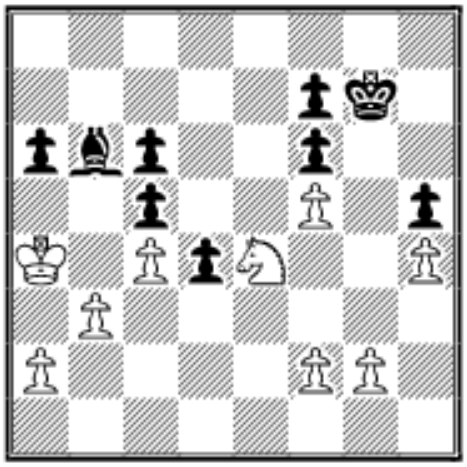
16.04 *A.Volokitin* (2493) - *R.Ponomariov* (2673)
Lausanne Young Masters 2001



White's knight is much superior due to the closed nature of the position and White's pawns are securely placed on light squares: **27...Be5 28.Ne3 Kf8 29.c4!** a good strategy, which gives White's knight the ideal blockding square d3 and the mighty central square e4. **29...d4 30.Nf1 h5 31.Nd2 Bd6 32.Ne4 Be7 33.Ng3 Kg7**



34.h4!? Imprisoning Black's king is even more convincing than grabbing the h-pawn. **34...Kh6 35.Ne4 Kg7 36.Kd3** the start of a king march to the queenside. **36...Kh7 37.Kc2 Kh6 38.Kb2 Kg7 39.Ka3 Bd8 40.Ka4 Bb6** (40...d3 41.Ka3 Ba5 42.Kb2 Bb4 43.f3+-)



Black is completely dominated, but how to deal the decisive blow? **41.b4!** the right moment to grab more space **41...cxb4 42.c5 Bc7 43.Kxb4 Bf4 44.Kc4 Be5 45.Ng3 a5 46.Ne2 1–0**

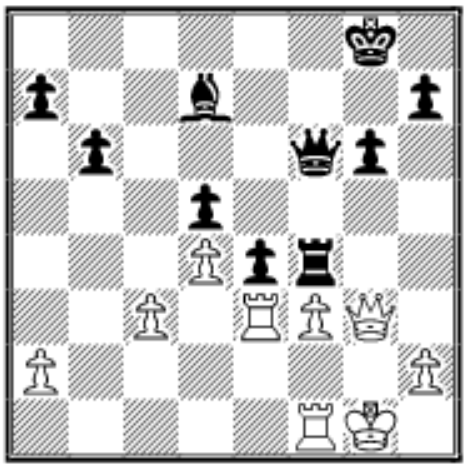
I want to end my discussion with three examples in which Ponomariov defeated very strong grandmasters:

16.05 *R.Ponomariov* (2684) - *A.Morozevich* (2742) FIDE WCh Moscow 2001

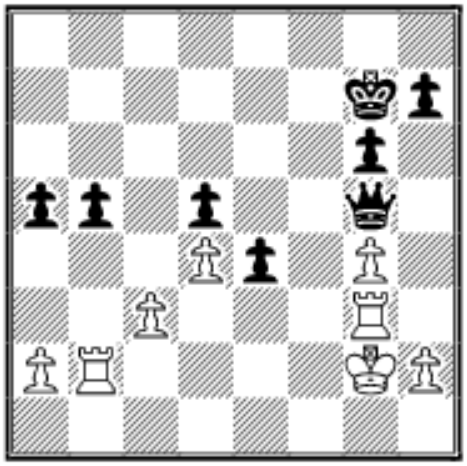


29.exd6! Qxd6 (29...cxd6 30.Qd7 Qg7 31.Qxd6+-) **30.Qxd6 cxd6 31.Re1** A good example of the power of a rook on an open file. **31...Rf8 32.Re7 Bb8 33.Nd2 Ng7 34.Nf3 Re8 35.Rb7 d5 36.Rb6 h5 37.Bg6 Rc8 38.Nxg5 f3 39.gxf3 Bf4 40.h4 Bc1 41.Rxa6 Bxb2 42.Bf7** threatening mate **42...Ne8 43.Rg6 Nc7 44.Rc6 Ra8 1–0**

16.06 *P.Svidler* (2686) - *R.Ponomariov* (2684) FIDE WCh Moscow 2001

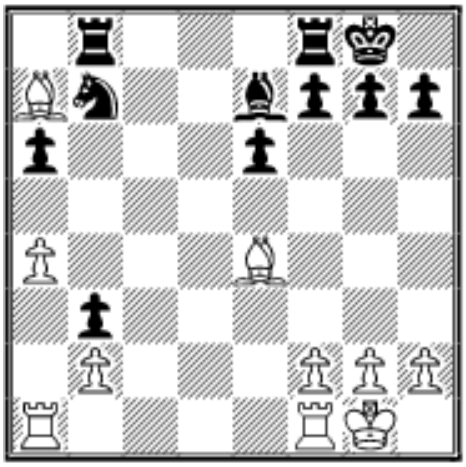


25...Bg4! 26.Qxg4 (26.fxg4? Rxf1+ 27.Kg2 Ra1 28.Qb8+ Qf8–+) **26...Rxg4+ 27.fxg4 Qg5 28.Rg3 b5 29.Rf2 Kg7 30.Kg2 a5 31.Rb2**

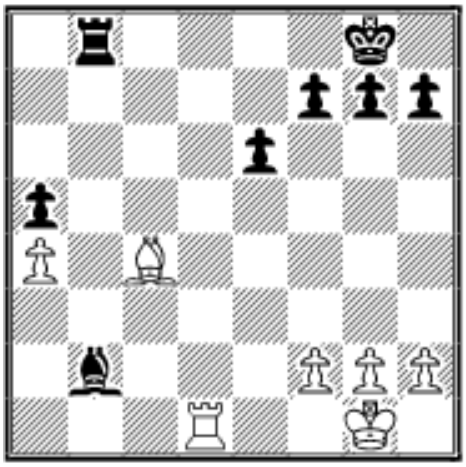


31...b4! Ponomariov wants to create two connected passed passed pawns. An important weapon for the queen fighting against two rooks. **32.cxb4 axb4 33.h3 Qc1 34.Rgb3 Kh6 35.Rxb4 Qd1 36.Kf2 Kg5 37.Re2 Kf4 38.Rb3 Qxd4+ 39.Kg2 Qc4 40.Rf2+ Kg5 41.Rf7 d4 42.h4+ Kxh4 43.Rxh7+ Kxg4 44.Rg3+ Kf5 0–1**

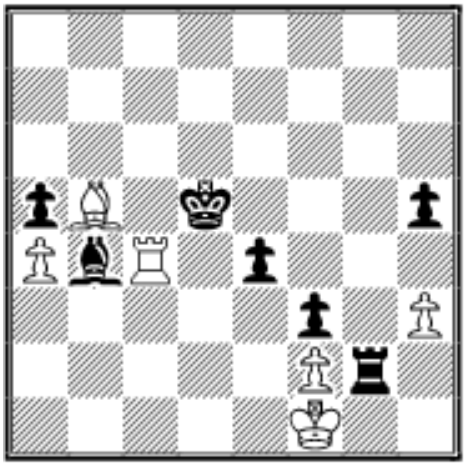
16.07 *A.Dreev* (2676) - *R.Ponomariov* (2684) World Teams Yerevan 2001



22...Nc5! Instead of fighting against the bishop pair, Ponomariov decides to sacrifice an exchange and to play on the dark squares. **23.Bc6 Rb4 24.Rfd1 Rc8 25.Bxc5 Bxc5 26.Rac1 Bd4 27.Bb5 Rb8 28.Rc4 Rxc4 29.Bxc4 Bxb2 30.Bxb3 a5 31.Bc4**



This endgame should be drawn, but the presence of rooks gives Black some hope. In the following Ponomariov shows how to play for a win: **31...g6 32.g3 Rc8 33.Bb5 Rc2 34.Bd3 Rc5 35.Kg2 Kg7 36.Bb5 Ba3 37.Rd2 Bb4 38.Re2 e5** the pawns start to roll. White should probably stop this by grabbing more space on the kingside himself. **39.Re4 h5 40.Rc4 Rd5 41.Rc7 e4 42.Rc4 Re5 43.Bc6 f5 44.Rc2 g5 45.Rc4 Kf6 46.Rc2 Re7 47.Bb5 f4 48.Rc6+ Ke5 49.gxf4+ gxf4 50.Rg6 Kf5 51.Rg8 Rc7 52.Rc8 f3+!** (52...Rxc8? 53.Bd7+=) **53.Kf1 Rg7 54.Rc4 Ke5 55.Bc6 Rg4 56.Bb5 Rg2 57.h3 Kd5**

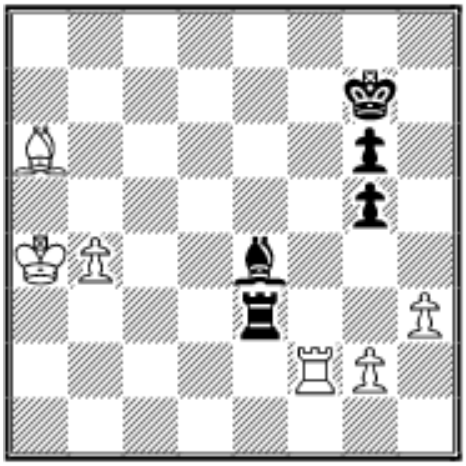


58.Rc8? 58.Ba6 was more tenacious although it already looks very unlikely, that White will be able to save his skin.
58...Bc5–+ 59.Rd8+ Ke5 60.Re8+ Kf4 61.Rc8 Bxf2 62.Rc4 0-1

Sources:
ChessBase *MEGABASE 2001*
The Week in Chess
Schach No.3/2002
New in Chess magazine No.2/2002

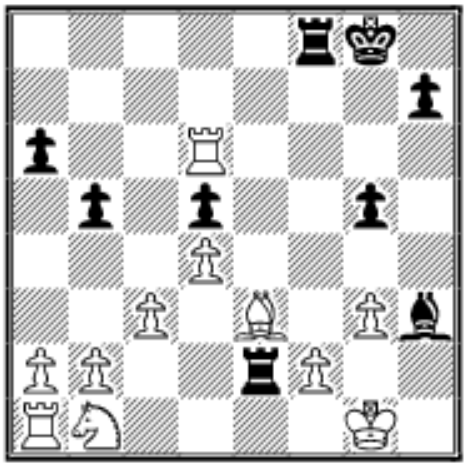
Exercises (Solutions next month)

Three exercises from the recent super tournament in Linares, where Ponomariov showed, that he already belongs to the circle of the world's top players and his win of the FIDE world championship was no accident:



E16.01 *M.Adams* (2742) - *R.Ponomariov* (2727)
SuperGM Linares 2002

Adams played 46.Rf2 and won later. Is 46.Re2 winning as well?



E16.02 *R.Ponomariov* (2727) - *V.Anand* (2757) SuperGM Linares 2002

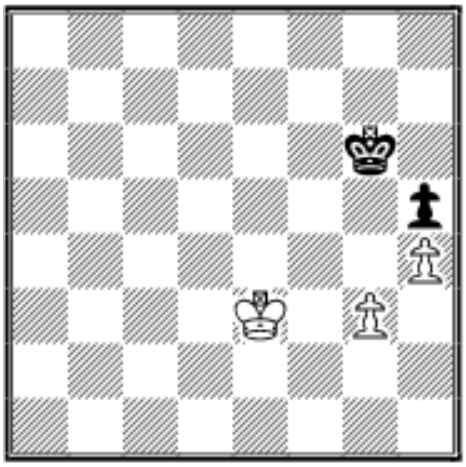
Anand has sacrificed a piece to reach this position. What was his idea? (Black to move)



E16.03 *R.Ponomariov* (2727) - *G.Kasparov* (2838) SuperGM Linares 2002

Kasparov played 43...Kf7 (43...Rf2! looks much more dangerous). What was Ponomariov's reply?

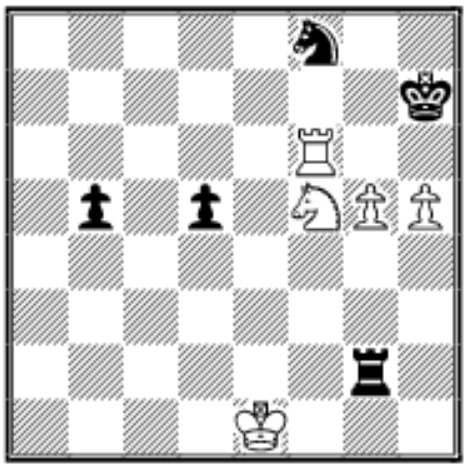
Solutions to last month exercises



E15.01 *R.Ponomariov* (2673) - *A.Moiseenko* (2561) 3rd Rector Cup Kharkov 2001

Black can't allow White's king to reach the opposition on the fourth rank. So the two drawing moves are **57...Kf5** ½–½ 58.Kf3 Ke5! 59.g4 hxg4+! 60.Kxg4 Kf6= and **57...Kf7** 58.Kf3 Ke7! 59.Ke3 Kf7! 60.Kd4 Kf6! 61.Ke4 Ke6!= Did you find both?

But not 57...Kg7? 58.Ke4! Kf6 59.Kf4! Kg6 60.Ke5! Kg7 61.Kf5! Kh6 62.Kf6! Kh7 63.Kg5!+-



E15.02 *R.Ponomariov* (2684) - *R.Vaganian* (2650) World Teams Yerevan 2001

Ponomariov won nicely with **56.Rf7+ Kg8 57.Nh6+ 1–0**

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

Karsten Müller



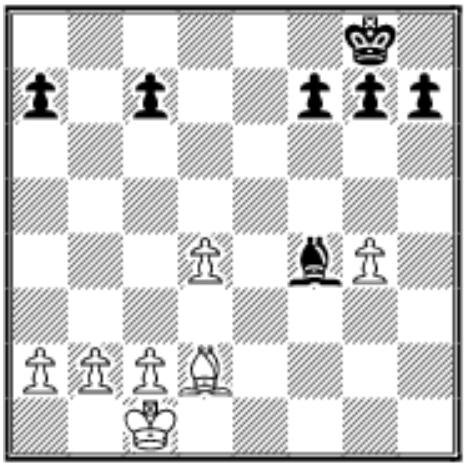
Readers Write

I have received several e-mails with interesting endgame material from readers and friends. Now it is time to deal with some of them:

A) In Pawn Endings Precise Calculation is Very Important

Joe Shipman (USA) has send me the following razor sharp pawn ending (the analysis is based on Joe's):

17.01 *Gorokhovski - J.Shipman* 15th US Correspondence Chess Championship (ICCF), Section 3

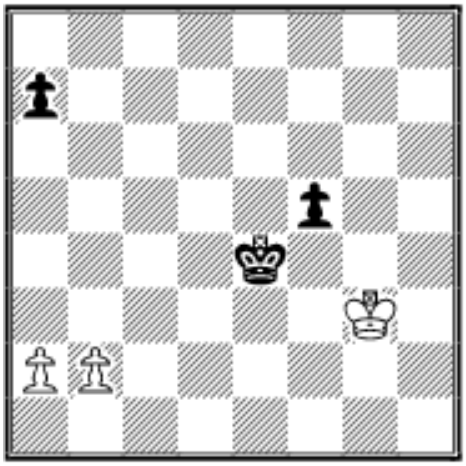


25...g5! Joe had to calculate the resulting pawn ending very precisely to make sure that he didn't lose. ...g5 makes a lot of sense as it speeds up Black's play on the kingside. **26.Bxf4 gxf4 27.Kd2 f5!** a nice move to save time again. It makes life really hard for White. **28.gxf5?!** extremely risky.

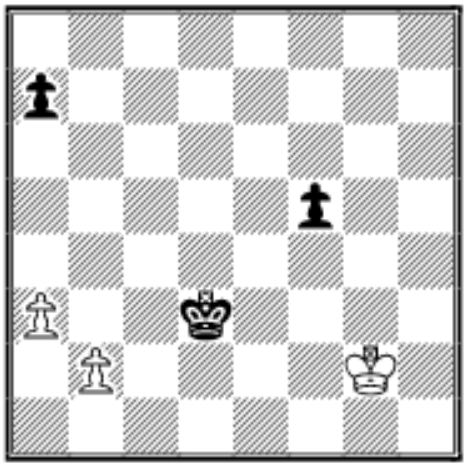
28.g5 was called for: 28...Kf7 29.Ke2 Kg6 30.Kf3 Kxg5 31.d5 h5 32.c4 h4 33.c5 Kf6 34.Kxf4 h3 35.Kg3 Ke5 36.d6 cxd6

A) 37.c6 is easier: 37...Ke6 38.b4 *(38.Kxh3? a5–+)* 38...d5 39.Kxh3 d4 40.Kg3 Kd6 41.b5 a6 42.a4=

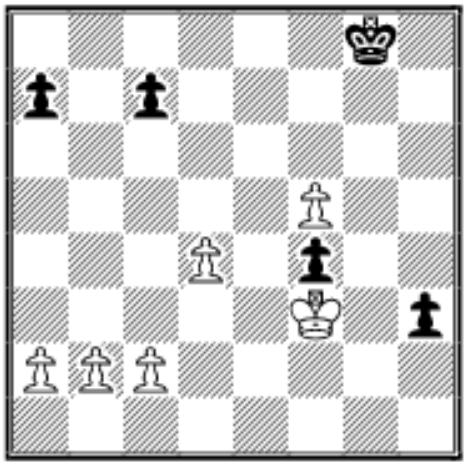
B) 37.cxd6?! Kxd6 38.Kxh3 Ke5 39.Kg3 Ke4



A very delicate situation has arisen. White has only one move to save himself: 40.a3! Ke3 *(40...a6 41.b4 Ke3 42.Kg2=)* 41.Kg2 Kd3

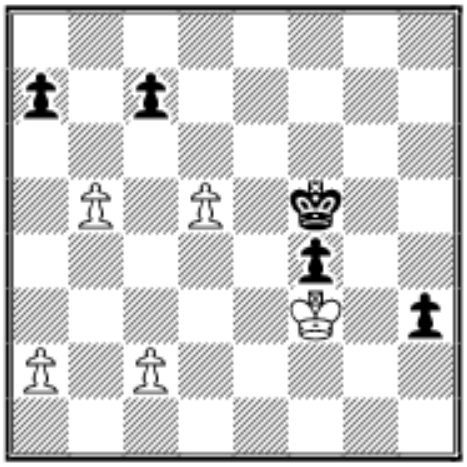


Again there is only one move left: 42.Kg3! *(42.Kf3? Kc2 43.a4 a5 44.b4 axb4 45.a5 b3 46.a6 b2 47.a7 b1Q 48.a8Q Qh1+–+)* 42...Kc2 43.a4 a5 *(43...Kxb2 44.a5 Kc3 45.a6 Kc4 46.Kf4 Kb5 47.Kxf5 Kxa6 48.Ke4=)* 44.b4 axb4 45.a5= **28...h5 29.Ke2 h4 30.Kf3 h3**



Black threatens to advance his king to f5 devouring the pawn on the way. Then he is in position to promote one of his pawns with h2 followed by Ke4. So White has to take measures on the queenside immediately. But which are called for? It is surprisingly difficult: **31.c4?** Now Black's plan can't be stopped anymore. The right way was: 31.b4 Kf7 32.b5 Kf6 33.d5 *(33.c4? Kxf5 34.d5 h2 35.Kg2 Ke4*

36.Kxh2 Kd4–+) 33...Kxf5



And now 34.d6 cxd6 35.a4

A) 35...Ke6? 36.a5 Kd7 37.c4= as 37...d5? 38.cxd5 Kd6 39.a6 Kxd5 40.b6 Kc6 41.bxa7+- even loses.

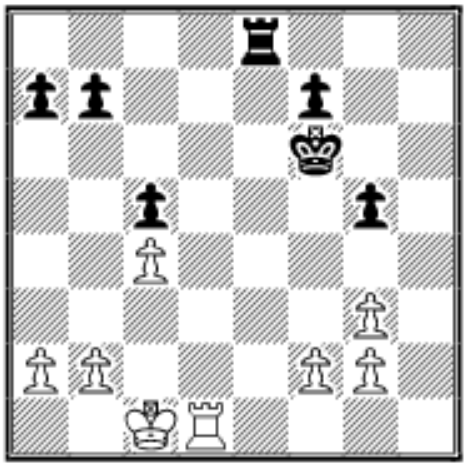
B) 35...Ke5? 36.a5 Kd5 37.c4+ Kc5 38.Kf2 a6 *(38...d5? 39.b6 axb6 40.a6 h2 41.Kg2 Kc6 42.cxd5+-+)* 39.b6 Kc6 40.Kf3=

C) 35...h2 36.Kg2 Ke4 37.Kxh2 Ke3 38.a5 f3 39.b6 axb6 40.axb6 f2 41.b7 f1Q 42.b8Q and with precise play, White should be able to hold the draw.

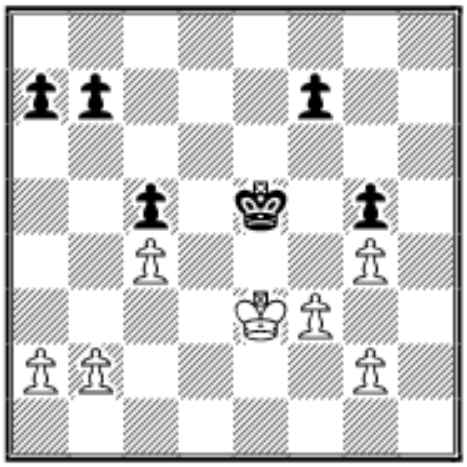
31...Kf7 32.d5 (32.b4 Kf6 33.b5 Kxf5 34.c5 *(34.d5 h2 35.Kg2 Ke4 36.Kxh2 Kd4–+)* 34...h2 35.Kg2 Ke4 36.Kxh2 Kxd4 37.a4 Kxc5–+) **32...Kf6 33.c5** (33.Kf2 Kxf5 34.Kf3 Ke5 35.b3 Kd4 36.a4 h2 37.Kg2 f3+ 38.Kxh2 Ke3–+) **33...Kxf5 0–1**

My teammate in the German Bundesliga, Swedish IM Emanuel Berg, showed me the following two examples in the train from Hamburg to Nürnberg. IM Oliver Reeh (also playing for the Hamburger SK) took part in the analysis as well:

17.02 *E.Berg* (2432) - *A.Rustemov* (2553) Bydgoszcz Bank Pocztowy op Bydgoszcz 2000

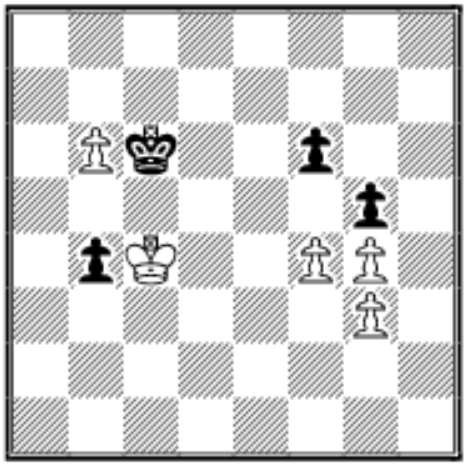


Emanuel has judged correctly, that the resulting pawn ending is won for him: **29.Rd6+ Re6? 30.Rxe6+ Kxe6!** After 30...fxe6 White wins easily by creating an outside passed pawn, e.g. 31.Kd2 g4 32.Ke3 Kf5 33.f3 a6 34.fxg4+ Kxg4 35.Ke4+- **31.Kd2 Ke5** 31...f5 32.Ke3 a6 33.g4 fxg4 34.Ke4+- White has gained the opposition and Black will fall in zugzwang soon. **32.Ke3 Kf5 33.f3 Ke6 34.g4 Ke5**



35.b3? An error as White has to be very careful with his spare moves to win the fight for the opposition in the end. 35.Kd3! was called for, e.g. 35...Kf4 *(35...Kd6 36.Ke4 Ke6 37.g3 f6 38.f4 a6 39.a3 b6 40.b3 b5 41.cxb5 axb5 42.a4 c4 43.a5 cxb3 44.Kd3+-* the outside passed pawn decides the issue.*)* 36.Ke2 Kg3 37.Kf1 a6 38.a3 b5 39.b3 bxc4 40.bxc4 Kh2 41.Kf2 a5 42.a4 f6 43.f4 gxf4 44.Kf3 Kg1 45.Kxf4 Kxg2 46.Kf5 Kf3 47.Kxf6 Kxg4 48.Ke5+-

35...a6? Black returns the compliment. 35...Kd6! saves all spare tempi and draws: 36.Ke4 Ke6 37.g3 f6 38.a3 b6 39.f4 a6 40.b4 cxb4 41.axb4 a5 42.c5 axb4 43.cxb6 Kd6 44.Kd4 Kc6 45.Kc4



45...Kb7!! 46.Kb3 Kc6 47.Kxb4 Kxb6

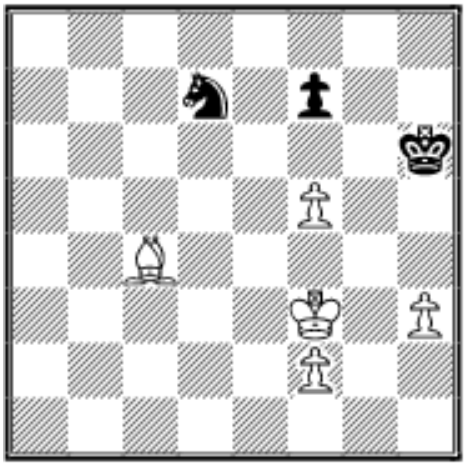
A) 48.Kb3 Kb7 *(48...Kb5 49.Kc3 Kc5 50.Kd3 gxf4 51.gxf4 Kd5*= draws as well.*)* 49.Kc3 Kc7 50.Kd3 Kd7 51.Ke4 Ke6=

B) 48.f5 Kc6 49.Kc4 Kd6 50.Kb5 Kd5 51.Kb6 Kd6=

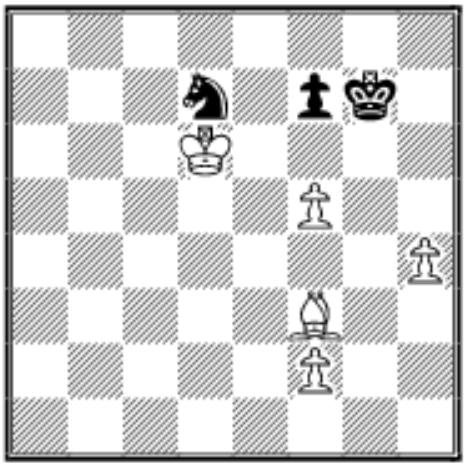
36.a3 a5 37.Kd3 Emanuel gives Rustemov no second chance **37...Kf4 38.Ke2 Kg3 39.Kf1 Kh2 40.Kf2 b6 41.a4 1-0** and Black resigned due to **41...Kh1 42.f4 gxf4 43.g5 Kh2 44.Kf3 Kg1 45.Kxf4 Kxg2 46.Kf5 Kf3 47.Kf6 Kf4 48.Kxf7 Kxg5 49.Ke6+-**

B) Knight against Bishop

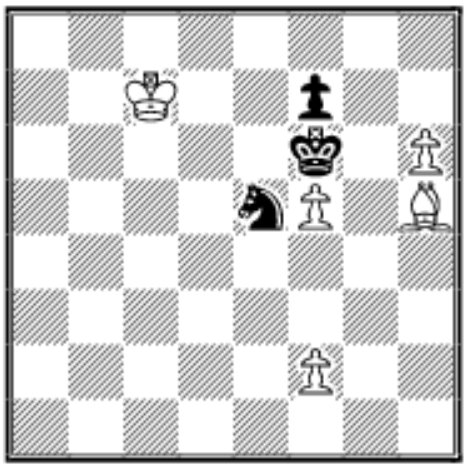
17.03 *E.Berg* (2500) - *H.Nakamura* (2430) Bermuda Open Southamton Princess Hotel 2002



Is this a fortress? Emanuel showed that this is not the case: **50.Ke4** Of course not 50.Bxf7? Ne5+= with an easy draw. **50...Nf6+ 51.Ke5 Kg7 52.Bb5 Nh5** (52...Nh7 53.h4 Nf6 54.Be2 Nd7+ 55.Kd6 Nf6 56.Bf3 Kf8 57.h5 Kg7 58.Ke5 Nd7+ 59.Kd5 Kf6 *(59...Nf6+ 60.Kd6 Ng8 61.Ke5+-)* 60.Kd6 Ne5 61.Be2 Kxf5 62.Ke7 Kg5 63.Kf8 Kf6 64.Kg8 Nc6 65.h6 Ne7+ 66.Kh7 Kg5 67.Bd3+-) **53.Be8 Nf6 54.Bc6 Nh5 55.Bf3 Nf6 56.h4 Nd7+ 57.Kd6**



The knight is quite strong when the play is only in a limited area. So White has to make long manoeuvres to break the resistance. **57...Nf6** 57...Nb6!? 58.h5 Kf6 *(58...Nc8+ 59.Kd7 Nb6+ 60.Kd8!* Black is in zugzwang. *60...Nc4 61.Ke7 f6 62.h6+ Kxh6 63.Kxf6+-; 58...Nc4+ 59.Ke7 f6 60.h6+ Kxh6 61.Kxf6+-)* 59.h6 Nc4+ 60.Kc7 Ne5 61.Bh5



and the white king goes to f8 followed by h7. 61...Nd3 62.Kd8 Nxf2 63.Ke8 Ne4 64.Kf8 Ng5 65.Bg4+- **58.h5 Ng8**

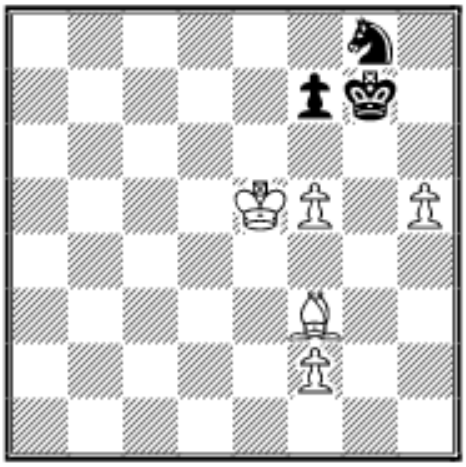
I 58...Nh7 59.Ke7 f6 60.Bg2 Ng5 61.h6+ Kxh6 62.Kxf6 Nh7+ 63.Kf7 Kg5 64.Bh3 Kh4 65.Kg7 Ng5 66.Bg2 Kg4 67.f6+-

II 58...Kf8 59.h6

A) 59...Nh7 60.Ke5 Kg8 *(60...Ke7 61.Bc6 f6+ 62.Kd4 Ng5 63.Bd5+-)* 61.f6 Nf8 62.Kd6+-

B) 59...Ke8 60.Bc6+ Kf8 61.f3 Nh7 *(61...Nh5 62.Ke5 Kg8 63.Bd5+-)* 62.Ke5 Ke7 63.f6+ Nxf6 64.Bb5 Nh7 65.Bd3 Ng5 66.Kf5 *(66.h7? f5!!* complicates matters.*)* 66...Nh7 67.Kf4+-

59.Ke5



59...Kh6

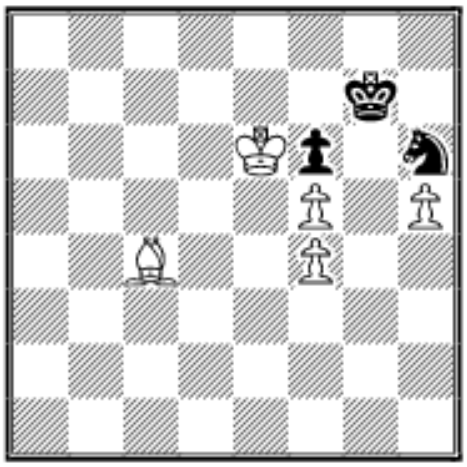
59...f6+ is more principled: 60.Ke6 Nh6 *(60...Kf8 61.Bd5 Ke8 62.f3 Kf8 63.Kd7 Nh6 64.Be6+-)*

A) 61.Bd5 Ng4 62.f3 Ne3 63.Be4 Nc4 64.h6+ Kxh6 65.Kxf6 Nb6 66.Ke7 Nc8+ 67.Kd8 Nd6 68.f6 Kg5 69.Kd7 Nf7 *(69...Nxe4 70.fxe4 Kxf6 71.Kd6+-)* 70.Ke7+-

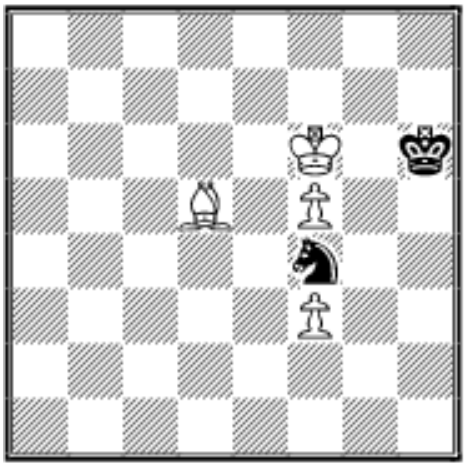
B) 61.Be2 Nf7 62.Bc4 Nh6 63.f3

B1) 63...Ng8 64.Kd7 Nh6 65.Be6 Kh8 66.Ke8 Kh7 67.Bc8 *(67.Kf8?! Kh8 68.f4? Nxf5!=)* 67...Kg7 *(67...Ng8 68.Kf7 Kh8 69.Ba6 Kh7 70.Bb7 Kh8 71.Kg6+-)* 68.Kd8 Nf7+ 69.Ke7 Ne5 70.Bb7 Nd3 71.h6+ Kxh6 72.Kxf6 Nf4 73.Be4+-

B2) 63...Nf7 64.Ke7 *(64.f4? Nh6=*

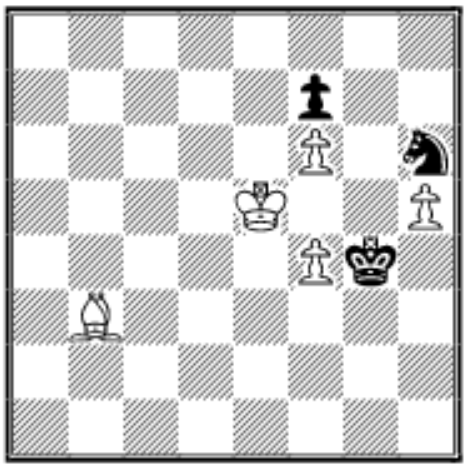


Black keeps the draw, because white can´t protect both the g4 and the g8 square at the same time, while attacking the f6-pawn.(O.Reeh)*)* 64...Ne5 *(64...Nh6 65.Be6+-; 64...Ng5 65.Bd5 Nh7* Now Black's knight can´t come to h6, so *66.f4* is possible: *66...Kh6 67.Bg8+-)* 65.Bd5 Nd3 and finally White manages to get h6+ in: 66.h6+ Kxh6 67.Kxf6 Nf4



68.Be4 A very important move. From here the bishop protects both the f-pawns. It also prepares for a later f5-f6 when Black doesn't have Kg6 anymore. *(68.Bc6?! Nh5+ 69.Kf7 Nf4 70.f6? Kg5! 71.Ke7 Ng6+!=)* 68...Nh5+ 69.Kf7! Black is now in zugzwang. If he just could say pass, whenever this position is reached, it would be a draw. *(69.Ke6?* allows Black to establish an unbreakable blockade: *69...Kg7 70.Ke7 Nf6=)* 69...Kg5 *(69...Nf4 70.f6 Kg5 71.Ke7+-)* 70.Ke6 Now Black is again in trouble. He can´t play Nf6 because of f4+ and he can't move is king because of f6 and the pawn will queen very soon. *(70.Ke7* wins as well: *70...Nf6 71.f4++-)* 70...Nf4+ *(70...Ng7+ 71.Ke5 Ne8 72.f4+ Kg4 73.Bc6+-)* 71.Ke5 Nh5 72.f4++- *(72.f6? Nxf6 73.f4+ Kg4!=)*

60.f6 Kg5 61.Be2 Nh6 62.Bd1! Kh4 63.f4 Kg3 64.Bb3 Kg4



Now White is active enough to sacrifice his bishop: **65.Bxf7! Nxf7+ 66.Ke6 Nd8+ 67.Kd7 Kf5** (67...Nf7 68.Ke7 Nh6 69.f7 Nxf7 70.Kxf7 Kxh5 71.f5+-) **68.Kxd8 Kxf6 69.h6 Kf7 70.f5 Kf8 71.f6 Kg8 72.Ke7 Kh7 73.f7 1–0**

Paavo Honkakoski from Finland has sent me the following fight:

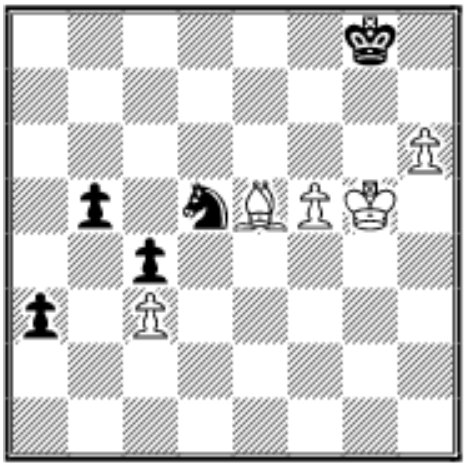
17.04 *P.Honkakoski - G.Brajnikov* CP–1999-S–00001

IECG



42...Kf7? Centralizing the knight immediately with 42...Nc7!? wins:

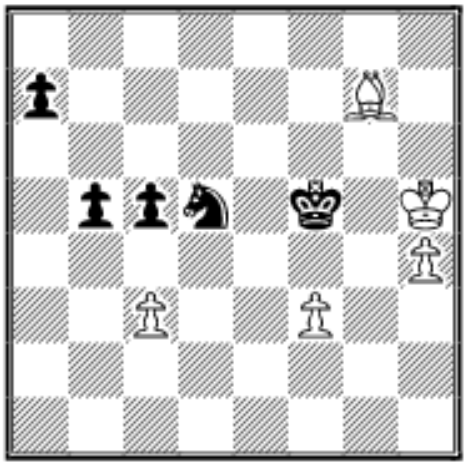
A) 43.f4 Nd5 44.f5+ Kf7 45.Be5 a5 46.Kxh5 *(46.c4 bxc4 47.Kxh5 c3 48.Kg5 a4 49.h5 a3 50.h6 c2–+)* 46...c4 47.Kg5 a4 48.h5 a3 49.h6 Kg8



50.f6 *(50.Kg6 Ne7+ 51.Kf6 Nc6–+)* 50...Nxf6 51.Bxf6 Kh7–+

B) 43.Bf8 c4 44.Bb4 Nd5 45.Ba5 b4 46.cxb4 a6–+

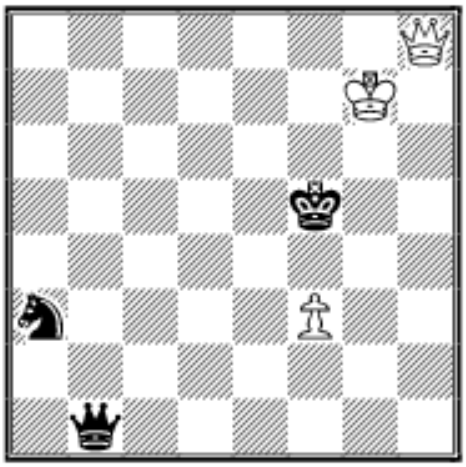
C) 43.Kg6 Nd5 44.Kxh5 Kf5



Now White's king is suffering badly from lack of space 45.Kh6 a5 46.Bf8

C1) Surprisingly, 46...Nxc3? is wrong: 47.Kg7 b4 48.Bxc5 b3 49.Ba3 Nb5

C1a) 50.Bb2? a4 51.h5 a3 52.Bxa3 Nxa3 53.h6 b2 54.h7 b1Q 55.h8Q

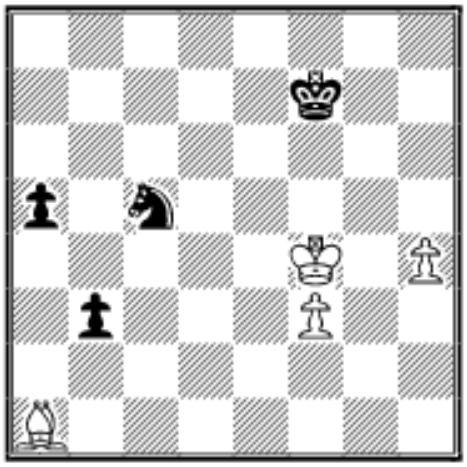


Now Black's wins by the well known mating motif: 55...Qb7+ 56.Kh6 Qc6+ 57.Kg7 *(57.Kh5 Qxf3+ 58.Kh6 Qc6+–+)* 57...Qd7+ 58.Kh6 Qd6+ 59.Kg7 Qe7+ 60.Kg8 *(60.Kh6 Qg5+ 61.Kh7 Qg6#)* 60...Kg6–+

C1b) 50.Bc1! a4 51.h5 a3 52.h6 b2 53.Bxb2 axb2 54.h7 b1Q 55.h8Q Qg1+ 56.Kf8 Qc5+ 57.Kg8 Qc4+ 58.Kh7 Qh4+ 59.Kg8 and it seems that Black can't win.

C2) 46...c4 47.Kg7 Nxc3 48.h5 Nd5 49.h6 Nf4 50.h7 Ng6 White's pawns are securely stopped and Black's triumph: 51.Bc5 c3 52.Be3 b4 53.Bd4 a4 54.Bc5 b3 55.Ba3 b2–+

43.Be5 b4 44.cxb4 cxb4 45.Kxh5 b3 (45...Ke6 46.Bd4 Kf5 47.Bxa7 b3 48.Bd4=) **46.Kg4 Nc5 47.Ba1 a5 48.Kf4**

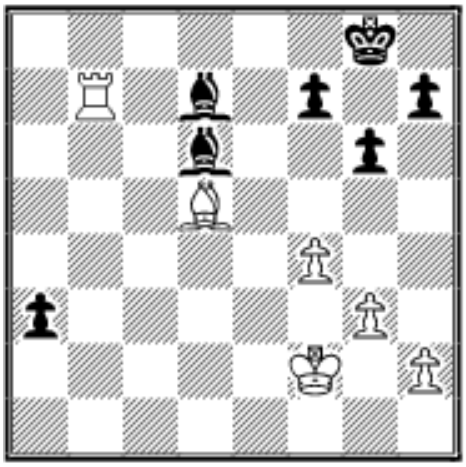


It seems like a miracle, but White's counterplay is just fast enough, so the players agreed a draw after 48...a4. Some sample lines run **48...a4 ½–½** (48...b2 49.Bxb2 Nd3+ 50.Ke3 Nxb2 51.Kd4=) **49.Ke3 a3 50.Kd2 b2 51.Bxb2 axb2 52.Kc2 Na4 53.f4 Kg6 54.Kb1 Kf5 55.h5 Kf6 56.Kc2 Kg7 57.f5 Kg8 58.Kb1=**

Sources:

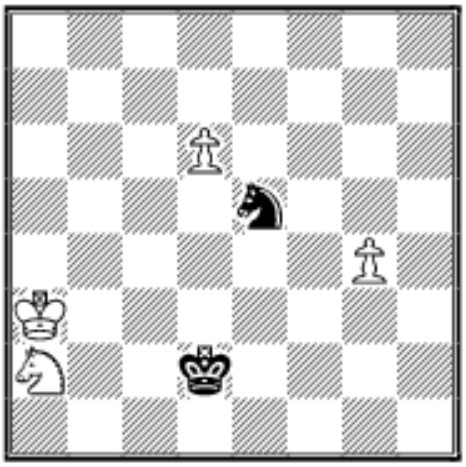
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ChessBase MEGABASE 2001

Exercises (Solutions next month)



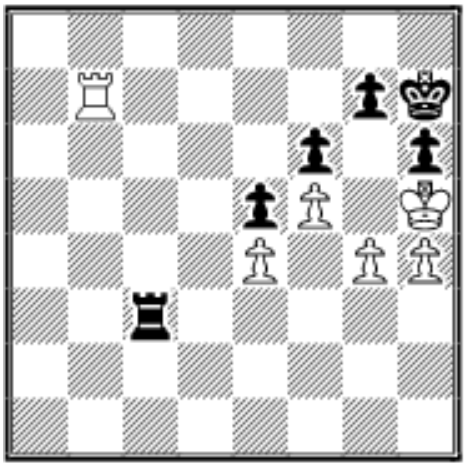
E 17.01 *A.Feuerstein - E.Mednis* U.S. Championship, New York 1957

Sadly, Edmar Mednis passed away recently, so I decided to add one exercise from his games. At first sight it does not look very good for him, but he had an amazing surprise in store. Which one? (Black to move)



E 17.02 W.Müller, K.Müller

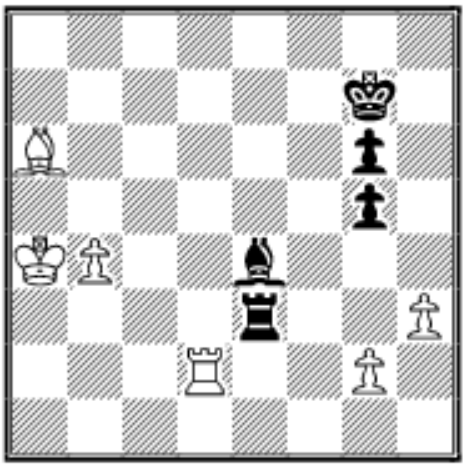
One line of analysis of my father reached the following position. We found a win for White together rather quickly. Can you do the same?



E17.03 *O.H.Meyer* - *S.Puttfarken* Hamburg Youth Championship under 12, Schönhagen 2002

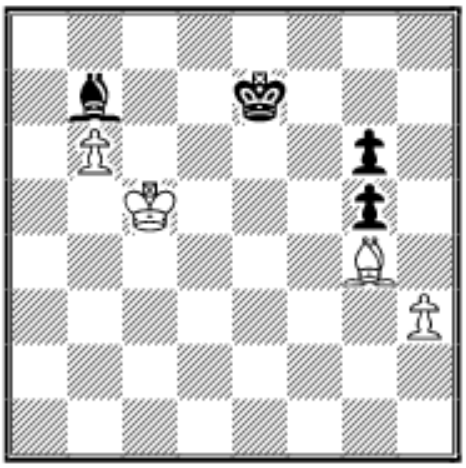
In a youth tournament Black decided to play 1...Rc4. Was this a fortunate choice?

Solutions to last month exercises



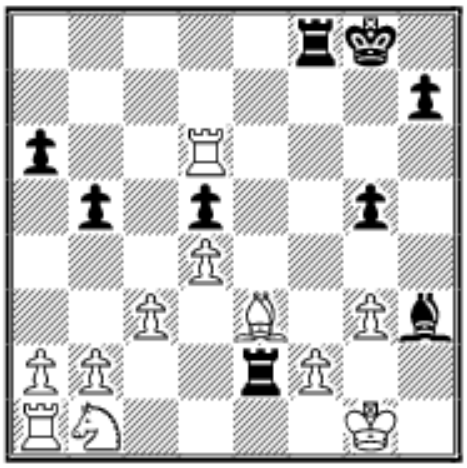
E16.01 *M.Adams* (2742) - *R.Ponomariov* (2727) SuperGM Linares 2002

46.Re2 wins as well. 46.Rf2 was the game continuation and Adams managed to convert his advantage later. **46...Rxe2** (46...Bc6+ 47.b5 Rxe2 48.bxc6 Rc2 49.Kb5 Kf6 50.Kb6 Ke6 *(50...Rxg2 51.c7 Rc2 52.c8Q+-)* 51.c7 Kd7 52.c8Q+ Rxc8 53.Bxc8+ Kxc8 54.Kc6+-) **47.Bxe2 Bxg2 48.Bg4** (48.b5? Bxh3 49.b6 Bg2=) **48...Kf6 49.Kb5 Ke7 50.Kc5 Bf1** (50...Kd8 51.Kd6 Bf1 52.Bd7+-) **51.b5 Bg2 52.b6 Bb7**



And now White has to pass the move to Black **53.Kc4 Kd6** (53...Bc6 54.Kb4 Kd6 55.Ka5 Bb7 56.Kb5 Ke7 57.Kc5+-) **54.Kb5 Ke7 55.Kc5 Bg2 56.Bc8 Bf3** (56...Kd8 57.Be6 Ke7 58.Bd5+-) **57.b7 Bxb7 58.Bxb7** And now White wins by the well known technique of

imprisoning Black's king in the corner to force the g5 pawn to move: **58...Ke6 59.Bc8+ Ke5 60.Bg4 Kf6 61.Kd6 Kf7 62.Kd7 Kf6 63.Ke8 Kg7 64.Ke7 Kg8 65.Kf6 Kh7 66.Kf7 Kh8 67.Kf8 Kh7 68.Be6 Kh8 69.Bg8 g4 70.hxg4 g5 71.Be6+-**



E16.02 *R.Ponomariov* (2727) - *V.Anand* (2757) SuperGM Linares 2002

Anand drew easily with **25...Rxe3** (25...Re1+ may work as well, but is not as convincing as Anand's move, e.g., 26.Kh2 g4 *(26...Bg4 27.Rxd5 h6 28.Rd6 Bf3 29.Nd2 Rxa1 30.Nxf3 Rxf3 31.Rxa6)* 27.Rxd5 Rxe3 28.Rg5+ Kh8 29.Rxg4 Bxg4 30.fxe3 Rf2+ 31.Kg1) **26.fxe3 Rf1+ 27.Kh2 g4 28.Rxd5 ½–½**



E16.03 *R.Ponomariov* (2727) - *G.Kasparov* (2838) SuperGM Linares 2002

Ponomariov played **44.bxc5 Bxc5 ½–½** and due to **45.Ra5=** a draw was agreed.

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COLUMNISTS

Endgame Corner

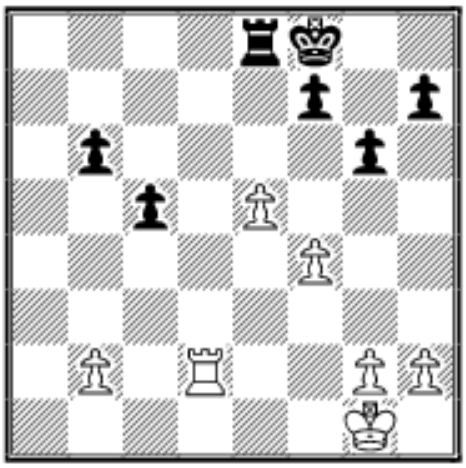
Karsten Müller



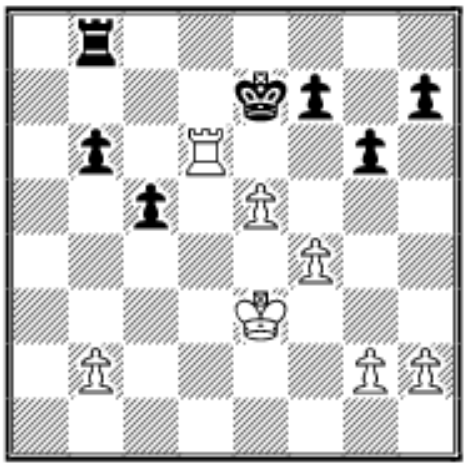
Rooks Revisited

In this column I want to look at some recent endings with at least one rook on the board. I start with pure rook endings: Doug Schwetke from the USA has sent me a very interesting game with his comments. My first **ChessCafe** column dealt with Rook+h and f pawn vs lone Rook (see the **ChessCafe Archives**) and Doug's endgame shows a battle with this material balance and the notorious 4 pawns vs 3 pawns on the kingside:

18.01 *A.Echeverry* (1910) - *D.Schwetke* (1667) DCC GP 8 Dallas, Texas 2002

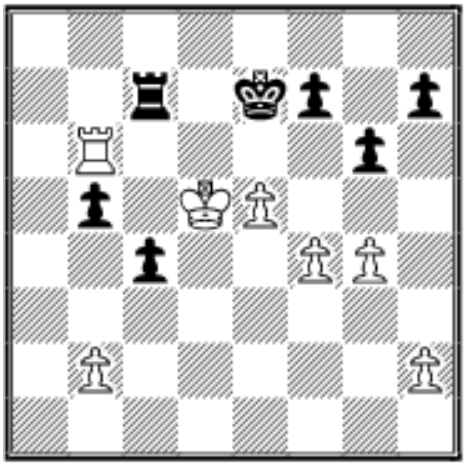


At first White activates his king and his rook and as activity is crucially important in rook endings his position is slightly better. **32.Kf2 Ke7?!** Activating the rook with 32...Ra8 is more precise. **33.Rd6 Rb8 34.Ke3**



34...Rb7?! Schwetke suggests 34...h5 and explains: “Even I know this is the correct pawn formation for Black. This comes back to haunt me big time. I could have played it maybe even as early as 31...h5.” (instead of 31...Kg8-f8) **35.g4!? b5 36.Ke4 c4?!**

36...Ra7! was called for, e.g., 37.Kd5 Ra2 38.Kxc5 Rxb2 39.g5 Rxh2= **37.Kd5 Rc7 38.Rb6**



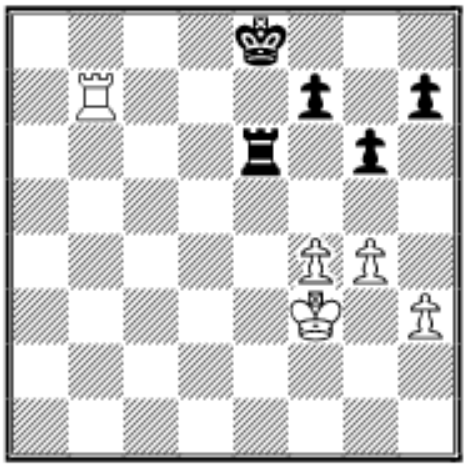
38...c3?! 38...Rd7+! 39.Kc5 Rd2 40.Rxb5 Rxh2 as given by Schwetke was called for, when Black should be able to hold the draw without having to defend an awkward 4 pawns vs 3 pawns rook endgame with the pawns all on the kingside. **39.bxc3 Rxc3 40.Rxb5** "Botvinnik said upon becoming world champion that he would learn to draw the endgame of rook plus 4 pawns vs rook plus 3 pawns with all pawns on the same side of the board. Here I demonstrate why I am not the 'World Champion'." (Schwetke) **40...Rc2?!** 40...Rd3+! was better to force White's king out of his commanding position. **41.Rb7+!** "Nice technique." (Schwetke) **41...Ke8?** 41...Kf8 was more tenacious. **42.h3?**

42.e6! fxe6+ *(42...Rd2+ 43.Ke5 Re2+ 44.Kf6 Rxe6+ 45.Kg7 Re2 46.Rxf7 Rxh2 47.g5 Ra2 48.Rf8+ Ke7 49.Rg8 Rh2 50.Rh8+-)* 43.Kxe6 Re2+ 44.Kf6 Rxh2 45.Kg7 Rh4 46.g5 Rxf4 47.Kxh7 Kf8 48.Kxg6 Rg4 49.Rb8+ Ke7 50.Rg8+-

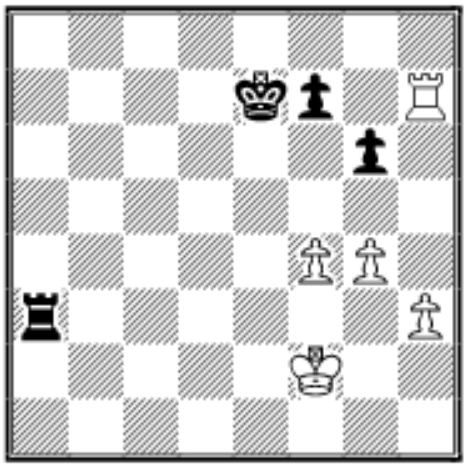
42...Rh2? (42...Rd2+! 43.Ke4 Rh2 was more precise.) **43.e6!** "See how effective the rook on the seventh is here." (Schwetke) **43...Rd2+** (43...Rxh3 44.Rxf7+-) **44.Ke4?** **"**Whoa Nellie. Did I just get a draw, again? I only see the win of the e-pawn." (Schwetke)

44.Ke5! Re2+ 45.Kf6 Rxe6+ 46.Kg7+- was winning due to White's very active pieces.

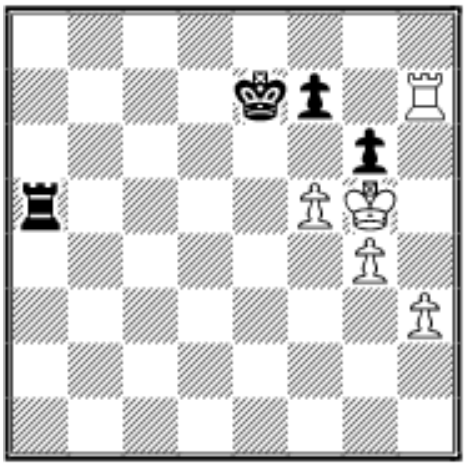
44...Re2+! 45.Kf3 Rxe6



"Now I offered a draw as I did not see the following manoeuvre. Not playing 34...h5 kills me here." (Schwetke) **46.Rb8+! Ke7 47.Rh8 Ra6 48.Rxh7 Ra3+ 49.Kf2**



49...Ra2+? Activating White's king is a big mistake. 49...Kf8 draws relatively easy. **50.Kg3 Ra3+?! 51.Kh4 Ra4?! 52.Kg5** After several Black inaccuracies is in deep trouble again. **52...Ra5+ 53.f5**



53...Rb5? 53...Kf8! was called for, e.g., 54.Kh4 gxf5 55.Rh5 Kg7 56.Rxf5 Ra3=

54.h4

54.Rh8 gxf5 55.gxf5 Rb3 56.f6+ Kd7 57.h4 Rg3+ 58.Kf4 Rh3 59.Kg4 Rh1 60.Ra8 Rg1+ and Black should be able to save the game.

54...Ra5?!

54...gxf5!? 55.gxf5 Rb1 (Schwetke) is more to the point.

55.Rh8 gxf5 56.gxf5 f6+??

Schwetke comments: “Fritz gives "the position was bad, and this mistake simply hastens the end. [Doug made a blundercheck with Fritz. Giving Fritz 10 seconds per move to find errors and comments on the play. KM] I actually think it clever. It allows my king access to the corner of the board and there is the theoretical possibility of the draw. during the game I thought I had read somewhere that R+h and f pawns vs rook can be a draw.”

This misses the point: 56...f6+?? is a losing blunder as the resulting ending with h- and f-pawn is lost. Black's position was still tenable:

56...Ra1! 57.f6+ Kd7 58.Rb8 Rg1+ 59.Kh6 Rg6+ 60.Kh7 Rxf6 61.h5 Rf4

A) 62.h6 Ke7 *(62...Rg4? 63.Rg8 f5 64.Rg6+-)* 63.Rb7+ Kf8=

B) 62.Kg7 Ke7 63.Rb7+ Ke8 64.h6 Rg4+ 65.Kh8 f5 66.Rg7 Kf8=

57.Kg6 Ra1 58.Rh7+ Kf8 59.Kxf6



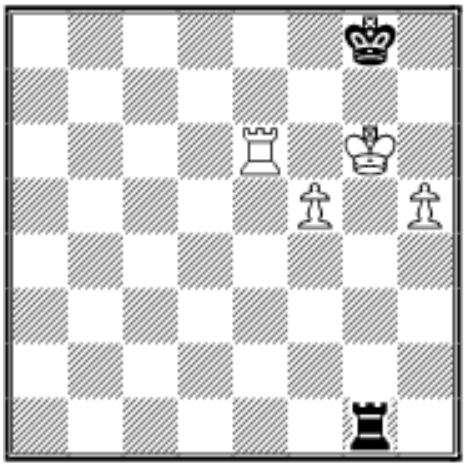
This endgame is lost because Black's king is passively confined to the 8th rank.

59...Ra6+ 60.Kg5 Kg8 61.Re7 Ra1 62.Kf6

One road to victory is 62.h5 Rg1+ *(62...Ra6 63.h6 Rb6 64.f6 Rb1 65.h7+ Kh8 66.Re8+ Kxh7 67.f7+-; 62...Ra2 63.Kg6 Rg2+ 64.Kf6 Ra2 65.Re8+ Kh7*

66.Kf7 Ra7+ 67.Kf8 Ra6 68.Re7+ Kh8 69.Re6 Ra8+ 70.Re8 Ra6 71.Kf7+ Kh7 72.f6+-) 63.Kf6 Rh1 64.Re8+ Kh7 65.Kf7 Rxh5 66.f6 Ra5 67.Kf8 Kg6 68.f7 Ra7 69.Re6+ Kh7 70.Re1 Ra8+ 71.Ke7 Ra7+ 72.Kf6 Ra6+ 73.Re6 Ra8 74.Re8+-

62...Rh1?! 63.Kg5?! 63.Re8+ "makes it even easier for White" (Schwetke) 63...Kh7 64.Kf7+- **63...Ra1 64.h5 Ra6 65.Re6?!** 65.f6 Ra1 66.h6+- was much easier. **65...Ra1 66.Kg6 Rg1+**



67.Kh6? (67.Kf6+- was the correct way to proceed.) **67...Rg7??** (67...Kf7! 68.Rg6 Rf1 69.Kg5 Rg1+ 70.Kh6 Rf1 71.Rg5 Kf6 72.Rg8 Kf7=)

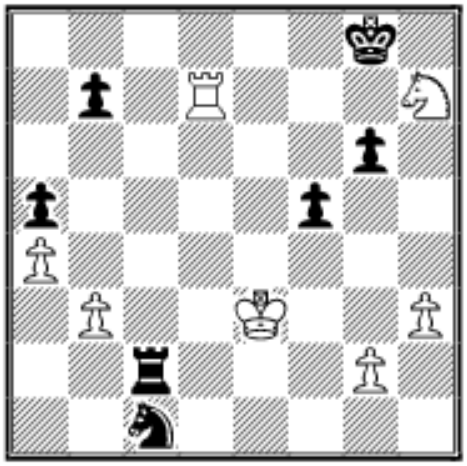
Schwetke expains his blunder as follows: "Fritz says 'the final mistake, not that it matters anymore.' Why did I make this move? I was delusional with hunger is the best excuse for cracking under pressure. Please notice my lack of endgame game skills has hurt me three times in this game. That is why this game is so important to my chess education. Sometimes lacking skills makes my games go on longer than they should. You would think a lack of skills would shorten your games. I am frequently the Last Man 'playing' in my games."

Thank you, Doug for allowing me to use your game and open comments in my column!

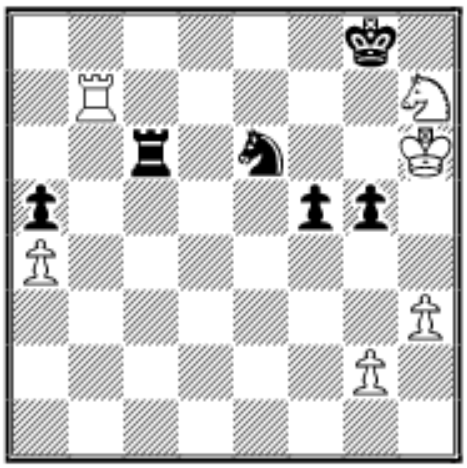
68.Re8+ Kf7 1-0 and Black resigned due to **69.Re7+ Kxe7 70.Kxg7+-** with an easily won pawn ending.

The next example shows an attack with very reduced material:

18.02 *E.Berg* (2500) - *H.Kallio* (2522) GM-B Bermuda 2002



White's king advances to support his attacking forces: **32.Kf4!? Nxb3?** (32...Rxg2 is better, e.g., 33.Ke5 Nd3+ 34.Kf6 Nc5 35.Rg7+ Kh8 36.Rc7 Ne4+ 37.Ke5 b6 38.Nf6 Nxf6 39.Kxf6 Rg3 40.Rc8+ Kh7 41.Rc7+ Kh6 42.Rc8=) **33.Kg5 Nc5!** (33...Rxg2+? 34.Kh6 Rg3 35.Rg7+ Kh8 36.h4 Rg4 37.Nf6 Rxh4+ 38.Kxg6+-) **34.Re7 Ne6+!** (34...Rxg2+? 35.Kh6 Rg3 36.Rg7+ Kh8 37.h4 Ne6 38.Re7+-) **35.Kh6** (35.Rxe6 Kxh7 36.Re7+ Kg8 37.Kxg6 Rxg2+ 38.Kxf5 is drawn.) **35...Rc6 36.Rxb7 g5**

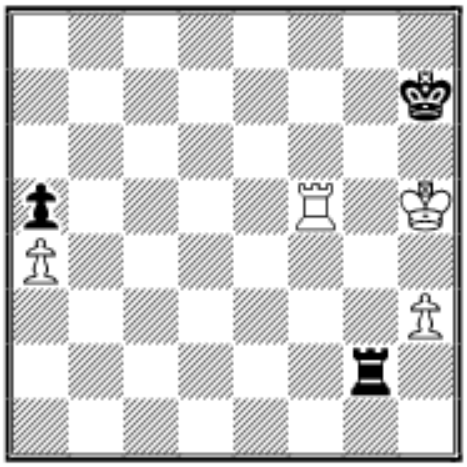


White's attack is very dangerous now. But it appears that Black can still fight very tenaciously.

37.Rb8+?!

37.Nf6+!? gives more chances in my opinion as the game leads to a pure rook ending, where White's winning potential is very reduced: 37...Kf8 38.Ra7 g4 39.hxg4 fxg4 40.g3

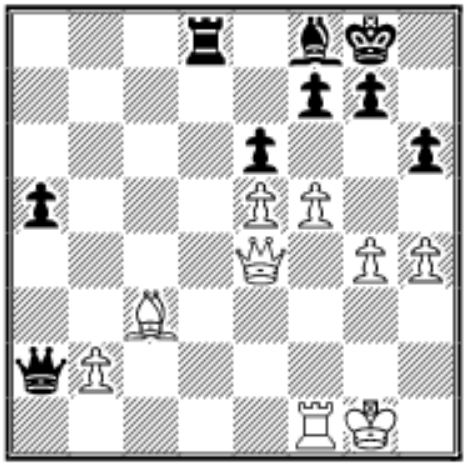
37...Nf8+! 38.Kxg5 Kxh7 39.Rxf8 Rg6+ 40.Kh5 Rh6+ 41.Kg5 Rg6+ 42.Kf4 Rxg2 43.Rxf5 Rf2+ 44.Kg5 Rg2+ 45.Kh5 1-0



and Black resigned as he loses the a-pawn. But the position is drawn nevertheless: **45...Rc2 46.Rxa5 Rc4** and **White's rook can't leave the a-file (this technique is worth knowing**!), e.g. **47.h4 Kg7 48.Ra7+ Kg8 49.Kg6 Rc6+ 50.Kf5 Rc4 51.h5 Kh8 52.Ke6 Kg8 53.Kd5 Rf4 54.Kc5 Rf5+=** see for example *Fundamental Chess Endings* 6.81 on page 200.

In my last example in this column I want to begin with analysis of some very interesting complications that occurred earlier in the game:

18.03 *K.Müller* (2506) - *P.Wells* (2517) Austrian Staatsliga A, Mörbisch 2001, Gleisdorf-Austria Graz, 1st board



Black's position is much easier to play as he has two clear plans:

A) a5-a4-a3 to destroy White's bishop's base and

B) to attack White's very open king position by manoeuvres like Bc5+, Rd3, Qd5 (for the moment the dominant position of White's queen prevents some of them, but this will not be forever).

White's attack on the other hand is not as dangerous as it looks at first sight:

28...a4 (28...Qb3!?) **29.fxe6 Qxe6**

I After 29...Bc5+ one possible continuation is 30.Kh2 fxe6 31.g5 hxg5 32.hxg5 a3 33.Qb7 axb2 34.Qf7+ Kh8 35.Qh5+=

II 29...fxe6 30.g5 hxg5 31.hxg5=

30.Qxa4



30...h5?! The alternatives are more dangerous, but I didn't find a way for Black to win, e.g.,

30...Bc5+ 31.Kh2 Qe7 32.Kg3 Rd3+ 33.Rf3 Rxf3+ 34.Kxf3 Qxh4 35.Qa8+ Kh7 36.Qe4+=

30...Rd3!?

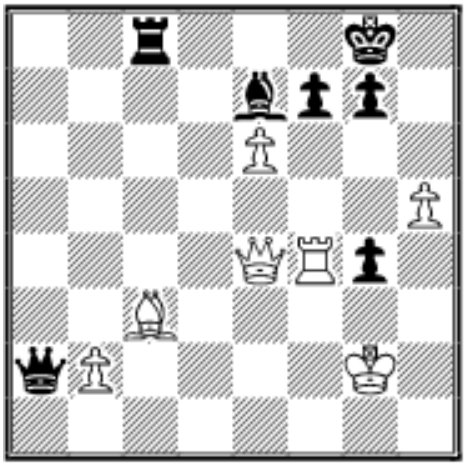
A) 31.Qe4?! Rg3+ 32.Kh2 Rxg4 33.Rf4 Rg6

B) 31.Kg2?! Qd5+ 32.Kh2 Qd8 33.Kg2 *(33.Be1? Rd4 34.Qb3 Qd7 35.Qf3 Rxg4 36.Qf5 Qxf5 37.Rxf5 g6 38.Rf3 Re4* and Black is clearly better.*)* 33...Qxh4 34.Rf3 Rd8

C) 31.Qf4?! Bc5+ 32.Kh2 Qa2

D) 31.Rf4 Qb6+ 32.Kf1 Qe3 33.Rf2 and Fritz says, that the position is equal. But this looks nevertheless very dangerous.

31.Qe4 (31.gxh5? Rd3 32.Qf4 *(32.Kf2 Qb6+ 33.Kg2 Qb7+ 34.Kh2 Qc8–+)* 32...Bc5+ 33.Rf2 Be3 34.Qe4 Qh3 35.Qa8+ Kh7 36.Qe4+ Kh6 37.Qc6+ Kxh5–+) **31...hxg4** (31...Bc5+ 32.Kg2 hxg4 33.Kg3=) **32.Kg2 Be7 33.h5 Rc8 34.Rf4 Qa2?! 35.e6!?**



Setting a trap **35...Qxe6?!** Wells was in time trouble and had to play this and the following moves very quickly.

I 35...fxe6? 36.Bxg7! Qd5 *(36...Kxg7? 37.Qg6+ Kh8 38.Qh6+ Kg8 39.Rxg4+ Kf7 40.Qg6+ Kf8 41.Qg8#)* 37.Bd4+-

II 35...f5! was the right answer: 36.Qd3 *(36.Qxf5 Rxc3=)* 36...Qxe6 37.Qxf5 Qxf5 38.Rxf5 Bf6 39.Bxf6 gxf6 and Black should be able to hold the rook endgame.

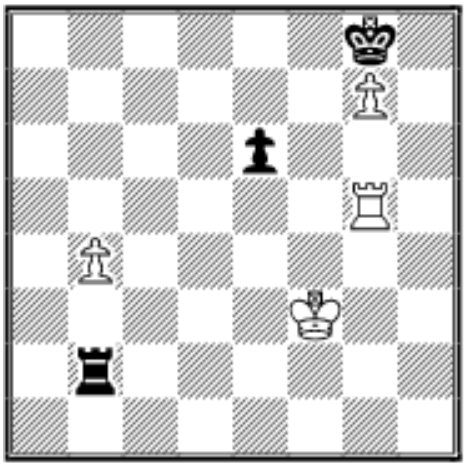
36.Qxe6 fxe6 37.Rxg4 Bf8 38.h6 g5?!

38...g6 39.Rxg6+ Kh7 40.Rxe6 Bxh6 and Black can most probably sacrifice his bishop for White's b-pawn to reach a drawn R+B vs R endgame.

39.Rxg5+ Kh7 40.Bg7 Rc2+

The pawn endgame after 40...Bxg7? 41.hxg7 Rg8 42.b4 Rxg7 43.Rxg7+ Kxg7 is lost as Black's king is outside the square of the b-pawn.

41.Kf3 Bxg7? The resulting rook endgame is lost due to White's dangerous outside passed b-pawn. Something like 41...Bd6 had to be tried. **42.hxg7 Kg8 43.b4 Rb2**



44.Rg4! White needs time to transfer his king to the queenside to support the passed b-pawn. The hasty 44.b5? spoils it: 44...e5 45.Rxe5 Kxg7 46.Ke4 Kf6= **44...Rb3+ 45.Ke2 e5 46.Kd2 e4** (46...Rf3 47.Kc2 Rf7 48.Kd3 Rb7 49.Kc4 Re7 50.Kd5 Re8 51.Re4 Kxg7 52.Rxe5 Rb8 53.Re4 Kf6 54.Kc6 Kf5 55.Rh4 Ke6 56.b5+-) **47.Rxe4 Kxg7 48.Rf4 Kg6 49.Kc2 Re3 50.b5 Kg5 51.Rb4 Kf5 52.b6 Re8 53.b7 Rb8 54.Kb3 1-0** and Black resigned due to **54...Ke6 55.Ka4 Kd6 56.Ka5 Kc5 57.Rb1 Kc6 58.Ka6 Kc7 59.Ka7+-**

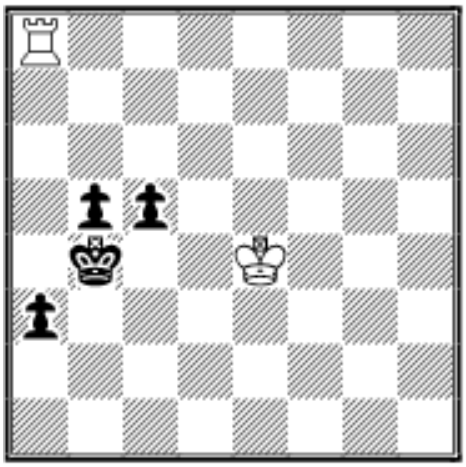
Sources:

Fundamental Chess Endings, Karsten Müller and Frank Lamprecht, GAMBIT 2001

ChessBase MEGABASE 2001

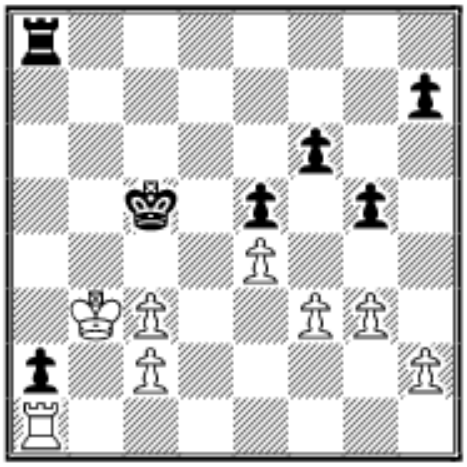
The Week in Chess

Exercises (Solutions next month)



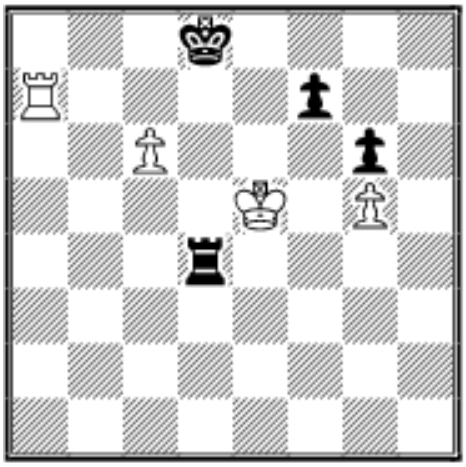
E18.01 *J.Loifenfeld* (2400) - *A.Illner* (2309)
2nd Bundesliga West, Germany 2000

Can White to move save himself?



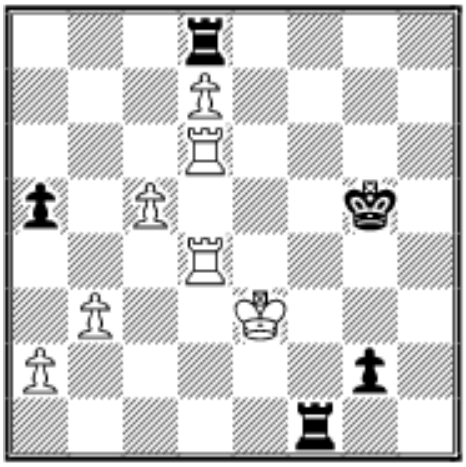
E18.02 *H.Hebbinghaus* - *T.Heinemann*
Northern German Blitz Team Championship Potsdam 2002

In a blitz game White took the pawn with 1.Rxa2. Was this a fortunate choice?



E18.03 *R.Polzin* (2469) - *E.Brestian* (2428) Austrian Staatsliga A, Graz 2002, Gleisdorf-Gamlitz, 2nd board

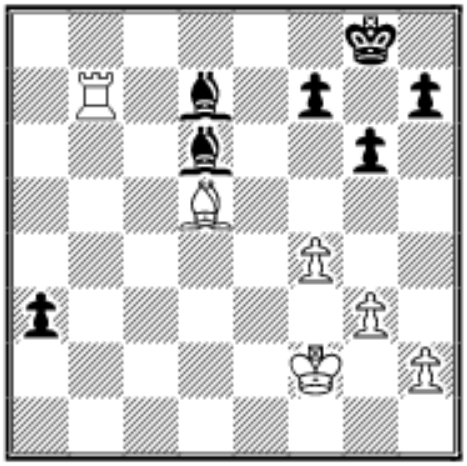
The position looks dangerous for Black. What should he do?



E18.04 *V.Anand* (2794) - *A.Shirov* (2722) Leon Man+Comp 2001

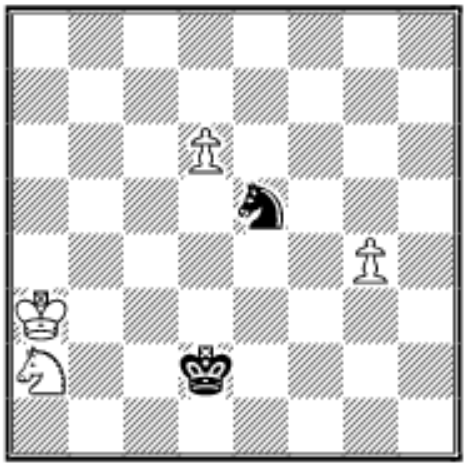
White to move and win.

Solutions to last month exercises



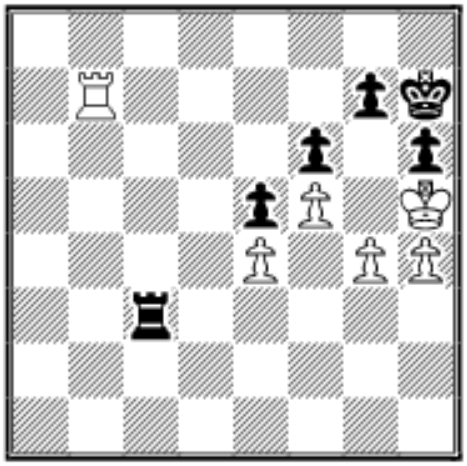
E17.01 *A.Feuerstein - E.Mednis* U.S. Championship, New York 1957

Mednis played the amazing **43...Bc6!! 0-1** and White resigned as he loses after **44.Bxc6** (44.Bxf7+ Kf8 45.Ra7 Bc5+–+; 44.Rxf7 Bxd5 45.Rd7 a2–+) **44...a2 45.Rd7 a1Q 46.Rxd6 Qa7+ 47.Kg2 Qc7 48.Rf6 Kg7–+**



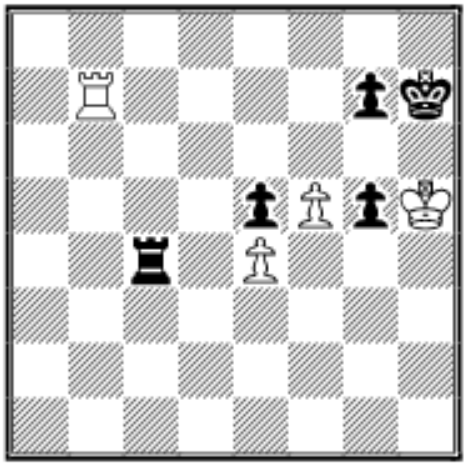
E17.02 *W.Müller, K.Müller*

White wins by avoiding nasty checks with **1.Kb3!** (1.Kb4? Ke3 2.g5 Kf4 3.g6 Nxg6 4.d7 Ne5=; 1.Ka4? Nc4 2.d7 Nb6+=) **1...Ke3 2.g5 Kf4 3.g6 Nxg6 4.d7 Ne5 5.d8Q+-**



E17.03 *O.Meyer - S.Puttfarken* Hamburg youth championship under 12, Schönhagen 2002

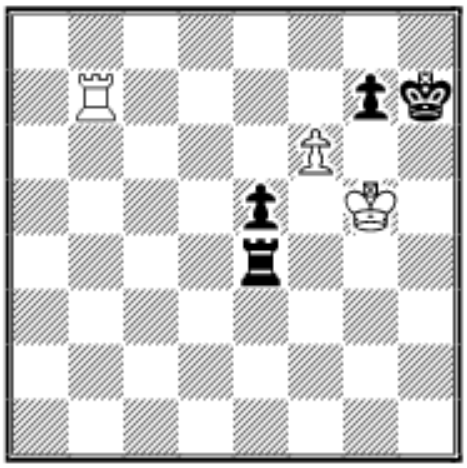
I want to thank Jeronimo Hawellek from Hamburg for allowing me to use his analysis of this instructive rook ending. The two very young players made several mistakes and **44...Rc4?** was the first of them. 44...Rg3= or 44...Rh3= would have drawn. **45.g5!** Threatening back rank mate. **45...hxg5 46.hxg5 fxg5**



47.Kxg5? I found the correct way to proceed in the post mortem analysis: 47.f6!!

A) 47...Rc8 48.Rxg7+ Kh8 49.Kg6 Rc6 *(49...Rg8 50.Rxg8+ Kxg8 51.Kxg5+-)* 50.Rd7 Rc8 51.Rh7+ Kg8 52.f7+ Kf8 53.Rh8++-

B) 47...Rxe4 48.Rxg7+ Kh8 49.Kg6 Rd4 50.Rh7+ Kg8 51.f7++- The pawns on e5 and g5 hinder Black. White shall not take these shields for his king! **47...Rxe4 48.f6**



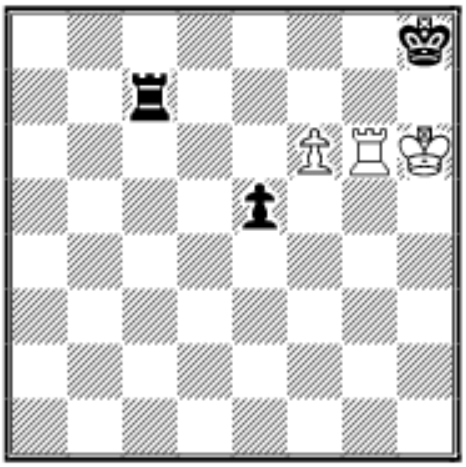
48...Rc4? Black had to play 48...Kg8! 49.Rxg7+ *(49.fxg7 Re1=)* 49...Kf8 50.Ra7 *(50.Kf5 Ra4 51.Rd7 Ra1=)* 50...Re1 51.Kf5 Rb1= and Black's rook can deliver a check against Ke6 and Kg6. **49.Rxg7+ Kh8 50.Kh6 Rc6**

50...Rh4+ 51.Kg6

A) 51...e4 52.Re7 Rg4+ 53.Kf7 Kh7 54.Ke8+ Kg6 55.f7 *(55.Rg7+? Kxf6 56.Rxg4 Kf5=)* 55...Rf4 56.f8Q Rxf8+ 57.Kxf8 Kf5 58.Kf7 Kf4 59.Ke6 e3 60.Kd5 Kf3 61.Kd4 e2 62.Kd3+-

B) 51...Rg4+ 52.Kf7 Ra4 53.Rg1 Ra7+ 54.Kg6 Kg8 55.Rb1 Ra8 56.Rb7+-

51.Rg6 (51.Kg6+-) **51...Rc7**



52.Rg5? A mistake allowing White to use a stalemate defence. White's rook had to move farther south.

I 52.Kg5? e4 53.Rh6+ Kg8 54.Kg6 e3 55.Rh4 e2 56.Re4 e1Q 57.Rxe1 Rg7+=

II 52.Rg1! e4 *(52...Rh7+ 53.Kg6 Kg8 54.Rd1 Rf7 55.Rd8+ Rf8 56.f7++-)* 53.Rd1 Kg8 54.Kg6 Rc8 55.Rd7 e3 56.Rg7+ Kh8 57.Rh7+ Kg8 58.f7++-

52...e4?

52...Rh7+! 53.Kg6 Kg8 54.Rxe5 *(54.Rg1 Rh2 55.Ra1 Rg2+ 56.Kf5 Rb2=)* 54...Rg7+= as 55.fxg7 is stalemate.

53.Rf5? (53.Kg6 Kg8 54.Re5+-) **53...Kg8 54.Re5 Rc4?** (54...Kf7 55.Kg5 e3=) **55.Kg6 Rc8 56.Rxe4 Kf8 57.Rh4! Kg8 58.f7+ 1–0**

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